PeaceRep
Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform

NEWS AND IMPACT / DRAFT COMPENDIUM

News through the years

A full-text chronological record, with selected stories for editorial review.

> **Editorial draft.** Story types are proposed classifications. Highlight choices, impact claims, image rights and credits need review before this document is shared with funders.

Saved News archive: 28 October 2026 · 172 full-text posts · 2018–2026

Contents

2026

2025

2024

2023

2022

2021

2020

2019

2018

Selected stories for editorial review

These posts are possible starting points for impact stories. Their selection and any claims about outcomes require evidence and editorial approval.

2021-05-27 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PA-X Data featured in new analysis of ceasefire design and effectiveness

Data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database has been featured in a new analysis of ceasefire design and effectiveness: The Logic of Ceasefires in Civil War.

2022-07-06 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

UN Women report cites PA-X research on local peace processes

PeaceRep welcomes a new report from UN Women on women's participation in local mediation in Iraq, Libya, Syria, and Yemen.

2023-03-08 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

International Women's Day 2023: Digital tools for inclusive peace

We celebrate the contribution of women's rights advocates working for inclusive, sustainable peace around the world, and share digital tools and resources to support this work.

2026-09-10 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PeaceRep research informs expert economic evidence to the ICC

PeaceRep research on predatory peace has been used to support expert economic evidence to the International Criminal Court (ICC) in The Hague in the Abd-Al-Rahman case.

2026

18 stories · Full original text

2026-10-22 / RECOGNITION

Prof Christine Bell recognised in prestigious alumni awards

Professor Emerita Christine Bell has been recognised in the first Cambridge Alumni Awards.

The shortlist highlights the breadth of alumni impact and the different ways people continue to use their Cambridge experience to make a difference.

Prof Bell was recognised in the **Global Achievement Award** category, which recognises alumni whose work has reached far beyond their immediate field, creating lasting impact around the world.

Image: Selwyn College, By Diliff – Own work, CC BY-SA 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons

Prof Bell said:

> "I owe Cambridge my founding legal education, which taught me how to use language to fashion constitutions and laws. This education enabled me to help groups at war to reach agreement. At heart this is a project of finding language which can bridge disagreement and begin to replace violence with politics."

The award commends Prof Bell's global achievements as an academic and mediator, including her work with PeaceRep:

> Prof Bell has worked for over thirty years as an academic and practicing mediator focusing on ending violent conflict. Obtaining a 1st class law degree at Selwyn College Cambridge and an LLM at Harvard Law School, on returning to her native Belfast she became active in human rights advocacy, working to ensure that the peace agreement improved human rights protections. As a lecturer in law, she established negotiation courses taken by many of Northern Ireland's politicians, and helped build the Human Rights Centre at Queen's University Belfast. Later, she established a Transitional Justice Institute at University of Ulster with colleagues.
>
> In 2011, Bell became Professor of Constitutional Law, University of Edinburgh, and has run a PeaceRep project that has produced peace and conflict data that supports groups living in conflict to end it. Alongside her work as an academic, she has been involved in peace negotiations at different stages in countries as varied as Colombia, Indonesia, Papua New Guinea, Ethiopia, Sri Lanka and the Middle East, including as a Mediation Advisor with the United Nations.

Now Professor Emerita of Constitutional Law at Edinburgh Law School, from 2021 – 2026 Prof Bell was the Principal Investigator of the FCDO-funded Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform (PeaceRep) research consortium, which continues to support peace processes around the world. Previously she led PeaceRep's predecessor, the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP), from 2015 – 2021.

The PeaceRep team extends our congratulations to Prof Bell for this well-deserved recognition of her global achievement.

Read the full announcement and shortlist

Read Christine's latest monograph, PeaceTech: Digital Transformation to End Wars

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/10/22/prof-christine-bell-recognised-in-prestigious-alumni-awards/

2026-09-10 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PeaceRep research informs expert economic evidence to the ICC

PeaceRep research on predatory peace has supported expert economic evidence to the International Criminal Court (ICC) in The Hague in the Abd-Al-Rahman case.

Tony Webster, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons

In October 2025, Ali Muhammad Ali Abd-Al-Rahman ('Ali Kushayb') was convicted by the International Criminal Court (ICC) of 27 counts of crimes against humanity and war crimes committed in Darfur, Sudan, between August 2003 and April 2004. He was later sentenced to 20 years' imprisonment.

At a reparations hearing at the ICC on 8 September 2026, Sudans Research Director at the LSE and former PeaceRep researcher Dr Matthew Benson-Strohmayer presented evidence on how reparations can reach some 3.5 million victims of atrocities in Darfur while Sudan is still at war.

Dr Benson-Strohmayer first brought this evidence to ICC Trial Chamber I in June 2026 in a 'friend of the court' (amicus curiae) submission. The submission is based on a joint economic report by Benson-Strohmayer and independent Sudanese expert Tahany Maalla, which draws on survivor-led research to ask not only what reparations are owed, but how they can reach victims now without being captured by the same networks that sustain Sudan's war economy. The filing describes the joint report as 'centrally contributing' to its observations.

The joint report applies Benson-Strohmayer's research on 'predatory peace', produced through PeaceRep, which shows how settlements and external interventions can legitimise wartime extraction by embedding it within formal post-war fiscal orders. The authors' proposed reparations framework is designed to work around – and avoid reproducing – Sudan's predatory political economy, in which war remains profitable. The authors therefore recommend proceeding with reparations during active

conflict, using service-based provision through accountable humanitarian and civic networks with safeguards against capture.

The evidence presented to the Chamber draws on a number of PeaceRep outputs, including *Of Rule Not Revenue: Predation, State-Unbuilding, and Conflict in Sudan and South Sudan, 1821-2023*, for Cambridge University Press; 'Predatory Peace: Fiscal Fragmentation and Coercive Statebuilding in South Sudan and Beyond' in the *Journal of Intervention and Statebuilding*; 'Of Rule Not Revenue: South Sudan's Revenue Complex from Colonial, Rebel, to Independent Rule, 1899 to 2023' in *Comparative Studies in Society and History*; and 'Revenue, Resistance, and Rule: Civic Fiscal Resistance and Statebuilding in Sudan, 1953-2023', revised and resubmitted to *Development and Change*.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/09/10/peacerep-research-informs-expert-economic-evidence-to-the-icc/

2026-08-27 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Digital transformation to end wars: foundational PeaceTech book updated for 2026

Prof Christine Bell's foundational book, Digital Transformation to End Wars, has been updated to a second edition for 2026.

PeaceTech: Digital Transformation to End Wars looks at how digital transformation is being used to support peace and transition processes, at a moment when war is on the rise. This open-access book combines an overview of transformative technologies and their key PeaceTech applications, with an account of how practices of production shape what PeaceTech is and can do.

What's new in the second edition?

Published by Springer Nature Link/Palgrave Macmillan, the new edition is updated with the latest innovations in mobile phone and app technology, geographic information systems, satellite technology, 'peace analytics' (data-analytics in the peacebuilding field), and Artificial Intelligence.

The book illustrates their key peacebuilding applications, such as support to local peacebuilding projects, large-scale 'conflict early warning systems', and peace mediation support, examining also the ethical and moral issues that arise. Notably these include conflict and mediation fragmentation, and the arrival of new forms of Gen-AI. PeaceTech ends with a provocation in the form of a 12-Step Manifesto focused on successful use of digital tools to support peace processes and end wars.

The first edition of PeaceTech was published in 2024 to widespread acclaim from the conflict and mediation communities.

> "Like so many other sectors, peacebuilding is experiencing disruption and opportunities as a result of the digital revolution. Christine Bell's magnificently accessible book walks us through PeaceTech. The book steers a wise path between digital optimism and pessimism and concludes

> with a call for how technology can work more effectively for peace. Highly recommended." — Roger Mac Ginty, Professor in Defence, Development and Diplomacy, Durham University

The book draws on Prof Bell's work as part of the cross-disciplinary PA-X Peace Analytics team, University of Edinburgh, Queen's University of Belfast and St Andrews. This work has pioneered innovative 'peace analytics' data on peace processes. The data has been used by the PA-X team to provide in-time evidence-based support to the mediation, design, and implementation of peace and transition processes globally, with a focus on inclusion.

About Professor Christine Bell

Prof Christine Bell, FBA, FRSE is Professor Emerita of Constitutional Law and Senior Adviser to PeaceRep at the University of Edinburgh. She holds an Honorary Professorship at The Institute for Global Peace, Security and Justice, Queen's University of Belfast. She is a Fellow of both the British Academy and Royal Society of Edinburgh. She is also a distinguished peace process mediator and PeaceTech innovator renowned for her transformative role in global mediation and transition processes. Prof Bell has over thirty years of experience in conflict mediation and constitution-drafting including with the United Nations and has advised on international legal and constitutional matters relating to mediation strategies and processes in varied contexts, including in Colombia, Israel/Palestine, Northern Ireland, Bougainville/Papua New Guinea, Sri Lanka, and Ukraine.

Download Digital Transformation to End Wars (open access)

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/08/27/digital-transformation-to-end-wars-updated/

2026-08-11 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

Edinburgh Law School hosts the July 2026 Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship

Photo: Shona McCallum – Beyond Borders Scotland

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship Programme has convened more than 400 women peacebuilders from over 40 conflict-affected countries across the Middle East, Africa, South Asia, Europe, and Latin America since 2017. Run by Beyond Borders Scotland (BBS) in partnership with PeaceRep experts at Edinburgh Law School (ELS) and funded by the Scottish Government, the Fellowship supports women peacebuilders and the critical work they do to end and transform violent and nonviolent conflict.

The July Fellowship welcomed women peacebuilders, researchers, lawyers, humanitarians, and mediators from 11 countries, all of whom drew on their professional and personal experiences as women working for peace and gender equality. During their time at ELS, the Fellows took part in thematic workshops on 'the Women, Peace and Security agenda', 'Inclusive Peacemaking in Contemporary Conflict' and 'Gender and Mediation' led by Senior Research Fellow Laura Wise, drawing on findings from the PeaceRep programme. Fellows also met members of the Scottish Peace Platform, of which BBS and ELS are the joint Secretariat, for a peer-exchange to share experiences from Fellows with members doing related work in Scotland.

Throughout the course of the week, Fellows also discussed and practiced mediation and negotiation, transitional justice, the climate-conflict-gender nexus, and the use of arts as a tool for peacebuilding. Scottish-focused experiences included a meeting at the Scottish Government with Minister for Equalities and International Development Simita Kumar MSP, Edinburgh's Forgotten Women's Tour, a visit to Traquair House in the Scottish Borders, and a ceilidh!

Senior Research Fellow Laura Wise said, "As conflict escalates around the globe, such spaces of solidarity and exchange are vital for learning from those most experienced in responding to conflict: women peacebuilders. We aim to create a space where Fellows feel comfortable to share their experiences across diverse contexts, and to build relationships with peacebuilding professionals based in Scotland, the rest of the UK, and Ireland. We are grateful to the Scottish Government for their continued funding to support the Fellowship programme, and to Edinburgh Law School for welcoming the Fellows."

Read more about the 1325 Fellowship

Read more about the Scottish Peace Platform

Photo credit: Shona McCallum – Beyond Borders Scotland

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/08/11/edinburgh-law-school-hosts-the-july-2026-women-in-conflict-1325-fellowship/

2026-06-04 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep's data-driven research commended at FCDO funding portfolio launch

PeaceRep's data-driven research has been commended by the UK Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) during a relaunch of the FCDO's funding portfolio.

Members of the PeaceRep team attend the GRTD launch event, 18 May 2026

In a launch event hosted at the British Academy in London on 18 May, FCDO introduced the new Global Research and Technology Development as a single, public-facing portfolio for research and development, streamlining existing research and innovation funding under a new brand. The department's approach will span five thematic areas: climate, food and nature; geopolitics and humanitarian; growth, energy and infrastructure; human development; and technology, gender and inclusion.

As an FCDO-funded research programme, PeaceRep was invited to showcase at the event alongside fellow funded research partners. The PeaceRep team featured a suite of new data reports and key findings based on the PA-X Peace Agreements Database and the MEND Mediation Events and Negotiators Database as an example of the programme's innovative digital approaches to PeaceTech, supporting adaptive management of peace and transition processes.

In his formal remarks during the event, FCDO Chief Scientific Adviser Professor Sir John Edmunds hailed PeaceRep as a prime example of the value of funding data-driven research to tackle shared global challenges.

> "[PA-X is a] quite amazing piece of work looking at the details of every peace process, peace agreement, and ceasefire agreement across the entire world since 1990, from obscure conflicts in Papua New Guinea to the Northern Ireland peace agreement – every single one digitised, analysed, made available for use via computer models so that negotiators can go in pre-warned with a strategy that is more likely to succeed. Quite amazing that we're at that stage of scientific development."

PeaceRep's Data Director, Dr Sanja Badanjak, attended the event and said,

> Showcasing PeaceRep's work at the launch of the FCDO's Global Research and Technology Development portfolio has been an excellent opportunity to better understand how our work fits into and can contribute to the interdisciplinary approaches to solving some of the world's most intractable problems. Research on conflict resolution is just one strand of these efforts, and we are glad to see how our work, combining data-driven insights with country expertise, develops the evidence base in Law and Social Sciences to support diplomatic efforts in navigating the complexity of contemporary peacemaking.

Further reading

PA-X Peace Agreements Database

MEND Mediation Events and Negotiators Database

Peace Agreements in 2025: Insights from the PA-X Database

Gender References in Peace Agreements in 2025: Insights from the PA-X Database

Mediation in 2025: Navigating overlapping conflict systems

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/06/04/peacerep-commended-at-fcdo-funding-portfolio-launch/

2026-05-19 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

PeaceRep collaborator Adeng Andrew Malual Leek appointed to South Sudan ministry

PeaceRep collaborator Adeng Andrew Malual Leek has been appointed Undersecretary in South Sudan's National Ministry of Gender, Child and Social Welfare. PeaceRep warmly congratulates Adeng on her appointment.

Adeng Andrew Malual Leek pictured with PeaceRep colleague Jan Pospisil in March 2026

Adeng has contributed to several PeaceRep events and panel discussions linked to the South Sudan Public Perceptions of Peace Survey in Juba. Most recently, she participated in the PeaceRep closing event in Edinburgh in March 2026.

A Chevening Fellow, Adeng is currently completing a Master's degree in International Human Rights Law at the University of Sussex. Her appointment took her by surprise, yet it reflects her long-standing record of engagement in women's rights advocacy and civil

society activism in South Sudan, as well as extensive experience in peacebuilding programme management across both national and international organisations.

With teaching at Sussex already completed for the academic year, Adeng is able to assume her new role in Juba while continuing toward the completion of her degree programme.

Read more about the Perceptions of Peace Survey

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/05/19/adeng-andrew-malual-leek-appointed-to-south-sudan-ministry/

2026-05-13 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New data reports highlight the changing nature of peacemaking

PeaceRep has released three new data reports revealing global trends in mediation and peacemaking practice in 2025.

South Sudan's delegates sign a peace deal to end the civil war, in Khartoum on August 30, 2018. (Getty Images)

The reports offer a unique way for users to engage with the extensive data in the latest versions of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database and the Mediation Event and Negotiators Database (MEND) database, offering key global insights at a glance.

Two new policy briefs also present headline key findings from PA-X and MEND to support policy and practice.

Changing peacemaking practice: PA-X findings
In 2025, PA-X researchers recorded 63 new formal and written peace agreements in Version 10 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. The new PA-X data report explores global insights into peace agreements signed in 2025, their characteristics, analysis of the agreement contents and key topics, as well as data on gender provisions in peace agreements and local agreements.

The research finds that peace agreements are becoming fewer, more fragmented, and increasingly internationalised. Since 1990, there have been over 2,200 formal, written, publicly available peace agreements across more than 180 peace processes. Most relate to conflicts within states, but the landscape of peacemaking has changed.

Formal, structured peace processes are no longer the norm; agreements are shorter and less ambitious, with fewer human rights and democratic transition provisions. Contemporary peacemaking increasingly operates through fragmented and "multimediation" environments involving multiple actors, tracks, and negotiation spaces.

Gender references in peace agreements: PA-X Gender Findings
This data report looks specifically at agreements included in PA-X Gender, which tracks the presence of any references to women, girls, gender or sexual violence.

The research finds that in 2025, 10 of the 54 peace agreements (19%) published on PA-X include at least one provision referencing women, girls, gender or sexual violence (excluding local agreements). This is a slight decrease compared to agreements in 2024 (23%) – a share that was heavily driven by gender-inclusive peace processes in Colombia – and identical to 2023 (19%).

Read the full PA-X data reports:

Peace Agreements in 2025: Insights from the PA-X Database

Gender References in Peace Agreements in 2025

Browse the headline findings:

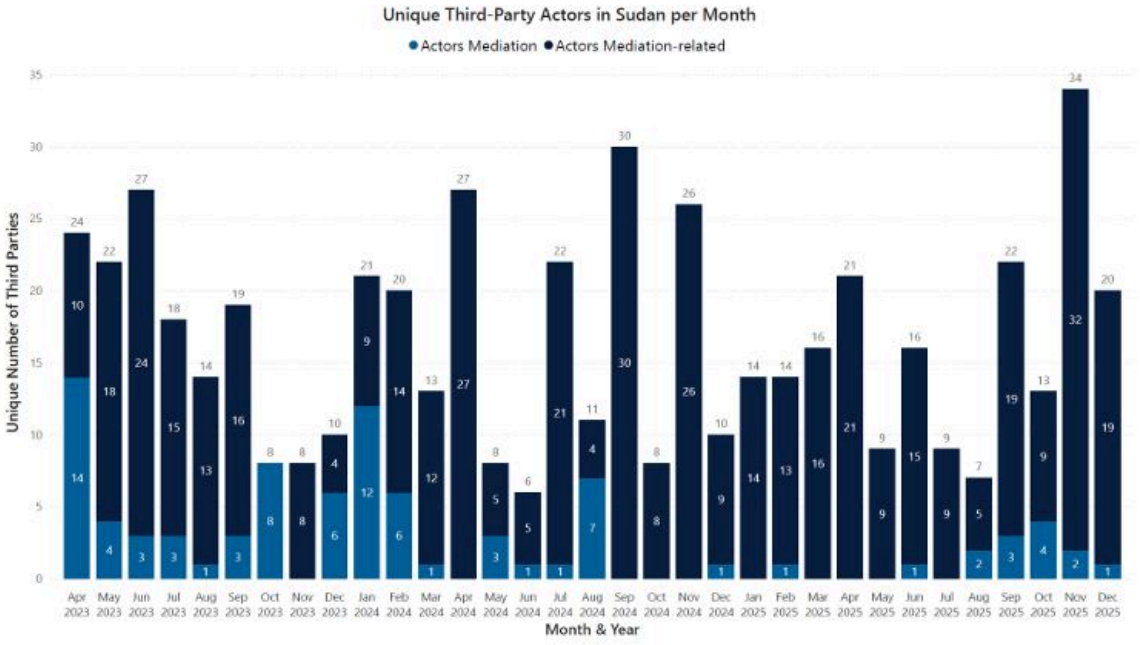
Changing Peacemaking Practice: PA-X Key Findings

Current trends in mediation: MEND findings

Mediation in 2025 reached an inflection point, with interstate mediation increasingly embedded within internationalised intrastate conflicts rather than operating as a standalone diplomatic tool. Such mediation activity increasingly reflected not discrete wars, but overlapping conflict systems characterised by escalation of risks, regional spillover, and multi-actor entanglement.

Drawing on the second release of the Mediation Event and Negotiators Database (MEND), the new MEND data report analyses 1,344 mediation and mediation-related events across eight conflict affected contexts: Israel, Syria, Sudan, Libya, South Sudan, Yemen, Afghanistan, and Mali. The report offers key findings and recommendations designed to support peacemaking and mediation policy and practice.

One trend highlighted in the report is a congestion of mediators in geopoliticised environments, as the image below shows for Sudan. More actors now possess the capacity to influence conflict management than at any point in the past, including states, international organisations, NGOs, and private actors.



Read the full MEND data report:

Mediation in 2025: Navigating overlapping conflict systems

Browse the headline findings:

Current Trends in Mediation: MEND Key Findings

About PA-X
As a cornerstone of PeaceRep's PeaceTech work, the PA-X Peace Agreements Database is the world's most comprehensive collection of peace agreements. PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools to support research, policy and practice, including visualisations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

Explore PA-X

About MEND

MEND offers a comprehensive record of peacemaking efforts within major armed conflicts, systematically tracking all mediation and mediation-related events involving external third-party actors—regardless of whether these efforts result in formal peace agreements.

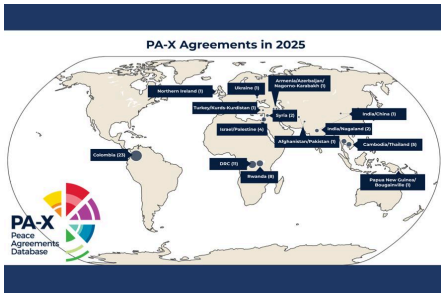
Explore MEND

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/05/13/new-data-reports-highlight-the-changing-nature-of-peacemaking/

2026-04-13 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PA-X Peace Agreement Database and Dataset now updated to Version 10

Introducing PA-X Version 10



The PA-X Peace Agreement Database and Dataset, available at www.peaceagreements.org, has been updated and is now current up to the end of 2025, containing 2257 agreements. This tenth update to the database brings 113 new peace agreement documents, 63 of which have been signed in 2025. As has been the case in previous data releases, the two PA-X sub-databases, PA-X Gender and PA-X Local, have also been updated, with 30 and 18 agreements, respectively.

Of the 63 new agreements in 2025, 30 have come from the several peace processes in Colombia, continuing the fraught Total Peace initiative in Colombia. The second most-prolific setting for peace agreements in 2025 has been Eastern DRC, where 11 new formal agreements have been signed in 2025: eight of those have been signed by DRC and Rwanda, and three have been signed by DRC and Alliance Fleuve Congo/March 23 Movement (AFC/M23). The collection of 2025 agreements also includes five agreements between Thailand and Cambodia and four agreements related to Gaza, among others.

About PA-X

PA-X is a rigorously curated and searchable dataset of peace agreements from over 170 peace processes worldwide, covering the period from 1990 to 2025. It includes:

- Full-text PDFs of agreements
- An English-language corpus, translated by experts in law and regional studies
- A human-coded dataset capturing 230 substantive categories related to peace processes
- Additional datasets including PA-X Gender, PA-X Local, and the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreements Dataset.

PA-X supports research, policy, and practice through a suite of digital tools, including visualizations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

Explore Version 10 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database here

Discover PeaceRep's range of PeaceTech tools

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/04/13/pa-x-now-updated/

2026-03-23 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

House of Commons Report on Women, Peace and Security Cites PeaceRep Evidence

In 2025, the cross-party committee of MPs issued a call for evidence on how the WPS agenda is being incorporated into UK aid programmes, amid plans for the UK's aid budget to be cut to 0.3% of GNI by 2027.

PeaceRep's submission to the inquiry set out contemporary challenges in global WPS adherence and used data from the PA-X Gender database to outline recent trends in gender provisions in peace agreements. The submission suggested ways of assessing the UK's progress in meeting its 2023 NAP commitments to inclusive peace processes, with an emphasis on the importance of robust and transparent data collection for monitoring and evaluation. The UK NAP is currently being refreshed, with publication of a revised NAP expected in spring 2026.

Photo by Iuliia Bondar via Getty Images

The IDC report finds that "while the UK has made commendable commitments to advancing and upholding the WPS agenda, it has frequently been failing to deliver on these."

PeaceRep's written submission draws on the expertise of lead author Laura Wise, PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow, with input from co-authors Allyson Doby, PeaceRep Communications Manager, and Robert Wilson, PeaceRep Research Fellow and Policy Coordinator.

PeaceRep lead author, Laura Wise, said:

> The IDC report rightly highlights the gaps between the UK government's rhetoric and its actions when it comes to advancing the WPS agenda. Despite claiming to be a "global leader" on WPS, the IDC inquiry and subsequent report demonstrates countless mechanisms, platforms, and opportunities through which the UK is falling short of this ambition, at a time when women's rights and gender equality are facing unprecedented threats. As a WPS data provider, we particularly welcome the Committee's findings and recommendations on the need for more robust monitoring and evaluation of the NAP, recognising the importance of systematic and transparent reporting for holding governments accountable for their actions.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/03/23/house-of-commons-report-on-women-peace-and-security-cites-peacerep-evidence/

2026-03-18 / EVENTS HELD

Time to Make a Change: PeaceRep Hosts Closing Events

On 11–12 March 2026, PeaceRep hosted a series of closing events marking the culmination of five years of research on reimagining peace processes in a fragmented world.

Since 2021, the programme has provided thought leadership and data-driven evidence to inform adaptive management of peace and transition processes. As PeaceRep approaches the end of programme funding in 2027, the events highlighted PeaceRep's core research findings and implications for policy, practice, and academia.

The events opened with a workshop on fiscal and monetary governance hosted by Deval Desai and Ed Laws. Policymakers, practitioners and scholars examined how fiscal and monetary governance interact with fragility and conflict, and how political analysis can more effectively inform policy and practice in these settings.

A second workshop convened policy stakeholders to discuss PeaceRep's multimediation concept and apply it to the current conflict and peacemaking environment in Sudan. Participants generated practical recommendations for conflict stakeholders in Sudan as well as feedback for the further development and operationalisation of the multimediation concept.

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

Finally, PeaceRep brought together researchers, PeaceTech developers, mediators, and policymakers for PeaceRep's final conference: 'Time to Make a Change: Reimagining Peace Processes in a Fragmented World'.

The full-day conference marked the culmination of five years of research across the PeaceRep consortium, offering a space for interdisciplinary discussion on contemporary peace and transition processes – and what needs to change to advance conflict resolution.

Breakout sessions allowed for focused discussion on country-specific conflict resolution in Sudan, Syria and Ukraine, while panels explored a range of themes, including:

- New perspectives on contemporary conflicts and peace processes
- Multimediation and fragmentation research and impact
- Mediation futures and PeaceTech

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

In today's increasingly complex and fragmented global landscape, the event provided an opportunity to share insights, reflect on PeaceRep's research and impact, and consider the future of peace processes. Throughout the day, a common theme re-emerged: hope.

Tim Epple, PeaceRep Managing Director, said:

> The way we have come together over the years across ten institutions makes me hopeful that we have forged lasting and impactful connections. PeaceRep has truly become something bigger than the sum of its parts, and I am very grateful for each and every one who has been part of this incredible journey. The evidence we have produced and skills we have gained are transferable and help us pave new paths forward. While our efforts to secure long-term funding for peace data will continue, it is fantastic to see colleagues starting new positions and winning research funding that will allow our work to live on in different ways.

We will be sharing key takeaways from the conference in the coming weeks.

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

Photo by Sam Ingram-Sills

What's Next?

March 2026 marks the culmination of five years of research and the final year of collaboration across the PeaceRep research consortium.

From March, PeaceRep will move into a new phase of synthesising our research findings and recommendations for policy and practice, as well as implications for future scholarship, while ensuring the longer-term sustainability of our legacy products including our flagship PA-X Peace Agreements Database and PeaceTech tools.

We extend our thanks to our funder, the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office of the UK Government, and to our consortium partners for their ongoing commitment and dedication to best practice in peace and transition processes: Conciliation Resources, Coventry University, LSE Conflict and Civicness Research Group, LSE Middle East Centre, International IDEA, Queens University Belfast, University of St Andrews, University of Stirling, and the World Peace Foundation at Tufts University.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/03/18/time-to-make-a-change-peacerep-hosts-closing-events/

2026-03-17 / EVENTS HELD

LSE Hosts Major International Conference to Support Research Informed Policymaking

On the 23rd February 2026, the LSE celebrated the conclusion of two research programmes with an international conference bringing academics into dialogue with an esteemed group of policymakers.

The Russo-Ukrainian War and the Future of European Security marked the conclusion of the Ukraine programme of PeaceRep (the Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform, funded by the UK Government) and Investigating Non-Nuclear Deterrence (funded by the Carnegie Corporation of New York), both hosted at the Conflict and Civicness Research Group based in LSE IDEAS, the in-house foreign policy think tank of the LSE.

Photo by Aleksandr Gusev/SOPA Images/LightRocket via Getty Images

Taking place under the Chatham House rule, the conference created a space for discrete, evidence-based discussions among colleagues working in the fields of foreign and security policy, and international development with a particular focus on European security and Ukrainian resilience, recovery and reconstruction. The following governments and institutions were represented among participants: the governments of Ukraine, the United Kingdom, Norway, Germany, Canada, the Netherlands, Finland and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development.

Welcoming attendees, President and Vice Chancellor of the LSE, prof. Larry Kramer said:

> It's hard to overstate the importance of the issues you'll discuss here today. Russia's invasion of Ukraine has transformed the European security landscape... the challenge posed by the war in Ukraine extends beyond levels of defence spending and raises questions about Europe's place in the world, as well as about Europe's capacity to exercise both soft and hard power. For Ukraine, the challenges are deeper and more existential. What kind of nation will Ukraine be after this war finally ends? If getting resources to wage the war has been difficult, how much more difficult will it be to get the resources needed for recovery and reconstruction?

Prof. Mary Kaldor, the Principal Investigator of Investigating Non-Nuclear Deterrence, said:

> One of the themes of the conference was a plea for a more concrete discussion about how to ensure European security in the face of a revanchist Russia and a hostile United States, and for more joined up thinking that addresses the complexity of the treats we face. This needs to integrate conventional defensive capabilities with strong policies targeted to reduce vulnerability to hybrid threats.

Dr. Yulia Markuts, Head of the Center of Public Finance and Governance, Kyiv School of Economics said:

> There is a vital role for the kind of interdisciplinary research presented at the conference in informing global policy making. I've seen this first hand in the work I've been leading on meeting Ukraine's budgetary and fiscal challenges. Not only does this require close coordination

> between the Ukrainian government and National Bank in the sphere of fiscal and monetary policy, but strengths and vulnerabilities in these areas are also shaped by geopolitical and military considerations. It is vital we continue these dialogues among policymakers and academics.

Dr. Luke Cooper, the Director of PeaceRep's Ukraine programme:

> Our programme can be proud of both its scientific accomplishments and the qualitative outcomes we've made to policy making and civic space in Ukraine. Led by our Ukrainian partners, the research has contributed to important innovations like the "Made in Ukraine" industrial policy agenda; has strengthened civic space by bringing local volunteer activists into a national network to share their insights and discuss common challenges; and also played a convening and research support role in the formation of the "People First" human rights coalition. These efforts reflect our approach of building research-policy-practice ecosystems, involving academics, civil society and major stakeholders, working to address global challenges.

A readout of some of the key points is available at the link below:

Readout: the Russo-Ukrainian War and the Future of European Security

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/03/17/lse-hosts-major-international-conference-to-support-research-informed-policymaking/

2026-02-27 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep Researcher Awarded Grant to Study UN Peacekeeping Norms

Photo by GLODY MURHABAZI/AFP via Getty Images

Dr Monalisa Adhikari, a Co-Investigator at PeaceRep, has been awarded a prestigious ESRC New Investigator grant for her project, "Bringing 'Norms' Back Home: Troop Contributing Countries and their domestic engagement with UN Peacekeeping Norms." The £358,000 grant will fund a two-year research project examining how military institutions in countries that contribute troops to UN peacekeeping missions (Troop Contributing Countries, or TCCs) engage with and comply with UN peacekeeping norms.

The project will investigate the incentives and challenges associated with norm compliance in policy and practice from the perspective of domestic military institutions. Partner institutions include the International Centre for Peace Studies in India, the University of Dhaka in Bangladesh, and the Centre for Nepal and Asian Studies in Nepal.

While existing research has shed light on how individual peacekeepers comply with norms during deployments, there is a significant knowledge gap regarding how military institutions in TCCs integrate liberal norms into their legal and policy frameworks and everyday practices. This project addresses this gap by exploring how military institutions in TCCs navigate, socialize, and comply with liberal norms advanced by the UN peacekeeping department.

The project will focus on India, Nepal, and Bangladesh, which are among the highest contributors to UN peacekeeping missions, providing 27.7% of total peacekeeping troops as of January 2025. By generating new evidence on how participation in UN peacekeeping missions impacts and shapes military institutions in TCCs, the project aims to contribute to a deeper understanding of the complex relationships between peacekeeping, norms, and military institutions.

The project will produce a range of academic outputs, including a publicly accessible dataset that documents how laws, decrees, constitutional provisions, internal guidelines, and standards in the three countries reference peacekeeping norms. Dr Adhikari, who leads PeaceRep's Myanmar work, highlighted the instrumental role of PeaceRep research on shaping the project, particularly in adapting research on the agency of conflict-affected states to examine the incentives and agency of countries that contribute troops to UN peacekeeping missions.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/27/peacerep-researcher-awarded-grant-to-study-un-peacekeeping-norms/

2026-02-23 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Iraq Hosts Final Conference: Reframing Iraq

On 14 February 2026, LSE hosted the PeaceRep Iraq Final Conference, "**Reframing Iraq: Power, Politics, and Paths to Inclusion**," marking the conclusion of the five-year PeaceRep Iraq research programme. Led by the LSE Middle East Centre and managed and directed by Kamaran Palani with contributions from Iraq-based researchers, PeaceRep Iraq has spent five years examining peacebuilding, governance, and state-society relations in post-conflict Iraq, funded by UK International Development from the UK Government.

Photo by LSE Middle East Centre

Kamaran Palani, who also organised the conference, reflected on the event's significance:

> This conference not only marked the conclusion of PeaceRep Iraq, but also brought together a diverse group of colleagues to discuss Iraq and key developments across the wider region. Participants travelled to London from Baghdad, Erbil, Sulaymaniyah, Beirut, other parts of the Middle East and the UK, representing leading voices in the field. We were pleased to have created a space for open, inclusive and wide-ranging dialogue on issues relating to Iraq and the broader region.

The event brought together PeaceRep researchers, academic experts, policy practitioners, and government officials across four thematic sessions. The four distinct sessions each addressed a key dimension in Iraq's political, social, and regional landscape. The conference was opened by Katerina Dalacoura, Director of the LSE Middle East Centre, and Mustafa Al-Soufi, Programme Coordinator for PeaceRep Iraq.

Photos by LSE Middle East Centre

Session 1: Power, Persistence, and Political Transformation

Chaired by analyst and researcher Ali Al-Mawlawi, this session examined the durability of Iraq's post-2003 political order, with a focus on the muhasasa system and the factors enabling its persistence despite recurring protest movements and generational change. Speakers Kamaran Palani (LSE Middle East Centre), Zmkan Ali Saleem (University of Sulaimani), and Juline Beaujouan-Marliere (PeaceRep) explored elite bargaining dynamics, opposition strategies, and intra-communal competition, asking: what sustains *muhasasa*, and what pathways exist for reform?

Session 2: Systems Under Strain — Resources, Education, and Humanitarian Transitions

Chaired by Mohammedali Taha, Director of the Media and Communication Unit at the KRG Prime Minister's Office, this session examined the systems shaping Iraq's development prospects. Michael Mason (LSE), Arda Bilgen (LSE Middle East Centre), and Alannah Travers (Queen's University Belfast) addressed water resource management and the UN's shift from humanitarian to development funding. Climate change featured prominently, with speakers highlighting intensifying water shortages, declining river flows, and rising temperatures as defining structural pressures on governance.

Session 3: Iraq in Regional Politics

Chaired by Sir John Jenkins, former British Ambassador to Baghdad and Associate Fellow of Chatham House, this session situated Iraq within the shifting dynamics of Middle Eastern regional politics. Galip Dalay (Chatham House), Bayan Sami Abdul Rahman (Advisor to KRG Prime Minister Masrour Barzani), Kamaran Palani, and journalist and filmmaker Simona Foltyn examined how neighbouring powers — Iran, Turkey, and the Gulf states — and developments such as the regime change in Syria shape Iraq's sovereignty and security. Speakers reflected on how Baghdad might navigate regional fragmentation and assert itself as a sovereign actor shaping its own direction.

Session 4: Bridging Research and Policy for Inclusive Peacebuilding

The closing session, chaired by Michael Mason, brought together researchers and government actors to discuss how evidence-informed research can support inclusive peacebuilding and governance reform in Iraq. Karwan Jamal (KRG Representative to the UK), Mohammad Al-Shumary (Iraqi Ministry of Foreign Affairs), Khogir Wirya (Middle East Research Institute), and Juline Beaujouan-Marliere examined progress more than two decades after regime change and explored how research–policy partnerships can be strengthened to support accountable and resilient governance.

What's Next?

Looking ahead, PeaceRep Iraq will publish research on two important topics in the coming months, both with relevance beyond the context of Iraq. The first examines Iraqis returning from al-Hol camp in Syria and their reintegration into Iraqi society. The second seeks to deepen our understanding of Iraq's power-sharing system, drawing on survey data exploring the perspectives of the country's ethnic and religious minorities. Blogs on both projects are also forthcoming.

March 2026 marks the culmination of five years of research and the final year of collaboration across the PeaceRep research consortium. From March, PeaceRep will move into a new phase of synthesising our research findings and recommendations for policy and practice, as well as implications for future scholarship, while ensuring the longer-term sustainability of our legacy products including our flagship PA-X Peace Agreements Database and PeaceTech tools.

Subscribe to our newsletter for the latest news, publications and blogs.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/23/peacerep-iraq-hosts-final-conference-reframing-iraq/

2026-02-16 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PeaceRep Researcher Hosts Women in Conflict Fellowship

As part of the Scottish Peace Platform, PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow Laura Wise hosted the Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship at Edinburgh Law School from 2–3 February 2026.

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship Programme, which has trained more than 360 women peacebuilders from 40 plus conflict-affected countries across the Middle East, Africa, South Asia, Europe, and Latin America since 2017. Run by Beyond Borders Scotland in partnership with Edinburgh Law School and funded by the Scottish Government, the Fellowship supports women peacebuilders and the critical work they do to end and transform violent and nonviolent conflict.

The February Fellowship welcomed women peacebuilders, researchers, lawyers, humanitarians, and leaders from 11 countries, all of whom drew on their professional and personal experience as women working for peace and gender equality. During their time at Edinburgh Law School, the Fellows took part in thematic workshops on 'the Women, Peace and Security agenda' and 'Inclusive Mediation in Contemporary Conflict' led by Laura, which drew on research from the PeaceRep programme.

Laura, who serves as Senior Advisor and Facilitator for the Fellowship, said, “As always, we feel honoured to be a part of the unique Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship programme, and to meet such incredible women. 2026 looks set to be another challenging year for all those working to advance peace and gender equality, so spaces that enable women peacebuilders to share their experiences from across diverse contexts, is more important than ever. We are grateful to the Scottish Government for their continued funding to support the Fellowship programme.”

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship is based around the principles of UN Security Council Resolution 1325, which ‘reaffirms the role of women in the prevention and resolution of conflict, peace negotiations, peace-building, peacekeeping, humanitarian response and in post-conflict reconstruction, and stresses the importance of their equal participation in all efforts for the promotion of peace and security’.

Read more about the 1325 Fellowship and the Scottish Peace Platform

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/16/peacerep-researcher-hosts-women-in-conflict-fellowship/

2026-02-12 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New PeaceRep Fragmentation Research Published by British Academy and Carnegie Endowment for International Peace

Photo by Thierry Falise/LightRocket via Getty Images

The British Academy and the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace have published new research from the PeaceRep Myanmar team as part of the Global (Dis)Order programme. The programme aims to “provide rigorous, objective, evidence-based analysis of the shifting dynamics of global orders from regional, multidisciplinary, sectoral and temporal perspectives” to support policymakers to navigate new global orders.

In the discussion paper “Peace Process Lite: When global fragmentation meets conflict fragmentation”, Dr Monalisa Adhikari, Dr Jennifer Hodge, and Laura Wise draw on PeaceRep’s Myanmar research, arguing that fragmentation has led to new pragmatic and reductionist forms of conflict resolution, marked by stabilisation, short-termism, ad hoc institutional arrangements, and transactional mediation relationships.

The co-authors suggest that this approach to peacemaking has emerged as an alternative to multilaterally-driven comprehensive peace processes and is contextually defined, localised, regionalised, and adapted, presenting both opportunities and challenges for policymakers and peacebuilders.

The PeaceRep paper is published as part of the volume “Understanding the interlocking shifts, actors and institutions contributing to peace and security today”, which includes papers on UN peacekeeping, Ukraine, Artificial Intelligence, armed groups, and humanitarianism.

Explore the report: Peace Process Lite: When Global Fragmentation Meets Conflict Fragmentation

Read the accompanying blog post: The Global (Dis)Order of Peacemaking in Myanmar

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/12/new-peacerep-fragmentation-research-published-by-british-academy-and-carnegie-endowment-for-international-peace/

2026-02-10 / HIGH-LEVEL VISITS

Chief Scientific Adviser Hails PeaceRep's Data-Driven Research on Visit to Edinburgh

Photo by PeaceRep

As Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) Chief Scientific Adviser, Prof Sir John Edmunds took the opportunity to speak with PeaceRep researchers about data-driven research and methodology.

As a global leader in PeaceTech innovation and peace analytics, PeaceRep showcased our databases and digital tools to support conflict resolution policy and practice. PeaceRep researchers introduced the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world, and demonstrated the PA-X Tracker, our newest tool offering data-driven insights into peace process implementation and monitoring. The delegation discussed how PeaceRep's development of PA-X has contributed to data infrastructure through the development of its ontology, with scope for much broader application.

The CSA commented on the importance of PeaceRep's research and data-driven insights: "The range, depth, and innovation of PeaceRep's work is impressive, and FCDO greatly values this research. Against a backdrop of major geopolitical conflict — in places such as Ukraine, Sudan and Gaza — PeaceRep provides the depth of analysis and clarity that policymakers urgently need. PeaceRep addresses some of the most critical and complex issues in contemporary peace processes and is an invaluable resource."

PeaceRep's Principal Investigator Prof Christine Bell and Managing Director Tim Epple thanked the FCDO for their continued support and funding of PeaceRep's research.

Prof Liz Baggs, Vice-Principal for Research and Innovation at the University of Edinburgh and Prof Alexandra Braun, Lord President Reid Chair of Law at Edinburgh Law School, praised PeaceRep for ongoing contributions to the field of peace and conflict studies and practice. PeaceRep is harnessing data, digital methods, and artificial intelligence for the public good – one of the core missions set out in the University's Research and Innovation Strategy.

About PeaceRep

PeaceRep is an international consortium of research and practitioner organisations led by the University of Edinburgh Law School. PeaceRep's interdisciplinary research examines the major trends and shifts in the post-1990 peace and transition process landscape. We work on comparative research, digital PeaceTech innovation, peace process design and support, and research-led teaching and training. PeaceRep is funded by UK International Development from the UK government from 2021–2027.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/10/chief-scientific-adviser-hails-peacereps-data-driven-research-on-visit-to-edinburgh/

2026-02-09 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Reimagining Peace Processes: PeaceRep to Highlight Research Findings and Recommendations

Since 2021, PeaceRep has been providing thought leadership and data-driven evidence on adaptive management of peace and transition processes, building on the foundations of the Political Settlements Research Programme, led by Edinburgh Law School, and the Conflict Research Programme, led by the London School of Economics and Political Science. PeaceRep set out to reimagine peace and transition processes in a changing geopolitical context, producing data-driven evidence and recommendations on new approaches to peace and transition processes.

Photo by Amir Levy/Getty Images

As our funding draws to a close for our current phase, March 2026 marks the culmination of five years of research and the final year of collaboration across our research consortium. From March, we move into a new phase of synthesising our research findings and recommendations for policy and practice, as well as implications for future scholarship, while ensuring the longer-term sustainability of our legacy products including our flagship PA-X Peace Agreements Database and PeaceTech tools.

Throughout this year, the teams at Edinburgh Law School and the University of St Andrews will consolidate findings across our key thematic and geographic areas.

A suite of synthesis outputs will summarise highlights from our intellectual leadership – including on global fragmentation, multimediation, and PeaceTech data-driven research – and will offer concluding recommendations drawing on five years of data-driven evidence. Our forthcoming suite of key findings on thematic and geographic areas as well as a suite of synthesis articles, reports, and policy briefs will set out our main concepts and contributions to the field, alongside implications for policy and practice.

A programme of events will give policymakers, practitioners, and academics the opportunity to interact with our synthesis work. LSE MEC will host a public event on 14 February on Reframing Iraq: Power, Politics, and Paths to Inclusion, presenting presents five years of field-based research on governance, power, and political transformation in post-2003 Iraq. LSE CCRG will host an end of programme event on its Ukraine project on 23 February and an end of programme Syria conference on 23 and 24 March. Consortium partner International IDEA will host the annual Edinburgh Dialogue on Post-Conflict Constitution Building and Women Constitution-Makers' Dialogue in late 2026. Other events and engagements will be taking place across the consortium by invitation only.

We will provide more information throughout 2026 about how to stay engaged with our work beyond 2027.

Time for a Change: final cross-consortium event

To celebrate five years of research with the full consortium, PeaceRep will host a three-day event in March 2026 highlighting the programme's significant impact and relevance across policy, practice, and academia.

The event will showcase insights from PeaceRep's comparative research into the shifting nature of peace processes in a fragmented conflict landscape, featuring keynote speeches, panel discussions on the programme's key contribution to scholarship, practice, and PeaceTech as well as country-focused workshops where researchers and practitioners will discuss the options for conflict resolution in Myanmar, Sudan, Syria, and Ukraine.

The event is invitation-only and space is limited. If you wish to attend, email peacerep@ed.ac.uk to be added to the waiting list.

A limited number of free spaces are available for PeaceRep's full-day conference on 12 March. Register now to secure your place.

Thanks

We extend our thanks to our funder, the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office of the UK Government, and to our consortium partners for their ongoing commitment and dedication to best practice in peace and transition processes: Conciliation Resources, Coventry University, LSE Conflict and Civicness Research Group, LSE Middle East Centre, International IDEA, Queens University Belfast, University of St Andrews, University of Stirling, and the World Peace Foundation at Tufts University.

PeaceRep is also grateful to the Covid Collective, the Economic and Social Research Council, the Scottish Council on Global Affairs, Scottish Funding Council (ISPF), the British Embassy Yangon, The

University of Edinburgh, and UN Women, for their generous support and collaboration over the last five years.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/02/09/reimagining-peace-processes/

2026-01-06 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New Research Shows Fragmentation Affecting Gender Equality in Peacemaking

Findings from collaboration between PeaceRep and the Scottish Council on Global Affairs reveal impact of fragmentation on the Women, Peace and Security agenda

Photo by JOAQUIN SARMIENTO/AFP via Getty Images

New research published by PeaceRep and the Scottish Council on Global Affairs shows the impacts of global fragmentation and multimediation on the Women, Peace and Security agenda (WPS), particularly on gender equality in peacemaking.

As part of the project 'Women, Peace and Security in the Age of Fragmentation', researchers held an expert hybrid workshop at the University of Edinburgh in October 2025. The workshop brought together a group of individuals at multiple career stages from the worlds of diplomacy, governance, research, policy, practice, and activism to collectively make sense of this current moment in peacemaking, and generate new ideas to respond to a common challenge.

Findings from these deliberations have now been published as a Scottish Council on Global Affairs Insight Report, accompanied by a standalone policy brief containing recommendations for donor governments, gender equality advocates, and WPS actors in peace processes.

The report sets out how global fragmentation manifests through diversified and competing peace processes, and highlights some of the contemporary global crises facing the WPS agenda, including anti-gender backlash, securitisation, and modern technological and climate threats to women and gender minorities. The report identifies new challenges faced by gender advocates in navigating peace processes under fragmentation, such as the side-lining of gender in mediation, splintering women's movements, and funding cuts.

Incorporating a feminist praxis of action and hope, the report also shares some ways that peace and security actors are navigating multimediation to advance gendered perspectives, explores the transformative potentials of inclusive grassroots peacemaking in fragmented conflicts, and suggests some ways to rethink WPS in response to global fragmentation.

Laura Wise, PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow and Principal Investigator of the SCGA project commented:

"The collective workshop and report really show the breadth and depth of the impact that global fragmentation is having on gender equality in peacemaking. The diversification of mediation initiatives is not only engendering new challenges that gender equality advocates now have to confront, but multimediation is also exacerbating longstanding gendered barriers to women and gender minorities participation in peace processes. However, we are encouraged that in the face of

such challenges, gender equality actors are still finding creative and feminist ways to navigate and influence peacemaking, and we hope that the tangible recommendations set out in the report serve as a call to action."

The project has also released a blog post on Women's Leadership in an Era of Multimediation and Fragmentation authored by Salma Yusuf, and a podcast conversation between Kasia Houghton, Laura Wise, and Fiona Campbell.

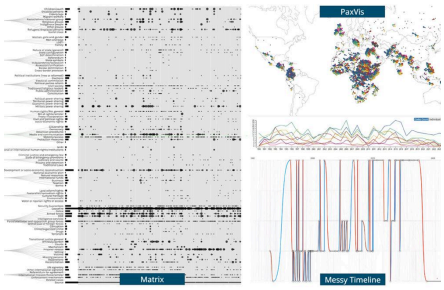
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2026/01/06/new-research-shows-fragmentation-affecting-gender-equality-in-peacemaking/

2025

23 stories · Full original text

2025-12-11 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Showcases Cutting-Edge Research at IEEE VIS 2025 in Vienna



PeaceRep had a strong presence at the IEEE VIS 2025 conference in Vienna – the world's leading conference for scientific visualisation, data visualisation, and visual analytics. Organised by the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), the conference brings together experts in the field from around the world. This year, all three submissions involving PeaceRep were accepted, highlighting the consortium's growing contribution to visualisation research at the intersection of peace, conflict, and data.

PeaceRep's accepted work included:

- A poster and accompanying short paper showcasing PeaceTech visualisation research
- A dedicated workshop on visualising peace and conflict resolution
- A full research paper, co-authored by PeaceRep visualisation researchers, and which received a *Best Paper Honorable Mention*

Poster Exhibition: Visualising Peace and Conflict

[Download the poster and the accompanying paper]

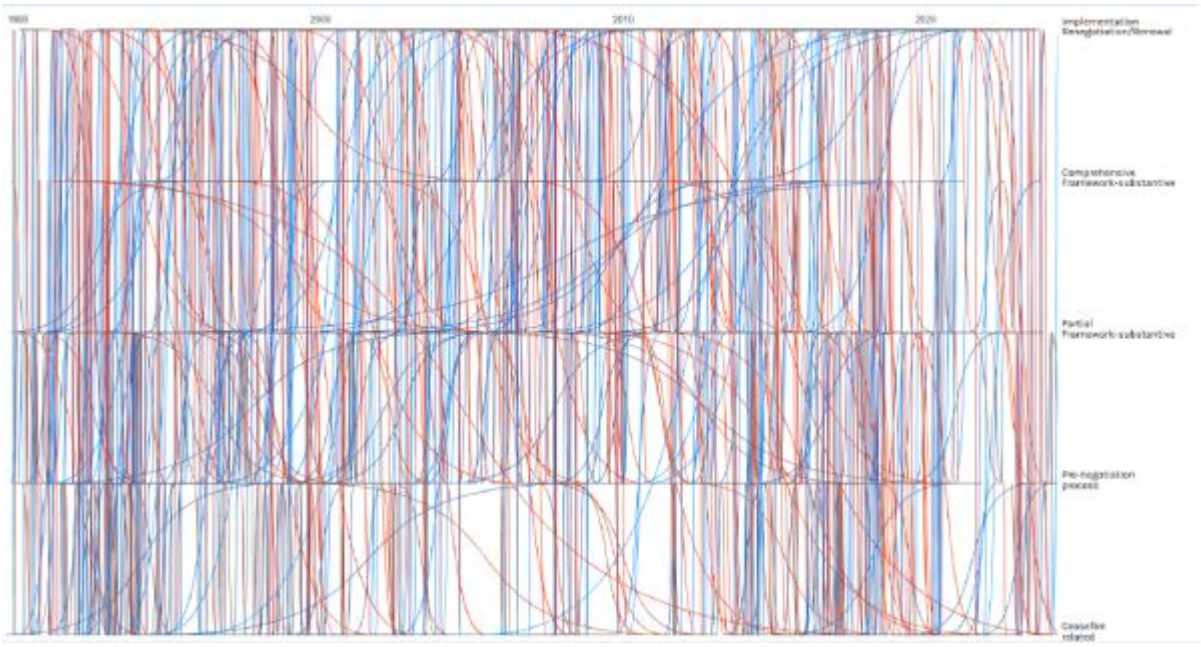
Created collaboratively by current and former PeaceTech researchers at PeaceRep [Tomas Vancisin, Jinrui Wang, Niamh Henry, Sarah Schöttler, Lucy Havens, Tobias Kauer, Sanja Badanjak, Christine Bell, and Benjamin Bach], the poster highlighted PeaceRep's three key approaches to supporting peace mediation through visualisation technology:

1. Analysis
2. Communication
3. Tracking

Featuring nine visualisations, the poster presented an emerging area of research that combines peace and conflict resolution with data visualisation as a way to address humanitarian and societal issues from new perspectives.

The poster drew significant attention throughout the conference. Some attendees were curious how peace and conflict can be represented visually, and what data makes this possible. Others were

impressed by PeaceRep's range of PeaceTech visualisations, and connected the exhibits to their own experiences, emphasising the potential for these tools to engage broader public audiences.



PeaceRep's 'Messy Timeline' was one of the visualisations featured in the poster

Workshop: Bringing Peace and Conflict to VIS4DH

Jan Pospisil at VIS4DH

Two out of seven days at the IEEE VIS conference are dedicated to workshops, including the long-running Visualisation for Digital Humanities (VIS4DH) workshop, now in its ninth year. VIS4DH focuses specifically on the intersection between the humanities and visualisation, and how these two areas of research can be advanced by combining research approaches.

This year, PeaceRep Research Associate Tomas Vancisin served as a co-organiser of VIS4DH and successfully advocated for Peace and Conflict to be the main theme, allowing for this (still relatively new) type of research to have unprecedented visibility within in the global visualisation community.

The VIS4DH team invited Jan Pospisil (Coventry University) to be the keynote speaker in recognition of his expertise and direct experience of gathering data in conflict settings through PeaceRep's

Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan surveys. The keynote attracted a diverse audience from across the VIS and Digital Humanities community, offering a rare insight into data collection and analysis in complex conflict environments.

Award-Winning Paper: Transparency Through Visualisation Badges

PeaceRep researchers also contributed to the paper *The Visualization Badges: Communicating Design and Provenance through Graphical Labels Alongside Visualizations*, authored by Valentin Edelsbrunner, Jinrui Wang (PeaceRep), Alexis Pister, Tomas Vancisin (PeaceRep), Sian Phillips, Min Chen, and Benjamin Bach (PeaceRep).

The paper introduces a new way to make data visualisations clearer and more honest: graphical badges. These badges act like small visual cues placed alongside a chart to communicate important context. They can flag a major finding, indicate when an axis has been truncated, or warn viewers about potential visual artifacts. In doing so, they help visualisation creators explain their analytical and design choices, while also helping readers better interpret what they see.

The framework behind these badges grew out of a series of co-design workshops involving PeaceRep researchers, which shaped both the concept and its practical use. PeaceRep's "Messy Timeline" visualisation was highlighted as an example for discussion, with PeaceRep researchers providing critical assessments of open data principles and uncertainty communication. This example became an important case study for the visualisation badges, and is featured on the badge website.

The project resulted in:

- a catalogue of 132 visualisation badges, including different design options
- multiple categorisation schemes
- real-world visualisation examples
- a set of clear guidelines for implementation

This paper was awarded a "Best Paper Honorable Mention," placing it among the top 5% of all submissions at the conference.

Citations

Edelsbrunner, V., Wang, J., Pister, A., Vancisin, T., Phillips, S., Chen, M., & Bach, B. (2026). Visualization Badges: Communicating Design and Provenance through Graphical Labels Alongside Visualizations. IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics.

[Explore PeaceRep's suite of data visualisation and PeaceTech tools →]

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/12/11/peacerep-showcases-cutting-edge-research-at-ieee-vis-2025-in-vienna/

2025-12-08 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Launching the Series: Syria in Transition: Comparative Lessons and Implications for International Engagement

Photo by Rami Alsayed/NurPhoto via Getty Images

One year after the fall of the Assad regime and the formation of Syria's new government, the country stands at a pivotal juncture. Governance under Syria's new President, Ahmed al-Sharaa, is maintained through a mix of transitional, local, and former opposition authorities, yet institutional capacity and legitimacy remain fragile, and long-standing political and social fractures continue to shape daily life. At the same time, these dynamics are also creating a narrow but meaningful opportunity – that if carefully leveraged – could help shape a transition toward a more inclusive, stable, and representative Syrian state.

To support understanding of these dynamics, PeaceRep's senior researcher Dr Juline Beaujouan and affiliate Rebecca Thompson are launching a new series of policy papers under the umbrella of *Syria in Transition: Comparative Lessons and Implications for International Engagement*. The first document in the series, released today, serves as a general introduction: it maps the transitional landscape, situates Syria's challenges in comparative perspective with Afghanistan, Iraq, and Lebanon, and identifies cross-cutting issues likely to shape the transition in the near term. This introductory framework lays the foundation for the focused policy documents to follow between December 2025 and March 2026, which will cover five main sectors:

- Political governance
- Financial restructuring
- International programming and aid delivery
- Social cohesion
- Conflict resolution and local political settlements

Each policy document will provide four core elements: a concise overview of the legacy of the Assad regime and the 14-year conflict, a situational analysis of Syria today, comparative lessons from transitions in Afghanistan, Iraq, and Lebanon, and a set of policy recommendations. Together, the series provides actionable guidance for international partners aiming to support Syrian-led solutions in a complex and evolving environment.

The series explores the challenges already defining the transition, including rebuilding political and financial governance, navigating hybrid security actors, managing crises and social tensions, and ensuring the meaningful inclusion of minorities, women, and youth. It also examines the pressures of

a difficult global context – shrinking aid budgets, climate shocks, technological disruption, and shifting geopolitics – that further complicate Syria's landscape.

Rather than treating transition as a linear process, the series embraces the "messy timeline" that characterises most peace processes. It recognises that legitimacy is built incrementally, and that informal networks often underpin early stability. The key challenge is to ensure that these early arrangements evolve into transformative, accountable, and representative governance, rather than becoming entrenched in rigid, unaccountable power structures."

By offering targeted analysis and policy-relevant recommendations, this series aims to support international partners in calibrating their approaches at a time when Syria's trajectory is not yet set. The stakes are high not only for Syrians, but for regional stability and the wider international order. In this context, engagement that is reflective, adaptable, and informed by both comparative experience and local realities can make a meaningful difference.

Policy Recommendations

The Syria in Transition policy series highlights five priority areas where Syrian institutions, communities, and their international partners can work together, under Syrian leadership, to support a stable and legitimate transition, summarised here below:

1. Political Governance

- **Strengthen local-national linkages** through structured forums, advisory channels, and regular engagement with local councils, autonomous administrations, and civil society.
- **Improve institutional representation** by adjusting selection and appointment mechanisms, introducing enforceable gender and minority benchmarks, and ensuring participation from currently excluded regions.
- **Lay the groundwork for future elections** through updated census data, strengthened civil registries, voter enrolment (including refugees), and clearer electoral rules.
- **Rebalance executive-legislative authority** by enhancing the new Assembly's budgetary and oversight functions and introducing sunset clauses on transitional powers.
- **Invest in administrative capacity and transparency** by supporting municipal governance, expanding digital tools, publishing laws and budgets, and enabling independent media and civic monitoring.

2. Financial Restructuring

- **Protect financial integrity** through strengthened anti-money laundering (AML) / Counter Terrorist Financing (CTF) systems, clear licensing rules, and safe channels for international finance.
- **Create predictable economic rules** on commercial law, property rights, and data protection to attract responsible investment.
- **Build credible payment systems** by using vetted intermediaries, piloting digital/blockchain tools, and engaging Gulf and diaspora financial hubs.
- **Rebuild regulatory capacity** via Central Bank reforms, anti-corruption mechanisms, and empowered parliamentary oversight.

- **Integrate informal finance** by licensing and gradually linking hawala networks to digital platforms while preserving accessibility.
- **Deliver visible citizen benefits** through reliable salary payments, secure remittance channels, and expanded small and medium-sized enterprises finance.

3. International Programming and Aid Delivery

- **Safeguard civil society independence** with direct multi-year funding.
- **Prevent elite capture** by maintaining diverse aid channels and linking funding to transparency.
- **Balance stabilisation and development**, ensuring continuity from emergency relief to inclusive economic recovery.
- **Avoid parallel systems** by aligning aid with legitimate national and local institutions.
- **Strengthen coordination** through joint donor assessments and a national, independent aid-monitoring platform.
- **Ensure inclusive engagement** by consulting governance actors and communities across regions.

4. Social Cohesion

- **Promote civic, non-sectarian governance** with strong minority protections and public consultation mechanisms.
- **Reinforce local–national coherence** by supporting legitimate local governance and structured multi-level forums.
- **Address economic grievances** through early anti-corruption bodies, cross-community projects, and market harmonisation.
- **Support returns and reintegration** by prioritising HLP rights, documentation, and community mediation.
- **Advance transitional justice** with national consultations, truth-seeking mechanisms, and an inclusive education curriculum.

5. Conflict Resolution & Local Political Settlements

- **Strengthen national–local political linkages** to rebuild trust and reduce political and social fragmentation.
- **Support locally grounded stabilisation** tied clearly to national frameworks.
- **Create incentives for cooperation** through shared service-delivery and inter-regional initiatives.
- **Clarify the transition roadmap** with transparent milestones and inclusive decision-making.
- **Embed conflict sensitivity and early-warning** in all planning.
- **Align international support** with Syrian-led priorities.

To learn more, contact Dr Juline Beaujouan at J.Beaujouan-Marliere@ed.ac.uk.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/12/08/launching-the-series-syria-in-transition/

2025-12-02 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Analysis Finds Russia Likely in Recession Amid Ongoing War Costs

Photo by ALEXANDER NEMENOV/AFP via Getty Images

A new PeaceRep report from LSE IDEAS at the London School of Economics and Political Science concludes that Russia is probably in recession, with its economy now around 1.5% smaller than it was in February 2022.

The paper was produced in partnership with Ukrainian Industry Expertise and provides an in-depth assessment of the current state of the Russian economy. The report is currently a preprint and has not yet been formally published.

As talks aimed at ending the war continue, the report challenges the prevailing view that Russia is in a stronger position, finding that Russia lacks non-inflationary options for financing its government deficit and is dealing with intense inflationary pressures. The authors also question previously reported inflation figures, estimating that the true rate is approximately double the official numbers over the course of the full-scale invasion – which would significantly reduce reported GDP growth.

Russia has run down its sovereign wealth fund reserves to support the war effort, and newly imposed oil sanctions are substantially affecting its capacity to earn external revenue. The conflict has also greatly widened inequality, significantly raising incomes for 20% of the population while leaving the majority worse off.

The report's authors argue that Russia should not be regarded as a "metaphysical entity" uniquely capable of defying the economic constraints it faces.

Dr Volodymyr Vlasiuk, Director of Ukrainian Industry Expertise and one of the report's authors, says:

> It is highly likely that the Russian economy is smaller today than it was in February 2022. Our research shows why the official rate of inflation looks suspect. Our alternative estimate of inflation means that Russian GDP should be downgraded, exposing the significant costs that the war has imposed on the Russian economy and the limits of its use of military Keynesianism.

Dr Luke Cooper, report author and Associate Professorial Research Fellow in International Relations and Director of PeaceRep's Ukraine Programme, says:

> Sanctions are having a cumulative and escalating impact on Russia's ability to finance the war. Russia is in effect having to choose between the wellbeing of the large majority of its population

> that are seeing no benefit from fighting this war of aggression and the regime's imperialist ambitions in Ukraine.
>
> The Kremlin now appears to be walking back some of its goals, like insisting on a Ukrainian withdrawal from Kherson and Zaporizhzhia oblasts, despite its momentum on the battlefield. This may be revealing of these economic challenges. It might be a sign that the regime is cognisant of the costs and risks of the war and believes that its ties to the Trump administration can ensure any deal is structured to favour its interests.

Read the new report: Against the Clock: Why Russia's War Economy is Running Out of Time

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/12/02/analysis-finds-russia-likely-in-recession-amid-ongoing-war-costs/

2025-11-21 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

PeaceRep Sudan Analyst Reacts to Atrocities in El Fasher

Photo by JORIS BOLOMEY/AFP via Getty Images

In October 2025 the city of El Fasher, in Darfur, fell to the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) after 18 months of siege. As the last key government-controlled city in Darfur, the fall of El Fasher left all major cities in Darfur under RSF control.

In a conflict where both the opposing factions of the Sudanese Armed Forces and the RSF have been accused of ethnically targeting groups and committing human rights violations against civilians, there is now mounting evidence of war crimes and crimes against humanity. The IOM reported almost 90,000 people had been forced to leave El Fasher, using extremely unsafe routes, with medical workers reporting atrocities being carried out in El Fasher by the RSF. Thousands remain trapped in the city in need of protection from armed actors and in urgent need of humanitarian supplies. With no access to food, water or medical supplies and with warehouses almost empty, aid convoys are also facing significant challenges in gaining secure access to El Fasher and IDP camps outside the city around Tawilah, where people have been forced to flee.

The fall of El Fasher follows several years of unrest. Sudan's twin transition from armed conflict and authoritarian rule has been stalled since the military coup of October 2021 and the installation of a military junta under General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan. In April 2023, tensions escalated further between al-Burhan and General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo ("Hemedti"), the leader of the RSF, resulting in violent clashes breaking out in Khartoum that signalled the beginning of a devastating war for control of the country. The ongoing conflict has displaced more than 12 million people and exacerbated instability and humanitarian crisis, which is now widely considered to be both the largest displacement crisis recorded and the largest humanitarian crisis on record.

PeaceRep reactions in the media

PeaceRep Sudan analyst Dr Jan Pospisil from Coventry University spoke to France 24 and TRT World about the ongoing situation in El Fasher.

Wider PeaceRep research and data on Sudan

PeaceRep research offers insights into the roots of the war and implications for mediation and humanitarian response. Our Sudan research examines Sudan's democratic transition through the development of policy analyses and academic research, exploring civic inclusion in peace and economic processes; the role of digital technologies in the violation and application of humanitarian law and consequences for famine prevention; natural resource management; and civil fiscal resistance and fragmented governance. Sudan is a key element of our work in the Global Transitions series, which looks at fragmentations in the global order and how these impact peace and transition settlements.

Recent PeaceRep publications and resources

Sudan peace agreements since 1990 can be accessed via the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, including the Juba Peace Agreement of 3 October 2020.

Track and monitor the implementation of peace and transition processes for Sudan via the PA-X Tracker.

From Paralysis to Pluralism: Repoliticising Mediation in Sudan

The ongoing war in Sudan exposes the limits of international mediation efforts when stripped of political substance. In this blog, Jan Pospisil argues that current approaches reduce mediation to a technocratic exercise, where inclusion is invoked more as a legitimising slogan than a meaningful political act. To make a difference, mediation must re-engage with power, fragmentation, and the complex realities of Sudan's political landscape.

Security, Fragmentation, and Civic Futures: Rethinking Reform in Sudan's Militarised Political Economy

This brief from the LSE's Conflict and Civicness Research Group (CCRG) contends that any serious approach to security sector reform (SSR) in Sudan must reckon with the political economy that sustains militarised rule.

Reframing the Nation: Army Media, Memory, and Militarised Legitimacy in Sudan's War

Since the start of the war in Sudan in 2023, the Sudan Armed Forces (SAF) has used Arabic-language media to portray itself as Sudan's only legitimate national institution—non-Islamist, inclusive, and the last safeguard against fragmentation. This policy brief from LSE CCRG explores how that projection is constructed, and how it draws on selective historical memory and co-opted revolutionary rhetoric to consolidate military legitimacy.

Third-Party Mediation in Sudan and South Sudan: Longer-Term Trends

This Global Transitions report from the University of St Andrews draws from a preliminary dataset on third-party mediation in Sudan and South Sudan (1988-2022) to determine if and how the growing presence of non-Western powers – especially out-of-region ones – indicates their greater involvement in peace processes and mediation.

Browse our full list of Sudan publications

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/11/21/peacerep-sudan-analyst-reacts-to-atrocities-in-el-fasher/

2025-10-29 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

UN Report Cites PA-X Data on Gender References in Peace Agreements

Photo by KENA BETANCUR/AFP via Getty Images

The UN Secretary-General's annual report on the women, peace, and security (WPS) agenda marks the 25th anniversary of WPS by highlighting progress, gaps and challenges since the UN Security Council adopted the first resolution on WPS in October 2000.

For the fifth year, the UNSG's report draws on PeaceRep analysis to illustrate broader trends in the implementation of the WPS agenda through the lens of peace agreements, specifically the inclusion of agreement provisions with reference to women, girls, gender, or sexual violence.

The report cites data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database on the percentage of peace agreements with provisions referencing women, girls, and gender issues from 1990 to 2024 – noting that although the number of provisions increased from 2023, the agreements were limited to four processes in three countries: Colombia, South Sudan, and the Sudan.

"Of 36 peace agreements reached in 2024 around the world, 11 (31 per cent) included at least one provision with reference to women, girls, gender or sexual violence (see figure II). Although this was an increase from 2023, the agreements with gender provisions were limited to only four processes in three countries: Colombia, South Sudan and the Sudan. The recent peace processes between the Government of Colombia and armed groups represented most of the gender references in 2023 and 2024, which was in large part attributable to the presence of women and their contributions to the agenda-setting of the peace process from the outset. While some agreements referred to women's participation, only the agreement reached in South Sudan contained a gender quota. Only 2 of the 11 agreements, in Colombia and the Sudan, included references to gender-based violence, and one in Colombia referred to the role of women in the implementation of the agreement." (p10)

Read the publicly available version of PeaceRep's analysis referenced in the report in this blog from Laura Wise and Fiona Campbell: Women, Peace and Security at 25: Assessing Implementation through Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements

The Secretary-General's report, delivered by António Guterres, informed the Security Council's annual open debate on WPS, held on 6 October 2025. The annual debate, part of the ongoing efforts since the adoption of Security Council Resolution 1325 in 2000, aims to drive forward the WPS agenda, reinforcing the urgent need for greater inclusion of women in peace processes.

Read the research behind the report:
Women, Peace and Security at 25: Assessing Implementation through Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements

Read the full UN Security Council report:
Report of the Secretary-General: Women, peace and security

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/10/29/un-report-cites-pa-x-data-on-gender-references-in-peace-agreements/

2025-10-28 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Hosts Scottish Council on Global Affairs Workshop on Women, Peace and Security

On 1 October 2025, PeaceRep hosted a workshop at Edinburgh Law School on 'Women, Peace and Security (WPS) in the Age of Fragmentation', supported by a Scottish Council on Global Affairs Insight Grant. The purpose of the workshop was to explore what global fragmentation and the contemporary WPS crisis/es means for women's rights advocates in peace processes.

Photo by STEFANIE GLINSKI/AFP via Getty Images

The workshop brought together a group of experienced individuals from the worlds of diplomacy, research, activism, and policy to collectively make sense of this current moment in peacemaking, and generate new ideas to respond to a common challenge. This collective work included reflecting on the past and present of peacemaking and WPS, but also thinking about the feminist futures that are possible. The workshop was structured as a series of conversations, with opening remarks from pre-invited participants designed to provoke discussion, followed by an open dialogue between all participants.

Thematic sessions included reflections on:

- **Peacemaking and WPS in crisis:** What are the greatest challenges facing contemporary peacemaking and the WPS agenda?
- **Challenges of inclusion in contemporary peace processes:** In what ways do fragmentation in peacemaking and multi-mediation inhibit the inclusion of women's voices and gendered issues from the peacemaking agendas?
- **Navigating inclusion in contemporary peace processes:** What can we learn from women who are organising to influence contemporary peace and mediation processes?

Participants drew on their experiences as negotiators, mediation advisers, advocates, academics, civil servants, and feminist activists, reflecting on contexts including Ukraine, Colombia, Yemen, Northern Ireland, Myanmar, Uganda, Sudan, and Iraq.

Reflecting on the workshop, Laura Wise, PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow and Principal Investigator of the SCGA project commented:

"Fragmentation raises huge concerns for women's rights advocates in peace processes, but we know little about what this means in practice, and how women are navigating complex multi-mediation initiatives to influence peacemaking. At a time when the WPS is facing existential threats from global de-funding and anti-gender movements, this workshop was a timely opportunity to share ideas not only on difficulties, but also feminist imagining of alternative futures in which sustainable peace is at the heart of mediation. I am grateful to the Scottish Council on Global Affairs for supporting this work."

The workshop discussions and key findings will be disseminated in late 2025 as a policy report (under the Chatham House rule), blogpost, and podcast episode, co-authored with Salma Yusuf, Kasia Houghton, and Fiona Campbell.

Sign up to PeaceRep's newsletter to be notified when future blogposts and reports are published.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/10/28/peacerep-hosts-scga-workshop/

2025-10-24 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Workshop in Jordan Explores Lessons from Global Conflict Research

PeaceRep convened a two-day workshop in Amman, Jordan, earlier this month – the first in a series of final PeaceRep events as the programme concludes – under the theme "**PeaceRep: What Have We Learnt?**".

Photo by RSS

Held under Chatham House rule, the workshop brought together researchers, policymakers, and civic actors from across PeaceRep's partner networks to reflect on the programme's findings and consider implications and priorities for future peacebuilding practice.

The discussions were organised around four key themes:

- **Conflict fragmentation and war economies**, examining structural dynamics across diverse contexts and their global intersections.
- **Civic and citizens' responses**, exploring how civic actors engage with conflict landscapes and contribute to peace-making.
- **Global and local fragmentations and multi-mediation**, considering how shifts in global order shape conflict constellations and mediation strategies.
- **Methodologies and frameworks**, identifying lessons for conflict research and future peace and conflict resolution strategies.

Photo by RSS

Over the two days, participants discussed case studies from Syria, South Sudan, Sudan, Somalia, Myanmar, Afghanistan, Iraq, and Ukraine, highlighting the interconnected nature of contemporary conflicts and the evolving logics of civic resistance and governance.

Reflecting on the workshop, Dr Luke Cooper, Director of PeaceRep's Ukraine programme, commented:

"The conference was a hugely important milestone on the road to the conclusion of the PeaceRep programme, drawing together our international partners for an intensive programme of discussion on key findings and cross-comparative syntheses."

Luke also highlighted PeaceRep's distinctive model of collaborative, in-country research as central to its success:

"The depth, nuance and complexity of the scholarship undertaken for the programme underlines the importance of what PeaceRep is calling 'civic network research'. This refers to our method of building sustained and on-going partnerships with individuals and research organisations working in-country to develop granular and sophisticated knowledge of conflict-impacted societies."

A participant from the Myanmnar Policy Institute remarked:

"Engaging with scholars and practitioners from other conflict-affected contexts was a valuable experience that broadened my perspective on how civic networks navigate the political economies of war. The workshop also encouraged me to reflect critically on Myanmar's own evolving conflict dynamics and how they intersect with wider global debates on peacebuilding and governance. "

PeaceRep extends its thanks to participants and partners who joined in Amman with special gratitude to HRH Prince El Hassan bin Talal, HRH Princess Sumaya bint El Hassan, President of the Royal Scientific Society, and workshop producer, Madihah Karim, Programme Manager of the Conflict & Civicness Research Group at LSE.

The workshop also provided space for researchers to exchange findings and engage with Jordanian and UNRWA officials. For an insight into their conversations with UNRWA officials working in the Baqa'a camp, read Madihah Karim's blog post.

الجَمعيّة العِلميّة المَلكيّة
Royal Scientific Society

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/10/24/peacerep-workshop-in-jordan-explores-lessons-from-global-conflict-research/

2025-09-02 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

New PeaceTech Course: Data, Visualisation, and AI for Peacebuilding

Peacebuilding professionals now have the opportunity to strengthen their technical and analytical skills through PeaceRep's new Continuing Professional Development (CPD) course on PeaceTech. This online course is designed for practitioners who want to integrate data, visualisation, and AI tools into their work to better understand and support peace processes.

Credit: MF3d

The course will introduce participants to social science approaches to peace and conflict data, as well as practical tools for analysis and visualisation. By the end of the course, participants will be able to access and work with key datasets, understand the principles of research design and data interoperability, and create clear, evidence-based visualisations, including using the PA-X Peace Agreement Database.

The course is led by Dr Sanja Badanjak, PeaceRep's Data Director and a Chancellor's Fellow in Global Challenges at Edinburgh Law School. Dr Badanjak specialises in quantitative and text-as-data methods, with research interests spanning institutions, elections, and peace processes.

The PeaceTech CPD course begins on 12 January 2026, with applications closing on 9 October 2025.

Learn more and apply here: https://peacerep.org/courses/peacetech-cpd-course/

About PeaceRep Teaching

As part of its teaching programme, PeaceRep offers part-time, short online courses designed to support the development of conflict advisers and peacebuilding professionals through carefully curated resources and expert-led seminars on cutting-edge peace process research.

Sign up to PeaceRep teaching updates to be notified about future courses. Contact peacerep.teaching@ed.ac.uk for more information.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/09/02/new-peacetech-course/

2025-08-22 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PA-X Data on Peace Processes and Internal Displacement Cited by UN Report

Photo by Luke Dray/Getty Images

PA-X data has been cited in a high-level United Nations report on the human rights of internally displaced persons (IDPs).

The report of the UN Special Rapporteur on the human rights of internally displaced persons (A/79/334), Paula Gaviria Betancur, examines the intersection of peace processes and internal displacement. First delivered by the UN Secretary-General to the UN General Assembly in September 2024, the report has continued relevance for a global conflict landscape in which an estimated 76 million people were internally displaced at the time of writing, more than half of those forcibly, predominately due to conflict and violence. In the report, the Special Rapporteur analyses how peace processes and internal displacement intersect, and offers a set of recommendations on how to make peacemaking more inclusive of internally displaced persons and their perspectives and human rights.

Peace Agreements and Internally Displaced Persons

The Special Rapporteur's report cites PA-X data to illustrate the number of references to internal displacement found in global peace agreements:

"Among the 2,055 peace agreements in the Peace Agreements Database, 156 contain provisions that specifically and clearly address internal displacement. However, only eight agreements are focused specifically on the participation of internally displaced persons" (page 8, paragraph 25).

PeaceRep researchers Niamh Henry, Robert Wilson and Tim Epple worked with the Special Rapporteur's team to provide analysis on IDPs in peace agreements, drawing on data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. By disaggregating PA-X data into mentions of displaced people and substantive provisions, the team generated insights into temporal trends across international and national peace processes. The authors found that partial or comprehensive agreements tend to hold provisions on displaced people more often than ceasefires or implementation agreements, with the majority of international and national examples being signed in Africa. The findings will be made public in a forthcoming PeaceRep data report on IDPs.

One of the authors, PeaceRep Research Fellow and Policy Coordinator, Robert Wilson, outlined the collaboration with the UN Special Rapporteur. "At a time when conflicts around the world with pre-existing internal displacement dynamics are escalating, and climate-induced disasters also multiplying, there is a clear need to focus more thinking and support into the issue of internal displacement. Our team drew on existing peace agreement data from processes in the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Myanmar, Sudan and South Sudan to support the UN Special Rapporteur team with an improved understanding of the provisions available in peace agreements that relate to internal displacement. We informed the Special Rapporteur's conclusions and recommendations in their report to the UN General Assembly, in which they called for more attention to internal displacement in peace processes".

Tim Epple, PeaceRep Managing Director, welcomed the Special Rapporteur's reference to PA-X data:

> We very much appreciate the opportunity to engage with the Special Rapporteur's team. I am delighted our data contributed to evidence-based analysis and recommendations on such an important issue. We hope future peacemaking practice will become more sensitive to the needs, interests, and perspectives of IDPs.

The research on IDPs follows previous PeaceRep research on humanitarian ceasefires and corridors.

About PA-X

PeaceRep maintains the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, which is currently the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world. PA-X contains over 2,000 peace agreements found in more than 170 peace processes between 1990 and 2024, with sub-datasets on local agreements, gender, and amnesties.

PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools and datasets to support policy and practice, including PA-X Gender, PA-X Local, and the PA-X Tracker.

PA-X has been designed to provide easy access to peace agreement texts and to allow users to explore patterns of agreements over time, both within processes and across processes.

PA-X data is regularly cited in UN reports, including the UN Secretary-General's annual report on Women, Peace and Security (WPS).

Further Reading:

Explore all mentions of refugees and internally displaced persons on PA-X

Read the UNHCR report

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/08/22/pa-x-data-on-peace-processes-and-internal-displacement-cited-by-un-report/

2025-08-19 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

International Development Committee Publishes PeaceRep Evidence on WPS

PeaceRep evidence

PeaceRep's submission sets out contemporary challenges in global WPS adherence and uses data from the PA-X Gender database to outline recent trends in gender provisions in peace agreements. The submission suggests ways of assessing the UK's progress in meeting its 2023 National Action Plan (NAP) commitments to inclusive peace processes.

The submission also outlines the ways that PeaceRep incorporates WPS principles across its ODA-funded programming to support women's participation in peace processes, including:

- Building gender dimensions of conflict and peace and transition processes into field-based research design and informing policy-level discussions with comparative country data.
- Regularly providing research and data to senior WPS stakeholders on gender-responsive peace agreements.
- Directly supporting women's participation in peace processes through convening high-level networks of women mediators, negotiators, and constitution-makers from conflict-affected places to advance thinking on peace process themes, and to provide peer-to-peer spaces for women peacemakers.
- Delivering structured courses and tailored trainings on women's participation in peace processes for peacebuilding professionals.

Photo by GUILLERMO LEGARIA/AFP via Getty Images

Finally, the authors offer recommendations on supporting women in peace processes and implementation of the NAP Strategic Partnerships: UK Capabilities.

PeaceRep's submission draws on the expertise of lead author Laura Wise, PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow, with input from co-authors Allyson Doby, PeaceRep Communications Manager, and Robert Wilson, PeaceRep Research Fellow and Policy Coordinator.

Lead author Laura Wise said,

> Our evidence to the International Development Committee shows that women peacebuilders are facing huge challenges to influence fragmented peace processes amid escalating conflict and a global gender backlash. The evidence published by the Committee demonstrates experts' widespread concerns about the UK Government's ability to maintain its position as a global WPS leader whilst cutting funding for programming that supports women's meaningful inclusion and diverse peacemaking. A refreshed UK Government National Action Plan is an opportunity to course correct, and to recognise that in an increasingly violent world, women peacemakers need support, rather than retrenchment.

WPS at 25

The IDC inquiry coincides with the 25th anniversary of the global Women, Peace and Security (WPS) agenda set out in UN Security Council Resolution (UNSCR) 1325. The UK's plans for implementing the WPS agenda are set out in the UK Women, Peace and Security National Action Plan (NAP) 2023–2027, which sets out the UK 's commitment to reduce the impact of conflict on women and girls and promote their inclusion to prevent and resolve conflict. A revised version of the NAP is scheduled to be published by the end of 2025.

Further Reading:

Read PeaceRep's submission in full

About the IDC WPS inquiry

Browse PA-X Gender

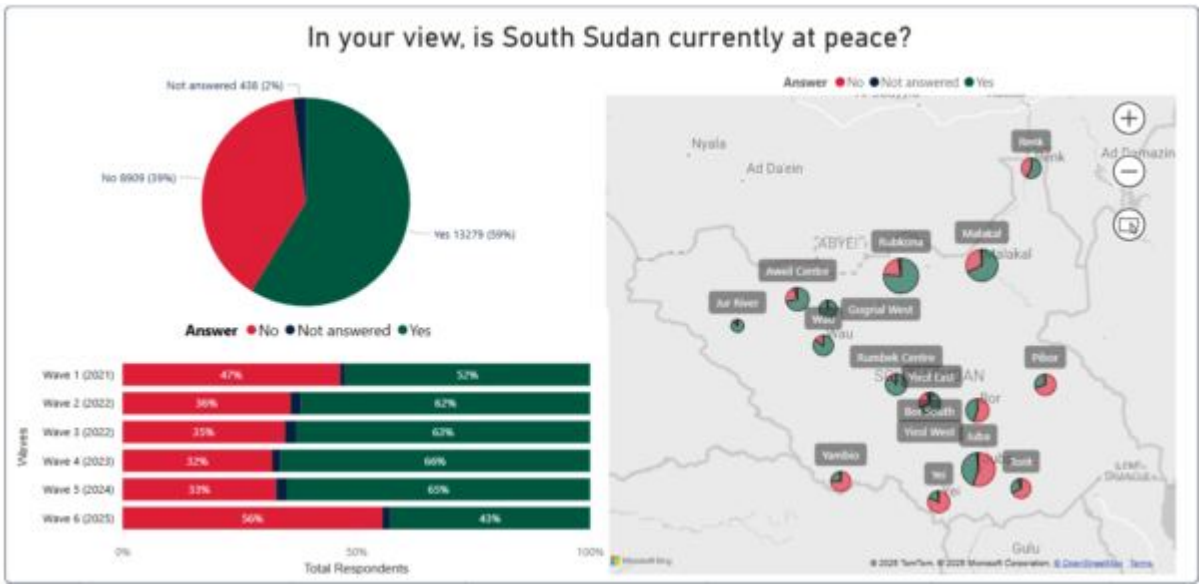
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/08/19/international-development-committee-publishes-peacerep-evidence-on-wps/

2025-08-07 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New Survey Findings from South Sudan Reveal Changing Attitudes Towards Peace

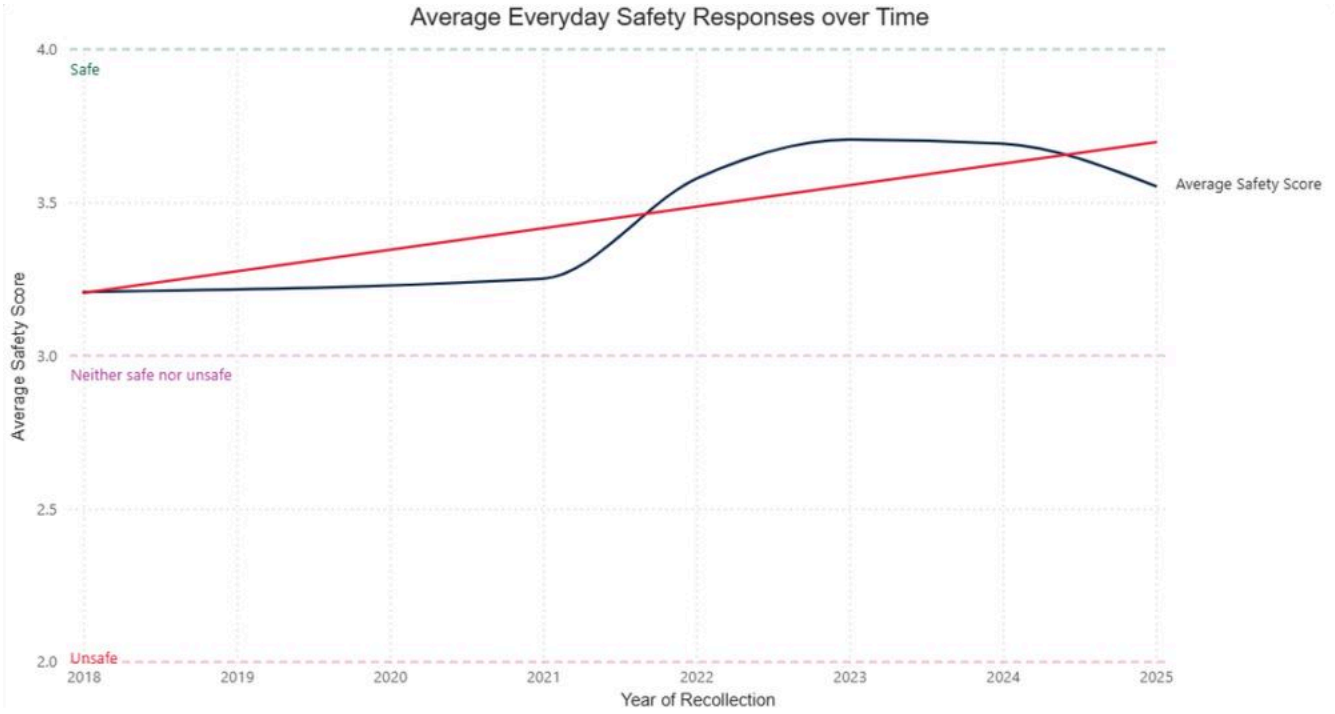
The latest findings from the sixth wave of the Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan survey reveal significant shifts in public sentiment between 2024 and 2025. Most notably, **56% of respondents now believe South Sudan is not at peace**, up from 33% in 2024.

Photo by PETER LOUIS GUME/AFP via Getty Images



Results for the survey question, 'In your view, is South Sudan currently at peace?'

Although respondents had generally reported feeling safer since 2021, **2025 marks the first year that perceived safety levels declined**, with significant variation across different locations. Insecurity remains particularly high in **Juba, Yei and Pibor**.

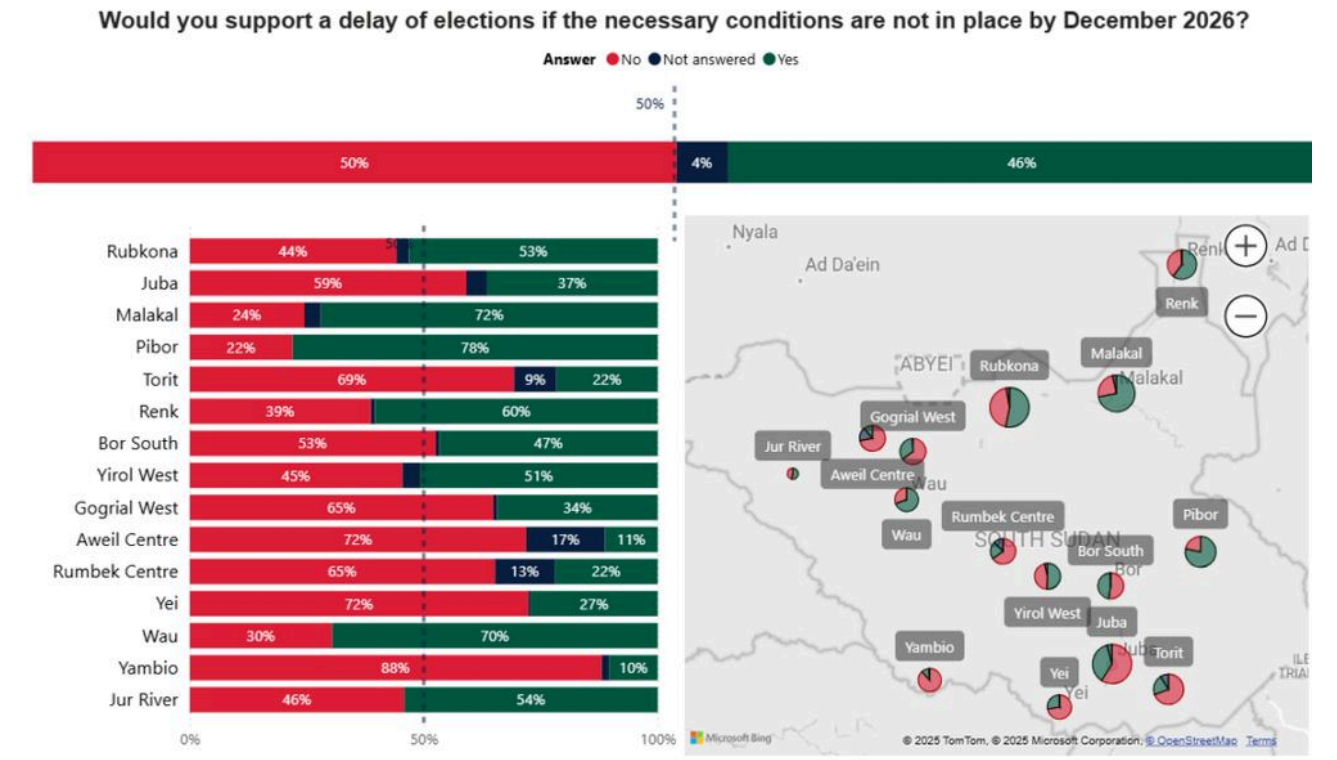


Perceptions of everyday safety have been improving over time, with the exception of 2025.

Attitudes towards upcoming elections

The survey also highlights growing public scepticism about the implementation of the 2018 peace agreement (R-ARCSS), though support for upcoming elections in December 2026 remains strong. Despite this, findings reveal:

- Optimism is declining, with a **5% drop** in the number of people who strongly agreed that elections give them hope for the future in 2025.
- Nearly **70% of respondents now see the risk of election-related violence as high or very high**, especially in Gorgial West and Rubkona.
- While most still support elections going ahead as planned, **46% now say they would support a delay** if needed.



Results by location for survey question 'Would you support a delay of elections if the necessary conditions are not in place by December 2026?'

What's new in wave 6?

For the first time, the survey asked respondents about their thoughts on **UNMISS** – the UN peacekeeping mission in South Sudan. Questions focused on whether it contributes to durable peace, helps prevent intercommunal violence, and supports the protection of civilians. Responses varied significantly by location and gender, and insights can be explored in detail via the interactive dashboard.

About Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan

The Perceptions of Peace survey includes responses from 22,677 people across 29 locations in 15 counties between 2021 and 2025. It provides rich data on how people experience safety, perceive peace, and view governance and elections.

The sixth wave of the survey was conducted from April to June 2025 by Detcro Research and Advisory, with support from the EU-funded project 'Raising Civil Voices', implemented by the Friedrich-Ebert Foundation South Sudan.

Explore the findings, regional differences, and key insights into perceptions of safety through the interactive dashboard.

Interactive dashboard: Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan

Explore all PeaceRep South Sudan research

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/08/07/new-survey-findings-from-south-sudan/

2025-08-05 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

Renewed Fighting Erupts in Gedo, Somalia: PeaceRep Research Sheds Light on Political Tensions Ahead of Elections

Photo by Sally Hayden/SOPA Images/LightRocket via Getty Images

Heavy fighting has broken out in Belet Hawa and Dollow between forces aligned to the Jubbaland administration and those loyal to the Federal Government of Somalia (FGS), following the controversial appointment of Abdirashid 'Janaan' as head of intelligence in Gedo. Janaan's return to power has reignited long-standing political and clan divisions in the region.

Reports indicate casualties, displacement, and the capture of a national intelligence official by Jubbaland forces. The appointment of Janaan—who has a well-documented and controversial past—marks a shift in President Hassan Sheikh Mohamud's strategy in Jubbaland, and coincides with preparations for local elections.

A new blog by Nisar Majid, Khalif Abdirahman, and Guhad Adan examines the dynamics of the current conflict, clan divisions, and election-related manoeuvring.

It complements PeaceRep Somalia's latest report on Gedo, Jubbaland, and the Marehan, which explores identity politics, state fragmentation, and regional reconfigurations.

Read the blog: Conflict and Election Politics in Northern Gedo, Somalia

Read the report: Gedo, Jubbaland and the Translocal Marehan: State fragmentation, identity politics and regional reconfigurations in the Somali territories

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/08/05/renewed-fighting-erupts-in-gedo-somalia/

2025-07-01 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

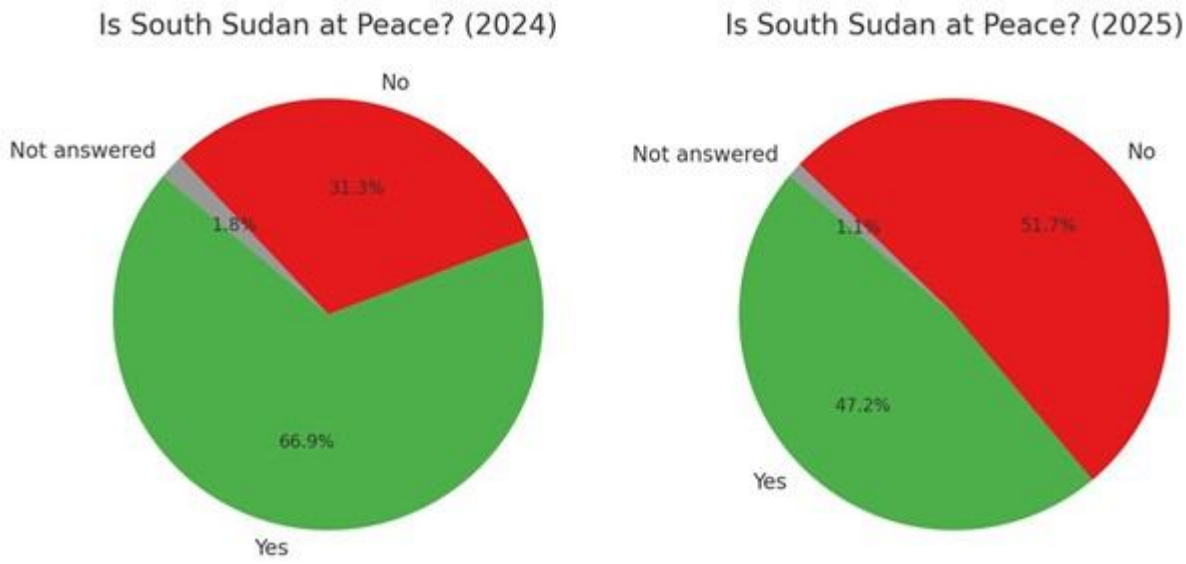
PeaceRep Survey Shapes Debate on South Sudan's Fragile Peace Process

Photo by ROBERTO SCHMIDT/AFP via Getty Images

PeaceRep's ongoing research into public perceptions of peace and governance in South Sudan continues to generate interest among key national and international stakeholders. Results from the latest iteration of the *South Sudan Public Perceptions of Peace survey*, led by Dr Jan Pospisil, have been widely cited in regional media and shared through a series of recent outreach events in Juba.

The survey remains one of the few systematic efforts to track how South Sudanese citizens view the peace process over time. As recent coverage from Eye Radio and the Sudans Post highlights, the 2025 results point to growing public scepticism about the implementation of the peace agreement, despite continued support for holding elections in 2026.

Initial findings from the latest round of the survey were presented in late June at events across Juba, including at Juba University and the Crown Hotel, in collaboration with the Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung Foundation and the EU-funded "Raising Civil Voices" project. The results were also the subject of a one-hour live discussion on Eye Radio, and will soon be made publicly accessible via the Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan interactive dashboard.



First insights from the latest wave of survey data comparing perceptions on if South Sudan is at peace (2024 vs 2025) – full results available soon!

South Sudan is currently in a prolonged transition process following the 2018 Revitalised Agreement on the Resolution of Conflict in Republic of South Sudan (R-ARCSS) peace agreement. PeaceRep's longstanding research in the country offers in-depth analysis into the roots and local perceptions of the conflict.

In a context where reliable data on public opinion is limited, PeaceRep's survey contributes substantively to understanding shifts in political sentiment, particularly following the escalation of violence in early 2025. These developments are explored further in recent PeaceRep commentary, including the blog "Never Let a Good Crisis Go" and research summary "South Sudan Violence: Insights from PeaceRep research".

Beyond tracking public attitudes, the survey aims to support more inclusive and responsive policy engagement by grounding peacebuilding discussions in citizens' lived experiences. As South Sudan approaches a potentially significant electoral milestone in 2026, the data remains a valuable resource for both national and international actors seeking to support a more sustainable peace process.

Interactive dashboard: Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan – new data coming soon

Explore all PeaceRep South Sudan research

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/07/01/peacerep-survey-shapes-debate-on-south-sudans-fragile-peace-process/

2025-06-25 / EVENTS HELD

Juline Beaujouan Speaks at Istanbul Conference on Great Power Competition and the Middle East

PeaceRep's Senior Research Fellow Dr Juline Beaujouan participated as a guest speaker in the high-level panel "Where the World is Heading: Changing Conflicts, Norms, and Hierarchies on the International Stage" during the international conference "Great Power Competition and the Middle East: Redrawing Trade Routes and Networks", held on 16–17 June 2025 at Boğaziçi University in Istanbul.

Organised by Boğaziçi University's Department of International Relations in partnership with the PLUS Institute (Austrian Institute for International Research and Development), the Al Jazeera Centre for Studies, the Foundation for Political, Economic and Social Research (SETA) in Ankara, and the Centre for Turkish Studies at Shanghai University, the conference brought together over 70 academics, strategists, and policymakers from countries including Türkiye, Austria, Germany, China, Russia, Iran, Qatar, the UK, and France.

The two-day conference explored the reshaping of global trade routes, regional connectivity networks, and the strategic ambitions of major global powers in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA). The event featured six specialised panels and a closing roundtable discussion, and was live streamed by TRT and the Al Jazeera Centre for Studies.

In her talk, Dr Beaujouan drew on her research with PeaceRep to examine the implications of a shifting international order for peacemaking and human security in the Middle East. She argued that the decline of liberal peace models and the rise of what she termed "post-liberal peace" is giving way to a more fragmented, hybrid, and pragmatic approach to conflict resolution – driven increasingly by powerful states and shaped by localised dynamics. She also argued that these dynamics can offer opportunities for sustainable peace in the region on the condition that emerging peace models are inclusive, adaptive, and grounded in the lived realities of those most affected by conflict.

Her intervention resonated with broader conference themes, including the impact of US-China rivalry, the consequences of 7 October 2023 and most recent escalation between Israel and Iran on

international norms, and the strategic influence of initiatives such as the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC). A central question raised was whether these projects will entrench fragmentation in the region or serve as opportunities for meaningful cooperation and integration.

Watch the session recording

Further Reading

Power Peace: The Resolution of the Syrian Conflict in a Post-Liberal Era of Peacemaking

Education in Syria: hidden victim of the conflict of weapon of war?

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/06/25/istanbul-conference/

2025-06-17 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

Applications Open: PeaceRep Expands Online Short Course Offering

Now open for applications:

Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World

Dates: 18 August – 26 September 2025

Application deadline: 4 July 2025

This five-week online course, developed and led by Laura Wise, explores contemporary developments in gender, peace, and security. Participants will examine how gender perspectives can be integrated into peace processes and agreements, and will gain practical experience using PeaceTech tools to support inclusive peacebuilding.

Learn more and apply now

Conflict Transitions in the Eastern Mediterranean Region

Dates: 20 October – 5 December 2025

Application deadline: 25 August 2025

Designed by Juline Beaujouan, this course introduces participants to the dynamics of conflict and transition in the Eastern Mediterranean Region. Drawing on case studies from Afghanistan, Iraq, Lebanon, South Sudan, Sudan, and Syria, the course equips peacebuilding professionals with the tools to critically engage with complex regional transitions and unresolved conflicts.

Learn more and apply now

Coming soon:

PeaceTech

Dates: January – February 2026

This forthcoming course, designed by Sanja Badanjak, explores the emerging field of PeaceTech—the application of data and technology in peacebuilding contexts. It is aimed at professionals working in international organisations, NGOs, government, or academia.

Sign up to be notified when applications open

About PeaceRep Teaching

As part of our teaching programme, PeaceRep offers part-time, short online courses designed to support the development of conflict advisers and peacebuilding professionals through carefully curated resources and expert-led seminars on cutting-edge peace process research.

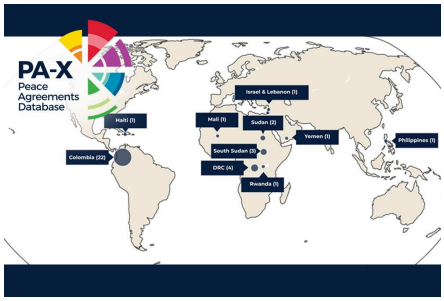
Sign up to PeaceRep teaching updates or contact peacerep.teaching@ed.ac.uk for more information.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/06/17/applications-open-peacerep-expands-online-short-course-offering/

2025-05-12 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Reintroducing PA-X: Peace Agreements Database Updated to Version 9 with 89 New Agreements

What's New in Version 9?

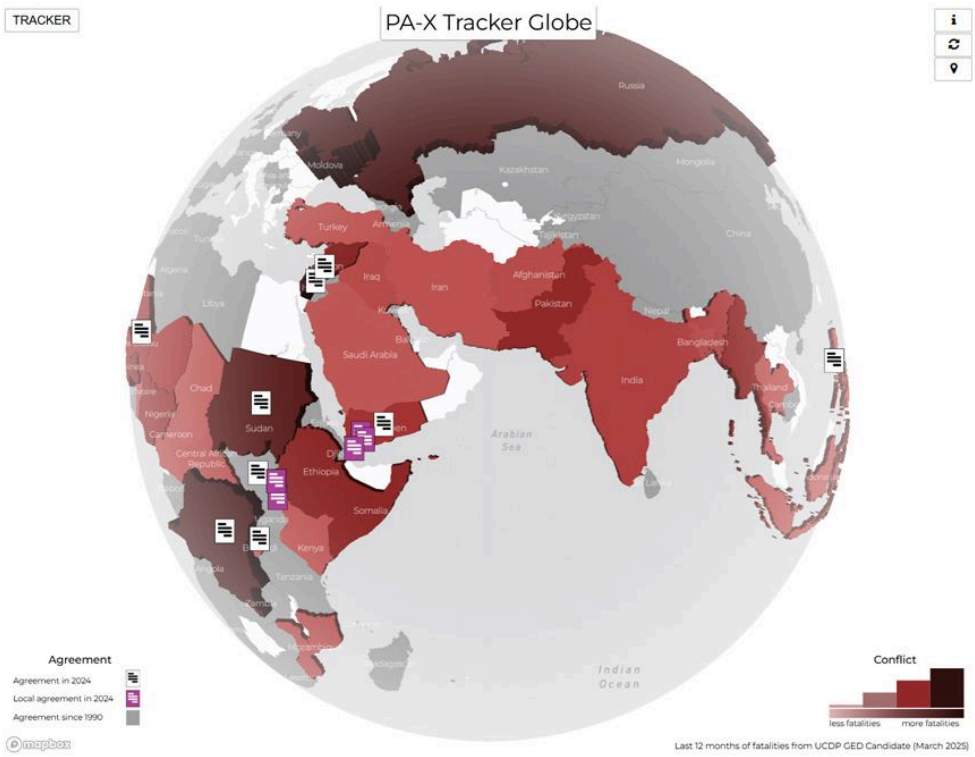


Expanded Coverage:

The April 2025 update adds **89 new agreements**, including both historical documents and agreements signed through the end of 2024. These newly included agreements span diverse contexts and phases of conflict resolution. They underscore the diversity of peacemaking efforts – with a variety of agreement signatory types and addressing multiple levels of armed conflict, from the local to the internationalised.

Many of the new additions come from Colombia, where 22 new agreements were signed in 2024, in a revival of the peace process that seeks to build on the 2016 comprehensive peace agreement.

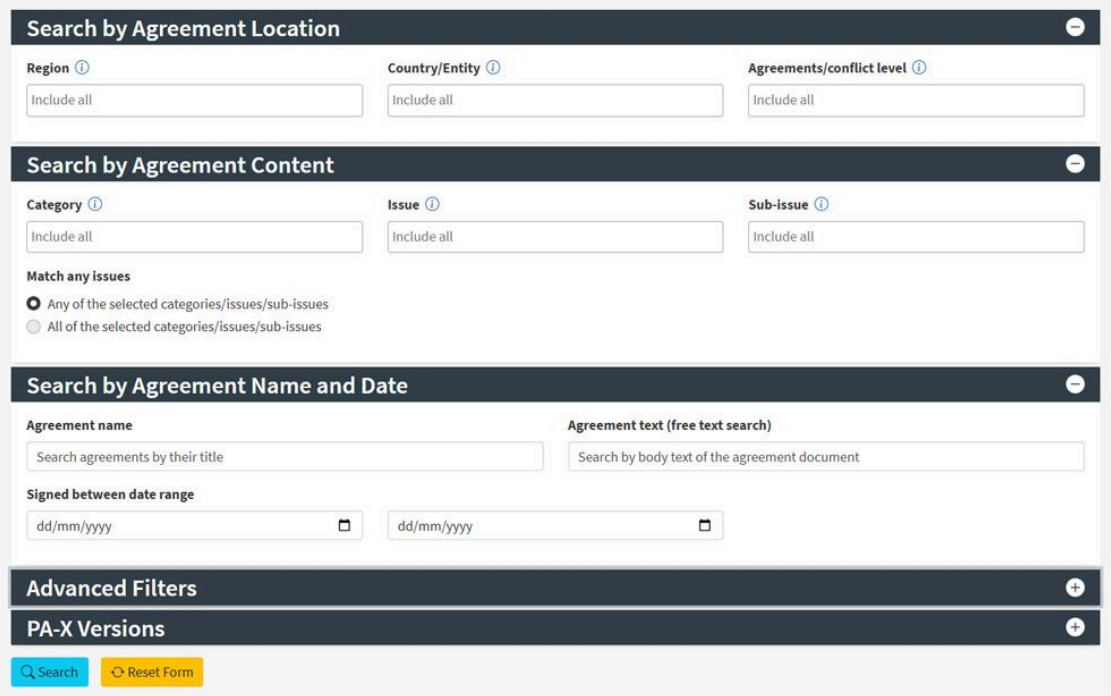
This new data feeds into many of our innovative PeaceTech tools, including the new PA-X Tracker Globe, an interactive tool that shows where peace agreements were signed in 2024, alongside the estimated number of conflict-related fatalities in each country.



Enhanced Search Functionality:

PA-X V9 introduces an improved, more intuitive search interface. From the same page, users can now:

- Conduct simple searches, for example by country or issue
- Apply advanced filters such as agreement stage, peace process, or type of conflict
- Export a custom subset of agreements based on selected filters, or access the full dataset from the downloads page



The new PA-X Peace Agreements Database search interface

Updated PA-X Gender Dataset:

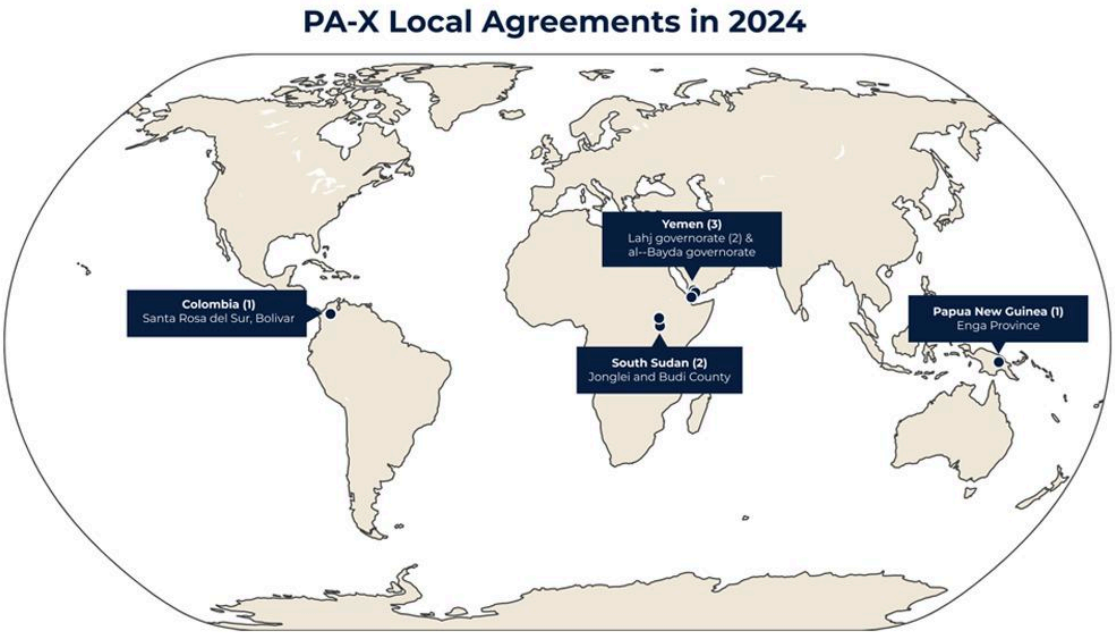
The PA-X Gender dataset—focusing on agreements that reference women, girls, gender, or sexual violence—has also been updated to include **28 new agreements**, bringing the total to 465.

Recent additions feature significant agreements from Colombia, Sudan, and South Sudan signed in 2024, including eight agreements from Colombia alone.

Updated PA-X Local Dataset:

The only known database of its kind, PA-X Local is subset of agreements included in the PA-X database that deal in some way with local issues, involve local actors, and deal with forms of local/communal violent conflict.

Agreements span the period from 1990 to the end of 2024, and while not exhaustive, form a collection of 367 local agreements from around the globe, with **18 new agreements** in this update of PA-X Local.



A world map showing the location of local agreements added to PA-X in the latest update

About PA-X:

PA-X is a rigorously curated dataset of peace agreements from over 170 peace processes worldwide. It includes:

- Full-text PDFs of agreements
- An English-language corpus, translated by experts in law and regional studies
- A human-coded dataset capturing 230 substantive categories related to peace processes
- Additional datasets including PA-X Gender, PA-X Local, and the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreements Dataset.

PA-X supports research, policy, and practice through a suite of digital tools, including visualizations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

Explore Version 9 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database here

Discover PeaceRep's range of PeaceTech tools

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/05/12/reintroducing-pa-x-peace-agreements-database-updated-to-version-9/

2025-04-22 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New PeaceRep–LSE IDEAS Report: Ukraine's Economic Strength Challenges Russia's Oil-Dependent War Effort

A major new report from PeaceRep and LSE IDEAS, the London School of Economics' foreign policy think tank, assesses the relative economic strengths and vulnerabilities of both Russia and Ukraine in

the ongoing war.

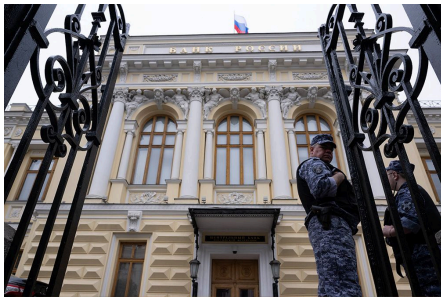


Photo by NATALIA KOLESNIKOVA/AFP via Getty Images

Authored by Dr Luke Cooper, a member of LSE IDEAS' Conflict and Civicness Research Group, the report was produced for the Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform (PeaceRep). It argues that focusing on the economic "home front" reveals the potential brittleness and fragility of the Russian war economy.

Ukraine's economic strengths, supported by Western financial aid—secured until 2027—and unprecedented tax revenue mobilisation, are often understated. The report suggests that, as things stand, Ukraine holds a surprisingly strong negotiating position.

The 60-page report develops this argument in detail, showing that:

- **Russia's war effort is heavily reliant on oil and gas revenues** and is experiencing serious fiscal pressure, including a looming credit crunch and the risk of a systemic banking crisis.
- **Both countries have adopted "military Keynesian" strategies**—using war spending to stimulate their economies—with differing outcomes: Ukraine's democratic institutions and EU aspirations provide checks on militarised rent-seeking, while Russia's autocratic centralisation entrenches elite interests and sustains the war.
- **As US-Russia talks gain momentum**, the report cautions that Ukraine could be side-lined. It calls for peace negotiations to be inclusive and grounded in rights-based principles, including independent human rights monitoring in occupied territories.
- **While neither side is positioned for "total victory"**, Russia's internal vulnerabilities could shift its negotiating calculus over the coming year.

"Despite fighting a vastly more powerful adversary, Ukraine's wartime economy has proven surprisingly resilient. Sustained by the inflow of external aid and the mobilisation of the Ukrainian people, Ukraine's wartime economy has helped level the playing field. Russia, by contrast, is betting its war effort on volatile oil rents and a fragile financial system that is coming under considerable strain. Even in the face of the Trump administration's apparent pivot towards the Russian side, Ukraine and its European allies hold more 'cards' than many, including President Trump, seem to believe," said Dr Luke Cooper, Associate Professorial Research Fellow in International Relations and Director of PeaceRep's Ukraine programme.

Read the full report here: https://peacerep.org/publication/russo-ukrainian-war/

Explore all PeaceRep Ukraine research

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/04/22/ukraines-economic-strength/

2025-04-01 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

South Sudan Violence: Insights from PeaceRep research

In March 2025, a Nuer community militia called the White Army attacked units of the South Sudan People's Defence Forces (SSPDF) in Upper Nile State, allegedly with the aim of community self-

defence. The campaign quickly spiralled out of control as the government responded militarily and by arresting leading opposition figures and risking the fragile national transition process.

PeaceRep research shows that the current crisis is a culmination of long-standing historical grievances, political power struggles, and external narratives that obscure the true drivers of conflict.

Photo by MAJAK KUANY/AFP via Getty Images)

Recent PeaceRep reactions in the media

In an article originally published in The Conversation, Jan Pospisil (Coventry University) examines the drivers of discontent and what is different this time compared to the outbreak of civil war in 2013.

Jan Pospisil offered expert commentary to TRT World on the drivers of discontent and how to avoid civil war.

Insights from PeaceRep research

South Sudan is currently undergoing a prolonged transition process that commenced with the 2018 Revitalised Agreement on the Resolution of Conflict in Republic of South Sudan (R-ARCSS) peace agreement. PeaceRep's longstanding research in South Sudan offers deep analysis into the roots and local perceptions of the conflict.

PeaceRep examines perceptions of peace in South Sudan, including through a series of surveys recording daily experiences of safety and views on; elections, governance arrangements, security arrangements, trust in public authorities, civic space, national identity, and social cohesion. Browse the interactive dashboard to explore findings: Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan.

In addition, PeaceRep's South Sudan research explores local peacemaking, public authority in the country, the key dynamics between Sudan and South Sudan and the impact of these dynamics on each other's transition processes, the role of different types of financial flows on governance outcomes, and mediation. For example, PeaceRep research shows that international mediation efforts in South Sudan are fragmented (Logo and Mariani, 2022) and strongly regionalised (Peter and Houghton, 2023). The 2024 Tumaini peace initiative being held in Nairobi for the holdout groups is yet another example of this (Magara and Pospisil, 2024).

PA-X Tracker South Sudan profile

Explore key events and actors in South Sudan from 1990 onwards with the PA-X Tracker. Underpinned by PA-X Peace Agreements data, the Tracker allows easy exploration of peace processes, actors, implementation, and timelines.

PA-X Tracker: South Sudan

PeaceRep South Sudan latest publications

Perceiving Peace in a Fragment State: The Case of South Sudan
This briefing aims to compare the empirical meaning of peace internationally and focuses on what peace means to people living in a fragment state, such as South Sudan, where armed violence is a regular occurrence in many of its parts.

[Peace in Transition: The Case of South Sudan]
Following a nationwide perception survey, this report paints a comprehensive picture of what peace looks like for those directly affected by armed violence in South Sudan.

[Climate Security in South Sudan: Findings from the 2024 Public Perceptions of Peace Survey]
This policy brief presents data on perceptions of climate security in South Sudan, and the need to strengthen climate security, adaptation, and disaster preparedness.

[Third-Party Mediation in Sudan and South Sudan: Longer-Term Trends]
This analysis of data on third-party mediation in Sudan and South Sudan signals important longer-term trends for conflict mediation efforts.

[Local Peacemaking in South Sudan: PeaceRep Workshop Report]
This report sets out the discussion points and key insights from a workshop on Local Peacemaking in South Sudan, organised and co-hosted by PeaceRep and the South Sudan Ministry of Peace Building in Juba in 2023.

Further reading

[Browse all South Sudan reports and blogs.]

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/04/01/south-sudan-violence/

2025-03-25 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep Researcher Awarded British Academy Grant for Peace Inclusivity Study

PeaceRep researcher **Dr Johanna Amaya-Panche** has been awarded funding from the British Academy to explore how international networks influence peace inclusivity in Northern Ireland's peace process.

Photo by Frédéric Soltan/Corbis via Getty Images

Dr Amaya-Panche is among just 27 researchers in the UK to receive a British Academy Talent Development Award, which supports innovative research in the social sciences, humanities, and the arts.

The funding will enable Dr Amaya-Panche to conduct fieldwork in Northern Ireland, using both quantitative and qualitative research methods to examine the relationships between intergovernmental organizations (IGOs), local stakeholders, and other international actors. The project aims to generate policy recommendations for more effective peacebuilding.

Speaking about the award, Dr Amaya-Panche said:

> This funding is a meaningful achievement for me and the PeaceRep team, as it allows us to deepen our understanding of the international dynamics shaping inclusive peace outcomes.

In addition to the £9,973 grant from the British Academy, Dr Amaya-Panche has also secured funding from the School of Law's Research and Impact Facilitation Fund, which will further support the project. In collaboration with Dr Sanja Badanjak (PeaceRep, University of Edinburgh) and Dr Malte Jauch (University of Essex), this additional funding will support a policy workshop to share key findings from the research.

Beyond this project, Dr Amaya-Panche is also investigating climate refugees, focusing on climate-induced migration between Colombia and Venezuela. She, along with Dr Malte Jauche (University of Essex) and Dr Rebecca Irons (UCL), has been awarded funding from the UKRI's International Impact Fund via the University of Essex for this research. Additionally, Dr Amaya-Panche and Dr Irons have received funding from the UCL Grand Challenges Grant to further support their work on this topic.

Dr Amaya-Panche's research focuses on the influence of international actors on the complex local dynamics of collective action strategies initiated by civil society agents, with the aim of promoting peace, resilience, and reconciliation.

Learn more about the BA-funded research project, 'International Networks and Peace Inclusivity in Peace Processes'.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/03/25/peacerep-researcher-awarded-british-academy-grant-for-peace-inclusivity-study/

2025-03-10 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

Funding Boost to Support Women in Peacebuilding

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship programme, delivered by non-governmental organisation Beyond Borders Scotland with support from peace and conflict experts from the University of Edinburgh Law School, has received additional investment as part of a new programme to support inclusive peacebuilding.

The First Minister of Scotland John Swinney announced the £400,000 funding boost to mark International Women's Day on 8 March 2025.

A 2023 Beyond Borders/PeaceRep workshop, led by Laura Wise and Juline Beaujouan.

Peacebuilding efforts

The Fellowship has already trained more than 360 women peacebuilders from 40 conflict-affected countries across the Middle East, Africa, South Asia and Latin America since 2017.

It is named after the UN Security Council Resolution 1325, which marks its 25th anniversary this year.

The new funding will enable Beyond Borders Scotland and Edinburgh Law School to continue to jointly support women peacebuilders and the critical work they do to end and transform violent conflict.

> *At a time of heightened global conflict – and when investments in overseas aid are being cut elsewhere – Scotland is proud to support the role of women in international peacebuilding efforts, sharing our values of democracy and devolution to help others build lasting, peaceful societies.*
>
> – John Swinney, The First Minister of Scotland

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship programme is held three times a year in Edinburgh and the Borders with a focus on conflict resolution, mediation, reconciliation and dialogue methodologies.

The programme is supported by a team of peace and conflict experts at Edinburgh Law School, including PeaceRep's Senior Research Fellow Laura Wise.

The Fellowship draws on insights and experiences from PeaceRep's data-driven research into women's inclusion in peace processes, underpinned by the PA-X Peace Agreements Database.

> *At a time when armed conflicts are becoming more complex, the University of Edinburgh welcomes the Scottish Government's unwavering commitment to inclusive peacebuilding.*
>
> *Globally, women are disproportionately affected by conflict and often denied full roles in local, national, and international peacebuilding efforts.*
>
> *We look forward to continuing to work with the Women in Conflict Fellows and Scottish peacebuilding community to increase the full, equal and meaningful participation of women in peacebuilding.*
>
> – Professor Jo Shaw, Head of Edinburgh Law School

> *This new project could not be more timely. Amidst current global fragmentation and the backlash against the Women, Peace and Security Agenda, this funding sends a strong signal.*
>
> *Our colleague Laura Wise has been central in leading research on women's inclusion in peace processes and in supporting the Fellowship and women peacebuilders from conflict-affected countries.*
>
> *We thank the Scottish Government for taking the initiative and continuing their support for this important work.*
>
> – Tim Epple, PeaceRep Managing Director at Edinburgh Law School

Further Reading

The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship programme

Read the Scottish Government's announcement

Read more on the University of Edinburgh news

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/03/10/funding-boost-to-support-women-in-peacebuilding/

2025-03-04 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Hosts Screening of Award-winning Documentary 'Devi'

On 27 February 2025, audiences gathered in Edinburgh for a film screening of *Devi*, an award-winning documentary exploring the life and work of Nepalese human rights defender Devi Khadka.

The film follows Devi's fight for justice against those who seek to erase rape from the history of Nepal's civil war. As she challenges this systemic silence, Devi confronts her own demons as a survivor of sexual violence.

A still from Devi shows Devi Khadka with other survivors of wartime sexual violence. Photograph: @devidocumentary

The screening, hosted by PeaceRep, GENDER.ED, and the Global Justice Academy at the University of Edinburgh, was followed by a thought-provoking Q&A with the film's director, Subina Shrestha, chaired by Chancellor's Fellow Kathryn Nash.

During the discussion, GENDER.ED Associate Director Kaveri Qureshi prompted Subina to reflect on her collaboration with Devi and the film's impact since its release. The panel also explored the power of storytelling and the responsibility it places on certain individuals to bring critical issues to light.

Devi confronts difficult themes, including trauma and sexual violence. While there is much work still to be done, the conversation delved into the incredible impact Devi Khadka has had on Nepal over the past five years.

Further Reading

Learn more about *Devi*

Browse PeaceRep key findings on gender in peace processes

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/03/04/peacerep-hosts-screening-of-award-winning-documentary-devi/

2025-01-29 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Myanmar Team Invited to Speak at British Academy

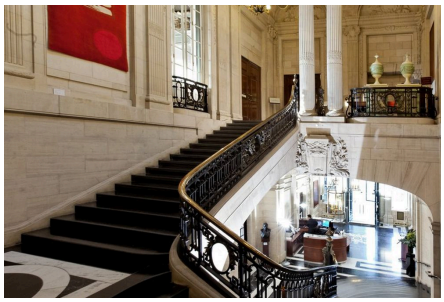


Photo by the British Academy

PeaceRep Senior Research Fellow Laura Wise and Postdoctoral Research Fellow Dr Jennifer Hodge were invited to present research on conflict fragmentation and peacemaking in Myanmar at the launch conference of new multi-year international policy programme on Global (Dis)Order, organised by the British Academy and the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. Their research paper was also co-authored by Dr Monalisa Adhikari.

The conference was held in London on January 13-15, and brought together practitioners, policymakers and researchers from diverse disciplinary backgrounds with demonstrable expertise that enables them to contribute authoritatively to the policy debate on this issue. Participants were asked to explore the current flux and fragmentation of the international system, in order to better understand the implications and lessons of reordering and disorder (positive, negative or otherwise).

Laura Wise and Jennifer Hodge were also invited to contribute initial remarks to a high level roundtable of diplomats, humanitarians, lawyers, researchers and peacebuilders on the 'Accountability Pathways and Prospects for Violations of the Laws of War', where they spoke on the challenges of pursuing accountability for Conflict Related Sexual Violence in contemporary conflicts.

Find out more about the Global (Dis)Order programme by visiting this web page: The British Academy – Global (Dis)Order

Learn more about PeaceRep's Myanmar research on their website: PeaceRep – Myanmar

Originally published by Edinburgh Law School on 27 January 2025.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/01/29/peacerep-myanmar-team-invited-to-speak-at-british-academy/

2025-01-22 / EVENTS HELD

Local Peacebuilding Initiatives in Iraq: Workshop Explores Community-driven Solutions for Lasting Peace

Photo by Sangar Salih

A one-day workshop held in January 2025 in Erbil, in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq (KRI), provided a platform for discussing the crucial role of Local Peace Committees (LPCs) and other community-driven initiatives in Iraq's ongoing peacebuilding efforts. Organized by PeaceRep Post-doctoral Research Fellow Juline Beaujouan and Sangar Salih (University of Salahaddin-Erbil), the workshop brought together practitioners, civil society members, and local leaders to explore the challenges and successes of these grassroots peace initiatives, particularly in the wake of Islamic State's defeat in 2017.

Since the collapse of the Islamic State group, local peacebuilding initiatives have played an essential role in the recovery and reconstruction of Iraq's communities. One such initiative, the network of LPCs formed by the Peace and Freedom Organization (PFO) in Nineveh in 2017, has been instrumental in fostering dialogue and rebuilding trust within and between communities. Similar initiatives have been established in Kirkuk and Diyala provinces, where local actors have worked tirelessly to resolve tensions and promote social cohesion.

The PeaceRep workshop explored several key themes, including the processes involved in establishing local peace initiatives, the importance of inclusivity, and how to ensure that marginalized groups such as women and youth are fully represented in peacebuilding efforts.

Photo by Sangar Salih

In addition to addressing local challenges, the workshop also examined the broader impact of these initiatives on Iraq's peace process. Discussions included the importance of collaboration with both

local, national and international actors. At the same time, participants acknowledged challenges such as navigating the complex political landscape and ensuring long-term impact.

The event offered a valuable opportunity for cross-sector collaboration, as participants brainstormed ideas for improving and scaling up successful practices, while also learning from past challenges. By fostering dialogue between local peacebuilders, government officials, and international partners, the workshop contributed to strengthening the collective effort to rebuild Iraq's social fabric.

In a region marked by conflict and division, the work of Local Peace Committees and similar initiatives provides a hopeful path forward, demonstrating the power of community-driven solutions in achieving lasting peace. The insights shared at this workshop will continue to inform future efforts to promote stability and healing in Iraq and beyond.

The organizers would like to extend their deep gratitude to the workshop participants for their trust and the honesty with which they shared their often-painful personal experiences of conflict and the challenges of peacebuilding. Their openness provided valuable insights into the realities of local peace efforts.

This workshop builds on a collaborative initiative between PeaceRep and the University of Salahaddin, which took place in August 2024. The initiative aimed to better understand and contribute to sustainable peace in the KRI and the broader context of Iraq.

Explore all PeaceRep Iraq research

Track and monitor the implementation of peace and transition processes for Iraq via the PA-X Tracker

Read this article in Kurdish

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2025/01/22/local-peacebuilding-initiatives-in-iraq-workshop-explores-community-driven-solutions-for-lasting-peace/

2024

13 stories · Full original text

2024-12-12 / HIGH-LEVEL VISITS

Indo-Pacific Minister Praises PeaceRep's Support for Global Peace Processes on Visit to Edinburgh

Photo by Edinburgh Law School

As Parliamentary Under-Secretary of State for Indo-Pacific, Minister West took the opportunity to speak with PeaceRep researchers about our ongoing research in Myanmar, where the programme has convened discussions with researchers and stakeholders. PeaceRep researchers shared findings and recommendations from a new policy brief on pathways ahead for Myanmar.

As a global leader in PeaceTech innovation, PeaceRep also shared highlights of our data and digital tools to support conflict resolution policy and practice. PeaceRep researchers introduced the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world, and demonstrated the PA-X Tracker, our newest tool offering data-driven insights into peace process implementation and monitoring. The Tracker allows users to understand how peace processes are unfolding, who is involved in them, and what impact the processes have had on a range of institutional, political, economic, humanitarian and security indicators.

The Minister commented on the importance of PeaceRep's research and data-driven insights which provide "an invaluable resource for researchers and peace practitioners alike".

PeaceRep's Interim Principal Investigator Prof Andrew Lang and Managing Director (Research) Tim Epple thanked the FCDO for their continued support and funding of PeaceRep's research.

Head of Edinburgh Law School Professor Jo Shaw welcomed PeaceRep's contribution to supporting peace processes through comparative research. Christina Boswell, Professor of Politics and Vice-Principal Research and Enterprise at the University of Edinburgh, praised PeaceRep for harnessing data, digital methods, and artificial intelligence for the public good – one of the core missions set out in the University's Research and Innovation Strategy.

About PeaceRep

PeaceRep is an international consortium of research and practitioner organisations led by the University of Edinburgh Law School. PeaceRep's interdisciplinary research examines the major trends and shifts in the post-1990 peace and transition process landscape. We work on comparative research, digital PeaceTech innovation, peace process design and support, and research-led teaching and training. PeaceRep is funded by the UK FCDO from 2021 – 2027.

Read PeaceRep's new policy brief: Pathways ahead for Myanmar: Assessing the Challenges and Opportunities

Explore the PA-X Database

Browse PeaceRep's key findings

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/12/12/indo-pacific-minister-praises-peacereps-support-for-global-peace-processes-on-visit-to-edinburgh/

2024-10-28 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

UN Report Cites PeaceRep Research on Stagnation of Gender References in Peace Agreements

The UN Secretary-General's annual report on the women, peace, and security (WPS) agenda presents a sobering assessment of the lack of progress over the past decade. As in previous years, the report draws on PeaceRep research and data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database to highlight the continued stagnation of women's participation in peace processes.

Citing research by PeaceRep Research Fellow, Laura Wise, the report notes on page 9, point 22:

UN Photo/Loey Felipe

> The data show little progress over the past decade. None of the peace agreements reached in 2023 included a women's group or representative as a signatory.

PeaceRep's research is also referenced on page 11, point 29, where the report discusses the rise in global conflicts:

> The rise in the number of conflicts worldwide has not been followed by a similar rise in the number of peace agreements. Multiple active conflicts in 2023, such as those in the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Myanmar, Sudan, Syria, and Gaza, remain unresolved and have contributed to the devastating harm experienced by women and girls, and civilians at large. Out of 31 agreements reached in 2023, only 8 (26 per cent) included explicit references to women, girls, gender, or sexual violence—a slight drop from 28 per cent in 2022.

The report also includes a chart from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database (V8) illustrating the percentage of peace agreements with provisions referencing women, girls, and gender issues from 1990 to 2023.

The Secretary-General's report, delivered by António Guterres, informed the Security Council's annual open debate on women, peace, and security (WPS), held on 24 October 2024. This year's debate, titled "Women Building Peace in a Changing Environment," focused on advancing the WPS agenda amidst global instability.

The report offers a stark warning:

> Amid record levels of armed conflict and violence, progress made over decades is vanishing before our eyes. Generational gains in women's rights hang in the balance around the world.

The annual debate, part of the ongoing efforts since the adoption of Security Council Resolution 1325 in 2000, aims to drive forward the WPS agenda, reinforcing the urgent need for greater inclusion of women in peace processes.

Read the research behind the report:
Gender, Peace Agreements, and Fragmentation (this blog is a publicly available version of the analysis referenced in the report)

Read the full UN Security Council report:
Report of the Secretary-General: Women, peace and security

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/10/28/un-report-cites-peacerep-research-on-stagnation-of-gender-references-in-peace-agreements/

2024-09-24 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

Applications Now Open: PeaceRep Launches Two New Short Courses

Following the success of PeaceRep's inaugural short course, Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World, we are excited to expand our offering of Continuing Professional Development (CPD) courses, with two new six-week online courses (including a pre-learning week) for peacebuilding professionals.

Photo by Abdulmonam Eassa/Getty Images

Led by PeaceRep Postdoctoral Research Fellow Juline Beaujouan, the courses offer an overview of the latest developments in conflict transitions in the EMR, as well as practical skills for professionals working in violent contexts.

Juline is a leading expert in Peace and Conflict Studies, with over eight years of experience across Europe, the Middle East, and North Africa. Her work emphasizes collaborative and responsible research, blending academic knowledge with evidence-based policymaking and community engagement.

Conflict Transitions in the Eastern Mediterranean Region

Since the Cold War, the EMR has witnessed a series of intrastate wars that are among the most prolonged conflicts in the world. As of 2023, there were ten states with active armed conflicts in the region. The failure of conflict resolution and the transition process in the region calls for new and critical approaches.

Drawing on examples from Afghanistan, Iraq, Lebanon, South Sudan, and Syria, the new short course introduces peacebuilding professionals to the core issues at play in the EMR, including how to navigate key debates in a rapidly changing field. The course will begin on 06 January 2025, **with applications closing on 31 October 2024.**

Skills-building for Working in Conflict Transitions

Working in conflict requires a set of specific skills which few new professionals have. Designed by Juline Beaujouan in collaboration with peace practitioners, this course goes beyond theoretical knowledge, providing participants with a basic "toolbox" of practical skills and strategies to deal with the challenges of working in violent environments.

The course content draws on established research and expertise from the PeaceRep programme, incorporating the latest developments in the peace and conflict field, such as the multiplication of non-state actors and emergence of new technologies. Beginning in February 2025, **applications for this course will close on 30 November 2024**.

About PeaceRep Teaching

As part of our teaching programme, PeaceRep offers part-time, short online courses designed to support the development of conflict advisers and peacebuilding professionals through carefully curated resources and expert-led seminars on cutting-edge peace process research.

PeaceRep's inaugural short course, Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World (now closed for applications), is scheduled to run for the second time later this month, following positive feedback from the first cohort of students.

Sign up to PeaceRep teaching updates to be notified when applications open.
Contact peacerep.teaching@ed.ac.uk for more information.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/09/24/applications-now-open-peacerep-launches-two-new-short-courses/

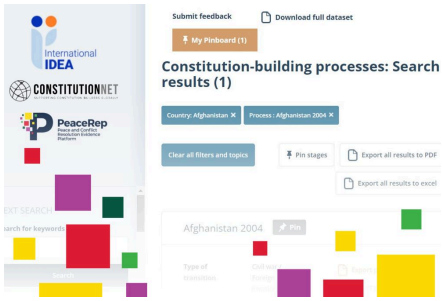
2024-09-19 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Unlocking Insights into Constitution-Building in Fragile Settings

A new resource for researchers and practitioners working in challenging environments has been launched: the Database on Constitution-Building Processes in Fragile Settings. This comprehensive database provides detailed insights into how constitutional processes unfold in challenging contexts, offering valuable information for those involved in similar efforts today.

Created by International IDEA with the support of PeaceRep, the database covers constitution-building processes from the 1990s to the present. The database tracks eight key stages, from initial

discussions to the final implementation. With over 200 data points for each case, users can delve into and compare the complex dynamics of constitution-building in highly fragile settings.



Key features of the database include strategic insights into major constitution-building efforts, easy access to specific stages of the process, and free global access to data that supports informed decision-making and research. Users can interact with the data through a double-coding methodology, explore via interactive pinboards, and download information in various formats.

Building on an earlier dataset (1975-2003), this tool provides a critical foundation for understanding the impact of design choices in constitution-building. Explore the database and learn more at https://pccbp.constitutionnet.org.

Learn more about the database or watch the video tutorial on how to explore the database.

Browse PeaceRep's key findings on constitution-building.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/09/19/unlocking-insights-into-constitution-building-in-fragile-settings/

2024-09-11 / EVENTS HELD

Global Fragmentation in Focus: PeaceRep Hosts International Scholars at 61st CRS Conference

Global (De-)Fragmentation in Peace and Conflict Research

The overarching theme of the conference, "Global (De-)Fragmentation? Consequences for Peace and Conflict Research and Practice," invited reflection on the complexities of fragmentation in international peace processes.

Representing an opportunity for the peace and conflict community to come together, panels covered a wide range of topics, from marriage, gender and social control, biodiversity and natural resources, and trends in data collection, to armed group fragmentation and the role of international actors in crises.

PeaceRep research contributed substantively to this discourse, with papers by PeaceRep scholars featuring in numerous panels. Notably, several attendees also presented papers that showcased findings derived from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. For example, Emilian Berutti from the Centre on Conflict, Development & Peacebuilding, introduced his urban agreements dataset, which builds on the PA-X Local database.

On left, Dana Landau (Basel) talks about using PA-X, and on the right, Emilian Berutti (CCDP) presents his urban agreements work which builds on PA-X Local.

PeaceTech as a Focus of Innovation

A major highlight of the conference was the PeaceRep-led PeaceTech workshop: “Digital Tools for Data-Driven Peace and Conflict Resolution: Demos, Challenges, and Opportunities.”

With over 50 participants from leading organisations such as ACLED, Earth Blox, the UN, and International IDEA, the workshop offered practical demonstrations and discussions on cutting-edge tools for geospatial mapping, data visualization, and peace analytics.

These technologies, many developed or applied by PeaceRep, aim to transform how researchers and practitioners engage with peace and conflict data, making it more accessible and actionable for policy interventions.

In a significant milestone for peace process tracking, PeaceRep's Managing Director Tim Epple and Data Engineer Niamh Henry officially launched the PA-X Tracker: Peace and Transition Process Tracker during the conference's first keynote. The innovative tool promises to become an essential resource for academics and practitioners alike, offering timely insights into peace and transition processes globally, with data drawn from PeaceRep's comprehensive PA-X Peace Agreements Database and other trusted sources.

PeaceRep's Commitment to Inclusivity and Global Dialogue

For the first time, PeaceRep-funded scholarships were awarded to seven participants from countries eligible for Official Development Assistance (ODA). These scholarships, designed to foster global dialogue, diversity, and inclusivity, enabled scholars from underrepresented regions to attend and contribute to the conference. This initiative underscores PeaceRep's commitment to expanding collaborative research opportunities and elevating diverse voices in peace and conflict discourse.

Keynotes: Expanding the Scope of Peace Research

Another highlight was the keynote delivered by Roger Mac Ginty, a member of PeaceRep's International Advisory Board. His presentation, titled "Peace Fragmentation: Maybe That's a Good Thing," offered provocative insights into how fragmentation within peace processes can present both challenges and opportunities for conflict resolution. Questions raised by this keynote were alluded to throughout the conference in later panels.

The conference also recognized outstanding contributions to the field. Imrana Alhaji Buba was awarded the Cedric Smith Prize for the best piece of research by a PhD candidate or someone having recently passed their PhD defense, for the paper, "Civilian Protection Payment and the Escalation of Violence against Civilians in Northwestern Nigeria."

The CRS Book of the Year Prize, which honours research that is contemporary, exceptional and world-leading, went to Peer Schouten for "Roadblock Politics: The Origins of Violence in Central Africa."

Despite an unfortunately timed fire alarm, attendees were happy to return to hear his keynote, which discussed the motif of the roadblock to explain much broader patterns of conflict and state building in Central Africa.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/09/11/global-fragmentation-in-focus/

2024-09-09 / EVENTS HELD

Building Bridges for Collaborative Research: PeaceRep Leads Workshop in Kurdistan Region of Iraq

On 11-12 August 2024, PeaceRep Post-doctoral Research Fellow Juline Beaujouan led a workshop at the University of Salahaddin in Erbil, Kurdistan Region of Iraq (KRI). Hosted by the Social Work Department, the workshop gathered 18 colleagues with expertise in social work, sociology, peace and conflict, and media studies around the themes of Knowledge Exchange and Collaborative Research. The workshop received the support of Professor Assistant Dr Musa Mohammed Khadir, Dean of the College of Arts.

This participatory workshop aimed to facilitate inter-disciplinary and inter-sectoral knowledge exchange between PeaceRep (UK) and the University of Salahaddin-Erbil (KRI), and to foster collaborative partnerships for future research projects. It also addressed the need to codify and systematise collaborative methodology to maximise research impact, while accounting for contextual differences and the essential engagement with local communities.

Attendees of the workshop in August University of Salahaddin. Photo by Juline Beaujouan

Over the course of two days, participants thought creatively about ways to create better forms of knowledge about KRI and Iraq, while reflecting on some key challenges when conducting research in difficult fields. They also started to develop fair, inclusive, and context-specific ethics procedures to guide fieldwork undertaken by staff and students at Salahaddin University's Social Work Department.

Future Collaborations Planned

The workshop has already yielded concrete results. In early September 2024, the Social Work Department appointed its first-ever ethics committee, an important first step at the University of Salahaddin-Erbil. Juline Beaujouan will sit on the committee as an external member and work collaboratively with other members to the development of ethics procedures until the end of the year.

Moreover, Juline Beaujouan and Dr Hakim Qadir Taha, Head of the Social Work Department, are currently working on a Memorandum of Understanding between PeaceRep and the Social Work Department to formalise the collaboration. In the forthcoming months, members of the two institutions will develop multi-disciplinary projects aimed at better understanding and contributing to sustainable peace in KRI and the rest of Iraq.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/09/09/building-bridges-for-collaborative-research/

2024-07-22 / RECOGNITION

Professor Louise Mallinder, PeaceRep Steering Committee member, joins Royal Irish Academy

Professor Louise Mallinder, member of PeaceRep's Steering Committee and Research Team based at Queens University Belfast, was officially admitted to the Royal Irish Academy on 28 May 2024 at a special ceremony in Dublin.

Photo by Royal Irish Academy/Queens University Belfast

As one of just 28 new members admitted to the Academy, Professor Mallinder was elected in recognition of her outstanding contributions to the humanities and social sciences.

A Professor of Law at Queens University Belfast, Professor Mallinder is also the Deputy Director at the Senator George J. Mitchell Institute for Global Peace, Justice and Security. Recognised as a globally leading figure in the study of Human Rights Law, her work with PeaceRep focuses primarily on amnesty laws and transitional justice. She is also the creator of the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement (ACPA) dataset, which forms part of the PA-X suite of datasets and digital tools.

The Royal Irish Academy was established in 1785 and honours Ireland's leading scholars. Members are formally admitted during a ceremony where they pledge the Member's Declaration of Obligations and sign the Roll Book of Members. Past members include Nobel laureates such as WB Yeats and Seamus Heaney.

The 28 newly elected members include Dr Ruth Patterson, the first woman to be ordained in Ireland, and Professor Brendan Kelly, who has published extensively on Ireland's history of institutional confinement.

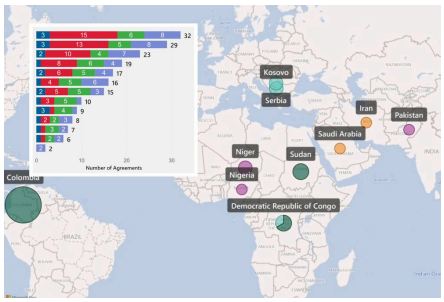
Explore Professor Mallinder's work:

- Blogpost: The Role of Transitional Justice in Ukraine
- Transitional Justice Series report: Amnesties and Inclusive Political Settlements
- Dataset: Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement (ACPA)

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/07/22/professor-louise-mallinder-peacerep-steering-committee-member-joins-royal-irish-academy/

2024-07-16 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New PA-X Data Report Highlights Peace Agreement Trends and Insights in 2023



PeaceRep has released a new data report sharing insights into global peace agreements signed in 2023. These agreements were added to Version 8 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database as part of its recent expansion.

A useful resource for peacebuilders and researchers alike, the data report summarises highlights from Version 8 of PA-X, including the characteristics of agreements in 2023 and their contents, gender provisions, local agreements, ongoing peace processes, and analysis of China as a third-party actor.

Key takeaways for 2023

With the number of peace agreements in 2023 primarily driven by the Colombian peace process, the data report reveals that the number of peace agreements signed each year is continuing to decline. This downward trend, along with an increased proportion of ceasefire and implementation agreements, calls for further interrogation of the changing nature and characteristics of peace processes.

Thirty-one (excluding local) agreements were signed in 2023. Of these 31 agreements:

- The **Colombian** peace process accounted for **68%** of agreements
- **87%** dealt with **intrastate** conflicts within a state's borders (27 agreements)
- **42%** were **ceasefire** agreements (compared to an average of 19% since 1990)
- **26%** included reference to **women, girls, gender, or sexual violence**

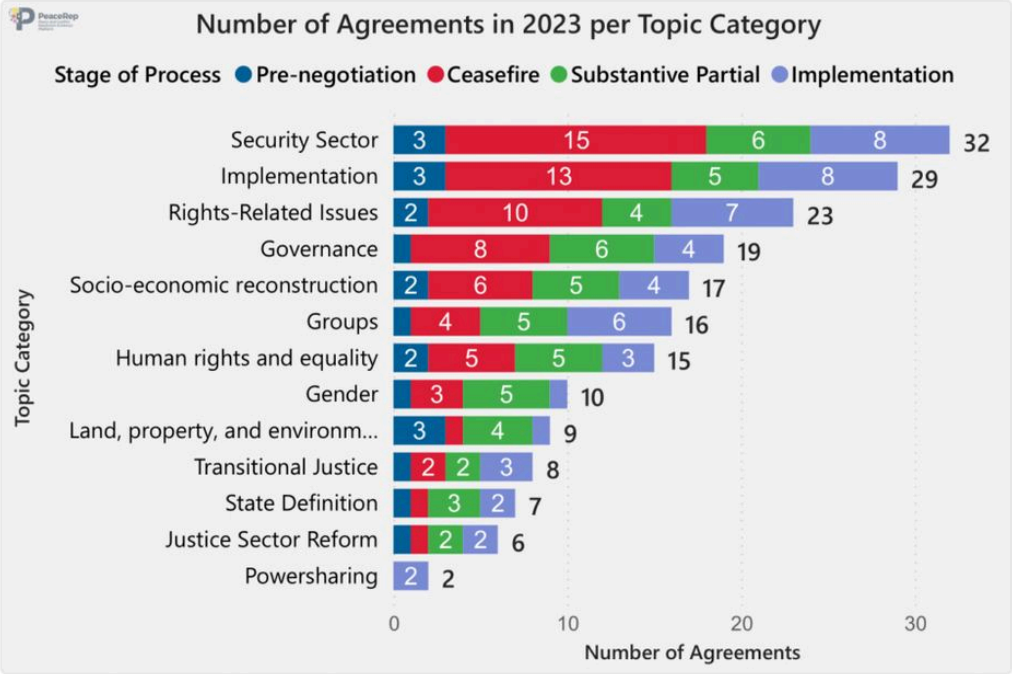
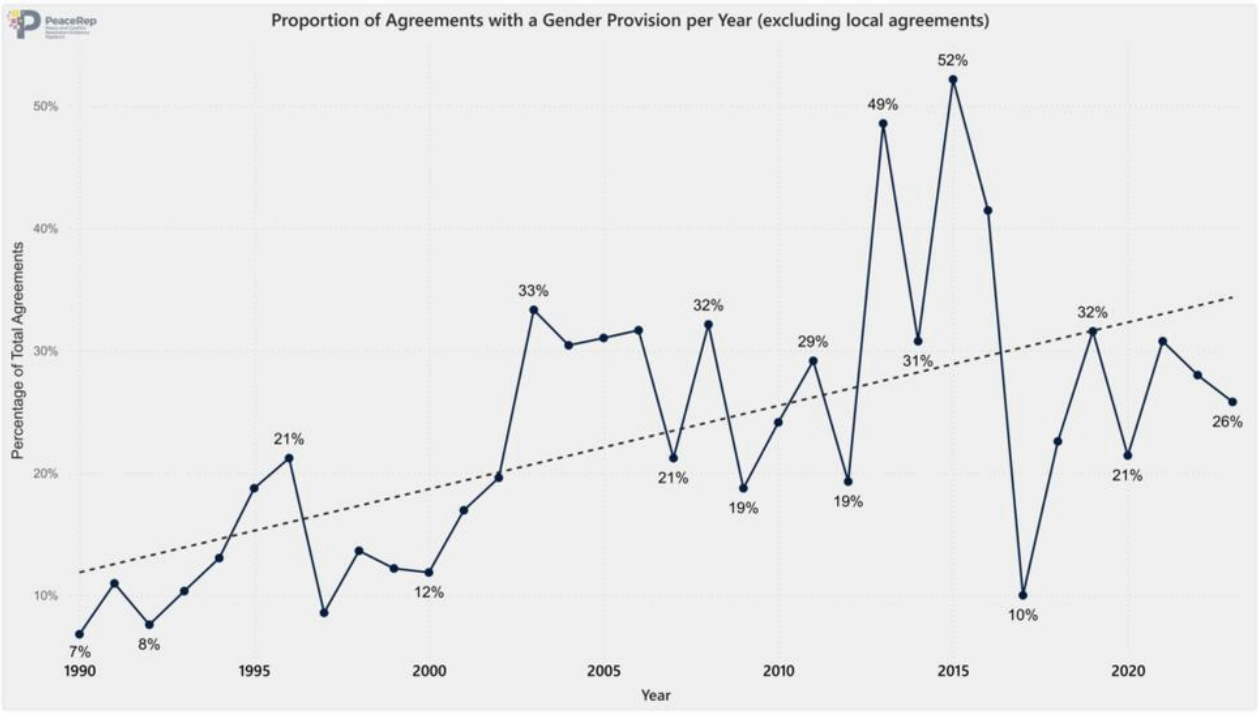


Figure 6 of the report shows the range of topics covered by peace agreements in 2023, with 90% of agreements including provisions relating to the security sector.

The report also examines China's role as a third-party signatory after China mediated an agreement between Iran and Saudi Arabia in 2023. This development reveals a shift in global diplomatic dynamics, with the complex roles of international mediators requiring further research.



The report highlights trends in peace agreements since 1990, including the proportion of agreements with a gender provision, as shown above.

The full data report explores these topics in greater detail, including data on gender provisions in peace agreements and the four local agreements from 2023 included in PA-X V8.

About PA-X

In 2024, PeaceRep launched Version 8 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, adding 52 new agreements and enhancing the database's accessibility and search functionality.

As a cornerstone of PeaceRep's PeaceTech work, the PA-X Peace Agreements Database is the world's most comprehensive collection of peace agreements. PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools to support research, policy and practice, including visualisations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

Read the data report: Peace Agreements in 2023: Insights from the PA-X Database

Explore the updated 'Messy Peace Processes' visualisation, now including PA-X V8 data

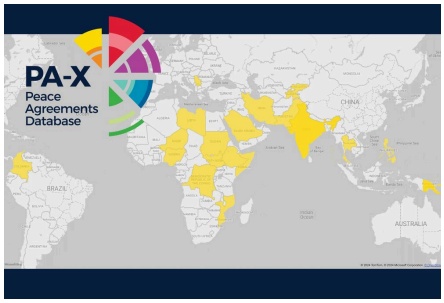
Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, Version 8

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/07/16/new-pa-x-data-report-highlights-peace-agreement-trends-and-insights-in-2023/

2024-05-27 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PeaceRep Releases PA-X V8 with New Agreements and Enhanced Accessibility

The PA-X Peace Agreement Database has just unveiled its eighth iteration, Version 8, marking a significant enhancement to this resource. With the addition of 52 new agreements, the database now boasts a comprehensive collection of 2,055 peace agreements that span the globe. These documents, pivotal in their roles in conflict resolution, have been gathered from over 170 peace processes between 1990 and 2024, with the latest entries capturing agreements up until January 2024.



Map created by Niamh Henry

This update not only enriches the PA-X collection with recent developments from countries like Colombia, Sudan, and the Philippines, but also incorporates historical agreements to deepen the repository's archival value.

The PA-X Gender database sees an addition of 14 agreements, each shedding light on the critical intersection of gender issues within peace processes. Similarly, the PA-X Local database grows with five new entries, spotlighting localised responses to armed conflicts. These expansions underscore PA-X's commitment to offering nuanced insights into the complex tapestry of today's peace processes.

Improving Accessibility

The V8 release also introduces an innovative update to the search functionality, enhancing the user experience. This new feature allows researchers and scholars to view categorized segments within the broader context of each agreement, thus providing a richer analytical perspective on the documents' contents.

Accessibility remains a cornerstone of the PA-X initiative. As with previous versions, the content of each agreement in the V8 release is meticulously coded and available for exploration on the PA-X website.

Users interested in a deeper dive can download the data as a CSV file for quantitative analysis or as a comprehensive corpus of agreement texts. For those seeking detailed study, PDF documents of each agreement are available, with translations into English provided alongside the original versions whenever available.

About PA-X

As a cornerstone of our PeaceTech work, the PA-X Peace Agreements Database is the world's most comprehensive collection of peace agreements. PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools to support research, policy and practice, including visualisations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

PA-X V8 also feeds through the PA-X Tracker, a new, innovative digital tool offering data-driven insights to support peace and transition processes. The suite of PeaceTech tools contained within the PA-X Tracker enables users to track and monitor progress and implementation of peace and transition processes. The Tracker allows users to understand how peace processes are unfolding, who is involved in them, and what impact the processes have had on a range of institutional, political, economic, humanitarian and security indicators.

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, Version 8

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/05/27/peacerep-releases-pa-x-v8-with-new-agreements-and-enhanced-accessibility/

2024-05-13 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

Gender and Peace Processes Short Course Applications Now Open

PeaceRep's five-week online course for peacebuilding professionals provides an overview of the latest developments in the field of gender, peace and security, with a focus on gender inclusive peace processes in a rapidly changing world. The September intake will take place from 16 September – 25 October 2024.

Photo by Mohammed Huwais/AFP via Getty Images

Open to all, the five-week course aims to build knowledge capacity in gender inclusion in peace processes, particularly among peacebuilding professionals in international organisations, non-governmental organisations, government, and/or academia. Students will learn how to use leading PeaceTech and data tools to assess gender inclusion in peace processes and strategize for inclusive change. Each week will cover a different topic related to gender inclusion and peace processes, including the Women, Peace and Security agenda, gender perspectives in peace agreements, and the challenges of advocating for gender inclusive peace processes in fragmented contemporary conflicts.

PeaceRep Research Fellow Laura Wise will lead the course. An expert in her field, Laura has previously worked with UN Women to support women engaged in peace processes in Syria, Yemen, Iraq, and Libya.

Apply by 30 June 2024 to be part of the September 2024 cohort.

Read more and apply: Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World

Course Feedback

Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World first ran in early 2024. Feedback from participants in the inaugural cohort shows that students welcomed the opportunity to share and learn from the experiences of others, the access to resources and tools to support gender inclusive peacebuilding, and the dedicated time to reflect on best practice in gender inclusive peacebuilding.

> "The seminars were a highlight of the course, as an invaluable place to learn from the experiences of others working in similar spaces. Laura was an excellent facilitator and she created an environment that was inclusive and engaging, with opportunities to participate on many levels depending on the student's expertise." – Previous participant

> "This course is a new academic area of learning for me so all topics were interesting to me. The live sessions and discussions added practical knowledge for me. The course provide a good picture of trends, issues, risks and opportunities in peace processes. I have been enlightened by the arguments for 'inclusive' peace processes." – Previous participant

About PeaceRep Teaching

As part of our teaching programme, PeaceRep offers part-time, short online courses designed to support the development of conflict advisers and peacebuilding professionals through carefully curated resources and expert-led seminars on cutting-edge peace process research.

Two additional short courses will run in early 2025: Conflict Transitions in the Eastern Mediterranean Region (January-February 2025) and Skills-building for Working in Conflict Transitions (February-March 2025).

Sign up to PeaceRep teaching updates to be notified when applications open.
Contact peacerep.teaching@ed.ac.uk for more information.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/05/13/gender-short-course/

2024-04-05 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Still Time to Talk: PeaceRep research features in Accord 30

PeaceRep partner Conciliation Resources recently published their highly anticipated new Accord, which focuses on the evolving mediation landscape. Accord 30 explores innovative approaches to engage armed groups, navigate the digital environment, and ensure diverse views are incorporated into peace processes.

PeaceRep thinking contributed extensively to the report, including the underlying approach and the following articles by PeaceRep authors:

1. **'Multimediation': adapting in response to fragmentation (Christine Bell)**In her contribution, Christine Bell argues that 'multimediation' – a collection of mediation and dialogue innovations taking place through ad hoc initiatives across contexts and organisations – could benefit from being developed into a more deliberate collective strategy. She suggests that multimediation could provide a pragmatic response to conflict fragmentation.
2. **Diversification and congestion in international peacemaking (Mateja Peter and Sanja Badanjak)**In their chapter, Mateja Peter and Sanja Badanja draw on data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database to provide insights into changing trends in international involvement in peacemaking. Across the mediation field, data shows diversification of third parties in peace processes and potential for congestion. These trends, they argue, are contributing to an increasingly fragmented mediation space.

PeaceRep Managing Director, Tim Epple, reflects:

> Conciliation Resource's new Accord could not have been timelier. Teresa Whitfield has done an incredible job editing this volume that is released at a time when peacemaking has come under considerable pressure. Recent armed conflicts and increasing fragmentation of both conflict and mediation constellations have led mediators to seriously reconsider their approaches and strategies. This Accord issue of 128 pages offers rich analysis and practical recommendations for a field at a crossroads.

Epple continues: "As the applicability of peacemaking models of the 1990s to today's conflicts is – rightfully – questioned, this volume provides both a sobering assessment of the limits of conventional mediation approaches while highlighting the immense adaptation and innovation that negotiators, civic actors, and mediators have driven in the recent past. We are proud to have contributed two chapters based on our work. PeaceRep can now draw on years of rigorous empirical research into exactly the kind of dilemmas this Accord so beautifully distills. We congratulate Conciliation Resources, Teresa Whitfield, and all those who have contributed to this Accord issue which will be an indispensable resource for years to come!"

This issue of Accord explores areas of adaptation and innovation in peace mediation in four sections:

1. The landscape for peace mediation
2. Diversified mediators, mandates and ambitions
3. Engaging resistant, elusive and excluded parties in peace mediation
4. Mediating with and on technology

Among the many recommendations included in the volume, and amid contexts of 'multimediation', Christine Bell proposes to:

- First, at the national level it would be possible to develop better mapping and exchange of information on mediation and peace efforts in ways that do not destroy them (recognising the need for discretion around some initiatives).
- Second, at the global level, there is a need for innovation in how to mediate between the mediators. In the short term, so Bell, thinking about how very different types of mediator could at least be corralled into some joint forums of information exchange or even dialogue, would be useful.
- Third, alongside these process innovations, we may also need substance innovation. Bell asks, provocatively: Could we find more novel ways to fund coherent pockets of democratisation or 'civicness' and self-government, without requiring it somehow to be fit into an idealised (state) architecture that bears very little relationship to how power is actually transacted?

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/04/05/still-time-to-talk-peacerep-research-features-in-accord-30/

2024-02-08 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PeaceRep launches the PA-X Tracker: Peace and Transition Process Tracker

Introducing a groundbreaking addition to its PeaceTech toolkit, PeaceRep launches the PA-X Tracker this week. This cutting-edge tool provides data-driven, evidence-based support to inform decision-making and research into peace and transition processes. It forms part of PeaceRep's wider commitment to peace analytics, leveraging technology for the digital transformation of peace and transition process design.

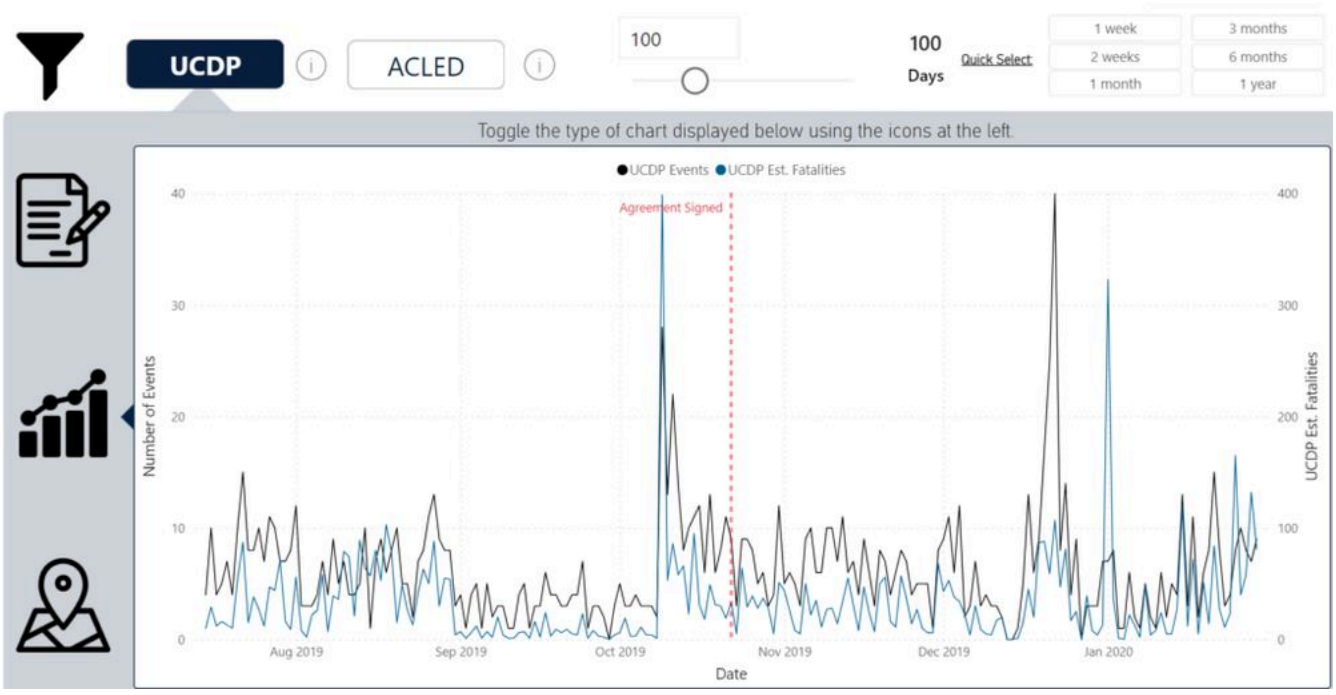
About the PA-X Tracker

The PA-X Tracker combines a range of data tools to enable users to track and monitor the progress and implementation of peace and transition processes.

The Tracker allows users to understand how peace processes are unfolding, who is involved in them, and what impact the processes have had on a range of institutional, political, economic, humanitarian and security indicators.

Users can compare data across different country contexts, or can select a country of interest to view country-specific data on a timeline, through interactive dashboards, interactive network graphs and other data driven applications.

The Tracker is designed for international, national and local mediators, peacebuilders, researchers, policymakers and anyone with an interest in understanding and monitoring contemporary peace and transition processes.



A 'before and after' view of the Tracker showing conflict events

What can the PA-X Tracker do?

The Tracker draws on the PA-X Peace Agreement Database and external data from trusted sources to offer:

- Interactive timelines of institutional change and key moments in a peace process
- Actor network graphs showing past agreement signatories
- Peace process overviews to enable comparative analysis
- Quantitative data for measurement of peace and conflict impacts
- Interactive maps that combine data to show a picture of peace and conflict data
- Local data collections bridging the gap between quantitative pictures of change and local perceptions of peace
- Qualitative implementation data for South Sudan and Ukraine

Pioneering Peace Analytics

PeaceTech is the use of digital innovation to support peacebuilding practices to improve and extend. PeaceRep is building PeaceTech innovation focused on better data for supporting adaptive management of peace and transition processes.

The Tracker forms a key part of PeaceRep's suite of peace analytics tools, supporting practitioners and researchers in accessing, visualising, and exploring peace and conflict data. The Tracker brings together quantitative, qualitative, structured and unstructured data into one interactive platform to provide strategic insight for the adaptive management of peace process implementation.

The Tracker builds on and expands the PA-X Peace Agreements Database into a broader platform for peace process data and analytics.

PeaceRep Executive Director Christine Bell introduces the PA-X Tracker in a new book, PeaceTech: Digital Transformation to End Wars. The chapter highlights PeaceRep's efforts to develop the Tracker in line with best practice in FAIR Principles for data management, including data interoperability and data literacy, and illustrates how peace analytics can support adaptive management of peace processes. The methodology for the Tracker can be found here.

Further information

The PA-X Tracker is now accessible from the new PA-X homepage, where you can track, search and explore all from peaceagreements.org. The new interface also includes a download centre to make it easier for users to find and access datasets and codebooks.

The Tracker is a live and growing platform. PeaceRep now enters a phase of continuing end user engagements and iterative design improvements, building to launch events around the UK, and online, later in 2024.

We expect to implement further updates and improvements to the Tracker as we gain insights into how users navigate and make use of the tool. During this period of interactive feedback, users can expect additional expansions and releases.

We welcome any and all feedback on the Tracker at peacerep@ed.ac.uk.

Learn more about the PA-X Tracker

Explore the PA-X Tracker

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/02/08/peacerep-launches-the-pa-x-tracker-peace-and-transition-process-tracker/

2024-01-22 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Introducing PeaceRep's New PA-X Peace Agreement Analysts

Members of the PeaceRep team based at the University of Edinburgh.

As PeaceRep prepares to release Version 8 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database later in 2024, we welcome five individuals to the PA-X team during this critical time. Our new PA-X Peace Agreement Analysts have joined the PA-X team to add additional capacity and assist with implementing key updates to PA-X V8.

We are delighted to introduce:

1. Moosa Izzat: Moosa's academic pursuits in Human Rights and Legal Studies, complemented by his research on citizenship laws, minority rights, and legal aid, are a great addition and serve our analytical needs. His internships and research roles, including at the Political Conflict, Gender and People's Rights Initiative at the University of California, Berkeley, showcase his adeptness in complex legal matters.

2. Kelsey Kestenbaum: With her background in Human Rights and Political Science, Kelsey's focus on global politics and international conflict is noteworthy. Her expertise in research and data organisation, honed through work on projects like International Crisis Behavior of Big, Allied, and Dangerous Organizations (ICBAAD), National Counterterrorism, Innovation, Technology, and Education Center (NCITE), and her experience at the US Government Accountability Office, make her a valuable asset to our team.

3. Tom Morley: Tom's focus on Human Rights and conflict resolution, especially in the MENA region, is enhanced by his academic background in Arabic and International Relations. His cultural experiences in Tunisia and Oman, along with his proficiency in Arabic, provide a deeper understanding of Middle Eastern conflicts.

4. Saketh Srinivas Pittala: Saketh's motivation for peace, rooted in personal experiences and his service in the National Cadet Corps Indian Army, underscores his commitment. His Public Administration background, research on conflict areas, and technical skills in database management and server operations are important contributions to our program.

5. Surya Kiran Yadav: Surya's first-hand experience in post-conflict environments, especially in Nepal and the Philippines, brings a unique perspective. His work with various institutions on conflict analysis and transitional justice, coupled with his research skills, enriches our team's expertise.

The new PA-X Analysts collectively bring a wealth of knowledge in research, data analysis, language proficiency, and cultural insights., and we are thrilled about the potential impact and fresh

perspectives they will bring to the PA-X team. Their diverse backgrounds and skills reinforce our commitment to understanding complex global conflicts and contributing to lasting peace.

PA-X is currently the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world. Currently in Version 7, PA-X contains 2,003 peace agreements, found in more than 150 peace processes between 1990 and 2023. PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools to support policy and practice, including visualisations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and a mobile app.

PA-X V8 will be released later in the year. Subscribe to PeaceRep's newsletter to be notified when the new release is live.

Welcome aboard, team!

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2024/01/22/introducing-peacereps-new-pa-x-peace-agreement-analysts/

2023

30 stories · Full original text

2023-12-15 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

COP28 highlights intersections between conflict and climate change

Acknowledging the links between climate change and conflict

Photo by GIUSEPPE CACACE/AFP via Getty Images

On 3 December 2023, COP28 dedicated the first ever thematic day to Relief, Recovery, and Peace, culminating in a new declaration on climate, relief, recovery and peace that calls for bolder collective action for climate resilience in conflict-affected contexts.

Although fragile and conflict-affected states are among the hardest hit by the effects of climate change, they are allocated a disproportionately small amount of international resources for adaptation and recovery, and are particularly vulnerable to climate hazards and shocks. In countries experiencing conflict, climate change can exacerbate displacement, food insecurity, and humanitarian crises, and heighten instability. The declaration acknowledges these intersecting effects of conflict and climate change, and states:

"On the occasion of the 28th UN Climate Change Conference, the first Global Stocktake under the Paris Agreement, as well as the first Relief, Recovery and Peace Day at a COP, call for bolder collective action to build climate resilience at the scale and speed required in highly vulnerable countries and communities, particularly those threatened or affected by fragility or conflict, or facing severe humanitarian needs, many of which are Least Developed Countries and Small Island Developing States. We stress that an ambitious, immediate scale up of enhanced support is urgently needed in such situations, including financial resources; technical and institutional capacities; local, national, regional partnerships; and data and information, recognizing the importance of complementarity and predictability."

The declaration commits to:

1. Enhanced financial support for climate adaptation and resilience
2. Understand and improve good practice and programming
3. Strengthen coordination, collaboration, and partnerships

As a non-binding call to action outside the UNFCCC negotiations, the declaration has so far been endorsed by 74 countries and 40 organisations. Intended to accelerate climate action and resourcing in conflict-affected contexts, the declaration may be used as the start of discussions around climate-sensitive programming for practitioners and policymakers. Time will tell whether the declaration is

sufficient to mobilise the international community to take meaningful conflict-sensitive climate action.

PeaceRep research on climate, peace, and conflict

PeaceRep's research increasingly addresses the nexus between environmental issues, climate change, conflict, and peace processes. Browse our key findings on environment, climate, and conflict.

About ten percent (211 out of 2003) of global peace agreements from 1990-2023 include provisions relating to the environment. In recent years, a small number of peace processes have recognised the issue and impacts of climate change, through peace agreement provisions that explicitly reference climate change. These include commitments to prepare to mitigate risks caused by climate change, introducing legislation in line with the Paris Agreement, supporting hydropower development, mainstreaming climate change issues in policy, and acknowledging the impact of climate change on desertification in conflict between farmers and pastoralists (PA-X Version 7, 2023).

Relevant publications

Decarbonization and Conflict Resolution: Implications for the Clean Energy Transition
This policy brief from the World Peace Foundation outlines a new, nuanced relationship among conflict, peacemaking, and natural resources in violent, transactional political systems, describing how the availability of discretionary oil rents impacts patterns of peacemaking. In a related blog on decarbonization and conflict resolution, the a WPF highlights how proposed policies need careful consideration where they may lead to destabilization for carbon-based political marketplaces.

The New Era of Turbulence: Peacemaking Trends in Post-Carbon Times
Based on an empirical comparison of peace processes in carbon-dependent economies over time, this article investigates the impact of decarbonization and the related decline of political finance in respective political marketplaces on peacemaking. The author argues that, while the period of high oil prices in the mid-2000s was characterised several significant peace deals that attempted comprehensive settlements, the decline of oil prices in the years from 2013 to 2021 has led to a new era of turbulence.

Managing Climate Change under the De Facto Authorities
The Afghanistan Research Network discusses the state of climate change-related work in Afghanistan prior to the collapse of the Republic, and offers a series of practical recommendations for resuming work on this issue in the current context.

Resolving Water Conflicts: Dispute Settlement Mechanisms Applicable to International Water Resources
This report sets out in very general terms the international legal framework that supports dispute resolution, focusing in particular on a range of dispute mechanisms that are available to states with transboundary water disputes that could be considered to be part of any 'tool kit' of conflict avoidance or resolution.

Water Resources and Inter-state Conflict: Legal Principles and the Grand Ethiopian Renaissance Dam (GERD)
This report draws together the key principles of international law applicable to transboundary watercourse disputes regarding quantity of water, and assesses the extent to which these principles provide guidance in negotiating the Egypt-Ethiopia watercourse conflict whilst also giving

consideration to other cases. The report examines how the principles of international law identified have been used in other similar negotiations, and may help guide the negotiations of the Egypt-Ethiopia conflict. A central component of the report suggests that a shift away from security centric zero-sum game water negotiations is possible if a more human needs based approach is adopted by states that find themselves in deadlocked hydro disputes.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/12/15/cop28-highlights-intersections-between-conflict-and-climate-change/

2023-12-04 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Conflict Research Society and PeaceRep to host 2024 conference in Edinburgh

In September 2024, the annual CRS conference will be hosted in partnership with PeaceRep at Edinburgh Law School.

The theme of the conference is '**Global (De-)Fragmentation? Consequences for Peace and Conflict Research and Practice**.' Submissions for proposals will be accepted until 20 January 2024.

This year, PeaceRep is excited to offer a limited number of PeaceRep ODA Scholarships for selected presenters from ODA recipient countries. Early career researchers are particularly encouraged to apply by submitting a paper to present at CRS 2024. The scholarship will cover the cost of attending the conference in Edinburgh, with full selection criteria available here.

The 2024 CRS conference theme

In recent years, intrastate conflict and mediation efforts appear to be more fragmented than ever before. Intrastate conflicts now exhibit higher levels of fragmentation, involving competing actors and interests across local, national and international levels.

As the international dynamics of conflict generation and resolution continually shift, creative solutions are urgently needed. The 2024 CRS conference aims to encourage dialogue, diversity and inclusiveness, and collaboration to find new approaches to achieving lasting peace.

Learn more about the CRS Call for Papers and the PeaceRep ODA Scholarship.

Explore PeaceRep's research on the theme of fragmentation.

CRS CONFLICT RESEARCH SOCIETY

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/12/04/crs-peacerep-cohost-2024-conference/

2023-11-23 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep awarded RSE Mary Somerville Medal

Members of the PeaceRep team at the University of Edinburgh were delighted to accept the Mary Somerville Medal at the Royal Society of Edinburgh (RSE) 2023 awards ceremony on 22 November.

Photo by Steward Attwood Photography – courtesy of the Royal Society of Edinburgh

The award announcement was made earlier this year, with PeaceRep recognised for its outstanding collaborative work, pivotal role in networking peace and conflict organisations, and digital innovation in peacebuilding research. Christine Bell, PeaceRep's Executive Director, commented:

> At a time when the world seems perilously engaged in war, this medal affirms the importance of continual peacemaking in dark and dangerous moments. Our team at the University of Edinburgh – many of whom started their careers with this project – has been privileged to work as part of a wider team of groups in Scotland, but also including local peacebuilders in contexts as varied as Afghanistan, Syria, South Sudan, Iraq and Yemen.

At yesterday's medal ceremony, PeaceRep was honoured alongside the EAVE II team, also based at the University of Edinburgh. EAVE II was recognised for the team's work on the COVID-19 response in Scotland and the UK and their use of a purpose-built rich data platform.

Members of the PeaceRep team based at the University of Edinburgh.

PeaceRep draws on data from around the world to better understand peace processes, their characteristics and levels of 'success'. With a suite of digital tools already available, PeaceRep is continuing to expand offerings with the recent release of a children and youth interactive dashboard.

Prof Bell continued:

> The award of the medal will encourage us, and we hope others, to continue to explore how new technologies can be used to harness innovation in research and practice. We are honoured to accept it, and in turn pay our tribute to those we work with who are struggling to address the violent conflicts in which they live.

The RSE relaunched its medals in 2022, with the new addition of the Mary Somerville Medal in the previously unrepresented sector of Teamwork and Collaborative Endeavour.

The medal: 'recognizes exceptional achievement in research in teamwork and collaborative endeavour within Scottish Higher Education Institute (HEI), between Scottish HEI and other institutions/businesses, and within other institutions, nationally and internationally.'

As a consortium of research institutions, non-governmental organisations, and local research teams led by the University of Edinburgh Law School, PeaceRep is made up of over 50 researchers, mediation practitioners, lawyers, data scientists, managers, and communications professionals dedicated to reimagining peace and transition processes in changing conflict contexts.

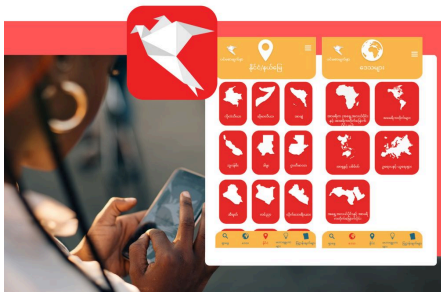
Explore PeaceRep's key research findings, data and digital tools, and publications.

Read more about PeaceRep consortium members.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/11/23/peacerep-awarded-rse-mary-somerville-medal/

2023-11-15 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Burmese translation of PeaceFem app launched



PeaceRep continues to expand the accessibility of PeaceFem with the launch of a Burmese version of the app.

The latest translation of the app supports PeaceRep's goal to extend its reach and accessibility among women's rights advocates in even more regions around the world. The app is now used in more than 60 countries.

This translation follows an update to the app in early 2023, which included translations into French and Indonesian, additional case studies, as well as technical improvements to aid in user experience.

What is PeaceFem?

The PeaceFem app brings together available data on women and peacemaking in one easy-to-use app in Arabic, English, French, Indonesian, and now Burmese. The app contains case studies on women's involvement and gender perspectives in peace processes from around the world, including Afghanistan, Myanmar, Indonesia, and Tunisia.

PeaceRep and our partners UN Women, Inclusive Peace, and the Gender, Peace and Security Centre at Monash University launched the PeaceFem mobile app in 2020. The app was created to meet the demand for tools and resources supporting women's inclusion in peace processes. PeaceFem is designed to support women's rights advocates, mediation teams, and other peace and security actors in influencing peace process negotiations by providing case studies on gender provisions in peace agreements, and strategies used to work for their inclusion.

PeaceFem is an important contribution to the growing field of PeaceTech, which uses data and technology to support peacebuilding. The app draws on case studies developed by Inclusive Peace and Monash University and 30 years of PA-X peace agreement data from the University of Edinburgh.

Women's participation in peacebuilding

Women's participation in peace negotiations contributes to durable peace. However, women are frequently excluded from participating, or face great personal risk in doing so. The recent Open

Debate on UN Security Council Resolution 1325 was informed by the Secretary-General's annual report, which once again cited PeaceRep research to illustrate the slow progress in women's participation and inclusion in peace processes.

Recent analysis demonstrates and reaffirms the need to prioritise women's inclusion in peace processes. Using a suite of PeaceTech data tools, including PeaceFem, PeaceRep aims to support women's participation in peacebuilding.

Download PeaceFem

PeaceFem is free to download from the Google Play Store (for Android) and the Apple App Store (for iOS). For more information, contact peacefem@ed.ac.uk.

Read more about PeaceFem: explore key features, and access user guides and how-to videos.

PeaceFem is a collaboration between UN Women, Inclusive Peace, Monash University's Gender, Peace and Security Centre, and PeaceRep: The Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform at the University of Edinburgh.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/11/15/burmese-translation-peacefem-launched/

2023-11-03 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New dashboard on children and youth in peace agreements released

Browse the interactive dashboard

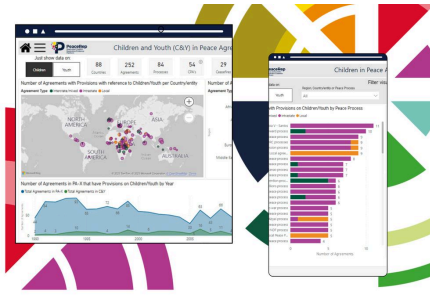


Image by PeaceRep

A comprehensive interactive dashboard offering unique insights into references to children and youth (C&Y) in peace agreements signed between 1990 and 2022 is now available.

About the C&Y dashboard

The interactive dashboard is the latest addition to PeaceRep's suite of PeaceTech data tools. It is based on Dr Sean Molloy's new 'Children and Youth in Peace Agreements Database and Dataset', which was created using 348 peace agreements from the PA-X database that code for general references to children and youth.

The dataset takes a closer look at the identified provisions and categorises them into specific topics, including child soldiers, children's rights, children and transitional justice, children and third-party actors and children and references to their inclusion, protection and provision.

Alongside the interactive dashboard, a new report by Sean Molloy, 'Child Soldiers and Peace Agreements,' was released this week. The report finds that of the 252 peace agreements signed between 1990 and 2022 that include references to children, 77 address child soldiers. The report also includes recommendations on how peace agreements can best address the issue of child soldiers.

Molloy shares insights on why further research is needed on children and how they feature in peace agreements, as well as the creation of the dataset:

> Peace agreements offer important opportunities to ensure that peacebuilding and post-conflict reconstruction efforts place children at their centre. Yet, there is relatively little known about how peace agreements address children, whether child-focused provisions are implemented, and what impact, if any, they have. This dataset helps to address the first of these gaps. It provides important data on when and how various types of peace agreement include commitments targeting children. In doing so, this database also facilitates future research on whether and how peace agreement provisions on children are implemented and the effects of this implementation on children's lives post-conflict.

Initially conceived of as a database on children in peace agreements, the final iteration also includes provisions relating to youth. Varying definitions of 'child' and/or 'youth' in different countries represented a challenge in the development of the database, so including provisions relating to both terms will assist users in determining where youth references might also pertain to children.

Additional background on the dashboard

Dr Sean Molloy is a PeaceRep Associate and NUAcT Fellow in Law based at Newcastle Law School (Newcastle University). His research focuses on children's rights, peace processes and transitional justice.

The dashboard was developed by PeaceRep Fellow in Data Engineering, Niamh Henry. A codebook is also available to assist users in navigating the dashboard.

This dashboard is our most recent addition to a collection of PeaceTech data and digital tools aimed at aiding policy and practice. PeaceRep is dedicated to PeaceTech innovation, particularly enhanced data for facilitating adaptive peace and transition process management.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/11/03/new-database-on-children-youth-peace-agreements/

2023-10-26 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PeaceRep analysis informs UN Secretary-General report on women, peace and security

Photo by UN Women

Once again, PeaceRep research informed the UN Secretary-General's report for the annual debate on women, peace and security.

The report draws on PeaceRep research to illustrate the slow progress in women's participation and inclusion in peace processes. The report, released in September 2023, informed the annual UN Security Council Open Debate on 25 October 2023.

The Open Debate on Security Council Resolution 1325[i] has taken place every year since the adoption of the resolution in 2000. The debate aims to further the women, peace and security agenda. The focus of this year's meeting was 'Women's participation in international peace and security: from theory to practice'.

The debate was informed by the annual report of the Secretary-General António Guterres on women and peace and security. In his report, Guterres noted that displacement and conflict can 'turn back the clock on women's rights'. Once again, the report[ii] draws on PeaceRep research to illustrate trends in women's participation and inclusion in peace processes. The report includes a chart drawn from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database version 7, showing the percentage of peace agreements with gender provisions from 2000–2022. The report also cites analysis from a recent blogpost by Laura Wise and Fiona Knäussel, '(Still) Searching for Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements'.

PeaceRep research is cited on page 3, point 8:

> Trend data since 1990 show that seldom are representatives of women's groups found as signatories of agreements. Of 18 peace agreements reached in 2022, only one (according to independent research) was signed or witnessed by a representative of a women's group or organization.

PeaceRep research is also cited on page 5, point 13:

> Peace agreements are key to creating the foundation for an inclusive and sustainable future. Research suggests that in 2022, 6 of the 18 peace agreements reached, or 33 per cent, included provisions referring to women, girls and gender. This is a similar proportion to recent years, with the proportion of agreements that include gender references plateauing between 20 and 35 per cent each year...

The report also includes further analysis from PeaceRep of substantive references to women's participation in those peace agreements, and the difficulties of implementing those provisions in Sudan.

Read the research behind the report
(Still) Searching for Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements

Local Peace Processes: Opportunities and Challenges for Women's Engagement

Read the full UN Security Council report
Report of the Secretary-General: Women, peace and security

References

[i] Security Council Resolution 1325

[ii] UN Security Council Report of the Secretary-General: Women and peace and security

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/10/26/peacerep-analysis-informs-un-secretary-general-report-on-women-peace-and-security/

2023-10-25 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Peace Analytics Series launched with new analytical insights from PeaceFem app

A new research paper using the PeaceFem mediation app as a unique dataset offers new insights on women's inclusion in peace processes.

In 'From Protests to Paper: Using PeaceFem to Analyse Women's Inclusion in Peace Processes', PeaceRep researcher Laura Wise explores the peace process data included in the PeaceFem app.

The paper is the first in PeaceRep's **Peace Analytics Series**, which presents the methodologies behind our leading PeaceTech innovations and contributes to a new research digital infrastructure in the field of peace and conflict studies.

Photo by Mustafa Saeed/AFP via Getty Images

A subsequent report on geocoding for peace and conflict studies will be released in early November, followed by papers on topics including semantic analysis for peace analytics, understanding PeaceTech, and named entity recognition. Subscribe to our newsletter to receive the latest reports as they are released.

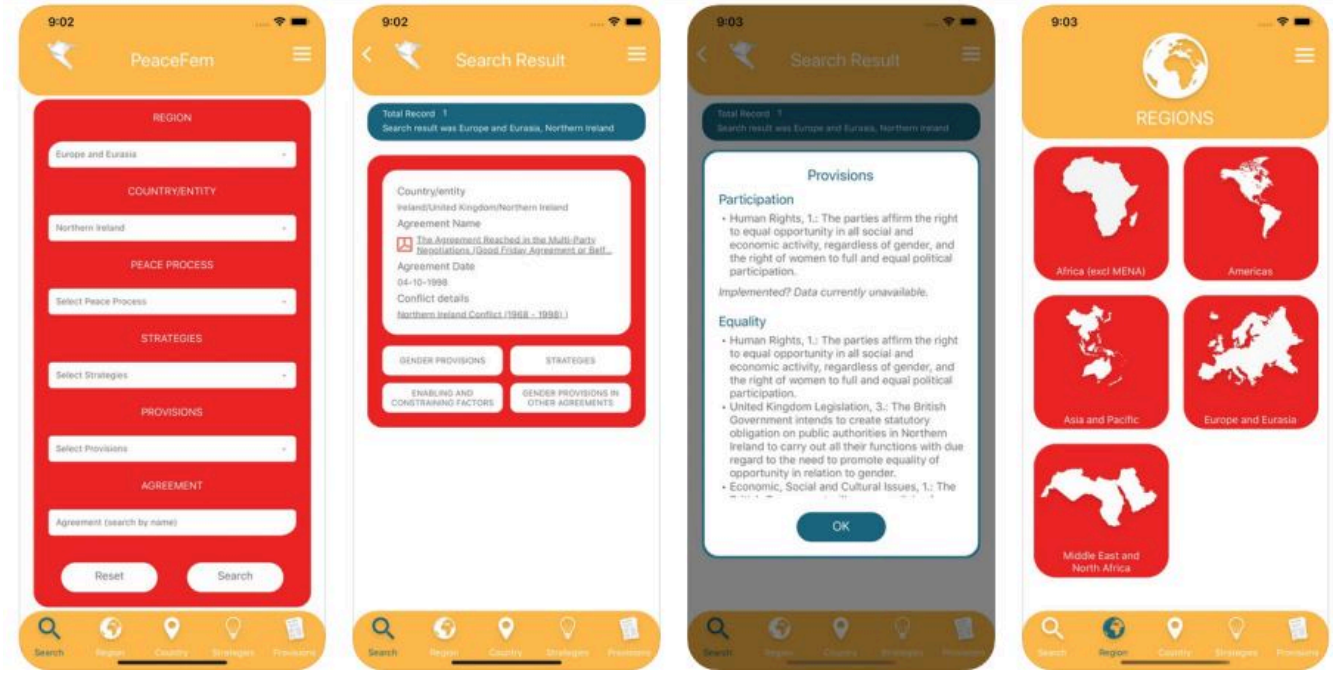
Findings from PeaceFem as a dataset

PeaceFem is a mobile app that illustrates women's inclusion in peace processes around the world. A contribution to the growing field of PeaceTech, which uses technology to support peacebuilding and peace mediation, the app brings together data on women and peacemaking in one easy to-use app in English, Arabic, French, and Indonesian. It is intended for use as an information tool by women's rights advocates, mediation and negotiation teams, as well as other actors working in peace and security, and to act as inspiration for anyone interested in inclusive peace mediation. PeaceFem provides information about strategies and modalities that women have used to influence peace agreements, the enabling and constraining factors that shaped the space for influence, and the gender provisions in the peace agreements that resulted, with some information on how well they were implemented.

The paper uses the app to review common modalities of women's inclusion in 24 peace processes across a global context, gender provisions in the resultant peace agreements, and important factors that enable and constraining women's full and meaningful participation in conflict transitions. The app matches data from the PA-X Gender Peace Agreement Database (Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform: PeaceRep), the Women in Peace and Transition Processes case study collection (Inclusive Peace), and the Towards Inclusive Peace: Mapping Gender Provisions in Peace Agreements case study collection (Monash Centre for Gender, Peace, & Security). The resultant dataset covers 39 peace agreements across 24 peace processes in 22 countries, from 1993 to 2016, with a focus on framework agreements (peace agreements that deal with substantive issues as an attempt to resolve the conflict).

The paper finds that:

- Of the 24 peace processes featured on the PeaceFem app, direct representation and consultations were the most common modalities of including women in those processes between 1993 and 2016.
- Peace agreement provisions for women's participation and gender equality were more prevalent than references to women's roles in implementation and women's protection in the same peace processes.
- Enabling factors for women's inclusion are varied and contextual, but there are some common threads across peace processes – such as having an active civil society and a pre-existing presence of women in public life.
- Constraining factors preventing women's inclusion are also contextual, but there are still some commonalities across processes – such as insecurity, violence against women, and negative societal attitudes towards women's political participation.
- As peace processes become increasingly fragmented and new technologies create both threats and opportunities for women's inclusion, PeaceFem provides insight into women, peace and security practices at a time when challenges to gender justice and peace seem greater than ever.



PeaceFem is a mobile phone app that tracks women's inclusion in peace processes around the world.

PeaceFem is a collaboration between UN Women, Inclusive Peace, the Monash University Centre for Gender, Peace & Security, and PeaceRep: Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform at the University of Edinburgh. It is free and available to download via Google Play and Apple Store.

Explore PeaceRep's research on gender perspectives and women's inclusion in peace processes.

Access PeaceRep data on gender perspectives in peace agreements from 1990-2023.

Peace Analytics Series

PeaceRep's Peace Analytics Series features the research methodology underlying the PeaceTech innovations of the PeaceRep programme.

The series includes: data scoping research; 'how to' discussions relating to particular challenges in the field of visualisations and geocoding; and other proof-of-concept tech-based innovations, such as the use of natural language processing. It is intended to present the methodologies and decisions behind our PeaceTech digital research, to make it transparent, and to contribute to establishing a new research digital infrastructure in the field of peace and conflict studies, by supporting others to reuse and repurpose our methodologies and findings.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/10/25/peace-analytics-series-launched-with-new-peacefem-paper/

2023-10-09 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Executive Director to outline plans for PeaceRep's new peace and transition process tracker at Data for Peace Conference

On 16 October 2023, Christine Bell will address the 2023 Data for Peace Conference in a session titled 'Peace Analytics: Peace and Transition Process Tracker'.

At the hybrid event next week, attendees will learn about plans for PeaceRep's new peace and transition process tracker ahead of its launch in 2024. The tracker is designed to support adaptive implementation of peace and transition agreements and builds on expansive PA-X data.

The PA-X Peace Agreements Database is the most comprehensive online archive, database, and dataset of peace agreements and processes between 1990-2023. However, there is a need to contextualise this data in order to analyse how peace agreements and negotiations unfold as part of a process.

Real-time tracking and mapping of peace processes, the conditions around them, and their impact on levels of peace within a country is challenging for many reasons, but can help identify trends and inform policymakers and the general public.

You can join Christine Bell's Breakout Session virtually, free of charge, to learn about the challenges of tracking peace processes, what this means for 'Peace Analytics', and for first insights into the new 'PA-X Tracker' ahead of its launch in 2024.

About the conference:

The 2023 Data for Peace Conference will take place between 16 October – 20 October 2023. The NYU Center on International Cooperation, with support from the Complex Risk Analytics Fund (CRAF'd) and its partners, will host a five-day hybrid conference with national and international experts in the data for peacebuilding and prevention ecosystem to facilitate peer-to-peer exchange and leverage emerging technologies and data science methods to tackle the growing challenges across the humanitarian-development-peace and climate nexus globally.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/10/09/executive-director-address-data-for-peace-conference/

2023-10-03 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PeaceRep hosts Beyond Borders Women in Conflict Fellows

On 23 August 2023, PeaceRep Research Fellows Laura Wise and Juline Beaujouan led a workshop session on 'The Art of Women in Peace' as a collaborative learning space for the Beyond Borders Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship Programme.

Drawing on insights and experiences from PeaceRep research on women in peace processes, and art as a tool for local peace in Syria, the interactive session offered the Fellows a space to reflect on the

challenges of inclusive peace in the places that they work, and potential ways that they can use their art to engender transformative change.

Photo by PeaceRep

The Beyond Borders August 2023 Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship Programme on The Arts as a Tool for Peacebuilding focused on the role and use of the creative arts as a tool for peacebuilding and conflict transformation. The Women in Conflict 1325 Fellowship is based around the principles of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 which "reaffirms the role of women in the prevention and resolution of conflict, peace negotiations, peace-building, peacekeeping, humanitarian response and in post-conflict reconstruction, and stresses the importance of their equal participation in all efforts for the promotion of peace and security".

The Fellowship has been held three times a year since 2016, in Edinburgh and online during the Covid-19 pandemic, and has built up a network of almost 300 women from 27 countries across the Middle East, Africa, South Asia and Latin America.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/10/03/peacerep-hosts-beyond-borders-women-in-conflict-fellows/

2023-10-02 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PeaceRep Launches New Short Course on Gender and Peace Processes

Through PeaceRep's new online course, students from around the world will have the opportunity to engage with cutting-edge materials and interact with leading experts on issues of gender inclusion and peacebuilding.

Photo by Mohammed Huwais/AFP via Getty Images

The short course, 'Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World', is the first of its kind from PeaceRep. Over five weeks, students will explore a range of critical issues, from the Women, Peace and Security agenda to the challenges of advocating for gender inclusive peace processes within the rapidly changing conflict landscape.

PeaceRep Research Fellow Laura Wise will lead the course. An expert in her field, Laura has previously worked with UN Women to support women engaged in peace processes in Syria, Yemen, Iraq, and Libya.

Open to all, the five-week course aims to build knowledge capacity in gender inclusion in peace processes, particularly among peacebuilding professionals in international organisations, non-governmental organisations, government, and/or academia.

The first cohort of students will begin their studies in January 2024. Students will learn how to use leading PeaceTech and data tools to assess gender inclusion in peace processes and strategize for inclusive change.

Apply by 31 October 2023 to be part of the January 2024 cohort.

Learn more and apply for PeaceRep's new online short course

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/10/02/peacerep-launches-new-short-course-gender/

2023-09-22 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceRep Researcher Addresses OSCE Conference on Gender Equality

The 2023 OSCE Chairpersonship of North Macedonia held the inaugural 2023 Chairpersonship's Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment Conference in Tetovo on 5-6 September 2023. The conference served as a forum for discussions among representatives from the OSCE participating States, partner countries, the private sector, academia, civil society and other international organizations. Participants held substantive discussions on gender equality related issues, while taking stock of achievements towards delivering on the OSCE commitments and also considering possible ways forward to further enhance work for the OSCE region.

PeaceRep Research Fellow and gender lead Laura Wise delivered a presentation as part of the Working Session on 'Women, Peace and Security: strengthening women's participation and leadership to deliver inclusive peacebuilding and conflict management solutions'.

The panel was moderated by Ambassador Michael Carpenter, Permanent Representative of the United States to OSCE, and also featured interventions from:

- H.E. Slavjanka Petrovska, Minister of Defence, North Macedonia
- Ms. Elisa Fernandez, UN Women, Deputy Regional Director for Europe and Central Asia
- Dr. Kateryna Levchenko, Government Commissioner for Gender Equality Policy of Ukraine
- Dr. Elena Stavrevska, Lecturer in International Relations, University of Bristol, and
- Dr. Lara Scarpitta, Senior Advisor on Gender Issues and Head of the Gender Issues Program, Office of the OSCE Secretary General

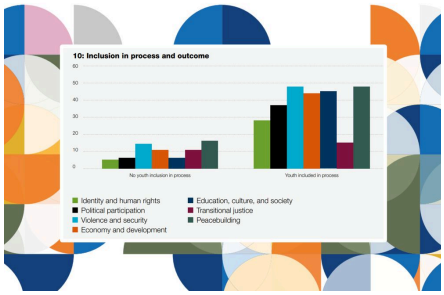
In her intervention, Laura shared insights from her research and the PeaceFem app on women's meaningful participation in peace processes, and discussed some of the enabling and constraining factors that can shape opportunities for inclusion. She also reflected on the current state of the women, peace and security agenda in the OSCE region and beyond.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/09/22/osce-conference-gender-equality/

2023-09-18 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PA-X Database Informs New Research on Youth in Peace Agreements

PeaceRep's open access PA-X Peace Agreements Database continues to be a valuable resource for those interested in the study and practice of peace processes.



Images: Room for Design and Ingimage (background)

Researchers at the University of Glasgow have utilised the 2,003 peace agreements contained in the PA-X database to produce research that explores the characteristics of peace agreements referencing young people.

Using the text search function of the database, Asli Ozcelik and Daniel Odin Shaw identified 208 peace agreements concluded between 1990 and 2022 that refer to youth, young people, or similar to bring an end to conflicts of inter-state, intra-state, or local nature.

A parallel research report introduces the new Youth in Peace Agreements Dataset (YPAD), which explores the characteristics of peace agreements that refer to youth and offers a thematic analysis of the references to youth in these agreements.

The 208 peace agreements identified by Ozcelik and Shaw represent 12% of all peace agreements concluded between 1990 and 2022. The YPAD categorises these agreements under eight main themes and 53 sub-themes. The authors identify Version 7 of the PA-X Peace Agreement Database as the primary source of data for their research:

> In building the dataset of References to Youth in Peace Agreements, 1990-2022 (YPAD), our principal source of data was the PA-X Database. PA-X is an exceptional source as it includes a wide range of peace instruments, including local peace agreements, that cannot be accessed elsewhere, as well as due its temporal coverage up until the end of 2022. PA-X also includes various search functions, including free text search, that allow researchers to tailor the use of the dataset to their research projects easily and effectively.

In addition to the user-friendly PA-X Database, PeaceRep also offers PA-X Local and PA-X Gender as additional databases, which focus on gender provisions in peace agreements and local peace agreements respectively.

Explore PA-X now

Explore the YPAD dataset

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/09/18/youth-agreements-dataset/

2023-08-24 / HIGH-LEVEL VISITS

Minister Lord Ahmad hails PeaceRep for "world-leading research" on peace and security

PeaceRep researchers demonstrated the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world, containing more than 2,000 peace agreements across more than 150 peace processes between 1990 and 2023.

Lord Ahmad commented on the relevance of the PA-X Database to current conflict mediation practices:

Photo: Edinburgh Law School

> PeaceRep's database is now the go-to site for mediators embarking on the difficult process of opening dialogue to stop violence and plot a path to peace.

Lord Ahmad, who is also the Prime Minister's Special Representative for Preventing Sexual Violence in Conflict, was keen to discuss PeaceRep's work in the Middle East and in South Asia, and on supporting women and girls. PeaceRep researchers shared key findings from PA-X Gender (a sub-database of peace agreements with provisions on women, girls, gender or sexual violence), how these findings informed the United Nations Secretary General's Women, Peace and Security report in 2022, and how the PeaceFem mobile app is enabling inclusive mediation practices.

Lord Ahmad also described PeaceRep as "a wonderful example of Scottish-based academic institutions leading and collaborating within an international consortium" with a focus on supporting peace and conflict resolution worldwide:

> PeaceRep is producing world-leading research and playing an extraordinary role in delivering peace and security across the world. The UK Government is proud to be supporting the team based at the University of Edinburgh.

PeaceRep's Executive Director Christine Bell and Managing Director Tim Epple thanked FCDO for their continued support and funding of PeaceRep's research.

Lord Ahmad later tweeted about the visit:

> Visiting @EdinburghUni to find out how @FCDOGovUK funded @Peace_Rep_ is using its world-leading research to support peace processes across the world. Learning lessons from the past is vital if we are to plot paths to peace and build a better future. pic.twitter.com/LTi54ZcNPE
>
> — Lord (Tariq)Ahmad of Wimbledon (@tariqahmadbt) August 23, 2023

Explore the PA-X Database

Explore PA-X Gender

Browse PeaceRep's key findings

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/08/24/minister-lord-ahmad-peacerep/

2023-07-28 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Navigating Fragmentation: New Policy Briefs and Perspectives on Syria

Photo by Abdulmonam Eassa / Getty Images

Policy Briefs – Navigating Fragmentation

Authors: Juline Beaujouan, Principal Investigator, and collaborators (in alphabetical order); Muhannad al-Rish, Abdallah El hafi, Eyas Ghreiz, and Ayham Odat

1. Humanitarian aid, borders and conflict lines
2. Improving free movement in Northwest Syria
3. Improving free movement in Daraa

Blogs

1. Syria and the Politics of the Earthquakes | تحميل عربي – Juline Beaujouan
2. Humanitarian Aid and Peace in Syria: An Intricate Relationship | تحميل عربي – Juline Beaujouan
3. Negotiating Humanitarian Aid with Armed Groups: Humanitarian Imperative or Red Line? | تحميل عربي – Juline Beaujouan
4. Why the Daraa Reconciliation Agreement Cannot Build Peace | تحميل عربي – Muhannad al-Rish
5. The Impact of Community Leaders on Social Peace in Northern Syria | تحميل عربي – Abdalghader Haj Othman
6. The Syrian Conflict and the Loss of National Identity | تحميل عربي – Areefa Abdel Hamid al-Mousa
7. The Drug Trade in Syria Threatens Regional Peace – Eyas Ghreiz

Research Project and the Syrian Context

Over a decade of violent conflict has left deep scars on the Syrian socio-political and geographical landscape. The country is fragmented into four governance and territorial entities, and communities are divided by conflict lines. Yet, global challenges – such as the Syrian refugee crisis, the threat posed by transnational radical groups, and most recently the Covid-19 pandemic – do not stop at borders. Identifiable "fragments" do not operate in complete isolation and are indeed inter-dependant.

The ***Navigating Fragmentation*** series of policy briefs has been developed from findings of a research project that focused on the ever-evolving and interactive process of fragmentation, looking at

dynamics of "rebordering" (Vignal, 2017) during and after the Covid-19 pandemic in Syria.

The project involved 84 interviews conducted in September 2022 and March 2023 in Syria – in northern Aleppo, Idlib and Daraa governorates – and in neighbouring countries, notably Iraq, Jordan and Turkey. Interviewees included international and local civil society members, governance stakeholders, medical professionals, and military personnel.

The policy briefs are also part of the PeaceRep-led Covid Collective project, *Interactive Fragmentation: Peace Routes and Roots for Peace in Syria*.

Explore all PeaceRep research on Covid-19

Syrian Perspectives on Syrian Peace

Three of the blogs published in this series were developed within the framework of the research project, *Syrian Peace: Delocalised, Imposed and Illegitimate?*, led by Juline Beaujouan. The project involved training a number of students and young professionals in academic research and writing skills, with the aim of promoting self-empowerment of Syrian local voices. Blogs developed as part of this project were authored by Muhannad al-Rish, Abdalghader Haj Othman, and Areefa Abdel Hamid al-Mousa.

Learn more

If you have further questions on these policy briefs, blogs, or research projects, please contact Juline Beaujouan: J.Beaujouan-Marliere@ed.ac.uk

PeaceRep's Syria research explores opportunities for peace, conflict resolution and civicness, and the potential of multiple vectors – including Covid-19, the private sector, humanitarian aid, technology, and existing local practices – to contribute to peaceful pathways out of conflict.

Explore all PeaceRep research on Syria

Browse PeaceRep's publications database

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/07/28/navigating-fragmentation-policy-briefs-syria/

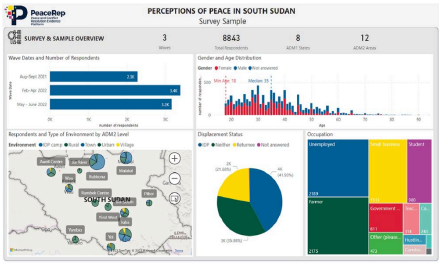
2023-06-20 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New digital tool highlights perceptions of peace in South Sudan

Browse the interactive dashboard

The dashboard is the latest addition to our suite of PeaceTech data and digital tools to support policy and practice. PeaceRep is building PeaceTech innovation focused on better data for supporting adaptive management of peace and transition processes.

Perceptions of Peace Survey



The dashboard is based on a three-wave survey that recorded the views of 8,843 people from 12 countries across 9 states and special administrative areas, covering urban, rural and IDP camp environments. Respondents were asked questions about their daily experiences of safety, based on indicators of 'everyday peace' developed through focus groups. They also shared their views on a wide range of related topics, including elections, governance arrangements, security arrangements, trust in public authorities, civic space, national identity, and social cohesion, among others.

Read the full survey report: Perceptions of Peace in South Sudan: Longitudinal Findings

About PeaceRep's research in South Sudan

PeaceRep's South Sudan research explores public authority in South Sudan, the key dynamics between Sudan and South Sudan and their impact on each other's transition process, and the role of different types of financial flows on governance outcomes. It will achieve this through the development of policy analyses and academic research rooted in robust evidence bases gathered in both countries and from across the world.

We are also examining perceptions of peace in South Sudan, through a series of surveys recording daily experiences of safety and views on elections, governance arrangements, security arrangements, trust in public authorities, civic space, national identity, and social cohesion.

Learn more about our South Sudan research.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/06/20/new-digital-tool-peace-south-sudan/

2023-06-13 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep wins Best Dataset and Best Data Visualisation at CDCS Digital Research Prizes

Best Data Visualisation: Ukraine Data Tracker

The Ukraine Data Tracker was created by PeaceRep team members Christine Bell, Sarah Schöttler, and Jinrui Wang. The tracker has two visual components: the Ukraine Conflict Map, and a dashboard for Russia as a Global Peace Actor.

CDCS shared the following as feedback received for the Ukraine Data Tracker:

> The Ukraine Data Tracker offers a haunting visualisation of the ongoing conflict, readily making apparent the devastating scale of the war. This valuable resource will be used by both researchers and lay people, the depth of information contained within made accessible with an easy to use interface.

> An easy and user-friendly tool that could be tailored to focus on different aspects of the analysed phenomenon. Also, a very timely project that could help users in visualising an ongoing issue.

Explore the Ukraine Conflict Map

Explore the Dashboard for Russia as a Global Peace Actor

Best Dataset: The PA-X Peace Agreements Database and Dataset (sixth release)

The sixth release of PA-X Peace Agreements Database and Dataset was developed and released with contributions from several PeaceRep team members, including Christine Bell, Sanja Badanjak, Laura Wise, Robert Wilson, Juline Beaujouan, Adam Farquhar, and Jennifer Hodge.

The seventh release of the PA-X Dataset has since been launched, and now provides data for more than 2,000 peace agreements documents spanning more than 150 individual peace processes. With this release, PA-X continues to be the world's most expansive and comprehensive online archive, database, and dataset of peace agreements and processes for the period 1990-2023.

VIDEO: Laura Wise and Adam Farquhar introduce the PA-X Database (via @EdCDCS on Twitter)

The following was shared as feedback for PA-X Version 6:

> This expansive dataset is more relevant than ever, serving to remind us that peaceful resolutions are still possible in a world increasingly ravaged by conflict. The extraordinary breadth of data gathered here offers the tools for future peacemakers to learn from and apply past successes to current resolutions.

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database

CDCS Digital Research Prizes

The CDCS Digital Research Prizes event is an opportunity to celebrate and share excellent work by researchers across the College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences at the University of Edinburgh. The research community nominated data-led projects and activities that show creativity, excellence and impact, and which model best practice in the use and sharing of data. Other categories for this year's prizes included Best Small Data-Driven Project and Best Novel Use of a Digital Method.

More about the Digital Research Prizes and all 2023 winners

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/06/13/peacerep-wins-digital-research-prizes/

2023-06-05 / HIGH-LEVEL VISITS

UK Minister welcomes PeaceRep support for peace and transition processes

Executive Director Christine Bell and Managing Director Tim Epple thanked FCDO for their continued support and funding of our research and presented examples of how we have informed and supported peace process design in varied contexts.

The Minister's visit coincided with the launch of version 7 of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. As the most expansive collection of peace agreements data in the world – containing 2003 peace agreements from more than 150 peace processes between 1990 and 2023 – PA-X data underpins a suite of digital tools to support research and practice. The PeaceRep data team highlighted our focus on digital innovation and offered an opportunity to interact with our digital tools and trackers.

The Minister welcomed PeaceRep's role in supporting peace and transition processes around the world, and later tweeted about the visit:

> During my visit to Edinburgh I welcomed how @FCDOGovUK funded @Peace_Rep_ is playing a major role in using research and evidence to support more effective peace negotiations and transition processes across the world. pic.twitter.com/F1P5oq9B6Y
>
> — David Rutley MP (@DavidRutley) June 5, 2023

Read key findings from our work and browse our digital tools.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/06/05/uk-minister-peacerep/

2023-06-02 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PeaceRep expands PA-X V7 to over 2000 agreements

PeaceRep welcomes the seventh release of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. Spanning more than 150 peace processes from 1990 to 2023 and containing 2003 peace agreements, PA-X continues to be an invaluable resource for those interested in the study and practice of peacemaking.

As a user-friendly tool, PA-X offers simple and advanced search options for ease of navigation. By selecting preferred parameters, users can filter and download specific subsets of the data, ensuring access to relevant, targeted information.

What's new in this release?

New documents: This release adds 44 new documents from 22 peace processes, 16 of which were signed in 2022. These include peace agreements from Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Yugoslavia (former), Central African Republic, Chad, Democratic Republic of Congo, Rwanda, Ethiopia, Ghana, India, Libya, Mali, Philippines, Russia, Ukraine, South Sudan, and Sudan.

Notable agreements: PA-X now includes agreements relating to Ukraine and Ethiopia from 2022, and a series of local peace conferences held in the early 2000s in what is now South Sudan.

> ***Initiative on the Safe Transportation of Grain and Foodstuffs from Ukrainian Ports*** **(July 2022)**
>
> In this newly added interstate agreement, part of the latest V7 release of the PA-X database, key provisions focus on establishing secure transportation channels for the delivery of vital resources such as grain and other food supplies. Originating from Ukrainian ports, these essential goods will navigate through the Black Sea, further extending into the Mediterranean.
>
> ***Agreement for Lasting Peace through the Permanent Cessation of Hostilities Between the Government of the Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia and the Tigray People's Liberation Front (TPLF)*** **(November 2022)**
>
> The Government of the Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia and the Tigray Peoples' Liberation Front (TPLF) have signed a Cessation of Hostilities Agreement, which is covered in the V7 release of the PA-X database. Initiated on October 25, 2022, these crucial talks set the stage for the much-needed reestablishment of peace, security, and stability in the turbulent Tigray Region. The agreement addresses issues such as DDR, protection of civilians, gender based violence and access.

PA-X Local and PA-X Gender

PA-X Local includes 12 new agreements that deal with local issues, involve local actors, and deal with forms of local/communal violent conflict. PA-X Gender now contains 14 new agreements that mention women, girls, or gender.

Peace Agreement Actors Dataset

PA-X V7 sets the groundwork for a new dataset of peace agreement actors and their commitments, due to be released at the end of 2023. The Peace Agreement Actors dataset has been developed as an extension of PA-X using FAIR principles, reusing existing data to answer new and different research questions. While PA-X data primarily provides information on peace agreements, their context and their content, the new actors dataset can be used to understand the peace processes from which these agreements stem, as well as the actors that take part in their creation.

The new dataset of peace agreement signatories counts more than 6000 instances of agreement-signing actors, and allows for the construction of actor networks to identify co-signing, as well as allowing for trends in agreement signing over time and in particular contexts. While the data are not

yet publicly available, our first data reports are expected to be published soon, looking at the trends in peace agreement participation by third-party signatories.

Dr Sanja Badanjak introduces the new actors dataset in this blog: FAIR Data in Action: PA-X data informs new dataset on peace agreement actors

Visualisations

PA-X forms the cornerstone of our PeaceTech work, building innovation focused on better data for supporting adaptive management of peace and transition processes. PA-X data underpins a range of digital tools to support policy and practice, including visualisations, trackers, interactive timelines, infographics, and the PeaceFem mobile app.

Explore our digital tools.

Explore PA-X now.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/06/02/pax-v7/

2023-05-23 / EVENTS HELD

Women, Peace and Security in the Digital Age: Key Take-aways from Panel Discussion

PeaceRep's Executive Director, Professor Christine Bell (University of Edinburgh Law School), welcomed attendees and shared some background on PeaceRep's research on women and gender, as well as the programme's work in the field of PeaceTech.

Attendees were then introduced to the PeaceFem app by Fiona Knäussel, Associate Researcher at the University of Oxford. Fiona shared an overview of the app's core features and how it can be used to support to support women in peacemaking.

The main panel discussion on the topic of "Women, Peace and Security in the Digital Age" was then introduced by Ms Laura Wise, Research Fellow at the University of Edinburgh Law School, who chaired the discussion. Laura introduced the panelists; Dr Monalisa Adhikari (Lecturer in International Politics, University of Stirling), Dr Sanja Badanjak (Chancellor's Fellow in Global Challenges, University of Edinburgh), and Dr Claire Duncanson (Senior Lecturer in International Relations, University of Edinburgh), and Ms Fiona Knäussel.

Fiona Knäussel presents an introduction to the PeaceFem app at the "Women, Peace and Security in the Digital Age" event on 9 May 2023, at Inspace, University of Edinburgh

The discussion began with an introduction to the United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325, i.e.: the Women, Peace, and Security (WPS) Agenda, and its four pillars; Participation, Protection, Prevention, and Relief and Recovery. Sanja Badanjak then described the two main strands of PeaceTech innovation; the practical use of technology in peace negotiations, and the data and tools used to analyse peace processes in order to identify trends. Sanja also highlighted how both strands of PeaceTech can pose challenges to women's inclusion in peacemaking; security issues with online interfaces pose a challenge for women in particular, while big data models and language models for analysis often do not accurately represent gender issues in the data.

Monalisa Adhikari shared insights from her work with research communities based in Myanmar, highlighting specific challenges for women in peacemaking in this context. In many ways, applications of PeaceTech and digital tools have enabled progress for women in peacemaking; a Myanmar study group was enabled with online meetings, and digital responses to the coup in Myanmar showed that women had taken on roles at the forefront of efforts towards democracy. Challenges to using digital tools for women's inclusion in Myanmar include the "digital haves and have-nots" of the population, periods of military-enforced internet shutdown, digital censorship by the regime, and repercussions for women who have been tracked and then harassed or arrested in response to their online activities.

Fiona Knäussel shared comparative insights on women's use of tech for peacebuilding in Yemen and the associated challenges, suggesting that a framework of four areas can be used to understand the factors that are shaping women's use of tech:

1. **Access and connectivity issues** – These can limit video and audio communications. In the context of Yemen, where some communities can s be conservative or patriarchal, women may not have their own digital devices.
2. **Security** – Women in Yemeni have been persecuted based on their online activity, meaning that digital activities can mean exposing themselves to risks.
3. **Circumstances** – The availability of tools, or lack thereof, is often a factor for women in Yemeni communities.
4. **Preparedness to engage with new methods effectively** – Different contexts will have different approaches to the teaching and learning of digital skills, and to the use of digital tools.

Laura then asked panellists: Is the WPS Agenda still fit for purpose in the Digital Age? Claire Duncanson argued that recently, it's not fit for purpose, but not because we're in Digital Age – rather that it needs to be broadened and deepened to consider important factors such as climate change and sustaining biodiversity, which can have significant effects on peace and conflict on a global scale. Digital technology can be used more effectively to communicate the urgency of these issues for peace and conflict considerations, however, a dilemma is posed by large scale technology also contributing to global warming through energy consumption.

On whether PeaceTech innovations can provide solutions to achieving WPS Agenda goals, Sanja Badanjak highlighted that existing data and models in the field are not yet developed enough to allow for accurate understandings of gender representation needs in peace processes. There is potential for developments where peacemaking activity is seeing effective engagement by women, but because big data is atheoretical and distinct from political contexts, we have a long way to go before data can accurately reflect important issues for women in peacemaking.

Panellists then opened the discussion to the audience, and gained valuable insights from feedback and further questions on aspects of the WPS Agenda and on applications of the PeaceFem app.

Learn more about the PeaceFem app

Learn more about PeaceRep's key findings on women and gender

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/05/23/women-peace-security-digital-age-key-takeaways/

2023-04-26 / MEDIA ENGAGEMENTS

Jan Pospisil shares Sudan conflict insights on BBC Radio

With a tenuous ceasefire in effect and thousands fleeing the country, the world's attention is focused on Sudan as the effects of the ongoing civil conflict are being felt on a global scale.

As peace-builders and mediators seek out avenues for peace negotiations, researchers and experts have been sharing insights on the background to the current conflict.

PeaceRep's Dr Jan Pospisil, Associate Professor at the Centre for Trust, Peace and Social Relations at Coventry University, featured on Nicky Campbelll'a live BBC Radio 5 programme on 25 April, to share insights on the current conflict from his research findings.

Dr Pospisil discussed how fighting between the Sudanese army and the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) in Khartoum is ultimately causing the most detriment to the city's civilians, due to the strategic location of the army's military installations within the city. The location of military installations also means that the conflict occurring is not a "war of control", according to Dr Pospisil, but rather a "cat-and-mouse game" for the military groups involved.

Listen back to the radio programme on BBC Sounds (Dr Pospisil features from 04:00)

Dr Pospisil's latest PeaceRep report was published on Monday 24 April, discussing how insistence on one unitary peace process for Sudan has resulted in rising tensions between the military regime and the civilian opposition, resulting in conflict escalating to a point of open civil war. The report outlines progress in a peaceful transition for Sudan requires an approach that accepts "the multiplicity of complementing and, at times, competing processes".

Access the report – Post Architecture: The Competitive Marketplace of Transition Management in Sudan

As recent events in Sudan demonstrate, the quest for short-term stabilisation can fail, undermining long-term peacebuilding and democratisation and resulting in the outbreak of armed violence. A unitary approach to peace process mediation can create significant stumbling blocks for transitional progress. The reality of the post-architectural transitional landscape requires a principled, pragmatic approach that accepts the multiplicity of complementing and, at times, competing processes.

Other experts on Sudan within the PeaceRep research team have shared findings and insights on the conflict via media outlets in recent weeks, and have authored reports that provide further insight into efforts towards a lasting peace agreement for Sudan. A full summary of PeaceRep research insights and analysis on the Sudan conflict is available, and is currently being updated regularly.

Access PeaceRep's summary of analysis on the Sudan conflict

Learn more about PeaceRep's Sudan research

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/04/26/jan-pospisil-sudan-conflict-insights-on-bbc-radio/

2023-04-24 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

Sudan clashes: insights from PeaceRep research and analysis

Fighting erupted in Khartoum on 15 April 2023, after tensions escalated between the army and the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) over shifting power dynamics between army general Abdel Fattah al-Burhan and RSF leader General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, known as Hemedti. After orchestrating a coup in October 2021, the two generals are now fighting for control of Sudan, with hundreds reported dead amid intensifying violence around the country – leading some analysts to predict the beginning of an ongoing civil war.

Recent PeaceRep reports offer insights and recommendations relevant to the current situation in Sudan. The PeaceRep Sudan research team are now considering the implications of the fighting for current research studies and forthcoming publications. Since the fighting began, PeaceRep Sudan researchers and contributors have also offered analysis and commentary on the emerging situation in the media.

Click here to access all PeaceRep Sudan research – including latest research reports, blogs, and media analysis

Sudan peace agreements since 1990 can be accessed via the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, including the Juba Peace Agreement of 3 October 2020.

About PeaceRep Sudan

PeaceRep's Sudan research is led by the Conflict and Civicness Research Group at LSE Ideas and the Centre for Trust, Peace and Social Relations (CTPSR) at Coventry University. The project is delivered in collaboration with World Peace Foundation, Tufts University.

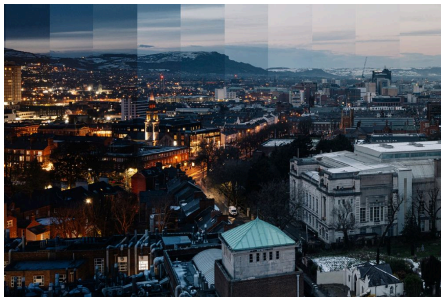
Read more about PeaceRep's Sudan research

To receive the latest PeaceRep research updates, subscribe to receive the PeaceRep newsletter via email.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/04/24/sudan-clashes-insights-from-peacerep-research-and-analysis/

2023-04-17 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

PeaceRep researchers join global political leaders in Belfast for Agreement 25



PeaceRep researchers will join global political leaders at Agreement 25, a three-day conference hosted at Queen's University Belfast in April to mark the 25th anniversary of the Good Friday/Belfast Agreement.

PeaceRep's Executive Director, Prof Christine Bell, will participate in an academic panel session on Tuesday 18 April with a focus on Rights and Social Justice. Prof Louise Mallinder, who leads PeaceRep research on amnesties, will chair the Legacy panel session on the same day.

Other conference participants include the Chancellor of Queen's University Belfast, Secretary Hillary R. Clinton, and Former President of the United States, President Bill Clinton.

Learn more about Agreement 25 and watch live online

Exploring the Agreement and the Northern Ireland Peace Process

Monday 10 April marked 25 years since the Good Friday/Belfast Agreement (GF/BA), a historic multi-party peace agreement, was signed by representatives of the UK and Irish governments and Northern Ireland's political parties. The GF/BA sought to end three decades of conflict in Northern Ireland, known as the Troubles, by creating a new and enduring power-sharing arrangement.

A new mural painted on the Peace Wall gates Belfast, Northern Ireland, with wording "25 years of building peace" (April 2023). Photo by Charles McQuillan / Getty Images

In the years leading up to reaching the Agreement in 1998, the Northern Ireland peace process involved multi-party participation for the implementation of ceasefires, decommissioning of paramilitary organisations, and multilateral negotiations, as well as the development of complementary agreements in the years following.

Access the Good Friday/Belfast Agreement via the PA-X Database

In addition to the Good Friday/Belfast Agreement, the PA-X Database contains 34 other peace agreements related to the Northern Ireland peace process.

Explore all Northern Ireland peace agreements via PA-X

Research and Resources on the Northern Ireland Peace Process

PeaceRep and the Political Settlements Research Programme – PeaceRep's predecessor programme – have shared research findings on key elements of peacebuilding efforts before and after implementation of the GF/BA, including national identity, transitional justice, women's inclusion and gender equality in Northern Ireland.

Browse reports and resources on the Northern Ireland Peace Process in the table below

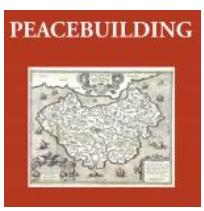
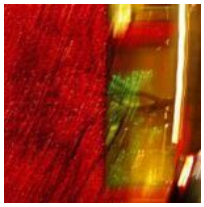
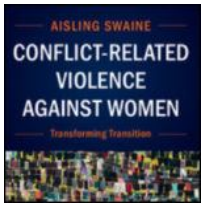
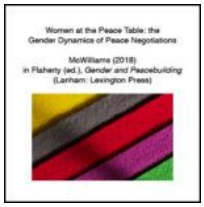
Image	Title	Authors	Pub Date
	International Organisations and Peace Inclusivity in Northern Ireland	Amaya-Panche, Jauch	2026
	Political commemoration and peacebuilding in ethno-national settings: the risk and utility of partisan memory	Brown	2019

Image	Title	Authors	Pub Date
	Transforming Responses to Domestic Violence in a Politically Contested Environment: The Case of Northern Ireland	Doyle, McWilliams	2019
	Trust Funds in Fragile and Conflict-affected States: Lessons from Northern Ireland	Kilmurray	2019
	Conflict-Related Violence Against Women: Transforming Transition	Swaine	2018
ISPP International Society of Political Psychology	How the "Northern Irish" National Identity Is Understood and Used by Young People and Politicians	Garry, McNicholl, Stevenson	2018
	Intimate Partner Violence in Conflict and Post-Conflict Societies: Insights and Lessons from Northern Ireland	Doyle, McWilliams	2018
	International Gender Equality Norms and the Local Peacemaking Political Settlement	O'Rourke	2017
	Justice Learning in Transition, A Grassroots Toolkit	Rooney	2017
	Women at the Peace Table: The Gender Dynamics of Peace Negotiations	McWilliams	2016

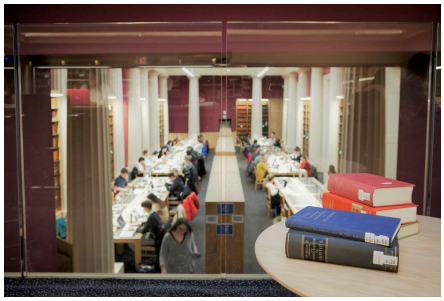
PeaceRep has also published summaries of key findings on topics relevant to the Northern Ireland peace process, including Power-sharing, Constitution-building, and Transitional Justice.

Explore all Key Findings

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/04/17/peacerep-researchers-mark-good-friday-belfast-agreement/

2023-04-05 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PeaceRep research informs new courses at the University of Edinburgh in Autumn 2023



The inception of these courses is a significant development for the PeaceRep programme's contribution to knowledge exchange and best practice in peace and conflict studies. By incorporating findings into the content of taught courses, PeaceRep research can inform students' understandings of new and emerging trends in peace processes and conflict resolution.

New courses for the coming academic year include an Honours course focusing on 'Conflict and Peaceful Transition in the Eastern Mediterranean Region', designed by Juline Beaujouan and an Honours course focusing on Global South actors, designed by Kathryn Nash. Two existing postgraduate courses designed by Kathryn Nash, focusing on Global South actors and on human rights and conflict resolution respectively, will continue to be delivered in the coming academic year.

Timely and relevant case studies from PeaceRep research have been incorporated into course materials, building on recent research and highlighting best practice implemented by global conflict resolution initiatives. Students will be prompted to learn from and consider modern issues that will inform future work as professionals. Guest lectures will feature expert input from the PeaceRep consortium.

The courses will be offered as part of various programmes of study at the University of Edinburgh, and will complement existing courses that focus on public international law, human rights issues and humanitarian law, armed conflict, peace and security, and gender justice. Beyond the Edinburgh Law School, PeaceRep courses are particularly relevant for students of Politics and International Relations (PIR), Islamic and Middle Eastern Studies, and International Development.

PeaceRep also presents its first continuing professional development (CPD) initiatives, designed to support the development of peacebuilding professionals through carefully curated resources and expert-led seminars on cutting-edge peace process research. 'Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World', designed by Laura Wise, introduces gender inclusion in peace processes. 'PeaceTech', designed by Sanja Badanjak, introduces the cutting-edge field of PeaceTech, the use of data and technology to support peacebuilding initiatives.

Courses taught by PeaceRep researchers at Edinburgh Law School in 2023-2024:

Conflict and Peaceful Transition in the Eastern Mediterranean Region (Honours) – LAWS11496
Led by Juline Beaujouan

Global South Actors in International Relations and International Law (Honours and PG) – LAWS11482
Led by Kathryn Nash

Human Rights and Conflict Resolution (PG) – LAWS11318
Led by Kathryn Nash

Current students can register for these Honours and PG courses via EUCLID from September 2023. Find out more about these courses via the DRPS 2023-2024 portal – search by course code (eg: LAWS11496).

Forthcoming PeaceRep CPD courses (2024/2025):

Gender and Peace Processes in a Changing World (CPD)
Led by Laura Wise

PeaceTech (CPD)
Led by Sanja Badanjak

Peacebuilding professionals can now register interest for PeaceRep CPD courses.

Browse PeaceRep's key findings by topic

Learn more about PeaceRep's CPD courses

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/04/05/peacerep-new-courses-autumn-2023/

2023-04-02 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep awarded Royal Society of Edinburgh medal for collaborative endeavour

In the medal citation, the RSE commended PeaceRep for its collaborative work.

Members of the PeaceRep team based at the University of Edinburgh.

"RSE/Mary Somerville Medal is awarded to the PeaceRep Team, who is represented by Scottish researchers and international collaborators conducting research, policy and impact work on peace and conflict studies at both the local and the global scales. The team has played a pivotal role in networking peace and conflict organisations across Scotland and Northern England, and in supporting the establishment of digital peace processes, including in Yemen."

This year's medallists have been awarded under the revised RSE Medal programme, which honours eminent women and their significant input to the sciences, arts, and letters in Scotland.

PeaceRep's Executive Director Prof Christine Bell said,

"At a time when the world seems perilously engaged in war, this medal affirms the importance of continual peacemaking in dark and dangerous moments. Our team at the University of Edinburgh – many of whom started their careers with this project – has been privileged to work as part of a wider

team of groups in Scotland, but also including local peacebuilders in contexts as varied as Afghanistan, Syria, South Sudan, Iraq and Yemen. The award of the medal will encourage us, and we hope others, to continue to explore how new technologies can be used to harness innovation in research and practice. We are honoured to accept it, and in turn pay our tribute to those we work with who are struggling to address the violent conflicts in which they live."

High attainment in earth and environmental sciences, and teamwork and collaborative endeavour – previously unrepresented sectors – are now recognised in the newly created medals.

A second recipient of the Mary Somerville Medal is the EAVE II team, also based at the University of Edinburgh. EAVE II was recognised for the team's contributions to the Scottish and UK governments' responses to the COVID-19 pandemic, informed by findings drawn from from a purpose-built rich data platform. Tracking the effects of the COVID-19 pandemic through data has also been utilised by PeaceRep in creating the Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker.

About PeaceRep
PeaceRep is a consortium of research and non-governmental institutions led by the University of Edinburgh Law School. We are a team of 50+ researchers, mediation practitioners, lawyers, data scientists, managers, and communications professionals dedicated to reimagining peace and transition processes in changing conflict contexts. We work on interdisciplinary research on peace and transition processes, innovative 'PeaceTech' and data, and peace process design and support across the Middle East, East and North Africa, and Asia.

Consortium members include Conciliation Resources, Centre for Trust, Peace and Social Relations (CTPSR) at Coventry University, Dialectiq, Edinburgh Law School, International IDEA, LSE Conflict and Civicness Research Group, LSE Middle East Centre, Queens University Belfast, University of St Andrews, University of Stirling, and the World Peace Foundation at Tufts University.

PeaceRep is funded by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) and has received funding for PeaceTech innovations such as the PeaceFem app from UN Women, the University of Edinburgh's ESRC Impact Acceleration Grant, and MSCA Train@ED Horizon 2020.

Explore PeaceRep's key research findings, data and digital tools, and publications.

Read more about PeaceRep consortium members.

PeaceRep
Peace and Conflict
Resolution Evidence
Platform

The Royal Society of Edinburgh
KNOWLEDGE MADE USEFUL

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/04/02/peacerep-awarded-royal-society-edinburgh-medal/

2023-03-23 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Twenty years on from the US invasion: Reflecting on drivers of conflict in Iraq

This week marks the twentieth anniversary of the United States' invasion of Iraq.

PeaceRep's Iraq research, led by Taif Alkhudary and Prof Toby Dodge at the LSE Middle East Centre, examines both the short-term and long-term drivers of conflict that continue to destabilise Iraq, causing both intra-elite and wide-scale violence. We work in collaboration with Iraqi researchers to understand **three key themes:**

1. **Demographic change and conflict:** the role of demographic change as a driver of conflict, as well as the role that youth and popular politics can potentially play in creating long-term stability.
2. **Geopolitics and the changing climate:** regional battles over natural resources and water scarcity as drivers of instability.
3. **Politically sanctioned corruption:** the impact of state and intra-sect fragmentation on corruption and political violence.

The role of opposition parties in consolidating democracy

In a new PeaceRep report published this week by the LSE Middle East Centre, Taif Alkhudary presents key findings and recommendations for policymakers, focusing on the role that prominent opposition parties – Al Bayt Al Watani and Imtidad – can play in consolidating democracy in Iraq.

Report: Changing the System from Within? Opposition Parties & Democracy in Iraq Post-2019

These opposition parties are faced with corruption and a lack of political freedom as the elites persist in protecting their own interests, fearing a loss of the power originally granted by the US. In a blog post shared in October 2022, Taif Alkhudary describes in more detail how coercion, co-optation, and sectarianism have been utilised by Iraq's sectarian power-sharing system, also known as the *Muhasasa Ta'ifia*, in attempts to crush opposition from the grass-roots parties that gained parliamentary seats in Iraq's 2021 elections.

Blog: Fragmentation of Iraq's 'Protest Parties' amid the Muhasasa System's Resilience

Popular Mobilization Forces post-2022

Simona Foltyn has authored a forthcoming PeaceRep report; Between State and Non-State: Popular Mobilization Forces during the 2022 post-Election Crisis. In a recent blog on the same topic, published by the Boston Review, Simona describes how the militarization of politics continues to destabilise Iraq decades after the US invasion.

Blog: Iraq, Twenty Years Later (Boston Review)

Political trust and social cohesion

In other recent PeaceRep reports, Juline Beaujouan and Amjed Rasheed have shared findings on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on political trust and social cohesion in Iraq, as well as the role of religious institutions in the prevention of violent extremism.

Report: Political Trust and Social Cohesion – The Impact of COVID-19

Report: The role of religious institutions in the prevention of violent extremism

PeaceRep publications on Iraq will be complemented by a series of events to be held in Iraq and London, bringing research findings to wider audiences. Events will include film screenings, exhibitions and collaborations with Iraqi activists.

Learn more about PeaceRep's Iraq research

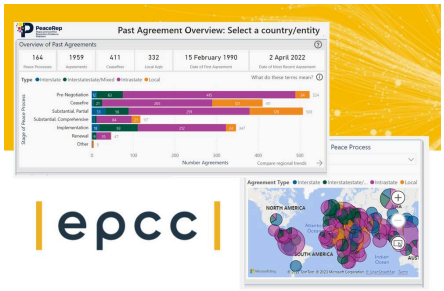
Learn more about the LSE Middle East Centre

Browse all PeaceRep publications

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/03/23/twenty-years-on-invasion-of-iraq/

2023-03-13 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

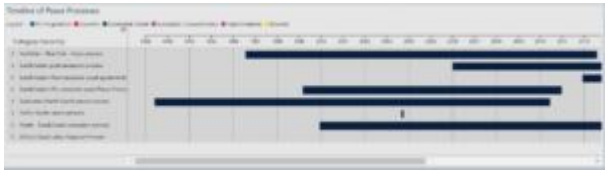
EPCC supports PeaceRep in building an online platform for peace process data analytics



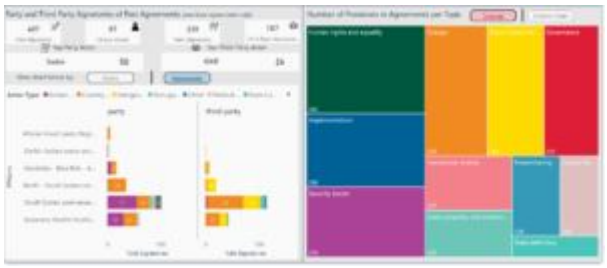
Based at the University of Edinburgh Law School, the PeaceRep team is researching how peace processes and transitions from armed conflict can be managed and supported, and how more inclusive post-conflict politics and greater opportunities for international development can be fostered. EPCC is helping the PeaceRep team to build a comprehensive system for combining data from a variety of sources, and in a variety of formats, to build interactive web applications that visualise and present peace process data.

See below for previews of PeaceRep's peace process tracker interface:

Preview of PeaceRep's peace process tracker interface, showing a bar graph that represents all peace processes for South Sudan by stage of progress



Preview of PeaceRep's peace process tracker interface, showing a timeline with peace agreements spanning years active for each peace process



Preview of PeaceRep's peace process tracker interface, showing a bar graph representing peace agreement signatories by actor type, and a treemap diagram representing peace agreements by topic

Data collection

PeaceRep's objective is to be the global leader in peace analytics and digital innovation in the field of peace studies. At the core of this endeavour is the data collection taking place for the PA-X Peace Agreement Database and Dataset, which is analysed and presented in parallel with data on other institutional developments (such as constitution-making, or elections), and data on a variety of socio-economic indicators provided by academic and official sources.

Transitions from conflict often include economic, political, institutional, and military transitions, all overlapping in time, space, and in terms of actors involved. The challenge for peace analytics is that these complex problems require calling upon data that vary in type (quantitative data, but also text and geo-location) and in size. The data relevant to PeaceRep also come from various levels – as the research relies on global, country-level data, peace process-level data, but also subnational data and data from surveys of citizens in particular countries. A further challenge stems from the processing and analysis component of this work, as the textual data in particular are summarised using natural language processing and machine learning methodologies.

Lasting data infrastructure

The cooperation with EPCC is aimed at building a lasting data infrastructure to store the wide and diverse data collected across the consortium, and in turn streamlining the usage of this data in a range of applications, including interactive peace process trackers that provide an integrated picture

of post-conflict transitions in particular countries. The EPCC team is constructing a PeaceRep data warehouse in EIDF and establishing data ingest workflows for harvesting data from a wide variety of sources from January to March 2023, and the cooperation is expected to continue well beyond that period. They are also developing reproducible methods for enhancing dataflows in a Power BI service to consume – and publish reports based on – the data stored in the warehouse.

These online interactive peace process trackers that PeaceRep and EPCC aim to deliver in 2023 and 2024 are intended to serve multiple purposes: for academic users, they provide a tool for discovery and hypothesis-making; for policy users, they are providing context and history to a problem they may be coming to for the first time as well as an assessment of how transitions from conflict are developing. They are also a means of relying on innovative technology developed by the University of Edinburgh to support policy-making that is adaptive, evidence-based, and in support of global development.

Find out more

Learn more about PeaceRep

Hosted and managed by EPCC, the Edinburgh International Data Facility (EIDF) provides the core data infrastructure that underpins the Data-Driven Innovation initiative.

Learn more about EIDF

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/03/13/epcc-supports-online-platform-data-analytics/

2023-03-10 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

Turkey-Syria Earthquakes: Insights for Recovery and Response

The earthquakes that hit Syria and southern Turkey in February 2023 have had a catastrophic impact on communities already suffering the effects of long-term conflict. More than 54,000 people have died and many more have been left homeless in freezing conditions as homes and key infrastructure have been destroyed or damaged. The destruction halted the flow of humanitarian aid to northwest Syria, which is home to over four million people who are dependent on aid due to the ongoing conflict. The humanitarian needs are immense, and there are many challenges to recovery and reconstruction.

PeaceRep's Syria research team is building on our existing research to explore the political, economic, and social responses to and implications of the earthquakes, as well as the impact on conflict dynamics and peacemaking at international, national, and local levels.

In the coming months, we will publish a series of blogs on the situation in Syria. In the longer term, the Syria team at LSE's Conflict and Civicness Research Group (CCRG) and the University of Edinburgh are in the process of redrafting our future research agenda to reflect the post-earthquake era. Key research questions include:

- The political economy of early and medium to long-term recovery in Syria after the earthquakes
- The role of private sector in peacebuilding and recovery

- The role of the Syrian civil-society-led health organisation in responding to the earthquakes
- The role of key state actors – such as the US, Russia and Turkey – in responding to the earthquakes
- How the Syrian regime is exploiting the post-earthquake moment to 'normalise' its relations with third countries and the international community
- A comparative analysis of the legitimacy and power of formal and informal authorities pre- and post-earthquake in a select earthquake-affected area, drawing and expanding on existing research and surveying on authority and legitimacy. Learn more about the Mapping Syria project
- The relationships, and tensions, between UN humanitarian actors and the local civil society such as the White Helmets in the post-earthquake relief effort
- Political and operational cross-border issues around post-earthquake humanitarian assistance, particularly across the Syria-Turkey border and across the east-west conflict lines inside Syria.
- The role of non-traditional donors and channels of solidarity in responding to the earthquakes

Insights from PeaceRep's Syria research

PeaceRep has published a number of reports, blogs, and policy briefs relating to Syria, many of which offer insights and recommendations relevant to the post-earthquake context.

In a rapid response to the earthquakes, the PeaceRep Syria team at CCRG have compiled a summary of relevant points from earlier publications, and what research to date can tell us about post-earthquake politics. Key themes covered in these papers include resilience, corruption and the politicisation of aid, the use of sanctions as a tool for economic reconstruction, and aid distribution channels and the conditionality of aid.

Read the full summary here

Read more about our Syria work

Additional PeaceRep research on Syria

Building Resilience in Syria: Fragilities and coping mechanisms

Fragmentation of Peacemaking in Syria: Reality and Perception

The Covid-19 Pandemic and Alternative Governance Systems in Idlib

Rethinking Governance: Insights from Syria during Covid-19

Learn more

PeaceRep's Syria work is led by Rim Turkmani of the LSE Conflict and Civicness Research Group, in collaboration with Mazen Gharibah and Zaki Mehchy. Research on fragmentation and governance is undertaken by Juline Beaujouan at University of Edinburgh, in collaboration with partners based in Syria, Jordan and Turkey.

Events

The LSE research team recently hosted an event discussing the earthquakes and their impact, *Politics of the Turkey/Syria Earthquake: Responses and aftermath.*

Access the event recording

How to help

The University of Edinburgh has shared information on providing support for those affected by the earthquakes, including a list of organisations that support communities throughout Turkey and Syria.

Find out more

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/03/10/turkey-syria-earthquakes-recovery-and-response/

2023-03-08 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

International Women's Day 2023: Digital tools for inclusive peace

Our PeaceFem mobile app is one example of an innovative digital tool designed to support inclusive peace. Developed with our partners UN Women, InclusivePeace, and the Gender, Peace and Security Centre at Monash University, PeaceFem provides insights and strategies to support women's inclusion in peace processes, alongside examples of gender provisions in peace agreements and their implementation. The app is available in Arabic, English, French, and Indonesian, and is being used by women's rights advocates, mediation and negotiation teams, and other peace and security actors in 60 countries around the globe.

PeaceRep Research into Women and Gender

The PeaceFem app is informed by our wider research, data, and digital tools on women's inclusion in peace processes. Our PA-X Women, Girls, and Gender database lists all peace agreements between 1990 and 2022 which have provisions on women, girls, gender or sexual violence, and provides full searchable content.

PA-X Gender underpins our research into when and how women and sexual and gender minorities navigate inclusion across all stages of a peace process. We examine how forms of violence change through conflict and what strategies women and gender equality advocates can use to intervene and influence peace settlements. PeaceRep has partnered with the Transitional Justice Institute at Ulster University, Conciliation Resources and UN Women in this research. We summarise our insights from this work in our key findings on Women and Gender.

With our partners International IDEA and the Edinburgh Centre for Constitutional Law, we founded the Global Network of Women Constitution Makers to elevate the role of women in constitution making. Our most recent annual dialogue addressed constitutional approaches to decentralisation.

In recent blogs, PeaceRep researchers explore how gender perspectives in peace agreements are evolving, how women face challenges to using tech tools for peacebuilding, and how including gendered perspectives on enforced disappearances would be a step forward toward women's empowerment and gender justice in post-conflict societies. In this report, we highlight the impact of Covid-19 on women's inclusion in the peace process in Yemen. And here, we examine how to increase the representation of women peace mediators. For even more publications and outputs from our women and gender research, browse our publications database.

We are proud to be working with our partners to build digital tools and resources to support women's involvement in peace processes. On this International Women's Day we celebrate the contribution of women's rights advocates working for inclusive, sustainable peace around the world.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/03/08/international-womens-day-2023-digital-tools-for-inclusive-peace/

2023-03-07 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Tim Epple joins PeaceRep as Managing Director

PeaceRep team members are delighted to welcome Tim Epple to the programme as its new Managing Director.

Tim works at the intersection of mediation and peace process practice and research, drawing on experience in the public and private sectors and academia. and to promote the use of evidence in mediation and peacebuilding programming. In 2019-2020, Tim worked with several current members of the PeaceRep team as part of the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) – PeaceRep's predecessor programme – as a Research Associate working on the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, and particularly PA-X Local.

For the past two years, Tim lived in Juba, South Sudan, where he worked as an Associate Strategic Planning Officer with the United Nations Multi-Partner Trust Fund for Reconciliation, Stabilisation, and Resilience in South Sudan (RSRTF), a joint initiative of the United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS) and the United Nations Country Team in South Sudan. The RSRTF is piloting an innovative whole-of-system and highly localised approach to stabilisation and peacebuilding. The Fund invests in locally driven area-based programmes that tackle the root causes of conflict and address immediate conflict triggers. These programmes build on local peace processes and seek to support the implementation of sub-national peace agreements, such as the Marial Bai peace agreement or the Pieri peace agreement. In his role with the RSRTF, Tim led on strategic planning, knowledge management and learning efforts, feeding insights from PSRP into the Fund's local peace process support work.

Tim has published on local peacemaking, state responses to social unrest, and the role of the media in peace agreements[*]. His current research focuses on the relationship between climate change and peacemaking.

Tim takes up this new role in support of Professor Christine Bell as Executive Director, and the wider PeaceRep consortium and organisational leads in delivering on PeaceRep research goals. Tim is managing the day-to-day research direction of PeaceRep as of January 2023, in accordance with the ideas and goals set out at the heart of the programme.

Learn more about Tim

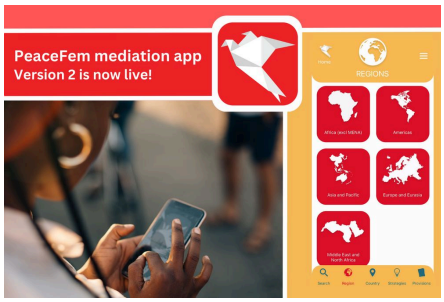
[*] References

1. 1. Peace Agreements, the Media, and Communication (Report)
   2. A globalised practice of local peace agreements (Article)
   3. State Responses to Social Unrest: Pathways out of Crisis (Report)
   4. The Impact of COVID-19 on Peace and Transition Processes: Tracking the Trends (Report)

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/03/07/tim-epple-joins-as-managing-director/

2023-02-20 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Supporting inclusive peace through technology: PeaceFem app V2 now live



Women's participation in peacebuilding is vital for building inclusive, sustainable peace. United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325 reaffirms the important role of women in conflict resolution and calls for women's equal participation and involvement in peace and security. Yet more than 20 years since its adoption, women frequently remain excluded from peace process negotiations and often participate at great personal risk. How can we encourage gender mainstreaming in peace processes, and can technology help?

In 2020 PeaceRep and our partners UN Women, InclusivePeace, and the Gender, Peace and Security Centre at Monash University launched the PeaceFem mobile app to meet demand for tools and resources supporting women's inclusion in peace processes. PeaceFem is designed to support women's rights advocates, mediation teams, and other peace and security actors in influencing peace process negotiations by providing case studies on gender provisions in peace agreements, and strategies used to work for their inclusion.

Following its launch in 2020, PeaceFem is now in use in more than 60 countries. We are delighted to announce that PeaceFem has now been updated for 2023, with additional case studies and languages that will expand the app's reach and accessibility among women's rights advocates in even more regions around the world.

What's new in Version 2?

- Additional case studies on women's involvement and gender perspectives in peace processes in Afghanistan, Myanmar, Indonesia, and Tunisia
- New full translations into French and Indonesian, alongside English and Arabic

- Technical improvements to improve user experience

PeaceFem is an important contribution to the growing field of PeaceTech, which uses data and technology to support peacebuilding. The app draws on case studies developed by InclusivePeace and Monash University and 30 years of PA-X peace agreement data from the University of Edinburgh.

PeaceFem is free to download from the Google Play Store (for Android) and the Apple App Store (for iOS). For more information, contact peacefem@ed.ac.uk.

Read more about PeaceFem – explore key features, and access user guides and how-to videos.

PeaceFem is a collaboration between UN Women, Inclusive Peace, Monash University's Gender, Peace and Security Centre, and PeaceRep: The Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform at the University of Edinburgh.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2023/02/20/supporting-inclusive-peace-through-technology-peacefem-v2/

2022

15 stories · Full original text

2022-11-03 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Local agreements and civicness in conflict: two new special issues

This aerial view shows makeshift structures of people displaced by drought at the Ladan internally displaced people (IDP) camp in Dolow on May 1, 2023. (Photo by Hassan Ali ELMI / AFP) (Photo by HASSAN ALI ELMI/AFP via Getty Images)

Journal of Peacebuilding: Local Agreements in Protracted Conflicts

This special issue summarises previous research by LSE CCRG aimed at understanding the processes and outcomes of agreements forged at the local or sub-national level in intractable conflicts.

In their introduction, Mary Kaldor, Rim Turkmani, Marika Theros write:

This article introduces a Peacebuilding special issue on local agreements in intractable conflicts. By 'local', we refer to any type of agreement that covers a geographical area less than the entire national territory although the issues and actors may be national, regional, international as well as local. Our main finding is that local agreements are a pervasive feature of contemporary conflict, owing to the fragmented decentred character of conflicts. Local agreements are not necessarily about peace; they may be a form of surrender, or about tactical alliances and deployment of armed groups. The overall conclusion is that local talks can contribute to what the paper defines as a peace logic, if they involve local civilians and multilateral actors, and are based on a detailed knowledge of context. Expanding this type of process on a large-scale may be the best opportunity for addressing the social condition that characterises contemporary intractable conflicts.

Read the full special issue on the publisher's website.

Journal of Society: Civicness in Conflict

This special issue contains articles from PeaceRep researchers based at LSE CCRG, including Mary Kaldor, Rim Turkmani, Marika Theros, and Nisar Majid.

In the introduction to the special issue, Mary Kaldor (LSE CCRG) and Henry Radice write:

Civicness is defined in three ways: (i) as a logic of public authority, that speaks to ideas of rights-based, inclusive rather than exclusive political orders; (ii) as a form of behaviour, acting 'as if' such a logic existed; and (iii) as a political position, articulated against uncivic politics, in particular the combination of endemic corruption, ethnic or religious sectarianism and economic and social

injustice. The introduction traces some conceptual, historical and vernacular entry points, before summarizing empirical research that points to the prevalence of civicness in all three senses in contemporary conflicts. It emerges even without free and secure spaces, and it often represents a strategy of survival. We also suggest that whether or not civicness is merely a way of surviving in conflict contexts or whether it represents an opening for challenging the dominant war logics depends to a degree on the character of international involvement.

Read the full special issue on the publisher's website.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/11/03/local-agreements-and-civicness-in-conflict-two-new-special-issues/

2022-10-27 / EVENTS HELD

Informing Peacebuilding Policy with PeaceRep Research: September 2022

PAVE Project roundtable, Tunis
Juline presented comparative insights on PAVE research in Tunisia, referring to research that she conducted with Open Think Tank in Iraq on addressing violent extremism through community resilience.

Insaniyyat Forum for Humanities and Social Sciences, Tunis
Juline presented on the tension and incompatibility between community resilience and state resilience in Iraq.

"The State of the State in the Middle East" academic and policy workshop, London
Juline participated following a previous workshop in the series, where she presented a paper on Covid-19 and alternative governance systems in Idlib, Syria.

Panelists at the Insaniyyat Forum at La Manouba University (Left) and at the PAVE Project roundtable event (Right)

Image credit: Johanna-Maria Hülzer/Berghof Foundation. September 2022

Related publications

- The role of religious institutions in the prevention of violent extremism in Nineveh province (Iraq)
- The Covid-19 Pandemic and Alternative Governance Systems in Idlib (Syria)

Explore all PeaceRep reports and policy briefs

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/10/27/informing-peacebuilding-policy-september-2022/

2022-10-20 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PeaceRep analysis cited in UN Secretary-General's report on women, peace and security

The UN Security Council held its annual Open Debate on Security Council Resolution 1325 – on women, peace and security – on 20 October 2022. Held annually since the adoption of Security Council Resolution 1325[i] in 2000, the debate aims to further the women, peace and security agenda, with this year's meeting aimed at "strengthening women's resilience and leadership as a path to peace in regions plagued by armed groups"[ii].

The debate was informed by the annual report of the Secretary-General on women and peace and security. This year's report[iii], published in October 2022, draws on PeaceRep research to illustrate trends in women's participation and inclusion in peace processes. The report includes a chart drawn from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database v6, showing the percentage of peace agreements with gender provisions from 2000–2021. This analysis is underpinned by blog posts by Laura Wise and Anna Asproni, Gender perspectives in peace agreements: Time for a new approach?, and Laura Wise, Peace Agreements with a Gender Perspective are Still an Exception, Not the Rule (published on the LSE Women Peace and Security blog).

PeaceRep's research is included on page 7, point 26:

> In 2021, 8 out of 25 peace agreements (32 per cent) included provisions referencing women, girls and gender, an increase from 26 per cent in 2020 (figure I). This number is still barely above the average over the last two decades. There is also a broad range across the agreements in terms of comprehensiveness and issues raised. The stage or type of agreement, the involvement of the United Nations as a third-party, women's participation and civil society participation in peace processes, and conflict duration, all have an impact on the inclusion of gender references in peace agreements. Notably, in 2021, detailed gender provisions could be found in local agreements, such as the Lou Nuer-Dinka Bor-Murle Action for Peace agreement in Jonglei, South Sudan[iv], where provisions seemed to be more contextually rooted in the community mediation processes preceding them. The Jonglei agreement also featured three women's representatives as signatories on behalf of their communities.

Read the research behind the report
Gender perspectives in peace agreements: Time for a new approach?

Read the full UN Security Council report
Report of the Secretary-General: Women, peace and security

References

[i] Security Council Resolution 1325

[ii] In focus: Women, peace and security (UN Women news)

[iii] UN Security Council Report of the Secretary-General: Women and peace and security

[iv] Lou Nuer-Dinka Bor-Murle Action for Peace agreement

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/10/20/peacerep-analysis-cited-un-secretary-generals-report-women-peace-security/

2022-07-22 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

What's New in Version 6 of the PA-X Database?

The sixth release (V6) of the PA-X Database and Dataset adds 44 new agreements to the collection, for a total of 1,959 agreements covering the 1990-2022 period with global scope. All the agreements are coded for a variety of substantive categories, from constitutional reform, to ceasefire provision, and transitional justice, to name but a few.

The PA-X website allows for the agreements to be explored and viewed, while the data can be downloaded as a csv file for quantitative analysis or as a corpus of agreement texts. Each agreement is available as a pdf document, and where the agreement was translated into English, both the English and the original language versions are available.

New Data on Local Agreements and Gender

Of these 44 newly added agreements , only 12 have a gender-related component, which is both low and in line with expectations1. These agreements have also been added to Gender PA-X, which provides more detail on how agreements deal with matters related to women, girls, and gender, with the same global coverage for the 1990-2022 period as the main PA-X collection.

Over its six releases, PA-X has seen a steady stream of local agreements – those that refer to localised conflicts or localised impact of wider conflicts – and in this release, such agreements make for nearly a third of the newly added documents: 14 of the 44 new agreements have been added to PA-X Local.

While most of the agreements among those newly added are from 2021 and 2020 (18 and 13, respectively), some older agreements have been added as well, the oldest among these dating back to 2008.

The newly added agreements also feature English translations of three local agreements from Syria, collected by the PeaceRep team at LSE Ideas, headed by Dr Rim Turkmani.

World map highlighting countries that are the subject of peace agreements added to version 6 of the PA-X Database

Unusual Additions

This release also contains some unusual documents, such as the agreement between Taliban and a local education department in Helmand2, which regulates the provision of education in the area and allows for passage of education workers. It is this aspect of normalisation and the provision for access and mobility that makes it an agreement that aims to regulate the armed conflict, even if it only contributes to resolving the entire conflict in a marginal way.

Another somewhat unusual document in the new release of PA-X is the Troika Statement on Witnessing the Juba Agreement3, which extends the Juba Agreement in Sudan so that the governments of United Kingdom, Norway and United States are formally acting as witnesses to the Agreement. The Statement adds little to the Juba Agreement, but it does expand the set of actors involved in the agreement, which is why it is added to PA-X as a key part of the negotiations in Sudan.

Explore the updated PA-X Peace Agreements Database

References

1. Gender perspectives in peace agreements: Time for a new approach? (PeaceRep blog)
2. Taliban MoU with Department of Helmand on Education (peace agreement)
3. Witnessing the Juba Peace Agreement: Troika statement (peace agreement)

Author

Sanja Badanjak's profile

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/07/22/whats-new-in-version-6-of-the-pa-x-database/

2022-07-06 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

UN Women report cites PA-X research on local peace processes

UN Women's new report explores the vital roles women play in mediating local conflicts in Iraq, Libya, Syria, and Yemen. The report aims to map entry points, techniques, key themes, and outcomes of

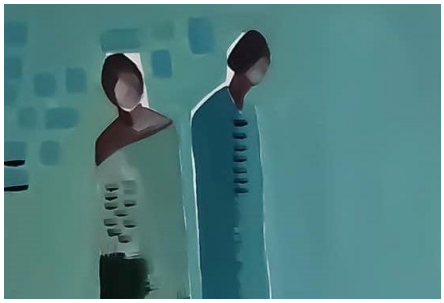


Image: 'Confusion', an art piece by Shatha Altowai

women's mediation in order to enhance understanding of this work, with the ultimate aim of better supporting the role of women in mediation and strengthening prospects for peace.

In setting out key terms, the report draws on analysis from our research on local peace processes. The report defines 'local mediation' as "referring to community-level mediation efforts that have limited territorial scope, are mediated by someone from that community, and address disputes that concern that community" (pp. 8) – a definition informed by the PA-X Spotlight report, Local Peace Processes: Opportunities and Challenges for Women's Engagement, based on the PA-X Gender and PA-X Local Peace Agreements databases. The authors also acknowledge the importance of defining terms, as "the way we talk about mediation determines how visible women are and how their contributions are valued" (pp. 7).

The report concludes with a list of key findings and recommendations for supporting women mediators.

About the UN Women report

Largely excluded from formal mediation roles, women across conflict-affected countries in the Arab region have been instrumental in diffusing tensions and mediating conflicts in their own communities. UN Women's new report "Women's Participation in Local Mediation: Lessons from Iraq, Libya, Syria, Yemen"sheds light on the diverse mediation roles women have played to resolve conflict and restore social cohesion in their communities. Drawing on various case studies from the four conflict-affected countries, the report demonstrates how women have mediated ceasefires and a halt to violations against civilians, brokered the release of political prisoners, prevented and resolved tribal conflicts and engaged in cross-line negotiations to secure access to water and other vital resources. Yet, their contributions to peace go largely unrecognized. The invisibility and marginalization of women's efforts means their work is less documented and understood, posing a challenge for those wishing to support them. The report makes a series of recommendations to support women's local mediation while stressing the importance of understanding the local contexts where women mediators operate and providing assistance in a way that ensures their safety and security.

Read the full report on the UN Women website: Women's Participation in Local Mediation: Lessons from Iraq, Libya, Syria, Yemen

About the PA-X Spotlight report

Read the PA-X Spotlight report by Laura Wise, Robert Forster, and Christine Bell: Local Peace Processes: Opportunities and Challenges for Women's Engagement. This report addresses the questions:

- When and how do local peace processes and agreements address conflict?
- What are the opportunities and challenges for women and gender-equality advocates seeking to meaningfully engage with local peace processes?

About the PA-X Peace Agreements Database

The PA-X Spotlight report draws on data and analysis from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, including the PA-X Gender and PA-X Local sub-databases on gender provisions and local agreements.

The PA-X Peace Agreement Database (www.peaceagreements.org) is a database and repository of peace agreements from 1990 to date, current up until April 2022. PA-X provides a comprehensive dataset of peace agreements, capable of underpinning both quantitative and qualitative research. PA-X has been designed to provide easy access to peace agreement texts and to allow users to explore patterns of agreements over time, both within processes and across processes.

PA-X also includes a suite of data visualisations that enable exploration of the data across time, space, and issues.

PeaceRep research impact

Read more about our research impact.

Image: Shatha Altowai

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/07/06/un-women-report-cites-pa-x-research-on-local-peace-processes/

2022-06-17 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Work with us: Finance and Project Officer role now open

PeaceRep seeks a senior administrator with financial experience to join the Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform (PeaceRep) as Finance and Project Officer. The successful candidate will support the Programme Director and Programme Manager in all aspects of financial management and will liaise with programme partners to ensure that deadlines are met.

The Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform (PeaceRep) is a research programme funded by the Foreign, Commonwealth, and Development Office (FCDO). The programme is re-thinking peace and transition processes in light of changing conflict dynamics, changing demands of inclusion, and changes in patterns of global intervention in conflict and peace/mediation/transition management processes. The programme is made up of a consortium of academic and practitioner organisations, led by the University of Edinburgh.

The PeaceRep Finance and Projects Officer will work closely with PeaceRep's Programme Manager and Programme Director and take responsibility for all aspects of the Programme's financial portfolio. The post-holder will be responsible for the financial management of the Programme, including budget projections, reporting, accounting and responding to audits, disbursements, helping to establish payment systems within the University operating structure, monitoring partners and network participant expenditure, liaising with their financial teams, and liaising with relevant FCDO financial systems and personnel.

Apply now: Finance and Project Officer

Contact peacerep@ed.ac.uk with any questions.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/06/17/work-with-us-finance-and-project-officer-role-now-open/

2022-06-13 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Christine Bell on geopolitical dimensions of the Russia-Ukraine conflict

Christine Bell has authored blog and a short report on geopolitical settlement in the context of Ukraine-Russia negotiations, entitled “Multilevel Peace Agreement Design: Dealing with Geopolitical Support”.

Professor Bell’s report addresses the geopolitical dimensions of the conflict, what type of agreement or agreements might be used to resolve these issues, and the ways in which this could be linked to any Russia-Ukraine settlement. The report is not an attempt to assume or specify settlement terms for any party: rather, the report argues that geopolitical agreement will likely be needed to capture commitments to issues in the conflict that require the active commitment and support of third-party states and organisations to be addressed. If geopolitical conflict is part of the problem, it has to be part of the solution. The Report aims to provide comparative information on process-design for geopolitical agreement, to those who are engaged in any settlement process at whatever point in the conflict and on whatever terms they decide are appropriate.

The report provides examples of how geopolitical agreement has been reached and formalised in other conflict contexts – including contexts of negotiated settlement, and contexts of victory and defeat. It touches on the issues that logically would need geopolitical settlement to be dealt with. It sets out options for the form in which agreement could be reached. It concludes by affirming that the design of the modality of agreement closely relates to how substantive issues are to be framed and resolved. Options regarding ‘form’ themselves have substantive implications for the position taken by parties with respect to the conflict. Creative use of the form of agreement is therefore important to being able to reach agreement on substance.

The main options set out are: use of UN Security Council Resolution; use of Treaty; signature or guarantor, or signing of an independent ‘International actor’ agreement as part of a package of any Russian-Ukraine agreement; and using ‘all of the above’ to create a multi-layered form of settlement.

This work is part of an ongoing process of considering how our ongoing comparative research might be useful to Ukraine. As part of a responsive approach to research, PeaceRep consortium researchers – many of whom are based at LSE – have published a number of blogs and reports, set out below. This work also draws also on the PA-X Peace Agreement Database, University of Edinburgh, which tracks all peace processes from January 1990 to date.

- Meeting the Immediate Needs of the Ukrainian Economy
- When is a civil war not a civil war?
- Ukraine-Russia crisis: Europe needs to rethink its security arrangements along the lines of the Helsinki Accords rather than of classic geo-political alliances like NATO
- The Ukraine invasion in an age of new wars (podcast)
- As a result of the war in Ukraine a new political order in Europe is taking shape
- Putin is the product of a corrupt economic system that we must now reform
- Why we need to unite for peace and human rights across the old divides

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/06/13/christine-bell-geopolitical-dimensions-russia-ukraine-conflict/

2022-05-19 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Job Opportunity: Postdoc in Eastern European peace and conflict studies

KonKoop is the research network for "Cooperation and Conflict in Eastern Europe: The Consequences of the Reconfiguration of Political, Economic and Social Spaces since the End of the Cold War". KonKoop is funded by the Federal Ministry for Education and Research (BMBF).

Network members of the network are the Center for Eastern European and International Studies (ZOiS) in Berlin, the Leibniz Institute for East and Southeast European Studies (IOS) in Regensburg, the Leibniz Institute for Regional Geography (IfL) in Leipzig, the Leibniz Center for Contemporary History Research (ZZF) in Potsdam, the Friedrich Schiller University Jena (FSU Jena), and the University for Sustainable Development Eberswalde (HNEE).

- Find out more about this opportunity and how to apply
- Visit the Leibniz Institute for East and Southeast European Studies (IOS) website

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/05/19/job-opportunity-postdoc-eastern-europe/

2022-05-17 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Addressing Gender-Based Violence in Post-Conflict Societies: PeaceRep Welcomes Research Intern

I am eager to apply what I have learned during my academic career as contribution to PeaceRep's work. The placement at PeaceRep is an excellent opportunity to enhance my data analysis skills and to study research issues relating to peace processes in-depth. I am particularly interested in the gendered aspect of conflict resolution.

Specifically, I wish to explore how criminal law's implementation (or lack thereof) in addressing Gender-Based Violence (GBV) in post-conflict societies influences national reconciliation and stability. One of the aims of my research is to understand the extent to which criminal law reform is an adequate response to redressing GBV and achieving justice in post-conflict environments, compared with other traditional indigenous and informal measures for national reconciliation. I am looking forward to collaborating with a team of academics and researchers dedicated to justice and conflict resolution.

- Read Anna's PeaceRep profile

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/05/17/research-internship-addressing-gbv/

2022-05-16 / RECOGNITION

PeaceRep research impact recognised by REF2021

Edinburgh Law School was recognised as having a 100% world-leading research environment, with 80% of research outputs rated as either world-leading or internationally excellent. REF2021 also recognised 92% of Edinburgh Law School's case studies as either world-leading or internationally excellent.

Read more about the results at Edinburgh Law School.

Local women sit and chat outside their home in front of a mural; a banner calls for justice, education, peace, bread, health and freedom; another reads "S.O.S They are killing us". August 11, 2021 in Taganga, Colombia. Photo by Kaveh Kazemi for Getty Images

PeaceRep contributed two case studies to the Edinburgh Law School submission, based on work undertaken in our previous phase as the Political Settlements Research Programme and supported by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO). More information will be published when the full case studies are released.

We are proud to be part of Edinburgh Law School and delighted to see the School recognised for the strength of its research environment, outputs, and impact. We look forward to continuing to support peace and transitions processes as PeaceRep: The Peace and Conflict Resolution Evidence Platform.

PeaceRep is grateful for funding provided by the Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO), UK.

Read more about our research impact.

Read more about our research.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/05/16/ref2021-recognises-peacerep-research/

2022-05-13 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Publications, Data and More: Explore the New PeaceRep Site

Peacerep.org introduces several new features:

- About PeaceRep: overview of the programme and consortium
- Research Themes: introduction to our main themes (fragmentation, country context, geopolitical transitions, and PeaceTech)
- Data: explore the latest version of the PA-X database and more

Existing functionality has been improved:

- Publications: streamlined database for easy use
- Resources: links to our podcasts, tools, and trackers
- News and Blogs: topical analysis from PeaceRep experts and guests
- Events: the latest webinars and events

Got feedback to share with us about this new website? Send us an email: info@peacerep.org

About PeaceRep

PeaceRep is re-thinking peace and transition processes in light of changing conflict dynamics, changing demands of inclusion, and changes in patterns of global intervention in conflict and peace/mediation/transition management processes. We are supporting the reimagining of peace and transition processes through a range of traditional, praxis, and digitally innovative research tools and projects. Read more about our research.

Subscribe to our newsletter to receive the latest updates.

Explore the new website

PeaceRep brings together a consortium of researchers drawn from universities, non-governmental organisations and inter-governmental organisations. More about the full consortium here.

PeaceRep is funded by the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO). More about our funders here.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/05/13/explore-new-site/

2022-05-11 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New PeaceRep publication series explores global transitions

Produced in collaboration with PeaceRep consortium partner University of St Andrews, this series is part of our body of work on how non-ODA states such as Russia, China, United Arab Emirates, and Qatar, and a range of regional organisations intervene in peace and transition processes, and with what goals.

View the full Global Transitions series

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/05/11/peacerep-publication-series-global-transitions/

2022-03-30 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Final Update to the Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 Tracker

On March 23rd 2022 we mark two years since UN Secretary General António Guterres called for a global ceasefire to assist in the fight against the growing threat of the Covid-19 pandemic.

Weapons being burnt during the official launch of the Disarmament, Demobilization, Rehabilitation and Reintegration (DDRR) process in Muramvya, Burundi.Photo/Martine Perret. www.un.org/av/photo/

While the call initially prompted a flurry of activity from governments, activists, and a variety of armed groups, including some genuine attempts to foster and broker ceasefires, the experience of the past two years has shown that armed conflict is impervious to even the most intense shocks – such as a global pandemic.

We developed our Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 Tracker as a collaborative project and platform, to assess the extent and impact of the response to the UNSG's ceasefire call. Our monitoring of a wide variety of news sources in multiple languages has shown that the initial responses to the call quickly gave way to 'business as usual', with negotiation activities and attempts to end or pause fighting only marginally (if at all) referring to either the pandemic or the ceasefire call.

In the current (and final) update to the tracker, we add the most recent instances of ceasefires, to complete the collection covering two years of negotiation activity surrounding attempts at ceasefire. Each of the 101 entries in the tracker is an event: a unilateral ceasefire, a reciprocation, a bilateral or multilateral ceasefire, or a related event.

Apart from supporting us in gaining a better understanding of ceasefires and peace processes, the Tracker has underscored the complexity of attempts to end fighting, with multiple such events only rarely reaching a point of prolonged ceasefire, and most often breaking down when offers of ceasefire are seen as not credible or disingenuous. This bears important lessons for the study of peace processes, as the focus on formal agreements may lead us to underestimate the variety of attempts to even begin talks. Seen in parallel with the PA-X Peace Agreements Database and Dataset, the Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 Tracker allows comparison between the formal and the informal negotiations, and between processes that failed before they produced a written deal of any sort and those that resulted in agreements, no matter how short-lived. Additionally, the Tracker forms a solid base for extending this data collection effort, in terms of an improved understanding of ad-hoc ceasefire attempts and as developed database infrastructure.

The Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 Tracker is available at https://pax.peaceagreements.org/static/covid19ceasefires/

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 is a collaborative project between

- Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP)
- Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO)
- Center for Security Studies (CSS) at ETH Zurich, Conciliation Resources
- Mediateur (European Forum for International Mediation and Dialogue)
- United States Institute of Peace (USIP)

with thanks to contributions from the Mediation Support Unit in the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs.

Funding: FCDO via PeaceRep and Covid Collective

Related work

- An interactive tracker for ceasefires in the time of COVID-19
- Designing an interactive real-time web-mapped dashboard to visualise conflict ceasefires data over COVID-19 infection rates: facilities and the way ahead
- Breathing Space: Vaccination Ceasefires in Armed Conflict
- Pandemic Pauses: Understanding Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 (PSRP Research Report)
- Ceasefire monitoring: developments and complexities. Accord Spotlight

Photo: UN Photo/Martine Perret

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/03/30/final-update-of-the-ceasefires-in-a-time-of-covid-19-tracker/

2022-03-03 / RECOGNITION

Professor Christine Bell appointed Honorary Professor at the Mitchell Institute

The Mitchell Institute brings together researchers from a wide range of disciplines to respond to the unprecedented global challenge of building a peaceful, inclusive and secure world.

Mitchell Institute Director Richard English said: 'We're delighted that Christine Bell will become an Honorary Professor at the Institute. Her pioneering work will complement and enrich areas of great strength here at Queen's, and it will be excellent to collaborate with this distinguished scholar over coming years.'

On behalf of the entire PeaceRep consortium, we congratulate Professor Bell on this appointment and look forward to continuing to collaborate with Queens University Belfast.

Read more on the Mitchell Institute's website

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/03/03/professor-christine-bell-appointed-honorary-professor-at-the-mitchell-institute/

2022-01-14 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PA-X Database development highlighted in 'Pathways to Peace and Security' journal

Dr Badanjak's paper is complemented by two relevant articles in this publication which are also included in the section titled "Datasets and Mathematical Methods in Peace and Conflict Studies",

authored respectively by Stina Högbladh (Uppsala University) and Thomas Morgan (Institute for Economics and Peace, Sydney).

Stina Högbladh's paper, titled "Peace agreements in armed conflicts: Focusing on finding a solution to the conflict incompatibility", describes the most up-to-date version of the Uppsala Conflict Data Program's (UCDP) Peace Agreement Dataset. The paper also provides an analysis of key trends in the dataset's peace agreements.

Thomas Morgan refers to the Global Peace Index (GPI) in an article titled "Peace as a composite indicator: The goals and future of the Global Peace Index". Morgan describes how the GPI, a composite indicator of peacefulness at the national level, brings together multiple indicators of violence to represent a continuous measure of peacefulness.

Dr Badanjak's article is now available via the project's publications database.

- Browse all PSRP research publications online
- Access the Fall-Winter 2021 issue of *Pathways to Peace and Security*

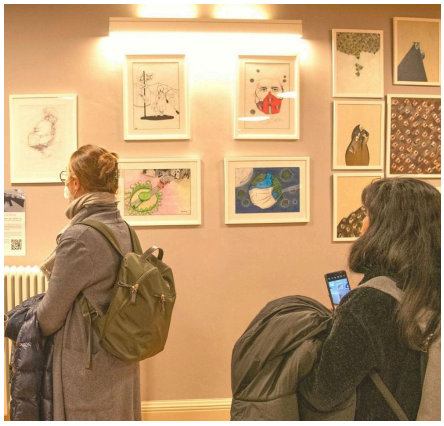
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2022/01/14/development-of-pa-x-database-in-pathways-to-peace-and-security-journal/

2021

23 stories · Full original text

2021-12-16 / EVENTS HELD

Art as a Tool of Peace Exhibition Launch



The event began with introductory remarks by Yemeni artist Shatha Altowai and PeaceRep researcher Dr Juline Beaujouan, who offered insights into the works and the role of art as a tool for local peace. This was followed by a presentation of the works during a musical performance by Yemeni musician Saber Bamatraf, together with Phil Westwell (uilleann piper and flutist) and Katherine Campbell (cellist). Attendees then had the opportunity to speak with the artists and researchers while viewing the full exhibition during a drinks reception.

Attendees reported that they found the artwork and music very engaging, moving, and thought-provoking. Dr Kasey McCall-Smith (University of Edinburgh) described how the exhibition showcased "Amazing approaches to conflict resolution flowing through to paper & action". Featured artists also shared their thoughts on the event on Twitter:

The exhibition pieces by Syrian artists were created as part of a research project supported by the FCDO-funded Covid Collective Research Platform at the Institute for Development Studies (IDS). In Syria, PeaceRep Research Associate Dr. Juline Beaujouan and colleagues, Abdulah El hafi and Eyas Ghreiz, built on collaborations with local communities in northwest Aleppo to investigate the shifting role of local civil society during the pandemic.

Learn more about the artists

- Shatha Altowai
- The Blue Team
- Saber Bamatraf

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/12/16/art-as-a-tool-of-peace-exhibition-launch-through-to-paper-and-action/

2021-12-13 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Fully Funded PhD Opportunity: At the Intersection of Sexualities and Political Settlement in Northern Ireland

Deadline for applications: 17:00 (GMT) on Tuesday 14 December 2021

A fully-funded PhD opportunity as part of the Beyond Opposition Project welcomes applications to explore LGBTQ+ inclusions and those who are opposed to, or concerned about, these in the context of Northern Ireland.

The successful candidate will be co-supervised by Professor Kath Browne, who leads the Beyond Opposition project at University College Dublin, and Professor Aisling Swaine, who has conducted research as part of the Political Settlements Research Programme.

The Beyond Opposition project explores the possibilities of co-creating worlds in which polarized differences can co-exist in liveable ways. This PhD project will take place as Brexit, Northern Irish protocol, and changes to sexualities and gender legislations are ongoing in Northern Ireland.

In the context of political settlements and post-agreement societies, and the disruptions of LGBTQ+ lives and spaces that can cut across other divisions, the project will explore key questions including: In what ways do oppositions to LGBTQ+ lives intersect with, contest and learn from oppositions prompted by political violence? In what ways might some oppositions become 'settled' while others remain unresolved? What are the implications of LGBTQ+ inclusions for post-agreement settled societies? What can peace building and transitional justice bring to divisions around sexualities and genders? Conversely, what can considerations of sexualities and genders bring to understandings of peace building and transitional justice?

Read more about the project and how to apply

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/12/13/phd-opportunity-sexualities-and-political-settlement-in-northern-ireland/

2021-12-10 / EVENTS HELD

Constitutions, Customary and Religious Law and Gender Equality: Third Annual Women Constitution-Makers' Dialogue

PeaceRep and International IDEA hosted the third annual Women Constitution-Makers' Dialogue on 18 and 19 November, with a focus on examining comparative experiences with constitutions, customary and religious law and gender equality.

For women peacebuilders and constitution-makers, the balancing act between cultural and religious rights and gender equality is often complex and involves intersecting identities and interests. Moreover, the process of forging consensus among women, among political decision-makers and within society more broadly can be challenging. How should women constitution-makers and their allies approach reconciling these rights within a constitutional framework?

This two-day event brought together 30 participants from diverse backgrounds and experiences, including experts from Bolivia, Botswana, Chile, Kenya, South Africa, South Sudan, Syria, and Tunisia, along with senior international advisors and academics in the fields of constitution-building, peace processes, and gender and democracy.

The agenda was organized into five sessions, including panellist presentations and open discussions:

1. Conceptualizing the theme of the event, framing the issues, and exploring trends in constitutional design and legal and policy approaches globally
2. Examining how demands for cultural and religious rights and gender equality arise in the constitution-making process and how intersecting identities shape coalition building amongst women
3. Comparing constitutional design approaches to legal pluralism and reconciling tensions between customary/religious systems and guarantees of gender equality and non-discrimination
4. Examining successes and challenges with implementing the constitutional balancing act and the extent to which constitutional frameworks and institutions have been able to transform the discriminatory aspects of custom or religion to further empower women.
5. Discussing how the constitutional architecture can be reimagined and identifying innovative approaches to harmonization, transformation, and empowerment.

Overall, participants emphasized that the issue of discrimination in customary and religious conventions is a global problem that precedes state-based constitutions. However, constitutions have an important role to play in transforming deeply held societal beliefs, attitudes and behaviours that contribute to the systemic and global marginalization of women.

Key to addressing this is recognizing that customary law – and to some extent religious law – are living systems, and that their ability to change over time is foundational to transformation. Advocates, traditional and 'formal'/civil leaders and institutions can be empowered and capacitated to support necessary change over time. As one participant noted, "Law is man-made, but can be woman-infused'.

The 2021 dialogue was the third in an annual Women Constitution-Makers series that was initiated in 2019 by International IDEA and PeaceRep. The dialogue series aims to foster a global network of women constitution-makers and peacebuilders centred on peer-to-peer exchanges and comparative experience sharing, elevating women's voices and roles in constitution-building and broadening understanding of women's experiences, interests and needs.

Publications on the outcomes for this latest event are forthcoming in 2022.

Read a full summary of the event on the International IDEA website.

Image credit: International IDEA

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/12/10/third-annual-women-constitution-makers-dialogue/

2021-11-29 / RECOGNITION

PSRP gender research awarded prestigious book prize

PSRP research into women's rights in armed conflict under international law has been awarded a prestigious book prize.

Prof Catherine O'Rourke won the Irish Association of Law Teachers (IALT) Kevin Boyle Prize for Outstanding Legal Scholarship for her book *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law* (Cambridge 2020). The book examines how institutions and regimes interact under international law to protect women's rights in conflict, using case studies to reveal the implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict.

In his nomination, Prof Rory O'Connell said:

> In *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law* (Cambridge 2020) Prof Catherine O'Rourke powerfully synthesises research across different areas of international law (human rights law, criminal law, humanitarian law, UN Security Council) to address the position of women in conflict. She expertly deploys feminist institutional methodologies to chart the development of international law and practice in this area and to identify optimum ways of effecting change going forward.

Catherine O'Rourke ran the gender stream of the Political Settlements Research Programme as part of her work as coordinator of gender research at the Transitional Justice Institute at Ulster University. In October 2021 she took up the post of Chair in Global Law at Durham University.

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law is an output of the Political Settlements Research Programme which is funded by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office.

About the book

Laws and norms that focus on women's lives in conflict have proliferated across the regimes of international humanitarian law, international criminal law, international human rights law and the United Nations Security Council. While separate institutions, with differing powers of monitoring and enforcement, implement these laws and norms, the activities of regimes overlap. *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law* is the first book to account for this pluralism and institutional diversity. This book identifies key aspects of how different regimes regulate women's rights in conflict, and how they interact. Using country case studies to reveal the practical implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict, this book offers a dynamic account of how regimes and institutions interact, the extent to which they reinforce each other, and the tensions and gaps in regulation that emerge.

- Counters siloed analysis by looking across various key regimes
- Looks at interactions in order to take a dynamic approach in examining institutions
- Explores case studies to reveal what fragmentation in law means in practice for the regulation of women's rights in conflict

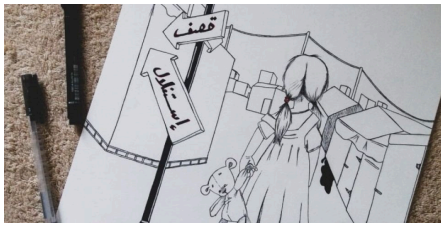
A policy summary drawn from the book is also available.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/11/29/book-prize/

2021-11-17 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Art as a Tool for Peace: Young artists from Syria and Yemen illustrate the transformative power of art

About the Exhibition



The exhibition features a series of paintings created by a group of young Syrian artists called the Blue Team (*Fariq Azraq* in Arabic), who have collaborated to illustrate life in opposition-held areas of Syria during the Covid-19 pandemic. Earlier in 2021, the artists produced two exhibitions in Syria – combining art, music, and activities – that offer powerful insights into the daily lives of Syrian displaced and ethnic minorities, and demonstrate how art can bring people together and act as a tool for local peace. Now in Scotland for the first time, this exhibition is an opportunity to view the paintings and hear the stories of these extraordinary young people.

The exhibition also features the work of award-winning Yemeni artist Shatha Altowai, an IASH Artist Protection Fund Fellow. In "The White Canvas", Shatha addresses issues that she has experienced and observed throughout her life in Yemen, specifically focussing on the last seven years since the eruption of the current war. She aims to highlight the lifestyles of Yemeni families living through the war, their solidarity, and how they seek to overcome the lack of basic necessities, such as food, water, electricity, fuel and security. Her work conveys the contradictory emotions of strength and fear that Yemeni families grapple with as part of their everyday experience.

Together these two sets of paintings offer a unique perspective on life in conflict zones, and on the power of art to bring people together and contribute to local peace.

About the Project

This exhibition is part of a research project supported by the FCDO-funded Covid Collective Research Platform, and forms part of PeaceRep's work on the nexus between the Covid-19 pandemic, peace and conflict and the interplay between several layers of crises. In Syria, PeaceRep Research Fellow Dr. Juline Beaujouan and two of her colleagues – Abdulah El hafi and Eyas Ghreiz – built on collaborations with local communities in opposition-held areas in the northwest of the country to investigate the shifting role of local civil society during the pandemic.

Learn more about this work

Exhibition launch at the University of Edinburgh, 24 November 2021

Art as a tool for local peace: Reflections of young artists in Syrian opposition-held areas

Young artists illustrate life in Syrian opposition-held areas

Shatha Altowai

The Blue Team

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/11/17/art-as-a-tool-for-peace-young-artists-from-syria-and-yemen-illustrate-the-transformative-power-of-art/

2021-10-28 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PSRP analysis cited in UN Secretary-General's report on women, peace and security

The UN Security Council held its annual Open Debate on Security Council Resolution 1325 on women, peace and security on 21 October 2021. Held annually since the adoption of Security Council Resolution 1325 in 2000, the debate aims to further the women, peace and security agenda, with this year's meeting aimed at supporting local women peacebuilders. Read a summary of the Secretary-General's statement at the debate.

The debate was informed by the annual report of the Secretary-General on women and peace and security. This year's report, published in September 2021, draws on PSRP research to illustrate trends in women's participation and inclusion in peace processes. The report includes a chart drawn from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, v5, showing the percentage of peace agreements with gender provisions from 2010–2020. This analysis is underpinned by a blog post by Laura Wise, Peace Agreements with a Gender Perspective are Still an Exception, Not the Rule, which was originally published on the LSE Women Peace and Security blog.

PSRP research is included on pages 8-9, point 26:

> Ensuring that peace agreements address the rights, concerns and perspectives of all women regardless of their ethnicity, race, sexual orientation, age or religion is important to opening the door to women's participation and rights in the implementation phase. However, the inclusion of references to women, girls or gender continues to fluctuate widely, and a low number of ceasefire agreements contain them. After a downward trend, the percentage of peace agreements more broadly with gender provisions has started to rise, but at 28.6 per cent in 2020 it remains well below the 37.1 per cent recorded in 2015 (see figure I). Research shows that the agreements most likely to mention women, girls or gender often arise at the comprehensive agreement stage, and ceasefire agreements remain a key gap. None of the ceasefire agreements reached between 2018 and 2020 included gender provisions or the prohibition of sexual violence.

The report also cites a 2019 PSRP publication by Robert Forster and Christine Bell, Gender mainstreaming in ceasefires: comparative data and examples as a source of comparative and deeper analysis on gender mainstreaming in ceasefires. Read the citation on page 2, footnote 2.

Read the full report: Report of the Secretary-General on women and peace and security.

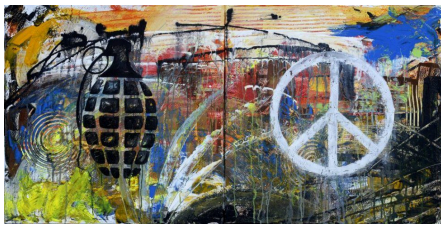
Photo credit: UN Photo

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/10/28/psrp-analysis-cited-in-un-secretary-generals-report-on-women-peace-and-security/

2021-09-06 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New collection highlights the significance of local peace processes

A new collection of essays published by the British Academy offers insights into the role of local peace agreements in international peacebuilding.



'War and Peace'. Via Wikimedia Commons. Photo credit: (U.S. Air Force art by Staff Sgt. Jamal D. Sutter/Released)

The collection, Local Peace Processes, brings together expert contributions from policy specialists and academics in the humanities and social sciences. Co-edited by Christine Bell and Laura Wise of the Political Settlements Research Programme and Jan Pospisil of the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution, the publication issues a number of policy recommendations and key findings for engaging with local agreement-making.

In recent years, the difficulties and failures of national level peace processes have prompted increased attention on 'the local' as a space of conflict resolution. The papers presented in this collection suggest both the existence of local peacemaking, and the impossibility of delimiting what is merely 'local' about it. This in turn points to a need for a new political imaginary for peace processes, which would go beyond the idea that it is about brokering elite pacts reached in a comprehensive peace agreement.

The contributions to this Collection all conclude that local agreements deserve greater attention as a peacemaking tool. They also demonstrate variation in how local agreements are used within and across contexts, and indicate significant involvement of international actors in many contexts.

This collection of studies emerged from a series of roundtables on Local Peace Processes that were convened as part of the British Academy's Conflict, Stability and Security programme, which supports research into conflict and insecurity overseas, together with the University of Edinburgh and the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution (ASPR), as part of the Political Settlements Research Programme funded by the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, UK AID.

The collection also draws on the PA-X Local Database, an open-access database of written local peace agreements from across a global set of conflict-affected contexts.

Professor Christine Bell FBA FRSE, co-editor of the collection and Director of the Political Settlements Research Programme, says:

> Local peace processes have the potential to reduce levels of conflict at critical moments when national peace processes are forestalled or delayed. Written and oral local agreements – often brokered in minority languages, and other non-written, non-verbal forms such as rituals and property exchanges – are often hugely significant at this local level.
>
> Insights from the humanities and social sciences help to broaden our understanding of different forms of trust-building and decision-making processes, in particular the importance of local peace negotiations. The wealth of multi-disciplinary research and evidence in this collection broadens our understanding of what it takes to build peace successfully in different contexts. It should be considered further by international actors, international donors and the research community.

Read the full collection and the key policy findings.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/09/06/new-collection-highlights-the-significance-of-local-peace-processes/

2021-08-26 / MEDIA ENGAGEMENTS

'The war is starting a new chapter': Michael Semple speaks to BBC Radio 4 on the future of Afghanistan

As a globally recognised expert on the Taliban movement, Prof Semple authored the PSRP report, An Independent Assessment of the Peace Process in Afghanistan, June 2018 – May 2021, as part of a team of three experienced analysts. The report is intended to contribute to the rethinking of approaches to peace-making in Afghanistan. Read the full report.

Michael Semple is a Professor at The Senator George J Mitchell Institute for Global Peace, Security and Justice, Queens University Belfast, and former deputy EU Envoy to Afghanistan. He lived in the region for more than 30 years.

Listen to the Today Programme interview here (Prof Semple's interview excerpt appears at 2:19:30).

Image by Alejandra Santiago from Pixabay

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/08/26/the-war-is-starting-a-new-chapter/

2021-08-16 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Help us support scholars and peacebuilders at risk in Afghanistan

As the situation unfolds in Afghanistan, our thoughts and prayers are with all those in the country, and in particular our colleagues who have taken risks for peacebuilding and inclusion of women. We are working to try to support scholars and peacebuilders at risk, and also to use our research capacity to inform the current situation as best as we can.

If you have any useful ways to support Afghans, and want help in connecting them to in-country efforts, but do not know how to go about it, please reach out to the programme at **politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk**.

For those that want to know more about the background, the PSRP's main research reports on Afghanistan can be found here **(An Independent Assessment of the Afghan Peace Process)**, and here **(Accord: Incremental Peace in Afghanistan)**.

Photo: Sohaib Ghyasi via Unsplash

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/08/16/help-us-support-scholars-and-peacebuilders-at-risk-in-afghanistan/

2021-07-28 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Rethinking approaches to peacemaking in Afghanistan

An independent assessment of the Afghanistan peace process June 2018 – May 2021 was conducted by a team of three experienced analysts of Afghanistan: Prof. Michael Semple, Queen's University Belfast; Ambassador Robin L. Raphel, former US Assistant Secretary of State for South Asia; and Shams Rasikh, independent researcher. The report is intended to contribute to the rethinking of approaches to peace-making in Afghanistan, in light of the high-profile peace initiative which took place between 2018 and 2021 and in the wake of the April 2021 US decision to conduct an unconditional troop withdrawal. The review considers the main lines of action in the peace process over the last three years, the obstacles which impeded progress towards peace, and the lessons learned.

The next phase of peace talks will be among Afghans, likely led by an Afghan government. This report develops a set of policy recommendations for coordinated Afghan and international actions for an incremental transformation of the conflict, based on changes on the ground in which the Taliban have launched a military offensive and Afghanistan faces the real threat of civil war without a US security umbrella.

The authors recommend continuing international engagement in support of the Afghanistan peace process but propose significant changes in approach, to reflect both the lessons of the two-and-a-half year US-led peace initiative and the changed circumstances brought about by the withdrawal of international military forces. The authors propose a six-pillar architecture to shape the integrated and multi-faceted approach to peace that can meet the challenges of the post-withdrawal Afghanistan: security, dialogue and Taliban engagement, violence reduction, state resilience, consensus building and strategic communications, and diplomacy.

Read and download the full report including policy recommendations: **An independent assessment of the Afghanistan peace process June 2018 – May 2021.**

Image by David Mark from Pixabay

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/07/28/rethinking-approaches-to-peacemaking-in-afghanistan/

2021-06-24 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Increasing the participation of women as peace mediators is essential for achieving gender equality and inclusive peace

Peace is more likely to last when it is inclusive. Yet, mediation efforts in the Arab States region and around the world are still largely led by men. Gender parity amongst mediators is not only essential to tap into the skills and experience of women, but also contributes to building lasting peace, according to a new report by PSRP and UN Women.

AMISOM Public Information, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons

To resolve conflict, peace envoys are usually sent by third parties such as the United Nations, Member States and regional organizations to mediate between the conflict parties and broker a peace deal. These envoys tend to be men drawn from a narrow pool of high-ranking politicians, such as former heads of state, foreign ministers or diplomats.

While the United Nations has made great strides towards gender parity, including through the appointment of women to senior leadership positions, women are still underrepresented as chief mediators, in both UN- and non-UN-led processes. The low number of women mediators in peace processes is often linked to a gender stereotype that men are more apt to deal with male-dominated armed groups.

To increase the number of women in high-level mediation positions, which in turn ensures more inclusive peace agreements, PSRP has collaborated with UN Women and the University of Durham to produce a new paper: "**Increasing the Representation of Women Peace Mediators: Collaborative Leadership Models for Ensuring Equality**". The report looks at co-mediation as a temporary special measure to ensure the appointment of equal numbers of men and women in leading mediation roles until gender parity is fully realized. Over time, co-mediation can address the historically male-dominated nature of the field and lead to more inclusive peace processes.

The paper was authored by Catherine Turner, Associate Professor, Deputy Director Global Security Institute at Durham University, and Christine Bell, Professor of Constitutional Law, University of

Edinburgh Law School and Director of the Political Settlements Research Programme.

“International organizations must recognize and increase the visibility of the work that women are already doing in mediation and conflict prevention,” said Catherine Turner. “It is crucial that organizations consider who is being appointed and who is not being appointed and take steps to ensure that opportunities are created for those who are missing.”

The paper looks at two models of co-mediation. The first is composed of one man and one woman who are appointed on an equal basis to lead a mediation process. The second is co-mediation by a panel of men and women to increase both women’s representation and the mediation team’s skills. Whereas co-mediation between two people prioritizes the need for gender parity, the appointment of a panel of mediators offers the opportunity to combine a more diverse range of backgrounds, skills and expertise of all genders. The paper also makes recommendations for increasing women’s representation in senior mediation that go beyond the co-mediation model.

“While co-mediation would increase the symbolic representation of women, it would not necessarily increase the gender responsiveness of mediation efforts” said Christine Bell, Director of PSRP. “Counting the number of women envoys should not become a tick-box exercise that enhances inclusivity in peace mediation without addressing the hurdles to women’s inclusion in peace efforts more broadly. For that, we also need the envoys’ commitment to gender equality values and standards regardless of their gender.”

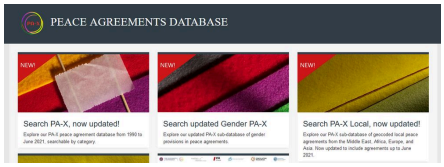
Read the full report: **Increasing the Representation of Women Peace Mediators: Collaborative Leadership Models for Ensuring Equality**

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/06/24/increasing-the-participation-of-women-as-peace-mediators-is-essential-for-achieving-gender-equality-and-inclusive-peace/

2021-06-03 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Newest release expands PA-X data to 2021

PSRP has just published the fifth release of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database. With this release, PA-X remains the most expansive and complete online archive, database, and dataset of peace agreements.



What’s new in this release?

New agreements: This release adds 47 new agreements spanning dates from 2008 – 2021. PA-X now includes the Juba Agreement (Sudan), which at 245 pages is one of the longest documents in the database. We have also added the Joint Statement on negotiations in Senegal (Casamance), from April 2021.

Historical agreements on PA-X Local and PA-X Gender: Many of the new agreements in this release are in our sub-databases. PA-X Local lists agreements that deal with local issues, involve local actors, and deal with forms of local/communal violent conflict, and PA-X Gender contains more detailed analysis of the agreements that mention women, girls, or gender. A total of 32 new agreements have been added to PA-X Local, from Central African Republic, Mali, South Sudan, Syria and Yemen, up to the first half of 2021. Most of these are historical additions, from 2008 onwards. A total of 14 new

agreements have been added to PA-X Gender, from Central African Republic, Myanmar, South Sudan, and Sudan. Most of these agreements are from 2019, 2020, and 2021.

Interim governance variable: We have also added a new variable in the PA-X dataset, which accounts for whether the agreement sets out an interim system of governance, in support of a transition. This is based on the definition from International IDEA: "Interim governance arrangements are an institutional framework established to create a 'bridge' from a situation of governance that has been interrupted by political or violent crisis often situated in an authoritarian past, towards a more peaceful, inclusive and democratic government." (Interim Governance Arrangements in Post-Conflict and Fragile Settings by International IDEA).

About PA-X

The PA-X Peace Agreements Database is a database and repository of peace agreements from 1990 to 2019. PA-X provides a comprehensive dataset of peace agreements capable of underpinning both quantitative and qualitative research. PA-X has been designed to provide easy access to peace agreement texts and to allow users to explore patterns of agreements over time, both within processes and across processes. PA-X is designed to be accessible to:

- mediators and parties in conflict seeking to understand how compromise can be crafted
- civic actors seeking to influence on-going peace talks and proposals
- social science researchers interested in understanding peace agreements quantitatively and qualitatively.

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database now. View the PA-X Codebook.

Data visualisations

PA-X also includes a suite of visualisations that show the full variety of peace agreements across time, space, and issues of contention. This is a fascinating resource for exploring PA-X data on peace agreements and learning about how peace processes unfold. View all visualisations.

Research drawing on PA-X

PSRP and others have published a wide range of publications drawing on PA-X data. For a full list, see our PA-X Publication Series.

How Peace Agreements Provide for Implementation

Principled Pragmatism and the Inclusion Project: Implementing a Gender Perspective in Peace Agreements

Introducing PA-X: A New Peace Agreement Database and Dataset

Peace Process Protagonism: The Role of Regional Organisations in Africa in Conflict Management

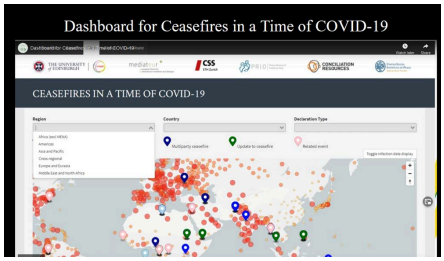
Untangling Conflict: Local Peace Agreements in Contemporary Armed Violence

The Logic of Ceasefires in Civil War by Govinda Clayton and Valerie Sticher

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/06/03/newest-release-expands-pa-x-data-to-2021/

2021-05-31 / EVENTS HELD

Ceasefires tracker featured at GeoConvergence Workshop



PSRP's Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 digital tracking tool was featured at the recent GeoConvergence Workshop.

The GeoConvergence Workshop, hosted on 18-20 May 2021 by the American Geographical Society in support of the National Science Foundation's Convergence Accelerator, identified opportunities provided by geospatial science and technology across industries and disciplines to forge collaboration between a diverse, global community of thinkers, innovators, and practitioners.

The Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 Tracker was featured as a Lightning Talk Video at the event, as part of a collection of videos highlighting current research endeavors and calls for future innovation. In the talk, PSRP's Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya introduces the tracker and its uses, and offers insights into how the tracker dashboard was developed by the PeaceTech team at the University of Edinburgh. Watch the video now.

About Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19

The **Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker** is a publicly available digital tracking tool to examine the consequences of the coronavirus outbreak on peace processes and armed conflict across the world. The tool monitors the progress of ceasefires alongside live data on infection rates in country. The data can be viewed in a timeline format, a search browse format, and a map format which also includes live data on infection rates in country.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 is a collaborative project between the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP), the Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), the Center for Security Studies (CSS) at ETH Zurich, Conciliation Resources, Mediateur (European Forum for International Mediation and Dialogue) and the United States Institute of Peace (USIP), with thanks to contributions from the Mediation Support Unit in the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs. Read more here.

The Tracker was recently featured in The Lancet, in a short piece highlighting the relationship between the Covid-19 pandemic and global conflict resolution was published in The Lancet Infectious Diseases on 14 December 2020: An interactive tracker for ceasefires in the time of Covid-19

Explore the Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker now.

About Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya

Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya is a Marie Curie Postdoc Fellow on data-driven innovation at Edinburgh University under TRAIN@ED project. He is working with peace-building processes compiling spatial data collected online, using AI, NLP and geo-visualization.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/05/31/ceasefires-tracker-featured-at-geoconvergence-workshop/

2021-05-27 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PA-X Data featured in new analysis of ceasefire design and effectiveness

Data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database has been featured in a new analysis of ceasefire design and effectiveness.

In a recently published study of effects of ceasefire design on reduction of conflict-related deaths, The Logic of Ceasefires in Civil War, Govinda Clayton (ETH Zurich) and Valerie Sticher (Leiden University and ETH Zurich) rely on PA-X data to show the importance of provisions on demobilisation and substantive issues in extending ceasefire duration. The authors classify ceasefires found in PA-X as definitive (containing provisions on substantive issues and demobilization), preliminary (containing some form of compliance mechanism) or as simple cessations of hostilities, and combine with the Uppsala Conflict Data Program's georeferenced event data to estimate duration of ceasefire models. The analysis shows that not all ceasefires can be expected to yield similar outcomes, as those that are designed with demobilisation in mind, and which aim to resolve some incompatibility between the warring sides, tend to result in longer periods of reduced conflict.

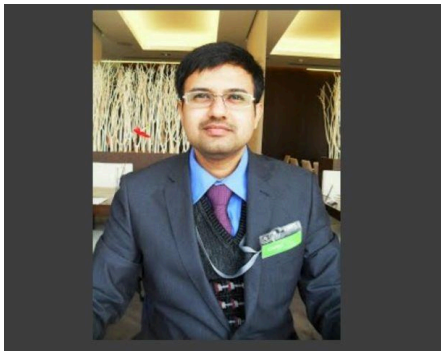
This is an excellent example of use of PA-X data in quantitative studies with global scope, and an important conceptualisation of ceasefire types. Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database for more information.

The original article, published in International Studies Quarterly, can be found here: The Logic of Ceasefires in Civil War.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/05/27/pa-x-data-featured-in-new-analysis-of-ceasefire-design-and-effectiveness/

2021-04-28 / RECOGNITION

MobilitySafe: navigating cities in times of pandemic and conflict



A PSRP researcher has been awarded a new grant under the ESRC Impact Acceleration Account scheme to develop a map-based tool to help individuals navigate cities in times of pandemic and conflict.

Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya, Train@ed Research Fellow at Edinburgh Law School, will lead the ESRC IAA project, 'Increasing safety and sustainability of micro-mobility modes in pandemic – MobilitySafe.'

In times of pandemic and conflict public transport and vehicle sharing services are frequently halted or avoided, and many people turn to cycling or walking for small distances. By partnering and working with urban development companies and agencies, such as GIZ India and Deloitte India, alongside local authorities, MobilitySafe aims to provide an open app and web-based utility to help users determine safe walking and cycling routes that avoid transmission spots or conflict zones.

"MobilitySafe aims to deliver safe micro-mobility transit routing for pedestrians and cyclists in pandemics and other civil disturbances in urban settings," said Dr Bhattacharya.

"Presently we are working with COVID-19 spread data developing algorithms that pick routes avoiding the spread. We have seen solutions aimed at vehicle transit systems, but a complete study for enhancing micro-mobility parameters and their interactions in a pandemic has not been undertaken successfully yet. We are looking forward to delivering such a solution that would encourage micro-mobility and recommend parameters that could lead to larger adoption of micro-mobility transits in cities. Once the application is adapted for the current pandemic data, the same could be adopted with other critical civic situations in future."

MobilitySafe is the most recent addition to PSRP's portfolio of PeaceTech work, which sees peace builders teaming up with data scientists to develop cutting-edge technology for inclusive peace. PSRP's PeaceTech projects include the **Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker**, a publicly available digital tracking tool that monitors the consequences of the coronavirus outbreak on peace processes and armed conflict across the world. To learn more, listen to PSRP's War, Peace, and the in Between podcast, Episode 1: PeaceTech: Digital Tools for Building Inclusive Peace, which features Dr Bhattacharya speaking about the Ceasefires Tracker and the PeaceFem mobile app on women and mediation in peace processes.

Devanjan is funded by MSCA TRAIN@ED Horizon 2020 Grant number 801215, and the project MobilitySafe is funded by Impact Acceleration Grant from the ESRC Impact Acceleration Grant awarded to the University of Edinburgh (grant reference ES/T50189X/1").

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/04/28/mobilitysafe-navigating-cities-in-times-of-pandemic-and-conflict/

2021-04-22 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

Young artists illustrate life in Syrian opposition-held areas

A group of young Syrian artists have collaborated to illustrate life in opposition-held areas during the Covid-19 pandemic. The artists produced two exhibitions – combining art, music, and activities – that offer powerful insights into the daily lives of Syrian displaced and ethnic minorities, and demonstrate how art can bring people together and act as a tool for local peace.

The two exhibitions were held in the framework of a research project supported by the FCDO-funded Covid Collective Research Platform at the Institute for Development Studies (IDS). The research revolves around PSRP's work on the nexus between the Covid-19 pandemic, peace and conflict and the interplay between several layers of crises. In Syria, PSRP Research Associate Dr. Juline Beaujouan and two of her colleagues – Abdulah El hafi and Eyas Ghreiz – built on collaborations with local communities in opposition-held areas in the northwest of the country to investigate the shifting role of local civil society during the pandemic.

The research team partnered with two groups of artists in Azaz and Afrin in the northwest of Aleppo. Both cities are currently under the control of the de facto Syrian Interim Government and a strong Turkish influence at a political and military level. Sixteen young artists aged 16 to 25 collaborated on the project to depict the lives of their communities during the pandemic. Through 60 unique

creations, they offered valuable and graphic insights into the suffering of Syrian displaced and ethnic minorities, among other important themes.

Photo: Blue Team

Photo: Civilian Cultural Association

The first art exhibition was held in Azaz on Wednesday 7 April 2021, with the support of Athar Youth Team and in collaboration with the Free University of Aleppo under the title: “There is not only Covid-19 Syrians suffer from”. It was attended by close to 400 visitors, including important local figures such as the president of the University, a member of the Constitutional Committee, members of the Syrian Coalition and members of the Syrian Civil Defense (White Helmets). The event was covered by Azaz Media Office.

Photo: Blue Team

On Monday 12 April 2021, the second exhibition was held in Afrin – a city historically inhabited by Kurdish populations – in collaboration with the Civilization Cultural Association and Gaziantep University under the title “Let us draw peace together”. The event was meant as an encounter between Arab and Kurdish artists to foster cross-community interactions. Besides visual art, it featured live music and activities for children. The event attracted 200 visitors and was covered by local media, including al-Jazeera Syria. Partners and volunteers were particularly grateful as it was the first event of its kind to bring together two groups representing different ethnic and religious affiliations around a common project.

Photo: Blue Team

Photo: Blue Team

Besides supporting local actors of everyday peace in their own terms, the project created momentum for artistic expression in the two cities and further collaborations among and between artists, academic institutions and civil society. The two team were invited by the director of the Watan Cloud organisation for women to hold a third exhibition in al-Bab city – in the northeast of Aleppo – after the month of Ramadan. The artists will also receive training on soft skills to allow them ownership of the project and enable them to sustain the momentum through more activities and civic engagement.

The success of the activities prompted several local figures to sustain the momentum and transform the collaboration into a partnership in its on rights between youth in Azaz and Afrin. The Minister of Local Administration in the Interim government and head of Afrin local council is currently working on establishing a team of Arab and Kurdish youth volunteers to build youth capacity and re-activate the marginalized volunteer and civil society network in Afrin. Similarly, the head of the education office within Afrin local council is investigating avenues for further cooperation with regards to education. The latter will empower groups of students at Gaziantep University (Afrin) and the Free University of Aleppo (Azaz) to coordinate cross-community cultural and artistic activities after the month of Ramadan. Finally, the two teams of artists are discussing future common projects to foster a culture of understanding, tolerance and peace in their areas. In addition to art exhibition, the artists in Azaz will help build the capacity of their colleagues in Afrin who have been marginalized and lack opportunities to use their art as a tool of expression and local peace.

The exhibitions will soon be accessible virtually through PSRP's website.

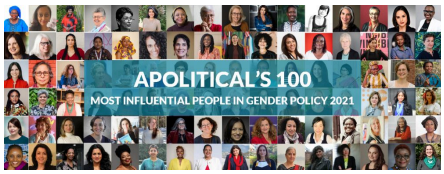
To learn more about the life of young Syrian artists in opposition-held areas and the importance of art in conflict-affected countries, read our blog "Art as a tool for local peace: Reflections of young artists in Syrian opposition-held areas" published in the Local Voices at a Crossroads series on the website of Civil Society Platform for Peacebuilding and Statebuilding (CSPPS).

To find out more about the events and PSRP's current projects in Syria, contact Dr. Juline Beaujouan at J.Beaujouan-Marliere@ed.ac.uk.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/04/22/young-artists-illustrate-life-in-syrian-opposition-held-areas/

2021-03-31 / RECOGNITION

Prof Aisling Swaine recognised in top 100 list



PSRP Associate Aisling Swaine has been named as one of the 100 Most Influential People in Gender Policy 2021 by Apolitical.

Apolitical's 100 Most Influential People in Gender Policy honours and celebrates people of all genders working on gender policy and making the world more equitable, whether they exert their influence through policymaking, public service, research, philanthropy, advocacy, activism or however else.

Aisling is Professor of Gender Studies, School of Social Policy, Social Work and Social Justice, University College Dublin. Aisling's research and teaching focuses on conflict-related violence against women, transitional justice and global gender policy, with a focus on gender-based violence and on the women, peace and security agenda. She was recognised in the 100 Most Influential People in Gender Policy for her work on gender-based violence.

PSRP is proud to congratulate Aisling on this recognition of her work. A selection of Aisling's work with the PSRP is available to browse below.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/03/31/prof-aisling-swaine-recognised-in-top-100-list/

2021-03-23 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

One year on, has conflict paused for the pandemic?

One year after the UN Secretary General called for a global ceasefire in the face of the novel cornavirus, has conflict paused for the pandemic? A new PSRP report launched today tracks ceasefires declared during Covid-19 and analyses what this means for the wider peace process landscape.

A. Amhimmid Mohamed Alamami, second from left, head of the Libyan Arab Armed Forces delegation, and Ahmed Ali Abushahma, head of the Government of National Accord military delegation, shake hands next to U.N. Libya envoy Stephanie Williams, center, on Oct. 23 in Geneva. (Violaine Martin/United Nations/AFP/Getty Images) (Violaine Martin/Un Photo Handout/EPA-EFE/REX/Shutterstock)

On 23 March 2020, the UN Secretary General (UNSG) Antonio Guterres called for an immediate global ceasefire, to help tackle the threat of Covid-19 rather than compound the risk to those in fragile and conflict-affected areas. In response to this call, multiple states, international, regional, and local organisations declared their support for a global ceasefire. The Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) has been tracking ceasefires declared during Covid-19 with the 'Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19' digital tracking tool. Our data shows that since March 2020, conflict parties have declared 25 ceasefires across 17 countries.

To coincide with the one-year anniversary of the global ceasefire call, PSRP has launched a new report: **Pandemic Pauses: Understanding Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19**. The report draws on data from the 'Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19' tracker to analyse how ceasefires have unfolded throughout the pandemic, and to consider how the pandemic has affected moves towards ceasefires and peace processes.

In Part I, we provide data on what types of ceasefires conflict parties have declared since March 2020, and the extent to which these ceasefires have held. In Part II, we put forward key analytical and practical concerns for understanding these ceasefires and considering what, if anything, ceasefires during the pandemic mean for wider peace processes. In Part III, we conclude that, although the Covid-19 pandemic has not been a 'game-changer' for ceasefire and peace process trajectories, it is now a crucial part of the context in which peace processes must take place. We make recommendations for how ceasefires, and peacemaking more generally, can be better supported during global health emergencies.

The report was written by a team of researchers at the Political Settlements Research Programme: Laura Wise, Sanja Badanjak, Christine Bell, and Fiona Knäussel, and draws on data from the 'Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19' tracker.

Read the full report now: **Pandemic Pauses: Understanding Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19**.

For more analysis on the nexus between conflict and Covid-19, visit our Covid-19 resource hub.

Image: A. Amhimmid Mohamed Alamami, second from left, head of the Libyan Arab Armed Forces delegation, and Ahmed Ali Abushahma, head of the Government of National Accord military

delegation, shake hands next to U.N. Libya envoy Stephanie Williams, center, on Oct. 23 in Geneva. (Violaine Martin/Un Photo Handout/EPA-EFE/REX/Shutterstock)

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/03/23/one-year-on-has-conflict-paused-for-the-pandemic/

2021-03-08 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Research boosts role of women in peace processes

AMISOM Public Information [CC0], via Wikimedia Commons

Edinburgh researchers have developed a new resource to help embed women's rights in peace negotiations in the Arab world and beyond.

A report launched to mark International Women's Day offers new guidance for women working in peace keeping processes in Iraq, Libya, Syria and Yemen. The work is the result of a partnership between Edinburgh Law School's Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) and UN Women – the body within the United Nations that globally champions gender equality, and the idea that all parts of an affected society should be included in its peace process.

Women are largely underrepresented in peace processes across the world, but there are a number of examples where women have successfully taken a seat at peace negotiations and influenced measures to ensure women's inclusion in peace processes. UN Women Regional Office for the Arab States and the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) have drawn on these case studies to publish the paper *Models for Women's Inclusion in Track One Mediation in Peace and Transition Processes*, setting out modalities that women and gender advocates in the region can adopt in order to access official peace and transition talks. These strategies can also be used by decision-makers and peace-mediators to include women and broaden the representative participation in the talks.

UN Women representatives say that while women in the Arab States region have managed to contribute to unofficial forms of peace activities and dialogues, their involvement in formal negotiations and talks has been limited, hindering prospects for inclusive and sustainable peace.

The report draws on various case studies of women who have exerted influence to have a seat at the official table and taken measures to ensure women's inclusion in peace processes.

Susanne Mikhail, UN Women Regional Director for the Arab States, said: "Twenty years since the adoption of the Women, Peace and Security agenda, women in the Arab States region still struggle to make their voices heard at formal peace talks. But women in the region can learn from women's experiences in other parts of the world who managed to make their voices heard and contribute to peace efforts.

The guide explores four main strategies for achieving a role in peace processes. This includes having representation in working groups, having a women's delegation present at talks, having a role in groups that advise mediators, and working with civil society such as non-governmental groups.The

paper also examines the advantages and disadvantages of each approach with a view to improving the practice of gender inclusion and women's political participation more broadly.

Professor Christine Bell, Director of Political Settlements Research Programme and one of the report's co-authors, said: "Inclusion of women in official talks requires mediators to have a clear set of options in front of them. We hope that by providing these options, with the evidence-base for their relative merits, our research will help international organisations and conflict parties to ensure that official talks include women and are better able to deliver meaningful change and sustainable peace."

The report is available in English and Arabic. Read the report on the UN Women website.

Further Reading

Join PSRP and special guests on 16 March 2021 for a roundtable event on women's rights in armed conflict: Roundtable on Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law

View PSRP's key findings from our research into gender perspectives in peace processes.

https://peacerep.org/publications-database/models-for-womens-inclusion-in-track-one-mediation-in-peace-and-transition-processes/

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/03/08/research-boosts-role-of-women-in-peace-processes/

2021-02-15 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PSRP quoted in analysis of Afghan peace process

A PSRP report on political settlements has been quoted in an opinion piece on the Afghan peace process: Will political factions in Afghanistan come to terms with each other? The article, written by Yasmeen Aftab Ali in the Daily Times, makes a case for establishing inclusive power-sharing arrangements that work towards achieving sustainable peace.

Taliban insurgents turn themselves in to Afghan National Security Forces at a forward operating base in Puza-i-Eshan.

Published in Feburary 2021 at the beginning of United States President Joseph Biden's term in office, the author cautions the Biden administration against focusing peace negotiations solely on the Taliban, as doing so risks exacerbating conflict by ignoring core issues and excluding key stakeholders. Instead, the author argues that peacebuilders must agree on a power-sharing approach that works for inclusive, sustainable peace by balancing conflicting demands and including the armed forces, civil society, and other stakeholders in the peace process. The piece stresses the importance of acknowledging existing divisions between political cultures and social groups, and the variables that divide and connect them, and using this as a springboard for peace initiatives.

The paper suggests the Biden administration pursue a two-pronged strategy of first acheiving a peace agreement, followed by a longer-term peace settlement. Here the author refers to a 2015 PSRP working paper by Professor Christine Bell, What We Talk About When We Talk About Political Settlements, which sets out that power-sharing arrangements are never fixed, but are continually being renegotiated and evolving.

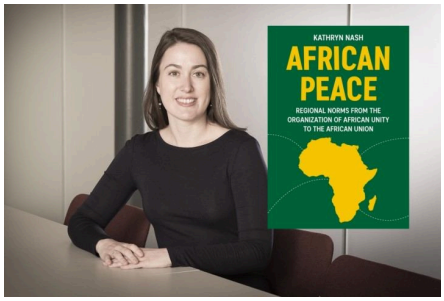
Read the full piece at the Daily Times.

Photo: Taliban insurgents turn themselves in to Afghan National Security Forces at a forward operating base in Puza-i-Eshan. By ResoluteSupportMedia via Flickr | CC BY 2.0

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/02/15/psrp-quoted-in-analysis-of-afghan-peace-process/

2021-02-04 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Dr Kathryn Nash launches new book on African Peace



Dr Kathryn Nash has released a new book, 'African Peace: Regional norms from the Organization of African Unity to the African Union'. Published by Manchester University Press, the book examines the role of African regional organisations in constructing collective conflict management rules for the continent.

Dr Kathryn Nash is a Postdoctoral Research Fellow at the University of Edinburgh School of Law.

About the book

African regional organizations have played leading roles in constructing collective conflict management rules for the continent, but these rules or norms have not been static. Currently, the African Union (AU) deploys monitors, authorizes peace support operations, and actively engages to resolve internal conflicts. Just a few decades ago, these actions would have been deeply controversial under the Organization of African Unity (OAU). What changed to allow for this transformation in the way the African regional organization approaches peace and security?

African peace examines why the OAU chose norms in 1963 that prioritized state security and led to a policy of strict non-interference – even in the face of destabilizing violence – and why the AU chose very different norms leading to a disparate conflict management policy in the early 2000s. Even if the AU's capacity to respond to conflict is still developing, this new policy has made the region more willing and capable of responding to violence. Nash argues that norm creation largely happened within the African context, and international pressure was not a determinant factor in their evolution. The role of regions in the international order, particularly the African region, has been under-theorized and under-acknowledged, and this book adds to an emerging literature that explores the role of regional organizations in the Global South in creating and promoting norms based on their own experiences and for their own purposes.

See full book details.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/02/04/dr-kathryn-nash-launches-new-book-on-african-peace/

2021-01-28 / EVENTS HELD

PSRP joins The Elders in conversation on women in mediation in the Arab world

In October 2020, The Elders and Wilton Park convened a high-level virtual gathering celebrating the 20th anniversary of the UN Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security. The event brought together experts in mediation, peacebuilding, and national and multinational officials to discuss the role of women in peace process mediation in the Arab world, alongside members of The Elders, Lakhdar Brahimi, Ban Ki-Moon, Graca Machel and Ellen Johnson Sirleaf. Read more about the event: The Elders in conversation on women in mediation in the Arab world.

Participants shared their collective experience and insight into the power and importance of women's engagement in mediation, and heard from leaders in the Arab world about the challenges and the opportunities of promoting women's participation as mediators during the Covid-19 pandemic.

PSRP Director Professor Christine Bell was one of several experts invited to contribute to the discussion and the accompanying report. The full event report summarising the discussions and policy issues is now available in English and Arabic. The Elders have also published a list of recommendations from the event.

Read more about the event from Wilton Park.

يساهم PSRP في تقرير Wilton Park حول دور المرأة في الوساطة في العالم العربي

في أكتوبر ٢٠٢٠، عقدَ "الحكماء" و Wilton Park تجمعًا افتراضيًا رفيع المستوى للاحتفال بالذكرى العشرين لقرار مجلس الأمن التابع للأمم المتحدة رقم 1325 بشأن المرأة والسلام والأمن. جمع الحدث خبراء في الوساطة وبناء السلام ومسؤولين محليين متعددي الجنسيات لمناقشة دور المرأة في الوساطة في عملية السلام في العالم العربي. انظر القائمة الكاملة للحدث: الحكماء في حديث حول المرأة في الوساطة في العالم العربي.

كانت مديرة PSRP البروفيسورة كريستين بيل واحدة من عدة خبراء الذين تمت دعوتهم للمساهمة في المناقشة، والتي تضمنت أعضاء من "الحكماء"، الأخضر الإبراهيمي، بان كي مون، غراسا ماشيل وإلين جونسون سيرليف. تبادل المشاركون تجربتهم الجماعية ونظرتهم الثاقبة حول قوة وأهمية مشاركة المرأة في الوساطة، وناقشوا التحديات والفرص لتعزيز مشاركة المرأة كوسطاء خلال جائحة كوفيد-١٩.

قبل الحدث، شاركت البروفيسورة بيل في تأليف ورقتين مناقشة حول نموذج الوساطة المشتركة وزيادة تأثير المجتمع المدني في عملية الوساطة، مع الدكتورة كاثرين تورن، الأستاذة المشاركة في القانون الدولي ونائبة مدير معهد الأمن العالمي في جامعة درم. التوصيات الواردة في هذه الأوراق زودت معلومات أستفيد منها في المناقشات خلال الحدث، وتم تضمينها في تقرير الحدث.

تقرير الحدث الكامل الذي يُلخص المناقشات، القضايا السياسية، والتوصيات متاح الآن. اقرأ التقرير كاملاً باللغتين الإنجليزية والعربية. كذلك، نشر "الحكماء" قائمة من التوصيات ايضاً.

اقرأ المزيد عن الحدث من Wilton Park.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/01/28/psrp-joins-the-elders-in-conversation-on-women-in-mediation-in-the-arab-world/

2021-01-24 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

PSRP joins the Covid Collective to study the nexus between conflict, peace, and Covid-19

https://pixabay.com/photos/corona-world-mask-virus-disease-4912807/

The Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) at the University of Edinburgh has joined an exciting and interdisciplinary collective of social scientists, from inside and outside academia. The FCDO-funded Covid Collective, which is based in the International Development Studies department at the University of Sussex, will produce cutting edge social science research to address the global challenges caused by the Covid-19 pandemic.

The PSRP has three main projects underway in collaboration with the Covid Collective. The first project, ***Covid-19, Peace and Transition Processes*** explores how Covid-19 and pandemic responses are affecting peace process dynamics, modalities, and prospects for successful mediation among the main conflict actors, at national and local levels. This project focuses on South Sudan, Yemen and Syria. The second project, ***PeaceTech, Tracking Data and the UN Ceasefire Call*** provides data and analysis on how the UN Global Ceasefire call is being received and taken up. It also considers what other conflict-related issues health interventions are having to navigate, with what consequences for political trust in both health providers and political leaders. Finally, the third project, ***Regional Responses to Covid-19, and Handling of the Covid-19 Transition nexus*** uses innovative data and documentary analysis techniques to understand new limitations on where and how internationals support both peace processes and pandemic responses. The project examines how this international engagement re-shapes the role and capacity of regional organisations in the conflict and health realms, and how new forms of regional coordination are playing out in-country. The main case study for this project is Kenya. View all PSRP Covid-19 research and outputs.

As a member of the Collective, the PSRP is focusing on the delivery of timely research useful to policymakers and in-country practitioners as to how to manage peace and transition processes in conjunction with the pandemic. It also aims to pioneer innovative research methods using technology, data-combining visualisations which can bring together global Covid19 peace and health data, remote forms of research, and artificial intelligence.

The PSRP's engagement in the Collective is overseen by Professor Christine Bell (Lead), Allyson Doby (Communications), Dr. Harriet Cornell (Project Management), and Dr. Rebecca Sutton (Representative to the Covid Collective Advisory Board).

Read more about the Covid Collective.

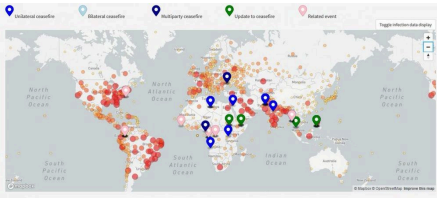
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2021/01/24/psrp-joins-the-covid-collective-to-study-the-nexus-between-conflict-peace-and-covid-19/

2020

40 stories · Full original text

2020-12-15 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

Ceasefires tracker featured in The Lancet



Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19, a digital tracking tool for ceasefires called during the Covid-19 pandemic, has been featured in The Lancet.

On 14 December 2020, The Lancet Infectious Diseases published a short piece from the University of Edinburgh's PeaceTech team highlighting the relationship between the pandemic and global conflict resolution. Acknowledging the distinct public health challenges of Covid-19 in conflict-affected states, the article introduces the UN Secretary General's call for a global ceasefire to halt violent conflict in the face of the pandemic and outlines the development of Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19, an interactive digital tool that monitors ceasefires called since March 2020. The authors offer key findings from the tracker on the relationship between the pandemic and conflict resolution efforts – notably, that the ceasefire call was not a game changer in terms of global conflict.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 is part of the University of Edinburgh's PeaceTech initiative, which harnesses the power of data and technology to support peacebuilding initiatives. The piece was written by members of the PeaceTech team at the University of Edinburgh: John Allison, Sanja Badanjak, Benjamin Bach, Christine Bell, Devanjan Bhattacharya, Fiona Knaussel, and Laura Wise.

Read the piece in full on The Lancet's website, or download as PDF.

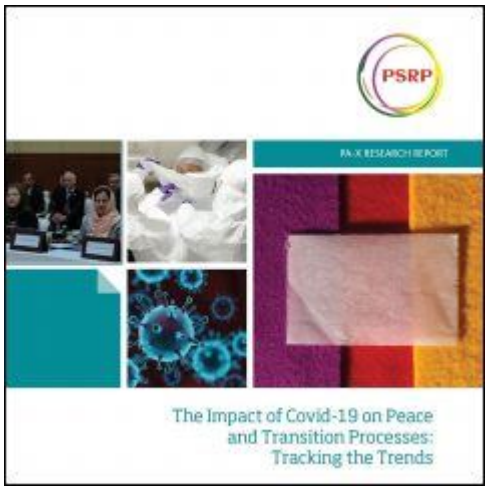
The Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker is a publicly available digital tracking tool to examine the consequences of the coronavirus pandemic on peace processes and armed conflict across the world. The tool monitors ceasefires alongside live data on infection rates in country, using an interactive timeline and map including live data on infection rates in country.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 is a collaborative project between the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP), the Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), the Center for Security Studies (CSS) at ETH Zurich, Conciliation Resources, Mediateur (European Forum for International Mediation and Dialogue) and the United States Institute of Peace (USIP), with thanks to contributions from the Mediation Support Unit in the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs.

Further Reading

PSRP Covid-19 Hub

Read all PSRP research and reports on the impact of Covid-19 on conflict-affected states.



The Impact of COVID-19 on Peace and Transition Processes: Tracking the Trends

This research report by Christine Bell, Tim Epple, and Jan Pospisil used expert surveys on a set of conflict countries to understand how Covid-19 pandemic responses were affecting conflict and peace process dynamics.

Ceasefire Arrangements

This report by Robert Forster asks when and how are ceasefires negotiated, and what are their critical elements?

Gender Mainstreaming in Ceasefires: Comparative Data and Examples

This report by Christine Bell and Robert Forster asks when and how have ceasefire agreements in armed conflict addressed women? Why should ceasefires include gender-specific provisions? Finally, what are the potential strategies for including women in ceasefire monitoring and implementation modalities?

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/12/15/ceasefires-tracker-featured-in-the-lancet/

2020-12-07 / EVENTS HELD

Constitution-Building in Response to Social Crisis: the Second Women Constitution-Makers Dialogue

When constitutions are written in response to violent conflict or as part of a peace process, a key aim of constitution-building is to end the fighting and channel disputes through political institutions. Because of this, people at the negotiating table tend to be parties to the conflict, who are predominately men. When constitution-building responds to broad social unrest, in comparison, a key aim is to create a new social and political order. People at the negotiating table in these processes tend to include leaders of social movements, which more often includes women. These foundational conditions, though operating on a continuum, have important implications for women's participation and influence in constitution-building processes and the nature of reforms.

In the last few years, there has been a rise in mass social protest movements throughout the world. Women (and youth) often play crucial roles in these movements as leaders and activists and are often central to catalyzing constitutional reform processes. Though particular demands vary by county, social protest movements often seek institutional reform, enhanced economic and political participation, and broader structural changes related to social justice, good governance and

democracy. These issues matter not only to women but to all members of society, and are often rooted in wide discontent with the existing social contact. Yet as the constitution-building process unfolds, alliances and strategic reform priorities often change. Moreover, the space for women's engagement and leadership tends to diminish as formal negotiations get underway. Why does this occur? And what can comparative experience tell us about the barriers and opportunities that women face during constitution-building in response to social crisis?

This year's Women Constitution-Maker's Dialogue explored these issues during a two-day online forum event with women constitution-makers and activists from ongoing and past reform processes in Chile, The Gambia, Kenya, South Africa, South Sudan, Sudan, Syria, and Yemen. The closed event was convened on 17 and 18 November by the Constitution Building Programme of International IDEA, in partnership with the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) of the University of Edinburgh. Participants discussed the relationship between social unrest and the design of constitutional reform processes, implications for democracy and peace, and opportunities to enhance and sustain women's influence as processes institutionalize. Discussions also examined the role of the international community in supporting and empowering women, and opportunities for strengthening engagement in the future.

The event was the second meeting in an annual series that was initiated in 2019 by International IDEA and PSRP. A report from the first event was released in 2020. The dialogue series aims to foster a global network of women constitution-makers and peacebuilders centered on peer-to-peer exchanges on women's participation in constitution-building and peacebuilding processes and contentious constitutional design issues. It aims to elevate women's voices and roles in constitution building globally, and to broaden understanding among the international community of women's experiences, interests and needs.

Image: Participants at the first Women Constitution Makers Dialogue at Edinburgh Law School, October 2019.

Further Reading

Women Constitution-Makers: Comparative Experiences with Representation, Participation and Influence

This report by Erin C. Houlihan was developed as a follow up to the First Annual Women Constitution-Makers Dialogue held in October 2019.

Founding women: A Dialogue with Women Constitution-Makers

In this video produced at the inaugural Women Constitution-Makers Dialogue in October 2019, event participants share their experiences of navigating gender and social transformation in a variety of contexts and discuss the importance of women's participation in constitution building.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/12/07/constitution-building-in-response-to-social-crisis-the-second-women-constitution-makers-dialogue/

2020-11-26 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Webinar: Why do local peace agreements matter?

Why Do Local Peace Agreements Matter?

PSRP webinar | Thursday 3 December 2020, 1-2pm GMT | Online via Zoom

Join us for a webinar on why local peace processes matter. What can we learn from local peace agreements about what conflict landscapes look like, and to what extent do our conceptualisations of armed conflict work? We will examine a case study of local agreements in Syria, with a focus on how particular they are from national agreements but also how 'local' they actually are in the context of a complex nested conflict, and then look at additional examples of local agreements from

around the world. The event will conclude with an open Q&A and the opportunity for discussion. Featuring PSRP's Dr Juline Beaujouan, Robert Wilson, and Dr Jan Pospisil from the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution alongside event chair Marika Theros from the Conflict Research Programme at the London School of Economics and Political Science. **Register now.**

This event is part of PSRP's Peace Talks webinar series, which will run from October 2020 – March 2021.

Local Peace Agreements: research and resources

At the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) we are investigating the fragmentation and localisation of conflict management and peacemaking through a collection of almost 300 local peace agreements: the PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database. This collection of local peace agreements raises the potential for analysing patterns in local peacemaking over time and across varying contexts, as well as exploring any links between local, regional and national-level peace processes. It also helps us to better understand the practices of highly localised actors, their influence on wider conflict dynamics, and their interactions with actors more embedded in the national-level process whose wider conflict agendas ultimately shape conditions at the local level. For further information on local peace agreements, we invite you to explore the following resources:

PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database

PSRP has created the PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database, which is publicly available at **www.peaceagreements.org/lsearch**. PA-X Local is the first open-access database of written local peace agreements from across a global set of conflict-affected contexts. The local peace agreements included are publicly available written agreements between locally-based and other actors,which address local conflict-generating grievances only within a part of the wider conflict-affected area. PA-X Local offers a glimpse into the processes and outcomes of local peacemaking, including information on how it relates to any national peace process.

Joint Analysis Workshop: Participant Perspectives

In October 2019, PSRP and ASPR hosted a joint analysis workshop at the British Academy in London. The event brought together different actors in peace and conflict processes to discuss what they think local agreements do and are, and how they fit into the broader practice of peace building. The event report, **Untangling Conflict: Local Peace Agreements in Contemporary Armed Violence** is available now.

A video featuring participant perspectives from the event is available here.

Local Peace Processes: Opportunities and Challenges for Women's Engagement

This PA-X Gender Spotlight report asks the questions: When and how do local peace processes and agreements address conflict? What are the opportunities and challenges for women and gender-equality advocates seeking to meaningfully engage with local peace processes?

Scratching below the surface: what can local peace agreements tell us about armed groups and conflict fragmentation?

This blog describes three initial observations on dynamics of conflict and peacemaking that have emerged from our review of local peace agreements.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/11/26/why-do-local-peace-agreements-matter/

2020-11-11 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

Covid Collective research platform launched to tackle global challenges caused by the pandemic

https://pixabay.com/photos/corona-world-mask-virus-disease-4912807/

The Political Settlements Research Programme is working with the UK's Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) and a group of world leading organisations to develop urgently needed research that will support recovery from Covid-19.

The FCDO-funded Covid Collective will commission urgent research to help tackle the social, political and economic impact of the pandemic. These include: Governance, Social Development, Inclusion, Conflict, Humanitarian and Environment. The research will be global with a particular focus on: The Middle East, Bangladesh, Uganda, Pakistan, Ethiopia, Kenya, Ghana, Malawi, Rwanda, Zambia, Zimbabwe, South Sudan, Sudan, Yemen, Iraq and Syria.

In its first round of grants, the Collective research platform, coordinated by the Institute of Development Studies (IDS), will bring together the expertise of eight partner organisations to deliver research that can inform decision-making on some of the most pressing Covid-19 related development challenges. The partners are: University of Edinburgh's Political Settlements Research Programme, University of Manchester, London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine, Overseas Development Institute, BRAC Institute of Governance and Development, the Center for Global Development, and the International Institute for Environment and Development.

The Covid Collective has two main functions: the co-generation of research and evidence through a grant-making mechanism and to support evidence-informed action through knowledge curation, learning and strategic communication.

Dr Peter J Evans, Governance, Conflict, Inclusion and Humanitarian Research Team, FCDO: "FCDO's social research programmes have pivoted to deliver research to help understand and tackle the wider social effects of the pandemic – and have done this despite disruption to travel, field research, and personal lives around the world.

"Our partnership with the IDS-convened Covid Collective takes this further with new urgent social research to understand how the pandemic has exacerbated a huge range of 'cracks' in social, economic and political systems around the world – and what we can do to help recovery – also build resilience for future crises".

Peter Taylor, Director of Research, IDS said: "The Covid Collective offers a tremendous, timely opportunity to ensure that high value research and knowledge generation responding to Covid-19 is funded effectively and efficiently. It will be a key source of rapid, clear, evidence-informed messages, options and alternatives for wider audiences, including policy- and decision-makers, on the most pressing Covid-19 related development challenges.

"IDS is looking forward to a truly collaborative effort that brings together researchers from around the world, and who can provide compelling, research-based arguments and options for building forward differently."

As part of the Covid Collective, PSRP will provide timely evidence on the ways in which Covid-19, and responses to it, are affecting peace and transition processes in some of the world's most protracted conflicts. The research will look at three dimensions. The first aims to understand how Covid-19 and pandemic responses are affecting prospects for successful mediation among conflict actors at national and local levels, with a particular focus on South Sudan, Yemen, and Syria. The second will explore how the UN Global Ceasefire call is being received and taken up, what other conflict-related issues health interventions are having to navigate, and with what consequences for political trust in both health providers and political leaders. The final study will look at how new limitations on international support for peace processes are affecting the response of regional organisations in the conflict and health realms. The project aims to deliver timely research useful to policymakers and in-country practitioners. It will also use innovative research methods and technologies which can contribute to new ways of working around pandemic lock-down constraints in already challenging contexts.

View all PSRP work on the nexus between conflict, peace, and Covid-19.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/11/11/covid-collective-research-platform-launched-to-tackle-global-challenges-caused-by-the-pandemic/

2020-11-05 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law: book launch marks key WPS anniversary

Dr Catherine O'Rourke of the Transitional Justice Institute launched her new book, *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law*, in an online event marking the anniversary of a key UN Security Council Resolution on Women, Peace and Security.

Part of Trinity College Dublin's Law School Author Series, the discussion was timed to coincide with the 20th anniversary of the landmark UN Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security, which was adopted on 31 October 2000. Speaking at the same time as the Open Debate on Women, Peace and Security at the UN Security Council on 29 October 2020, the event featured Dr O'Rourke in discussion with Aisling Swaine, Professor of Gender Studies, UCD, and Aoife O'Donoghue, Professor of International Law and Global Governance, Durham University, together with host Donna Lyons. Dr O'Rourke introduced her new book, *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law*, and took comments and questions from the co-presenters about the book and the current state of the Women, Peace and Security agenda.

A recording of the event is now available. Watch the event in full on YouTube.

About 'Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law'

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law (Cambridge University Press, 2020)

Written by Dr Catherine O'Rourke, Director of the Transitional Justice Institute at Ulster University, the book uses case studies to reveal the implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict.

Laws and norms that focus on women's lives in conflict have proliferated across the regimes of international humanitarian law, international criminal law, international human rights law and the United Nations Security Council. While separate institutions, with differing powers of monitoring and enforcement, implement these laws and norms, the activities of regimes overlap. *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law* is the first book to account for this pluralism and institutional diversity. This book identifies key aspects of how different regimes regulate women's rights in conflict, and how they interact. Using country case studies to reveal the practical implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict, this book offers a dynamic account of how regimes and institutions interact, the extent to which they reinforce each other, and the tensions and gaps in regulation that emerge.

- Counters siloed analysis by looking across various key regimes
- Looks at interactions in order to take a dynamic approach in examining institutions
- Explores case studies to reveal what fragmentation in law means in practice for the regulation of women's rights in conflict

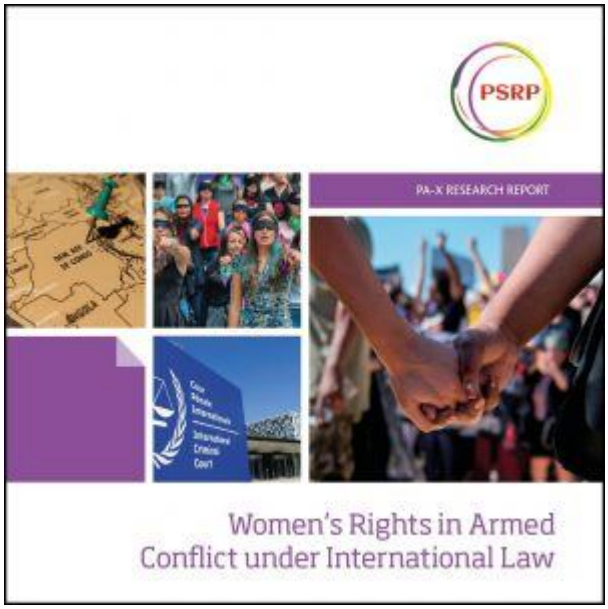
Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law (Cambridge University Press, 2020) identifies key aspects of how different regimes regulate women's rights in conflict, and how they interact. Using country case studies to reveal the practical implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict, this book offers a dynamic account of how regimes and institutions interact, the extent to which they reinforce each other, and the tensions and gaps in regulation that emerge. A policy summary drawn from the book is also available.

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law is an output of the Political Settlements Research Programme.

Further Reading

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law (Cambridge University Press, 2020) by Catherine O'Rourke

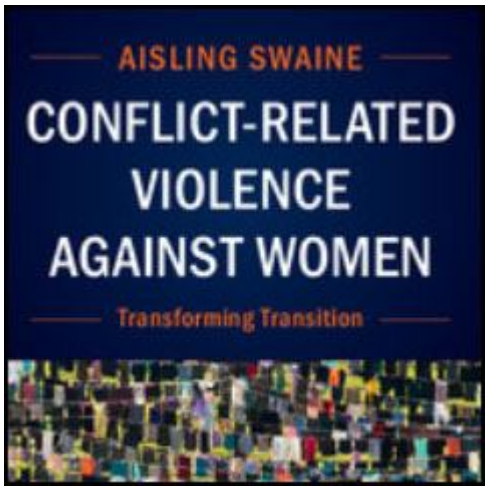
Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law identifies key aspects of how different regimes regulate women's rights in conflict, and how they interact. Using country case studies to reveal the practical implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict, this book offers a dynamic account of how regimes and institutions interact, the extent to which they reinforce each other, and the tensions and gaps in regulation that emerge.



Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law (Policy Brief) by Catherine O'Rourke

Protections for women's rights in armed conflict (WRAC) have proliferated under international law in the last three decades. Consequently, there is now a wide range of international institutions engaged in defining, monitoring and enforcing women's rights in different conflicts under international law. Key institutions of relevance include the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), human

rights treaty-bodies, the International Criminal Court (ICC) and the United Nations Security Council (UNSC). The increase in institutional activity is a broadly positive development. Nevertheless, there is significant scope to strengthen the legal status of specific protections to women's rights; to improve how key institutions comply with and implement their own guarantees of women's rights; to improve coordination amongst key institutions; and to maximise the strengths of different monitoring and enforcement procedures to protect and promote different women's rights in different conflict settings. This policy brief elaborates these key findings and concludes with recommendations to a range of key actors.



Conflict-Related Violence Against Women: Transforming Transition by Aisling Swaine

By comparatively assessing three conflict-affected jurisdictions (Liberia, Northern Ireland and Timor-Leste), Conflict-Related Violence against Women empirically and theoretically expands current understanding of the form and nature of conflict-time harms impacting women. The 'violences' that occur in conflict beyond strategic rape are first identified. Employing both a disaggregated and an aggregated approach, relations between forms of violence within and across each context's pre-, mid- and post-conflict phase are then assessed, identifying connections and distinctions in violence. Swaine highlights a wider spectrum of conflict-related violence against women than is currently acknowledged. She identifies a range of forces that simultaneously push open and close down spaces for addressing violence against women through post-conflict transitional justice. The book proposes that in the aftermath of conflict, a transformation rather than a transition is required if justice is to play a role in preventing gendered violence before conflict and its appearance during and after conflict.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/11/05/womens-rights-in-armed-conflict-under-international-law-book-launch-marks-key-wps-anniversary/

2020-11-04 / MEDIA ENGAGEMENTS

A virtual tool for effective peace process support

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19, a digital tool developed to track ceasefires during the Covid-19 pandemic, has been featured in a Swiss Peace review of cutting-edge digital technologies for peacemaking. KOFF Peacebuilding Magazine by Swiss Peace profiled the tool in the November 2020 special issue entitled Digital Technologies: A Game Changer for Peace?

The Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker is a publicly available digital tracking tool to examine the consequences of the coronavirus pandemic on peace processes and armed conflict across the world. In March 2020, the UN Secretary General called for a global ceasefire in the face of the Covid-19 pandemic. The tool monitors ceasefires alongside live data on infection rates in country, using an interactive timeline and map including live data on infection rates in country.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 is a collaborative project between the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP), the Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), the Center for Security Studies (CSS) at ETH Zurich, Conciliation Resources, Mediateur (European Forum for International Mediation and Dialogue) and the United States Institute of Peace (USIP), with thanks to contributions from the Mediation Support Unit in the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs.

The KOFF Peacebuilding Magazine praises the ceasefires tracker for supporting peacebuilding during the pandemic:

> The virtual tracking tool thus functions as a reliable and rich public resource of information on ceasefires that enables experts working on peace process support and beyond to track the cessation of hostilities in real-time, accurately identify where their support can be best-placed and maintain a critical bird's-eye view of the interplay between ceasefire developments and the evolution of the pandemic.

Read the feature in full at the KOFF Peacebuilding Magazine website.

The special issue also features a range of cuting-edge PeaceTech innovations, including an app for peaceful local development, a project ensuring good governance in a digitalized security sector, and a project linking global education and digital peacebuilding to create opportunities for large-scale online dialogue and collaboration.

David Lanz, Co-Head Mediation Program at Swiss Peace also featured the ceasefires tracker alongside the PA-X Peace Agreement Database and the PeaceFem app in a Twitter thread on the best interactive online tools for peace mediation. Read the thread here.

The Ceasefires Tracker was also recently featured by ReliefWeb.

Explore Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19.

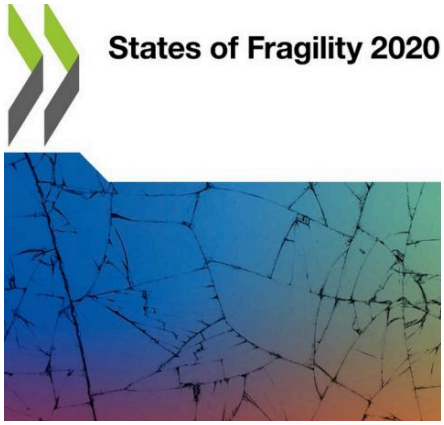
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/11/04/a-virtual-tool-for-effective-peace-process-support/

2020-11-01 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PSRP research informs OECD's States of Fragility 2020

Research from the Political Settlements Research Programme has contributed to the States of Fragility 2020 report from the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD).

States of Fragility 2020 examines the dramatic impact of Covid-19 on the global state of fragility and sets out a policy agenda at a critical turning point. The report cites PSRP research and data on global ceasefires, gender provisions in peace agreements, and the nature of local peace agreements.



Chapter 1 uses data from the Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker to illustrate the response to global ceasefires declared during the pandemic.

Chapter 2 of the report looks at Peace, Fragility and Fragile Contexts, including ways to support the long-term local capacity for sustaining peace in fragile contexts. This section cites the PSRP report, Untangling Conflict: Local Peace Agreements in Contemporary Armed Violence by Jan Pospisil, Laura Wise, and Christine Bell, which outlines how local peace agreements represent the diversity and the splintered nature and patchiness of contemporary armed conflict.

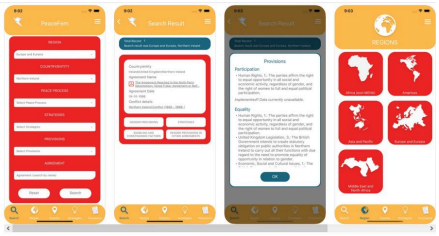
In the Annex, the authors also cite PSRP data from the PA-X Gender Peace Agreements Database to assess the rate of inclusion of gender provisions in peace agreements involving fragile contexts.

Read OECD's States of Fragility 2020 in full on the OECD website.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/11/01/psrp-research-informs-oecds-states-of-fragility-2020/

2020-10-16 / EVENTS HELD

PeaceFem: Can Technology Support Inclusive Peacemaking?



The Covid-19 pandemic has highlighted a shift towards greater reliance on technologies for supporting ways of working and convening across the world. In recent years, however, peacebuilding practitioners and researchers have become interested in the potential of technologies to support the quest for more inclusive and sustainable peace processes.

As part of the Virtual Torino Forum for Sustaining Peace, hosted by United Nations System Staff College, on September 8th 2020, the Political Settlements Research Programme and UN Women presented their new PeaceFem mobile app, and led a discussion with participants on the potential of technology to support the Women, Peace and Security and Youth, Peace and Security Agendas.

PeaceFem is a mobile phone app that tracks women's inclusion in peace processes around the world. PeaceFem provides information about strategies women's rights advocates have used to influence peace agreements. It also informs users about the enabling and constraining factors that shaped the space for influence, and the gender provisions in the peace agreements that resulted. And it provides information on how well they were implemented. The app draws on PA-X peace agreement data from the University of Edinburgh, and case studies developed by InclusivePeace and Monash University's Gender, Peace and Security Centre.

In the session, participants first heard reflections from Professor Christine Bell, Director of PSRP, on the emergence of the field of PeaceTech, and why a series of innovative experiments with peace process data by PSRP and partners led to the creation of the PeaceFem app. Sarah Brun, UN Women ad

interim Head of the Arab States Regional Office, then discussed women's involvement in peacebuilding in the region, and why such technologies are important for women's inclusion in peace processes. PSRP Research Associate Laura Wise shared the PeaceFem app features with participants – who had downloaded the app prior to the session – and discussed how the app could be used to support women in peace processes. Finally, PSRP Graduate Fellow Fiona Knäussel reflected on the complexity of bringing together the right people to develop a PeaceTech tool like PeaceFem, and on challenges for women accessing and using PeaceTech in general.

PeaceFem is free to download in English and Arabic from the Google Play Store (for Android) and the Apple App Store (for iOS). For more information, please contact peacefem@ed.ac.uk.

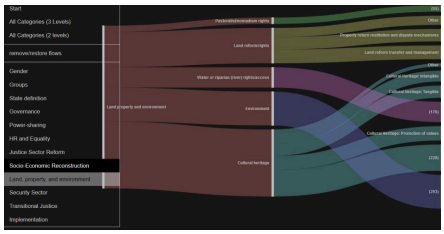
This article is cross-posted on the UNSSC website.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/10/16/peacefem-can-technology-support-inclusive-peacemaking/

2020-10-15 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New visualisations explore global peace agreement data

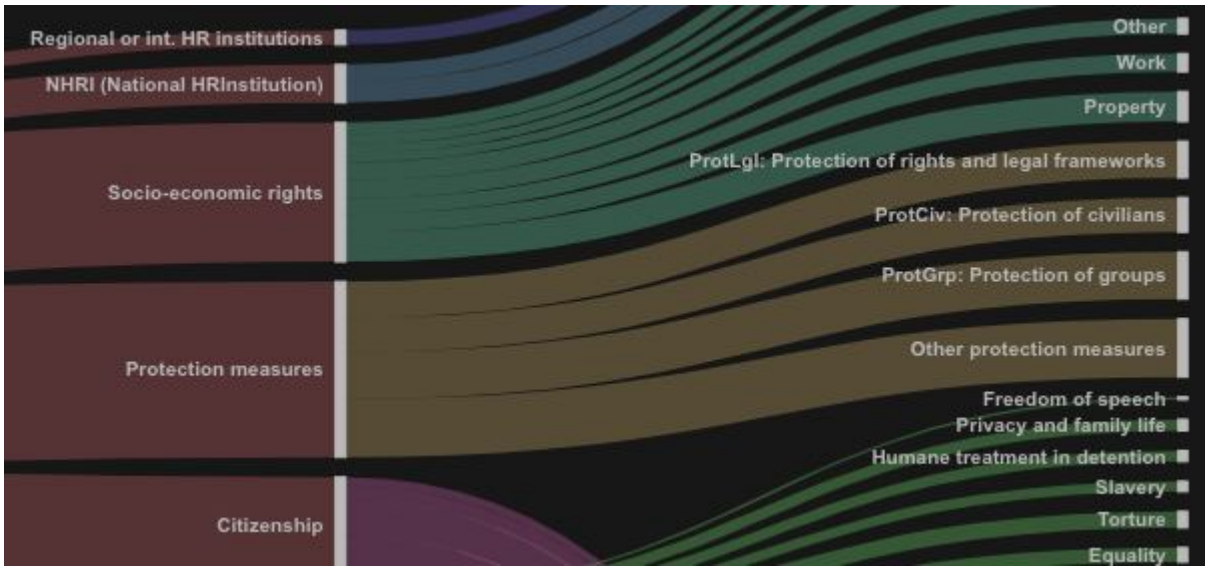
PSRP has collaborated with Dr Jaume Nualart to produce a series of data visualisations using PA-X Peace Agreements Database. The visualisations offer stunning new ways to represent and explore global peace agreements. Explore the new visualisations on the PA-X website.



Overview of issues and agreement types in PA-X

Designed by Dr Jaume Nualart, this visualisation shows an overview of peace agreement types and their substantive content. By choosing different elements and issues, users can quickly understand the content of the PA-X peace agreements.

Alluvial of Mentions



This interactive visualisation, designed by Dr Jaume Nualart, provides an overview of issues that are part of the PA-X search tools. As a visual representation of the PA-X codebook, it shows how issues are organized, and the types of issues that the PA-X team has found addressed in the data.

Student Projects

In continuation of the PSRP collaboration with Dr Jaume Nualart, we are happy to present a second round of students' work on visualising the PA-X data. These projects were created by students in the Data Science Master's programme at the Open University of Catalonia, during the 2019-20-S2 semester. Each project represents the student's unique view of the PA-X data, and we are happy to invite you to explore their vision.

Explore the new visualisations on the PA-X website.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/10/15/new-visualisations-explore-global-peace-agreement-data/

2020-09-30 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New book examines women's rights in conflict

PSRP welcomes a new book examining how institutions and regimes interact under international law to protect women's rights in conflict. Written by Dr Catherine O'Rourke of the Transitional Justice Institute at Ulster University, the book uses case studies to reveal the implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict.

Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law is published by Cambridge University Press, 2020. A policy summary drawn from the book is also available.

About the book

Laws and norms that focus on women's lives in conflict have proliferated across the regimes of international humanitarian law, international criminal law, international human rights law and the United Nations Security Council. While separate institutions, with differing powers of monitoring and enforcement, implement these laws and norms, the activities of regimes overlap. *Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law* is the first book to account for this pluralism and institutional diversity. This book identifies key aspects of how different regimes regulate women's rights in conflict, and how they interact. Using country case studies to reveal the practical implications of the fragmented protection of women's rights in conflict, this book offers a dynamic account of how regimes and institutions interact, the extent to which they reinforce each other, and the tensions and gaps in regulation that emerge.

- Counters siloed analysis by looking across various key regimes
- Looks at interactions in order to take a dynamic approach in examining institutions
- Explores case studies to reveal what fragmentation in law means in practice for the regulation of women's rights in conflict

Contents

PART I: LEGAL AND CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

1. Fragmented Protection of Women's Rights in Conflict: An Introduction
2. An Overview of Laws and Institutions
3. Regime Interactions and Tensions
4. Opportunities and Dilemmas for Women's Participation

PART II: CASE STUDIES

1. Women's Rights and International Law in a Fragile State: Democratic Republic of Congo
2. Women's Rights and International Law in Ending Conflict: Colombia
3. Women's Rights and International Law in Building Peace: Nepal

PART III: LOOKING FORWARD

1. Fragmented Protection of Women's Rights in Conflict: The Story So Far
2. A New Story: A Feminist Toolbox for Fragmentation

Advance Praise

> "Over the past three decades, the language of women's rights has entered various legal regimes applicable in armed conflict: international human rights law, international humanitarian law, international criminal law and the 'Women, Peace and Security' agenda of the UN Security Council. Catherine O'Rourke offers a fresh and perceptive analysis of these important developments through the lens of fragmentation. She studies the overlaps and tensions in these normative systems, and the problems of implementation and accountability that result. Three country case studies anchor this impressive book, grounding its insights in women's lived experience. Women's Rights in Armed Conflict under International Law both extends the legal literature on fragmentation and provides an invaluable guide for lawyers and activists working to protect women's rights in conflict."
>
> – *Hilary Charlesworth, Melbourne Laureate Professor, University of Melbourne*

> "This publication challenges the current discourse that frames women's rights in armed conflict as one grand narrative under the 'Women, Peace and Security' agenda, through an overview of normative standards and institutionalized practices under four international regimes: humanitarian law, human rights law, criminal law and security council resolutions. The use of case studies further contributes to a substantive understanding of the different legal regimes, the challenges of gaps and fragmentation, and importantly the consequences of a lack of coherence. This book will contribute to a more nuanced understanding of gender justice, accountability and the realization of women's rights."
>
> – *Rashida Manjoo, University of Cape Town, Former UN Special Rapporteur on Violence Against Women, its Causes and Consequences*

More information

The book is an output of the Political Settlements Research Programme, funded by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office.

Read and download a book excerpt.

Read a policy summary of the book.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/09/30/new-book-womens-rights-in-armed-conflict-under-international-law/

2020-09-28 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Peace Talks from PSRP: New Webinar Series on Peace and Conflict

Peace Talks from PSRP: Webinar Series on Peace and Conflict

Join the Political Settlements Research Programme and special guests for a series of webinars featuring insights into our current research on peace and conflict.

All webinars will be held over Zoom, with registration links emailed to participants ahead of the event. More information and registration details for each event are available in the event listings linked below.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19

Friday 9 October 2020

On 23 March 2020, the UN Secretary General Antonio Guterres called for an immediate global ceasefire, in order to tackle the threat of Covid-19 in fragile and conflict-affected areas. In this event, we present insights from USIP and PSRP research tracking the causes and consequences of ceasefires declared during the Covid-19 pandemic and reflect on the potential of ceasefires to lead to a more sustainable peace process.

Featuring special guest Tyler Thompson, United States Institute of Peace (USIP), and PSRP's Dr Sanja Badanjak and Laura Wise.

Register for Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19 on Eventbrite.

A Quick Start Guide to the Power of PA-X

Thursday 12 November 2020

In this webinar, PSRP's Dr Sanja Badanjak and the PA-X coding team will introduce the PA-X Peace Agreements Database and demonstrate its potential for exploring and interpreting 30 years of peace agreements from around the world.

Introduction to the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement Database

Monday 16 November 2020

In this webinar, Prof Louise Mallinder of Queens University Belfast will introduce the new Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement Database (ACPA) that she has created in conjunction with PSRP. ACPA covers amnesties that were granted during ongoing conflicts, as part of peace negotiations, or in post-conflict periods beween 1990-2016. Prof Mallinder's presentation will use the findings from this database to demonstrate the diversity in how and why amnesties are used in response to conflict and to explore how choices within amnesty design can complement inclusive peacebuilding.

Why Local Peace Agreements Matter

Thursday 3 December 2020, 13:00-14:00 GMT

This event will examine what we can learn from local peace agreements about what conflict landscapes look like, and to what extent our conceptualisations of armed conflict work. We will look at a case study of local agreements in Syria, with a focus on how particular they are from national agreements but also how 'local' they actually are in the context of a complex nested conflict, and then

look at additional examples of local agreements from Yemen and sub-Saharan Africa. Featuring PSRP's Dr Juline Beaujouan, Robert Wilson, and Dr Jan Pospisil from the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution. Register now.

PeaceTech and Data4Peace: What are we learning? (14 January 2021)

Thursday 14 January 2021, 13:00-14:00 GMT

Join us as we explore the growing field of PeaceTech, an interdisciplinary field using emerging technologies to build digital platforms for peacebuilding. This introductory event will draw on PSRP's work and partnership to offer key insights and learnings from the PeaceTech team at the University of Edinburgh, including:

- What is PeaceTech? How can technology help facilitate inclusive peace, and what is the new potential regarding data analysis?
- Data on peace processes: What are the new possibilities for data collection, analysis, and connectivity: what can we do with data on peace and conflict now that we couldn't do 10 years ago?
- What types of interdisciplinary and research-practice-tech teams are needed to produce effective PeaceTech projects?
- What lessons have we learned about designing an effective collaborative PeaceTech project in the 'data' space?

Featuring Prof Christine Bell, Dr Sanja Badanjak, Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya, and Fiona Knäussel from the Political Settlements Research Programme, with special guest Dr Benjamin Bach, Lecturer in Design Informatics and Visualization at the Bayes Centre, School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh, as event chair.

Register now.

Conflict, Peace & Covid-19

Thursday 11 February 2021, 13:00-14:00 BST

The Covid-19 pandemic has had a disproportionate impact on vulnerable and conflict-affected states. In this webinar, learn more about PSRP's research into the nexus between conflict and Covid-19. Featuring PSRP's Dr Kathryn Nash, Dr. Juline Beaujouan, and Robert Wilson.

Three forms of power-sharing and their relationship to inclusion of non-dominant groups

Thursday 11 March 2021, 13:00-14:00 BST

This webinar will examine the relationship between power-sharing and inclusion of non-dominant groups, and will use PA-X data to demonstrate how peace agreements provide for above-average inclusion of women, girls, and gender. Featuring PSRP's Dr Kevin McNicholl.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/09/28/peace-talks-from-psrp-winter-webinar-series/

2020-09-28 / RECOGNITION

PSRP researcher secures Edinburgh Teaching Award

The Political Settlements Research Programme is delighted to announce that PSRP postdoctoral fellow Dr Kathryn Nash has recently successfully secured the Edinburgh Teaching Award.

Dr Nash is a postdoctoral research fellow with the Political Settlements Research Program (PRSP). She completed her PhD at the School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London. Her research focuses on norms, the role of regions in the international community, and peace and security issues.

The award also now makes Dr Nash a Fellow of the Higher Education Academy. Becoming a Fellow of the HEA provides national recognition of a commitment to professionalism in teaching and learning in higher education. The Edinburgh Teaching Award is open to all staff within the University who have roles which relate to teaching and/or supporting learning.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/09/28/psrp-researcher-secures-edinburgh-teaching-award/

2020-09-14 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PSRP researcher awarded Chancellor's Fellowship

As of August 2020, Political Settlements Research Programme's Dr. Sanja Badanjak has started in her new role as Chancellor's Fellow in Global Challenges.

The Chancellor's Fellowship provides an opportunity for researchers to develop their research agenda over a period of five years, and to transition into the post of lecturer, pending successful review. The Fellowships are intended to support cutting-edge interdisciplinary research, and Sanja will focus on bringing together insights from political science, legal studies, and data science in order to better understand the processes though which political arrangements in fragile societies may achieve stability and constancy, that is, the manner in which they become institutionalised. This will build on her work with the PA-X Peace Agreements Database and Dataset, which she will continue to develop and extend as part of her new role.

Sanja remains with the University of Edinburgh Law School and affiliated with the PSRP, and with PA-X in particular, though she will be focusing more on developing, planning, and implementing future research aimed at addressing the challenges which developing countries are currently facing.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/09/14/psrp-researcher-awarded-chancellors-fellowship/

2020-09-02 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Role of amnesties in peace building explored in new database

Researchers have launched a comprehensive public database exploring amnesties granted during conflicts.

The resource is the first public, open access database which explores amnesties in ongoing conflicts, as part of peace negotiations, or in post-conflict periods.

The Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement (ACPA) dataset contains detailed information on 289 amnesties introduced from January 1990 to September 2016 in all world regions.

The project brings together the research of lead academic Professor Louise Mallinder from the School of Law at Queen's University Belfast and the technologies of the Political Settlements Research Programme, based at Edinburgh Law School.

Online resource

Funded by the Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office, the project has developed a new online tool for conflict parties and peacebuilders.

Amnesties are measures that seek to remove criminal liability for wrongdoing. They are often used during armed conflicts or as part of negotiated peace settlements to reduce the violence and contribute to sustainable peace.

The new resource provides descriptions of key themes relating to the scope and legal effects of different forms of amnesty, together with information on when and how they are implemented to remove criminal liability for conflict-related offences.

Creative solutions

> The question of amnesty is often one of the big stumbling blocks to a peace agreement. By making amnesty processes fully searchable, and providing strong analysis on how to craft amnesties through Professor Mallinder's report, we hope that actors in conflict will be better able to find creative solutions for moving the peace process forward, that avoid impunity.
>
> Professor Christine Bell, Edinburgh Law School

> The use of amnesties is often highly controversial, particularly where amnesties are granted to war criminals or those responsible for serious human rights violations. This is a live issue in many parts of the world today, with amnesties under consideration in the United Kingdom, Ukraine, Thailand, and in Afghanistan, where a peace agreement was reached between the US and the Taliban in February 2020 and direct negotiations between the Afghan government and the Taliban are due to begin. The political negotiations between the Afghan government and the

> Taliban demonstrate how amnesty can be a prerequisite for opening peace negotiations or reaching an agreement. Furthermore, debates in recent weeks among Afghan actors and representatives of other states over the release of Taliban detainees from prison reveal how actors may both recognise that amnesty is necessary for peace while also seek to limit the impunity that it creates. These debates indicate that the legitimacy of amnesty may rest on multiple factors including how amnestied persons are monitored after they receive amnesty; the forms of post-amnesty conditions that can be imposed for them to retain amnesty; and whether the peace process seeks to fulfil victims' rights. These issues are often omitted from approaches to amnesty that consider only whether the amnesty extends to international crimes and serious human rights violations.
>
> Professor Louise Mallinder, School of Law at Queen's University Belfast

The key themes explored by the resource include the context in which the amnesty was introduced – such as timing or regime type, and the process of introducing the amnesty.

It also looks at the categories of persons who benefited from the amnesty or were excluded from its terms, and the conditions that amnestied persons must comply with to obtain or retain amnesty.

Other key areas examined are the crimes that are included or excluded from the amnesty, the effects of the amnesty on criminal justice, civil remedies and administrative accountability processes.

How the amnesty was implemented, including whether victims had a voice in the process of deciding whether individual amnesty applicants should be granted amnesty, is another theme.

> Professor Mallinder's database is a tremendously valuable resource for research on conflict and peace processes. It allows researchers to compare the manner in which amnesties are implemented, as well as providing an insight into the workings of amnesty processes for those who may be considering the use of amnesty in negotiations on ending conflict. The ease of access to these data and the detail that Professor Mallinder provides on each process will surely encourage and support a wave of new research on the relevance and effect of amnesties in the context of armed conflict.
>
> Sanja Badanjak, Chancellor's Fellow in Global Challenges from the School of Law

Explore the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement Database at https://www.peaceagreements.org/amnesties

Further Reading

[Introducing the Amnesties, Conflict and Peace Agreement Database]

Prof. Mallinder introduces the new ACPA database and summarises its key functionality and findings.

[Amnesties and Inclusive Political Settlements]

This research report by Prof. Mallinder explores when and how amnesties are used during conflict and transitions towards peace.

A

mnesties Infographic

Amnesties can encourage those involved in conflict to move from war to peace by offering immunity for some actions during war. This infographic explores how amnesties are in tension with, or can be reconciled with accountability.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/09/02/role-of-amnesties-in-peace-building-explored-in-new-database/

2020-08-31 / EVENTS HELD

Can PeaceTech end conflict during Covid-19?

The Political Settlements Research Programme recently joined the Edinburgh University Women in STEM Society to discuss how PeaceTech tools support those brokering peace, and the challenges and opportunities the Covid-19 pandemic presents.

The Covid-19 pandemic is having disproportionate impacts on people in countries already affected by conflict, and travel restrictions both within and between countries have disrupted in-person mediation processes that have historically relied on bringing people together. Since March 2020, those working in the nascent field of PeaceTech (technological tools that support peacebuilding) have suddenly found their services more in demand than ever, as peacebuilders and their supports shift to online ways of working, often in communities where internet accessibility is not always guaranteed.

On 30 August, Professor Christine Bell, Laura Wise, and Fiona Knäussel spoke to the Edinburgh University Women in STEM Society to illustrate how PSRP has developed a suite of PeaceTech tools to support those brokering peace, and explain how these have come into their own during the Covid-19 pandemic and beyond. They discussed the opportunities and challenges of developing technological responses to facilitate conflict resolution, and how PeaceTech could assist women's meaningful inclusion in peace processes.

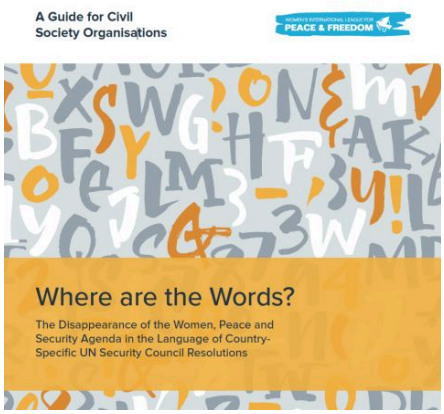
Watch the video in full below, or on Youtube.

For more Covid-related research, reports, and analysis from PSRP, visit our Covid-19 Hub.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/08/31/can-peacetech-end-conflict-during-covid-19/

2020-07-20 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Holding the UN Security Council Accountable for WPS Agenda Commitments



The Women's International League for Peace and Freedom (WILPF) has published a new guide for civil society and activists to ensure that the Women, Peace and Security (WPS) Agenda is included in UN Security Council resolutions.

The guide provides a practical framework for activists who research and work to include WPS in UNSC resolutions. It also highlights the connections between the WPS Agenda and international law and encourages more intentional use of them.

Drafted with an eye to the 20th anniversary of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security (WPS) coming up in October 2020, this guide supports peace activists to evaluate how far we've come – and what's still needed.

Read more about the guide on the WILPF website: https://www.wilpf.org/new-guide-holding-the-un-security-council-accountable-on-the-wps-agenda

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/20/holding-the-un-security-council-accountable-for-wps-agenda-commitments/

2020-07-16 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Concern over the impact of media decline in deeply divided societies

Traditional journalism has been in decline for years, with major implications for the media's role in holding political power to account.

But now fresh concerns have been raised over the impact the trend is having on societies that already face deep divisions or conflict.

The Political Settlements Research Programme played a partnership role in an international media conference on the issue, held in Northern Ireland in November 2019. The event was hosted by Social Change Initiative and partnered by Conciliation Resources.

The importance of supporting independent journalism was highlighted at the conference, but it also revealed the impact that a weakened news industry is having in deeply divided societies. PSRP's Prof Christine Bell and Tim Epple presented new research at the conference on the role of the media in international peace accords, including in Northern Ireland.

News outlets around the world were already under financial pressure due to the loss of advertising revenue to online giants such as Facebook and Google. The Covid-19 pandemic has deepened the crisis.

Social Change Initiative has now produced a package of material drawn from the conference which aims to respond to the crisis in the media, its impact on deeply divided societies, while also featuring media experts discussing how best to chart a way forward.

The special report produced by Social Change Initiative includes an examination of the impact of media decline in Northern Ireland since the 1998 Good Friday/Belfast agreement ended decades of violence.

See the conference article and videos here.

The Media in Deeply Divided Societies from The Social Change Initiative on Vimeo.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/16/concern-over-the-impact-of-media-decline-in-deeply-divided-societies/

2020-07-08 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Data reveals effect of coronavirus pandemic on war and peace around the world

The Covid-19 pandemic has not paused conflict around the world – despite calls for a global ceasefire, researchers have found. But there are positive movements that could be built on, backed by a new UN Security Council Resolution. The data comes from a new digital tracking tool jointly developed by the Political Settlements Research Programme at the University of Edinburgh.

Even in the time of a global public health crisis caused by the Covid-19 pandemic, ceasefires have proved difficult to

implement and hold, a new data resource suggests.

Researchers at the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP), based at the University of Edinburgh Law School, jointly developed a publicly available digital tracking tool to examine the consequences of the coronavirus outbreak on peace processes and armed conflict across the world.

The **Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker** monitors the progress of ceasefires alongside live data on infection rates in country. The data can be viewed in a timeline format, a search browse format, and a map format which also includes live data on infection rates in country.

The Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker has been developed by the University of Edinburgh's Political Settlements Research Programme, together with MediatEUr (European Forum for international Mediation), The Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), ETH Zurich – a research university, Conciliation Resources, and the United States Institute of Peace (USIP). Further research inputs have been received by the Mediation Support Unit in the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs. The tool involves a unique online collaboration across these organisations, all of whom have practice and research expertise in negotiating, monitoring and delivering ceasefires.

Ceasefires in a Time of Covid-19

Issued during the initial surge of Covid-19, on March 23rd 2020, the UN Secretary General's call to reach a global ceasefire prompted optimistic reactions that the unprecedented threat of the virus could bring longstanding conflict parties to end hostilities. As can be seen from the data collected by our teams, the response by warring parties has been uneven and varied.

More than 170 states supported the UN's appeal, as did other peacebuilding and religious organisations. We see the wide response, from nearly all global regions, and from a wide range of actors, as a positive outcome of the UNSG's call, bringing attention to the needs of those affected simultaneously by the violence and uncertainty of conflict, and the public health emergency of the Covid-19 crisis.

However, the ultimate ambition of the call, putting a pause on fighting across the most violent conflicts, unfortunately has not been fulfilled, as was the case with undeterred conflict in Yemen, and the speeding up of conflict in Libya. Furthermore, the delayed passing of UN Security Council Resolution 2532 (2020) in support of the call on 1 July, three months after the initial action by the UNSG, demonstrates the challenges of reaching sustained ceasefires in conflicts where members of the Security Council are involved in complex and nested regional conflicts.

The **Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker** provides a detailed insight into these various settings and allows for an overview of the armed and other actors that responded to the UNSG's call, as well as the sequences of events that these responses prompted from their respective contexts.

This ceasefire tracking tool makes it clear that, even in a time of public health crises, ceasefires are difficult to implement, and even when proclaimed by armed actors, coordination still matters for these ceasefires to hold. We found that in most cases of initial participation in the UNSG's call, the ceasefires lapsed, either after an agreed period had passed, or due to the lack of a reciprocal response by other actors.

Professor Christine Bell, Director of the University of Edinburgh's Political Settlements Research Programme, said:

> "This ceasefire tool assists international organisations such as the UN, peacebuilding organisations, and people in-country, to monitor both the pandemic and ceasefires."

Nancy Lindborg, President and CEO, United States Institute of Peace (USIP), said:

> "With the recent endorsement of UN Security Council Resolution 2532, the world has acknowledged Secretary General Guterres' statement that 'the fury of the virus illustrates the folly of war.' USIP is pleased to collaborate on this timely initiative to equip practitioners and policymakers around the world with solid evidence to inform and bolster their efforts to build peace."

Kathrin Quesada, SEO, MediatEUr, said:

> "This innovative digital tool enables experts working on peace process support to track the cessation of hostilities in real-time, accurately identify where their support can be best-placed and have a critical bird's-eye view of the interplay between ceasefire developments and the evolution of the pandemic."

Dr Govinda Clayton, Leader of Civil Wars Ceasefires Research Programme, Center for Security Studies at ETH Zurich, said:

> "Developing a clearer understanding of when and why ceasefires occur, and how these arrangements influence conflict and peacemaking process, are pressing questions that can benefit from close collaboration between academic and policy constituencies. The Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker provides a valuable tool for both communities to explore and assess the response to the United Nations call for a global ceasefire."

Henrik Urdal, Director, Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), said:

> "Ceasefires in civil war is a greatly under-researched area. The Covid-19 Ceasefires Tracker allows us to identify and explore mechanisms related to humanitarian ceasefires, and to better understand the dynamic between belligerents."

Jonathan Cohen, Executive Director, Conciliation Resources, said:

> "This digital tool gives up-to-date and accessible information about how ceasefires are working and not working to help end armed violence during the Covid-19 pandemic – essential reading for anyone interested in peacebuilding."

To access the Covid-19 Ceasefire Tracker, visit
https://pax.peaceagreements.org/covid19ceasefires/

View more PSRP Covid-19 research here.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/08/data-reveals-effect-of-coronavirus-pandemic-on-war-and-peace-around-the-world/

2020-07-06 / MEDIA ENGAGEMENTS

PeaceFem app featured on That's TV Scotland

The new PeaceFem mobile app on women and peacemaking was featured on That's TV Scotland.

In an interview with That's TV Scotland, PSRP Graduate Fellow Fiona Knäussel spoke about the process of designing the PeaceFem app, the importance of supporting women's rights advocates to push for the inclusion of gender provisions in peace agreements, and how the app can be used to reach women mediators around the world.

The interview was aired on Freeview Channel 8 on Friday 3 July 2020. A brief clip of the interview is available here.

Read more about the PeaceFem app.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/06/peacefem-app-featured-on-thats-tv-scotland/

2020-07-02 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

PA-X database expanded to June 2020

We've updated our PA-X Peace Agreements Database with new agreements covering the first half of 2020. With this release, PA-X remains the most expansive and complete online archive, database, and dataset of peace agreements.

New Peace Agreement Documents from 2020

The new release expands the PA-X database with an additional 36 new documents covering more than 150 peace processes between 1990 and 1 June 2020, bringing the PA-X database to a total of 1868 documents. As always, these are coded for all of substantive and contextual categories that PA-X offers, and can be searched and downloaded in multiple formats.

This release also updates PA-X Local, which lists agreements that deal with local issues, involve local actors, and deal with forms of local/communal violent conflict; as well as PA-X Gender, which contains more detailed analysis of the agreements that mention women, girls, or gender.

About PA-X

The PA-X Peace Agreements Database is a database and repository of peace agreements from 1990 to 2019. PA-X provides a comprehensive dataset of peace agreements capable of underpinning both quantitative and qualitative research. PA-X has been designed to provide easy access to peace

agreement texts and to allow users to explore patterns of agreements over time, both within processes and across processes.

PA-X is designed to be accessible to:

- mediators and parties in conflict seeking to understand how compromise can be crafted
- civic actors seeking to influence on-going peace talks and proposals
- social science researchers interested in understanding peace agreements quantitatively and qualitatively.

PA-X also includes a suite of visualisations that show the full variety of peace agreements across time, space, and issues of contention. This is a fascinating resource for exploring PA-X data on peace agreements and learning about how peace processes unfold.

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database now.

Further Reading

Read our PA-X Publication Series which draws on PA-X data.

Read our blog on local peace agreements, Scratching below the surface: what can local peace agreements tell us about armed groups and conflict fragmentation? by Juline Beaujoan, Tim Epple, Rob Wilson, and Laura Wise.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/02/new-agreements-expand-pa-x-database-to-june-2020/

2020-07-02 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

UN Security Council calls for Covid-19 ceasefires

The UN Security Council has called for a humanitarian ceasefire in response to the Covid-19 pandemic.

The Security Council unanimously passed resolution 2532 on 1 July 2020, calling for "a durable humanitarian pause for at least 90 consecutive days, to enable the safe, unhindered and sustained delivery of humanitarian assistance, and provision of related services by impartial humanitarian actors, in accordance with the humanitarian principles of humanity, neutrality, impartiality and independence."

The resolution echoes the UN Secretary General's call for a global ceasefire to enable health responses to the pandemic, which he made in a speech on March 2020. Over 170 states supported the call, as did other peacebuilding and religious organisations, and a number of armed actors and states responded by declaring or agreeing ceasefires.

PSRP has been closely following the ceasefire call as part of our research into the effects of the pandemic in conflict-affected areas. We are tracking global ceasefires that have been called as a result of Covid-19, and combining this with our existing knowledge on ceasefires and specific country

contexts to assess the varied outcomes and implications of these ceasefires. More information on our research is forthcoming in early July.

Read more about our Covid-19 research on the peace-conflict-Covid-19 nexus.

Image: JasonParis on Flickr (CC BY)

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/07/02/un-security-council-calls-for-covid-19-ceasefires/

2020-06-25 / EVENTS HELD

Making inclusive peace a reality: virtual launch of the PeaceFem mobile app

New 'PeaceFem' mobile app supports women to mediate in peace processes

PSRP is delighted to introduce the new PeaceFem mobile app on women and peacemaking. Join us for the launch event, *Making inclusive peace a reality: virtual launch of the PeaceFem mobile app* on Tuesday 30 June. Full event details below.

PeaceFem brings together data on women and peacemaking in one easy-to-use app in English and Arabic. The app was designed to support women's rights advocates in influencing peace process negotiations, particularly in the Arab world, but also beyond. It provides information on 30 key peace processes around the world, where gender inclusion was a key feature of the peace settlement. The app provides information about the strategies used to include women; the enabling and constraining factors that enabled women; fully searchable gender provisions in the peace agreements that resulted; and information as to how well they were implemented. Read more.

The app has been developed in collaboration with UN Women, InclusivePeace, the Monash University Gender, Peace and Security Centre, and the Political Settlements Research Programme at the University of Edinburgh.

PeaceFem is available to download from the Google Play store and the Apple Store.

Download on Google Play Store (for Android)

Download on Apple App Store (for iOS)

Making inclusive peace a reality: virtual launch of the PeaceFem mobile app

Join us for the launch seminar on Tuesday 30 June at 1:00pm (UK time). For more information and to register, visit https://peacerep.org/event/making-inclusive-peacemaking-a-reality-virtual-launch-of-the-peacefem-mobile-app.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/06/25/making-inclusive-peace-a-reality-virtual-launch-of-the-peacefem-mobile-app/

2020-06-20 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

How is Covid-19 impacting peace and conflict dynamics?

Since the Covid-19 pandemic emerged in December 2019, PSRP has been researching the impacts of the pandemic, and associated response policies, on peace and conflict dynamics around the world.

We are pleased to launch two new reports on the nexus between Covid-19, peace, and conflict.

The Impact of COVID-19 on Peace and Transition Processes: Tracking the Trends

In May 2020, PSRP, through collaboration between University of Edinburgh and Austrian Study for Peace and Conflict Resolution, conducted a survey-based, small-scale research project assessing the impact of Covid-19 and related response policies on peace processes and armed conflict in 21 countries over four continents. The survey responses have been qualitatively assessed and are presented in a new report, **The Impact of COVID-19 on Peace and Transition Processes: Tracking the Trends**.

> **"The Covid-19 crisis is not causing conflict as such, but is playing into existing conflict fault lines and threats to peace processes."**

Key Findings:

Peacebuilding experts reported a general sense of pessimism about the pandemic's impact on peace and conflict dynamics. The main causes for pessimism included the diversion of national and international actors' attention, potentially reduced donor funds, and the strategic 'gaming' of the crisis by government and non-state actors for conflict-related purposes. The UN Secretary General's global ceasefire call was only of limited success, with tangible, albeit short-lived, impact in Colombia, the Philippines, and Yemen. Our research found that the Covid-19 crisis, as such, is not 'causing' conflict but is playing into existing conflict fault lines and threats to peace processes.

The crisis-related lack of national peace processes and conflict oversight has provided an opportunity for armed campaigns, and has also resulted in an increase of local violence. Survey respondents identified that authoritarian tendencies appear to be strengthening under the guise of Covid-19 responses, and there are worrying trends in shrinking civil society space and the postponement of elections. Experts also identified xenophobia and other forms of discrimination as key themes across contexts, with anti-foreigner sentiments aimed at UN staff, expatriates, and outsider ethnopolitical groups.

Read the full list of findings in the report, The Impact of COVID-19 on Peace and Transition Processes: Tracking the Trends.

Political Trust and Social Cohesion at a Time of Crisis: The Impact of COVID-19 on Kurdistan Region-Iraq

This research project examined the sociopolitical impact of Covid-19 in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq (KRI). It mainly focused on evaluating the level of political trust in a number of actors who provide as many sources of information about the situation, and social cohesion across the region's cities and communities. The responses of almost 1,000 Kurdistanis were quantitatively and qualitatively analysed and compiled in a report, jointly published with Open Think Tank (OTT).

Key Findings:

Our research found that the COVID-19 pandemic has fostered social cohesion in the KRI. Importantly, respondents have been shown to rely mostly on their social circles and family throughout the crisis, rather than regional and federal institutions.

The results of this survey highlight a strong lack of trust in federal political figures and institutions. At the regional level, while institutions responsible for mitigating the impact of the pandemic attracted the highest level of trust across the three governorates, Kurdistanis remain divided along lines of political affiliation and geography.

Those surveyed strongly supported the preventive measures in general imposed by the KRG on the three governorates. Yet, answers to the survey reveal that such measures have had an impact on the personal economic circumstances of Kurdistanis, especially among the younger portion of the population, who expected to face financial difficulties in the near future as a direct consequence of the pandemic and its impact.

Read the full list of findings in the report, Political Trust and Social Cohesion at a Time of Crisis: The Impact of COVID-19 on Kurdistan Region-Iraq

Further Reading

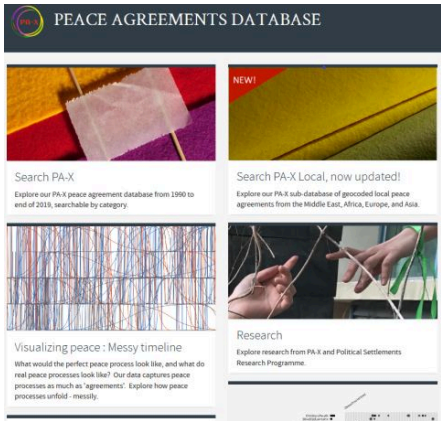
Both of these reports are part of our Covid-19 series on the nexus between Covid-19, peace, and conflict. For more from the series, visit our Covid-19 Hub.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/06/20/how-is-covid-19-impacting-peace-and-conflict-dynamics/

2020-06-01 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New agreements added to PA-X Local Asia and Europe

New data release: PA-X Local Asia and Europe



The Political Settlements Research Programme is proud to announce the addition of 36 peace agreements from Asia and Europe to its new PA-X sub-database: PA-X Local.

PA-X Local was launched in April 2020. This update adds agreements from across Asia and Europe, including from Bosnia, Croatia, Pakistan, the Philippines and Nepal. PA-X Local now contains local peace agreements from the Middle East, North Africa and sub-Saharan Africa, Asia, and Europe.

PA-X Local is the first open-access database of written local peace agreements from across a global set of conflict-affected contexts. The local peace agreements included are publicly available written agreements between locally based and other actors, which address local conflict-generating grievances only within a part of the wider conflict-affected area. PA-X Local offers a glimpse into the processes and outcomes of local peacemaking, including information on how certain local processes may relate to national peace processes.

This database lists all agreements included on the main PA-X Peace Agreements Database that deal in some way with local issues, in cases of local negotiation practices that are on the margins of wider conflict, or in cases of local/communal violent conflict. Agreements are collected from 1990 to the end of 2019. The collection is not exhaustive of all local negotiation practices, since it only brings together a selection of accessible documents which are written, formally agreed, and publicly available. Often informal and unwritten agreements are also used in these types of peace processes.

The features of PA-X Local include:

- Information about the peace process that led to the signing of the agreement
- Analysis of potential links to national-level peace processes
- Name and geographical referencing of the conflict area
- Categorisation of peace agreement participant types, including mediators
- Coding of four new categories of substantive issues addressed by agreements: use of rituals and prayer; acknowledgement of grievances; references to cattle rustling or livestock theft; and removal of social cover.

Over the past few years, PSRP has engaged with the emerging research agenda interested in local peacemaking, and the connections between peace processes at multiple levels of politics, which laid the conceptual groundwork for this database. This work by researchers at Edinburgh Law School,

at the University of Edinburgh, included the sourcing, translating, and coding of a selection of written local peace agreements. For more information about how researchers selected and processed the agreements that they were able to access, see 'About PA-X'. PSRP are hugely grateful to all those involved in local peace processes who have sent in texts of local peace agreements for inclusion in the database.

All agreements on PA-X Local are included in Version 3 of the main PA-X database launched in January 2020 and are therefore coded for an additional 225 substantive categories ranging from provisions on power sharing, to human rights, and the security sector. Due to the availability and accessibility of some peace agreement texts compared to others, in some contexts there may be more peace agreements on PA-X Local relating to certain actors or areas of the conflict. This does not in any way suggest that there is a hierarchy of agreements or that PSRP have made such an assessment of importance – PA-X Local only includes agreements that researchers were able to access, and they do not make any changes to the original texts or terminology used in texts. We encourage anyone who thinks we have missed agreements to get in touch with the programme team at politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk.

Like the main database, PA-X Local is open to all, including mediators and parties in conflict, civic actors, and social science researchers. There are numerous potential applications for this data in peacemaking practice, policy-making, and research. This new data could enable, for example:

- Analysis of patterns in local peacemaking over time
- Comparative studies of local peace processes within or across countries
- Examinations of the link between local, regional, and national-level peace processes
- Better understanding of practices of highly localised actors and their influence on wider conflict dynamics
- Case study research to draw out 'lessons learned' for local peacemaking practice
- Learning and teaching on local peacemaking

As part of PSRP's Local Peace Processes research stream, led by the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution, PSRP has held two 'Joint Analysis Workshops' that brought together leading researchers, peacebuilders, mediators, and representatives from intergovernmental bodies to reflect on local peace processes and local peace agreements. A report of findings from these workshops is open access and free to download.

If you would like to be notified about the release of additional local agreements from PA-X Local, feel free to sign up for our programme newsletter.

PA-X Local has been developed, designed, and coded by: Christine Bell, Sanja Badanjak, Juline Beaujouan, Margherita Distrotti, Tim Epple, Robert Forster, Robert Wilson, and Laura Wise.

Search PA-X Local now.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/06/01/pa-x-local-asia-and-europe/

2020-05-20 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

Assessing the impact of Covid-19 on peace and conflict

The Political Settlements Research Programme is assessing the impact of Covid-19 on peace and conflict dynamics in a series of expert surveys of peacebuilding experts across 20 countries.

Peace, Conflict, and Covid-19

The Peace, Conflict, and Covid-19 project is a survey-based small-scale research project assessing the impact of Covid-19 and related response policies on peace processes and armed conflict in more than 20 countries across four continents. A short online survey will elicit insights from country experts, including those working in civil society, academia, human rights, peacebuilding, and research. This study is being carried out by the PSRP in partnership with the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution.

The responses will be qualitatively assessed and taken as a comparative trend study on how Covid-19 and Covid-19 response policies impact peace processes globally, putting it together with other reports and secondary sources from the field.

The data will be made available in a report and briefings which aim to inform policy makers and stakeholders of possible shifts in the peace process landscape due to the current crisis. The report will be made accessible to all the respondents and is intended to inform future development and peacebuilding programming decisions in the countries under consideration.In an article published by the University of Edinburgh, PSRP Director Prof Christine Bell outlined the potential impacts of Covid-19 on peace and conflict:

> The UN Secretary General's call for COVID-19 was a potential game changer in conflicts such as Yemen and Syria. Covid-19 ceasefires open up a possibility for the virus to be dealt with in a way that is just not possible when conflict is raging. However, it also opened the possibility of building confidence between armed groups, that might outlast the COVID-19 epidemic and bring more lasting solutions. It is vital that we understand the dynamics between Covid-19, conflict and peace. We are delighted to play a role in gathering data along with a range of collaborators and partners globally, which might help to support the UN Secretary General's ceasefire call.

The Impact of Covid-19 on Kurdistan Region, Iraq

Two additional surveys, led by the PSRP's Dr Juline Beaujouan aim to assess the impacts of the virus on the Kurdistan region of Iraq and the lives of refugees/IDPs in the Middle East.

The first study aims to assess the socio-political impact of Covid-19 in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq, in which government and populations often feel alienated from the federal state. It mainly focuses on evaluating the level of political trust in a number of actors who provide as many sources of information about the situation, and social cohesion across the region's cities and communities. The responses of almost 1,000 Kurdistanis will be quantitatively and qualitatively analysed and compiled in a report to be published in Arabic, English and Kurdish. Research conducted in collaboration with Open Think Tank (OTT).

The Impact of Covid-19 on the Treatment and Lives of refugees/IDPs in the Middle East

The second study mainly focuses on evaluating how the Covid-19 situation impacted 1) the work of humanitarian workers; 2) the perception of refugees/IDPs as vulnerable populations; 3) the mitigation of the humanitarian crisis. Perceptions and insights of experts – humanitarian workers, policymakers, civil society – acting at the (inter)national and local levels will be collected via an online survey to be sent over 7 countries and administrative entities. Research conducted in collaboration with Open Think Tank (OTT).

Read more about our work on Covid-19 and conflict.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/05/20/assessing-the-impact-of-covid-19-on-peace-and-conflict/

2020-05-20 / RECOGNITION

Studying intergovernmental responses to Covid-19 in the Global South

PSRP researcher Dr Kathryn Nash has been awarded £1861 from the University of Edinburgh College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences fund for research on Covid-19 related challenges to study the responses of Global South regional and sub-regional organisations to the Covid-19 crisis.

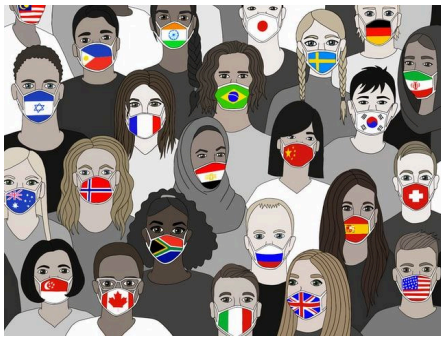


Photo by Laura Makaltses via Unsplash
https://unsplash.com/photos/5hp3iqwZXD8

Responses at the international and national levels have been widely tracked. However, many regions in the Global South have more recently dealt with public health crises and frequently deal with trans-border challenges. Responses from Global South intergovernmental organisations (IGOs) to the Covid-19 crisis may provide examples of effective strategies that other regions could adopt.

This project will gather information on the responses of IGOs to the Covid-19 crisis through the collection of primary source documents, such as press releases, joint statements, declarations, resolutions, and other similar documents. It will then produce research on the responses of organisations in Latin America, Africa, and Asia to answer two questions: First, how have IGOs responded? Second, what strategies developed to react to this crisis will become part of standard operations and potentially inform responses to future crises?

The initial outputs from this study will be a series of blogs on the responses of regional and sub-regional organisations in Latin America, Africa, and Asia. In addition, Dr Nash will collaborate with the University of Edinburgh Covid-19 response governance mapping initiative to provide information on regional and sub-regional responses in Africa that will feed into their work on detailed case studies of governance responses in African states. In the medium-term, the project will produce detailed reports and articles on regional and sub-regional responses to Covid-19 that ties in with our broader work on IGO responses to trans-border peace and security challenges.

The project is being led by Dr Kathryn Nash in collaboration with Monalisa Adhikari and Hannah den Boer.

Read more about our work on Covid-19.

Image: Illustration by Laura Makaltses via Unsplash

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/05/20/studying-intergovernmental-responses-to-covid-19-in-the-global-south/

2020-05-13 / MEDIA ENGAGEMENTS

PSRP ceasefires research featured on Good Morning Scotland

The PSRP's research on the impact of Covid-19 in conflict-affected regions was featured on the BBC's Good Morning Scotland.

PSRP Director Prof Christine Bell gave a short interview with Laura Maxwell and Gary Robertson on 13 May 2020. Prof Bell spoke about the UN ceasefire call, the impact of the pandemic on peace processes around the world, and how crises can impact peace.

The PSRP is working on several projects related to Covid-19, including an expert survey designed to assess whether the outbreak and associated responses have changed the dynamics of peace and conflict. Read more about our research into the impact of the pandemic in conflict-affected areas.

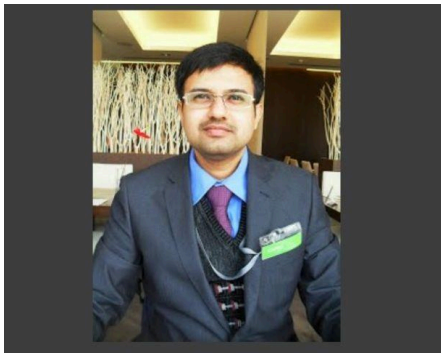
Listen to the Good Morning Scotland interview here.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/05/13/psrp-ceasefires-research-featured-on-good-morning-scotland/

2020-05-08 / TRAINING & FELLOWSHIPS

PSRP welomes new Train@Ed Fellow

PSRP is proud to welcome Dr Devanjan Bhattacharya as the new Train@Ed Postdoctoral Fellow.



TRAIN@Ed is an ambitious new postdoctoral fellowship scheme providing researchers from around the world the opportunity to develop their career in one of the world's leading universities. Each Fellow will take part in a dedicated skills development programme designed to help the Fellow establish a sustainable career in research.

Devanjan will be working with the PSRP and PeaceTech, focussing on collaborative map visualisations for participation and mediation in peace processes, along with the School of Informatics and the School of Design.

Devanjan holds a PhD and Masters degree in Geomatics Engineering from the Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee. His background is in information technology, geographical information systems(GIS), mapping, expert system and knowledge based application development, software development.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/05/08/psrp-welomes-train-ed-fellow/

2020-05-04 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Local peace agreements from Sub-Saharan Africa added to PA-X Local

New data release: PA-X Local sub-Saharan Africa

The Political Settlements Research Programme is proud to announce the addition of 91 peace agreements from sub-Saharan Africa to its new PA-X sub-database: PA-X Local.

PA-X Local was launched in April 2020. This update adds agreements from across sub-Saharan Africa, including from the Central African Republic, Kenya, Mali, Nigeria, Somalia and South Sudan. PA-X Local now contains local peace agreements from the Middle East, North Africa and sub-Saharan Africa. Over the next few months, PSRP will add further agreements from Asia and Europe.

PA-X Local is the first open-access database of written local peace agreements from across a global set of conflict-affected contexts. The local peace agreements included are publicly available written agreements between locally based and other actors, which address local conflict-generating grievances only within a part of the wider conflict-affected area. PA-X Local offers a glimpse into the processes and outcomes of local peacemaking, including information on how certain local processes may relate to national peace processes.

This database lists all agreements included on the main PA-X Peace Agreements Database that deal in some way with local issues, in cases of local negotiation practices that are on the margins of wider conflict, or in cases of local/communal violent conflict. Agreements are collected from 1990 to the end of 2019. The collection is not exhaustive of all local negotiation practices, since it only brings together a selection of accessible documents which are written, formally agreed, and publicly available. Often informal and unwritten agreements are also used in these types of peace processes.

The features of PA-X Local include:

- Information about the peace process that led to the signing of the agreement
- Analysis of potential links to national-level peace processes
- Name and geographical referencing of the conflict area
- Categorisation of peace agreement participant types, including mediators
- Coding of four new categories of substantive issues addressed by agreements: use of rituals and prayer; acknowledgement of grievances; references to cattle rustling or livestock theft; and removal of social cover.

Over the past few years, PSRP has engaged with the emerging research agenda interested in local peacemaking, and the connections between peace processes at multiple levels of politics, which laid the conceptual groundwork for this database. This work by researchers at Edinburgh Law School, at the University of Edinburgh, included the sourcing, translating, and coding of a selection of written local peace agreements. For more information about how researchers selected and processed the agreements that they were able to access, see 'About PA-X'. PSRP are hugely grateful to all those involved in local peace processes who have sent in texts of local peace agreements for inclusion in the database.

All agreements on PA-X Local are included in Version 3 of the main PA-X database launched in January 2020 and are therefore coded for an additional 225 substantive categories ranging from provisions on power sharing, to human rights, and the security sector. Due to the availability and accessibility of some peace agreement texts compared to others, in some contexts there may be more peace agreements on PA-X Local relating to certain actors or areas of the conflict. This does not in any way suggest that there is a hierarchy of agreements or that PSRP have made such an assessment of importance – PA-X Local only includes agreements that researchers were able to access, and they do not make any changes to the original texts or terminology used in texts. We encourage anyone who thinks we have missed agreements to get in touch with the programme team at politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk.

Like the main database, PA-X Local is open to all, including mediators and parties in conflict, civic actors, and social science researchers. There are numerous potential applications for this data in peacemaking practice, policy-making, and research. This new data could enable, for example:

- Analysis of patterns in local peacemaking over time
- Comparative studies of local peace processes within or across countries
- Examinations of the link between local, regional, and national-level peace processes
- Better understanding of practices of highly localised actors and their influence on wider conflict dynamics
- Case study research to draw out 'lessons learned' for local peacemaking practice
- Learning and teaching on local peacemaking

As part of PSRP's Local Peace Processes research stream, led by the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution, PSRP has held two 'Joint Analysis Workshops' that brought together leading researchers, peacebuilders, mediators, and representatives from intergovernmental bodies to reflect on local peace processes and local peace agreements. A report of findings from these workshops will be published with the British Academy in 2020. An initial PSRP publication by Laura Wise, Robert Forster, and Christine Bell on the opportunities and challenges for women's engagement in local peace processes is open access and free to download.

If you would like to be notified about the release of additional local agreements from Asia and Europe, feel free to sign up for our programme newsletter.

PA-X Local has been developed, designed, and coded by: Christine Bell, Sanja Badanjak, Juline Beaujouan, Margherita Distrotti, Tim Epple, Robert Forster, Robert Wilson, and Laura Wise.

Search PA-X Local now.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/05/04/local-peace-agreements-from-sub-saharan-africa-added-to-pa-x-local/

2020-04-27 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Call for submissions on data visualisations and policymaking

Call for submissions for a special issue on the theme of "Data Visualisations & Policymaking"

Editors
William Allen (University of Oxford); Verity Trott (Monash University); Kathryn Nash (University of Edinburgh)

Deadline
Abstracts for articles: 31 May 2020
Decisions announced by 15 June 2020

Theme
We are witnessing a proliferation of data visualisations – defined by a leading visualiser as 'the presentation and representation of data to facilitate understanding' (Andy Kirk, 2016: 19). There has been significant research (notably Cukier and Mayer-Schonberger's 2013 book) drawing attention to the limitations particularly of big data and new data sources, yet despite these concerns we are seeing an increasing popularity of data visualisations in policy debates. Visualisation can simplify data and convey a rhetoric of neutrality making them powerful conduits for the spread of information. It is these same characteristics that can make data visualisation dangerous for the spread of misinformation, the misrepresentation of data, and the erasure of key information that is absent from the data or that does not translate well into the logic of visualisation or datafication. It is imperative then to ask: How and in what circumstances do data visualisations shape policy and how are they simultaneously influenced by the demands and constraints that exist within policy and the political, social and cultural climates more broadly? We frame this special issue by asking how do data visualisations relate to the domain of policymaking across multiple topics.

The purpose of this special issue is to provoke a reflection and consideration of what forms of knowledge, and epistemologies more broadly, are privileged in a world that is increasingly preoccupied with datafication and data visualisations. Is this a particularly effective way to convey data or are we being swept up in a trend that may not be conveying our data in the ways we understand? With these themes and questions in mind, we ask for article abstracts to address the following:

- How are data politics present in data visualisation?
- How do data visualisation and policymaking inform and relate to each other?
- What is 'effective' policy impact, and to what extent does (or can) data visualisation achieve this?
- What are best practices in data visualisation?
- How has data visualisation been used to influence policy (in any field), and how has policy influenced the use and practice of sharing academic findings?

This special issue call is part of a project supported by seed funding from the British Academy, and we expect to hold a workshop to support its publication. If the COVID-19 crisis continues to prevent travel,

then we will hold a digital forum, and any accepted participant may participate in the forum remotely if they are unable to travel.

We recognise that the current crisis has brought unprecedented workloads and caring obligations, and we are concerned about recent journal submission data showing a widening gender gap. We will accept multiauthor submissions that allow for burden sharing. Furthermore, if you would like to be a part of this but are concerned about workload and caring responsibilities, please submit a proposal and let us know what article length and deadlines would be feasible.

Submission Details
Please send a 300 word abstract with a 100-word author bio to the following address by 31 May, 2020: Kathryn.Nash@ed.ac.uk

Completed articles should be 6,000 – 8,000 words and article drafts will be expected to be completed by 15 September, 2020.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/04/27/call-for-submissions-on-data-visualisations-and-policymaking/

2020-04-27 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PSRP research quoted in UN Insider

PSRP Director Prof Christine Bell is quoted in a recent piece by UN Insider on the growing support for global ceasefires during the Covid-19 pandemic.

The UN Insider article introduces the call from UN Secretary General Antonio Guterres for countries to lay down their weapons in the face of Covid-19, and refers to PSRP research on ceasefires and the relationship between armed conflict and crisis.

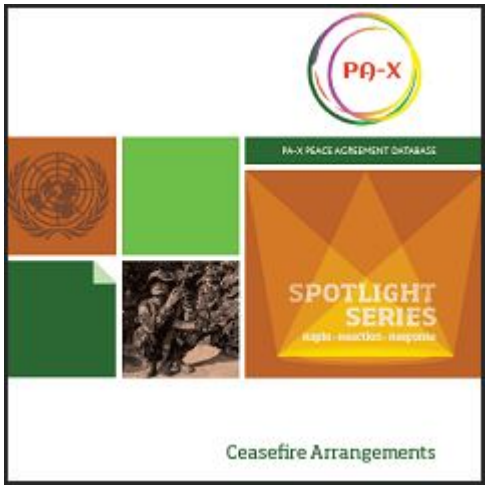
The article cites an original opinion piece by Christine Bell, COVID-19 and Violent Conflict: Responding to Predictable Unpredictability, which offers baseline understandings for designing the most effective responses to the COVID-19 pandemic in conflict-affected regions. From UN Insider:

> Picking up the threads of the UN chief's appeal, Bell added: "We know from experience that the relationship between armed conflict and crisis is complicated and leads to unpredictable results. If this unpredictability is, however, itself predictable — a "known unknown" — can a "smart" response be put in place?" Our ongoing research at the Political Settlements Research Programme suggests that the following 11 baseline understandings are likely to be key in designing the most effective responses to the COVID-19 pandemic in conflict-affected regions:
>
> 1. Implementing technical solutions is always political, and "conflict lenses" are needed to anticipate the effectiveness of any response.
> 2. Mid-level peacebuilders have unique capacities to bridge and build trust between the state and local communities.
> 3. Flexible aid may be needed that can bypass the State in contentious areas.
> 4. Crisis management can have "peace dividends".

5. Conflict parties often seek to make military and political gains, under cover of crisis response.
6. State and non-State armed actor capacities for mobilization, and their political and military calculations, will be different.
7. COVID-19 may pose unique logistical challenges to current peace processes.
8. Diplomacy and peacekeeping may become “absent”.
9. Emergency legislation is a response with conflict-dangers.
10. Elections are also peculiarly at threat, with specific conflict consequences.
11. A lack of international legal confidence.

Read the article in full on the UN Insider website.

For more information, read PSRP research on ceasefires:



Ceasefire Arrangements
When and how are ceasefires negotiated, and what are their critical elements? The Spotlight reviews core elements included in the 267 ceasefire agreements signed between 1990 and 2015 listed on the PA-X Peace Agreements Database.

Gender Mainstreaming in Ceasefires: Comparative Data and Examples

When and how have ceasefire agreements in armed conflict addressed women? Why should ceasefires include gender-specific provisions? Finally, what are the potential strategies for including women in ceasefire monitoring and implementation modalities?

Humanitarian Assistance and Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements

When and how do peace processes provide for humanitarian assistance? Do peace agreements that provide for humanitarian assistance adopt a gender perspective?

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/04/27/psrp-research-quoted-in-un-insider/

2020-04-16 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

New visual tool illustrates local peace in Libya, Syria, and Yemen

A new visual tool illustrates the geographical distribution of local peace agreements in Yemen, Syria and Libya.

This interactive map displays all local peace agreements signed in Libya, Syria, and Yemen that are included in the new PA-X sub-database of local peace agreements in the Middle East and North Africa. The map includes key information about each agreement as well as a link to detailed coding. It allows the visualisation of peace and its geographic distribution in those three conflict-affected countries. Created by Juline Beaujouan.

For more information on local agreements in the MENA region, visit the PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/04/16/new-visual-tool-illustrates-local-peace-in-libya-syria-and-yemen/

2020-03-29 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Introducing the PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database

The Political Settlements Research Programme is proud to announce the launch of its new PA-X sub-database of local peace agreements: PA-X Local.

PA-X Local is the first open-access database of written local peace agreements from across a global set of conflict-affected contexts. The local peace agreements included are publicly available written agreements between locally-based and other actors, which address local conflict-generating grievances only within a part of the wider conflict-affected area. PA-X Local offers a glimpse into the processes and outcomes of local peacemaking, including information on how it relates to any national peace process.

This database lists all agreements included on the main PA-X Peace Agreements Database that deal in some way with local issues, in cases of local negotiation practices that are on the margins of wider conflict, or in cases of local/communal violent conflict. Agreements are collected from 1990 to the end of 2019, with global coverage, but PSRP will publicly release monthly by region from March to June 2020. The collection is not exhaustive of all local negotiation practices, since it only brings together accessible documents which are written, formally agreed, and publicly available. Often informal and unwritten agreements are also used in these types of peace processes.

This interactive map displays all local peace agreements signed in Libya, Syria and Yemen that are included in the newPA-X sub-database of local peace agreements in the Middle East and North Africa. The map includes key information about each agreement as well as a link to detailed coding. It allows the visualisation of peace and its geographic distribution in those three conflict-affected countries.

Over the past few years, PSRP has engaged with the emerging research agenda interested in local peacemaking, and the connections between peace processes at multiple levels of politics, which laid the conceptual groundwork for this database. This work by researchers at Edinburgh Law School, at the University of Edinburgh, included the sourcing, translating, and coding of a selection of written local peace agreements. For more information about how researchers selected and processed the agreements that they were able to access, see 'About PA-X'. PSRP are hugely grateful to all those involved in local peace processes who have sent in texts of local peace agreements for inclusion in the database.

The first version of PA-X Local launched today features 133 agreements from the Middle East and North Africa (MENA), particularly from Libya, Syria, and Yemen. Over the next few months, PSRP will add at least 150 further agreements from Asia, Europe, and sub-Saharan Africa. The features of PA-X Local include:

- Information about the peace process that led to the signing of the agreement
- Analysis of potential links to national-level peace processes
- Name and geographical referencing of the conflict area
- Categorisation of peace agreement participant types, including mediators
- Coding of four new categories of substantive issues addressed by agreements: use of rituals
- and prayer; acknowledgement of grievances; references to cattle rustling or livestock theft; and, removal of social cover.

All agreements on PA-X Local are included in Version 3 of the main PA-X database launched in January 2020 and are therefore coded for an additional 225 substantive categories ranging from provisions on power sharing, to human rights, and the security sector. Due to the availability and accessibility of some peace agreement texts compared others, in some contexts there may be more peace agreements on PA-X Local relating to certain actors or areas of the conflict. This does not in any way suggest that there is a hierarchy of agreements or that PSRP have made such an assessment of importance – PA-X Local only includes agreements that researchers were able to access, and they do not make any changes to the original texts or terminology used in texts. We encourage anyone who thinks we have missed agreements to get in touch with the programme team at politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk

Like the main database, PA-X Local is open to all, including mediators and parties in conflict, civic actors, and social science researchers. There are numerous potential applications for this data in peacemaking practice, policy-making, and research. This new data could enable, for example:

- Analysis of patterns in local peacemaking over time
- Comparative studies of local peace processes within or across countries
- Examinations of the link between local, regional, and national-level peace processes
- Better understanding of practices of highly localised actors and their influence on wider conflict dynamics
- Case study research to draw out 'lessons learned' for local peacemaking practice Learning and teaching on local peacemaking

As part of PSRP's Local Peace Processes research stream, led by the Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution, PSRP has held two 'Joint Analysis Workshops' that brought together leading researchers, peacebuilders, mediators, and representatives from intergovernmental bodies to reflect on local peace processes and local peace agreements. A report of findings from these workshops will

be published with the British Academy in 2020. An initial PSRP publication by Laura Wise, Robert Forster, and Christine Bell on the opportunities and challenges for women's engagement in local peace processes is now open access and free to download.

If you would like to be notified about the release of additional local agreements from Asia, Europe, and sub-Saharan Africa, feel free to sign up for our programme emails at https://peacerep.org/subscribe/

PA-X Local has been developed, designed, and coded by: Christine Bell, Sanja Badanjak, Juline Beaujouan, Margherita Distrotti, Tim Epple, Robert Forster, Robert Wilson, and Laura Wise.

Search PA-X Local now.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/03/29/introducing-pa-x-local/

2020-03-26 / EVENTS HELD

Entry Points for Conflict Transformation in the MENA Region

PSRP Research Associate Juline Beaujouan co-organized a workshop with the Berghof Foundation to discuss potential for conflict transformation with Salafi-Jihadi groups in the MENA region.

On Monday 9th March, Berghof Foundation in cooperation with the AHRC's Open Research Initiative (OWRI) and al-Sabah Programme (Durham University) and PSRP (University of Edinburgh) hosted a workshop on "Insights of Recent Research about the Development of Salafi-Jihadism in the MENA Region and Entry Points for Conflict Transformation".

The workshop primarily intended to provide a forum for exchange between academics and practitioners from MENA and Europe on the mobilization and demobilization dynamics of Salafi-Jihadi armed groups. Panellists offered a diverse yet complementary overview of the historical, social, political and religious dynamics that help better understand the rationale behind this kind of violence and highlight opportunities for conflict transformation.

The event also brought together a wide audience composed of political and religious figures, including representatives of the Lebanese and British governments, civil society, academics from Europe and MENA, and practitioners of conflict transformation and peacemaking. To reflect this diversity, insights and comments were made in English and Arabic with live translation throughout the day.

In a first instance, panellists shared insights of recent analysis about Salafi-Jihadism in the MENA region, collecting feedback and developing avenues for future research that could bridge the divide between academics and practitioners. Subsequently, panellists compared experiences and lessons learned from practical approaches to strengthen community resilience and identifying entry points for conflict transformation.

Presentations included the outline and outcome of a three-year multidisciplinary research conducted by Prof. Anoush Ehteshami, Amjed Rasheed and Juline Beaujouan (PSRP) on the impact of the MENA (dis)order, the erosion of the state and the role of non-state actors – mainly the Islamic State (IS) – in

shaping the politics of the MENA region. Berghof teams in Beirut and Berlin were also actively involved in the panels. Namely, Véronique Dudouet, Programme Director for Conflict Transformation Research, offered an overview of the research findings of the Berghof-led project "Salafi-Jihadi armed Groups – (De)-escalation and Dialogue Options" conducted in Mali, Somalia and Syria.

Discussions highlighted the variety of Salafi-Jihadi groups and their claims and the difficulty to coin a single all-encompassing approach for conflict transformation. Participants were also encouraged to reflect on the opportunities and challenges for youth inclusion in MENA societies as a means to prevent them from joining violent armed groups. This insight echoed the realization that a high number of aspiring jihad fighters did not join the ranks of Salafi-Jihadi groups on religious grounds but for an array of reasons. As such, their engagement often materialized grievances, lack of future prospects, and the response to the recurrent violence – sometimes invisible – that marks the lives of young individuals in the MENA region.

Participants also emphasized the role religious figures should play to counter the narrative of violence in the name of religion. Finally, participants noted that strengthening community resilience should go hand in hand with the integration of Salafi-Jihadi groups in state structures to give them the option to express their grievances via non-violent channels. Yet the absence of the state at the central and local levels greatly impeded such prospect for conflict transformation.

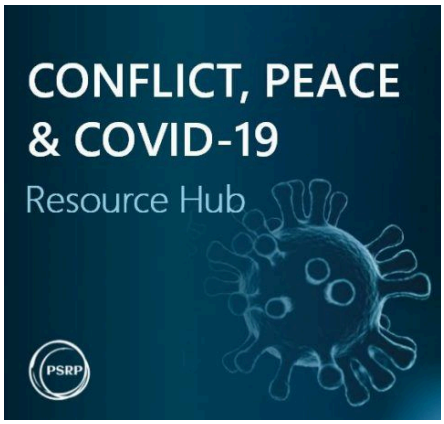
Read more about the workshop from the Berghof Foundation.

Image: Participants at the workshop on 9 March 2020.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/03/26/entry-points-for-conflict-transformation-in-the-mena-region/

2020-03-25 / OTHER PROGRAMME NEWS

Conflict, Development, and Covid-19 Resources



The Covid-19 pandemic is disproportionately affecting vulnerable populations around the world. The consequences of the virus on conflict-affected states are so powerful that United Nations Secretary General Antonio Guterres has called for a global ceasefire to stop violent conflict in support of the fight against novel coronavirus.

The Political Settlements Research Programme is committed to supporting communities experiencing violent conflict. We have put together a list of blogs and other resources addressing the Covid-19 pandemic from the perspective of conflict-affected states. If you would like to add to this list, please email politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk. Read our statement on how we are handling our work during this time. You can also subscribe to our email updates.

1. Covid-19 Tools
2. Conflict, Peace, and Covid-19 Nexus
2.a Unity-Separatist Issues
2.b Geopolitics
3. Development-Related

3.a Elections
4. Emergency Legislation and States of Emergency
5. Ceasefires
6. Gender
7. International Influence and Mediation of Peace Processes
8. Role of Research and Expertise
9. Human Rights
10. Countries (Afghanistan, Kosovo, Sudan, Yemen, Venezuela, Sri Lanka, Israel-Palestine, Ukraine, Somalia, Colombia, Ethiopia, Pakistan, El Salvador, Philippines, Thailand, Libya, Lebanon)

1. Covid-19 Tools

Perspectives on a Pandemic: COVID-19 Analysis from CIC – NYU Center on International Cooperation
Regularly updated collection of articles, blog posts, and policy papers on COVID-19 by the CIC.

COVID-19 Response and Resources by the Alliance for Peacebuilding (AfP)
Collection of resources (incl. blogs and webinars) on AfP members involved in COVID-19 responses, who are helping mitigate the crisis and protect the world's most vulnerable populations.

COVID-19 Open Research Dataset (CORD-19)
The Allen Institute for AI has partnered with leading research groups to prepare and distribute the COVID-19 Open Research Dataset (CORD-19), a free resource of over 51,000 scholarly articles, including over 40,000 with full text, about COVID-19 and the coronavirus family of viruses for use by the global research community.

Mapping Risk Factors for the Spread of COVID-19 in Africa – Africa Centre for Strategic Studies
A series of maps graphically representing relative levels of vulnerability across the African continent.

COVID-DEM Infohub – How is COVID-19 affecting democracy? – Democratic Decay
Long-form academic research
COVID-DEM's aim is to help democracy analysts worldwide track, compile, and share information on how State responses to COVID-19 are impacting on democratic governance.

Mobility Restrictions COVID-19 – IOM
Portal that maps and monitors types of travel restrictions imposed by countries.

Coronavirus & Civic Space – ICLN
Resources and information on how international law provides a framework to uphold human rights during crisis response.

COVID-19 Community Mobility Reports – Google
See how your community is moving around differently due to COVID-19.

COVID-19 key information for South Sudan – CSRF South Sudan
Library of analysis and tools to help design and deliver more context-aware responses to COVID-19 in South Sudan.

Global Protest Tracker – The Carnegie Endowment for International Peace
A one-stop source for following crucial trends in the most significant antigovernment protests worldwide that now also monitors global protests in times of COVID-19.

Coronavirus and Global Disorder analysis resources – The Carnegie Endowment for International Peace
Carnegie experts offer analysis on the political, economic, and geostrategic effects of the global pandemic.

Life with Corona
Charitable open access citizen science project that collects data to allow a comprehensive insight into daily life during the pandemic.

COVID-19 Map – Johns Hopkins University

COVID-19 Civic Freedom Tracker – ICLN, ECLN, UN Special Rapporteur Fionnuala D. Ní Aoláin

Oxford COVID-19 Government Response Tracker – University of Oxford

#COVID19 – A global joint response (resources) – ACAPS

COVID-19 – Government measures (dataset) – ACAPS

COVID-19 AND PERSONS DEPRIVED OF LIBERTY INFORMATION HUB – Association for the Prevention of Torture

Tracking the Global Response to COVID-19 – Privacy International

Country Policy Tracker – OECD

Understanding the Coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic through data – World Bank

COVID-19 Disorder Tracker – ACLED

2. Conflict, Peace, and Covid-19 Nexus

NEW: A Global Call: Will COVID-19 bring more peace to the world? – Borja Paladini Adell, Peace Research Institute Oslo

Is there a Responsibility to Protect the world from pandemics? – Thomas Peak, Centre for Geopolitics

A dangerous cocktail: Coronavirus and war – Orly Stern

Fear of a fragile planet – Naomi Hossain, Institute of Development Studies

Violence imperils coronavirus response in conflict zones around the world – Danielle Paquette, Susannah George and Sudarsan Raghavan, The Washington Post

COVID-19 Symposium: COVID-19 in Conflict-Affected Areas–Armed Groups as Part of a Global Solution – Marcos D. Kotlik and Ezequiel Heffes, Opinio Juris

COVID-19: Four ways peacebuilders can respond – Rebeca Crozier, International Alert

COVID-19 and conflicts: Views from peacebuilders – Margot Jones, EPLO

Coronavirus in Conflict Zones: A Sobering Landscape – The Carnegie Endowment for International Peace.
A compilation of a dozen country analysis considering the consequences coronavirus will have on conflict-affected countries.

Coronavirus in conflict:The fight has hardly begun – Eleanor Gordon, Florence Carrot, The Interpreter

(EVENT) Coronavirus and Conflict: The Security Sector Response – USIP

The role of community peacebuilders in a pandemic: what we learnt from the Ebola crisis – Janet Adama Mohammed, Conciliation Resources

Responding to COVID-19: The Need for Conflict Sensitivity – Céline Monnier, NYU CIC

COVID-19 and the impact on local peacebuilding – Conducive Space for Peace, Humanity United, Peace Direct

COVID-19 and the toxic politics of exploitation – Louisa Waugh, Saferworld

Peace building in the time of Coronavirus – Michael Keating, EIP

How is COVID playing out in Fragile and Conflict Affected Settings? – Duncan Green, From Poverty to Power

Covid-19 and Violent Conflict: Responding to Predictable Unpredictability – Christine Bell, Political Settlements Research Programme (Just Security)

COVID-19 in Africa: "Know your Epidemic, Act on its Politics." – Alex de Waal, LSE

The Impact of COVID-19 on Global Peace Operations – Cedric de Coning (IPI Global Observatory)

Covid-19 and Conflict: Seven Trends to Watch – Crisis Group

Conflict and peace scenarios in times of conflict

Dan Smith, SPRI Director, Covid-19-Conflict YouTube Analysis

CRP Update on Covid-19 in DRC, Iraq, Somalia, South Sudan, and Syria – Conflict Research Programme

Richard Gowan about the consequences of Coronavirus for peacekeeping

Dealing with Covid-19 in Conflict Zones Needs A Different Approach – Katie Peters & Sherine El Taraboulsi-McCarthy, ODI (Thomson Reuters Foundation News)

Could coronavirus lead to a "positive peace"? – Rachel Scott, UNDP

Conflict and peace scenarios in times of COVID-19 – Juan Garrigues, CIDOB

COVID-19: One War that Must Be Fought – DPPA

Peace and Pandemics: How COVID-19 will impact violence and what we can do about it – Rachel Locke

COVID-19: Building a more peaceful world from a global crisis – Jessie Banfield, International Alert

Militancy in Lake Chad and Mozambique, COVID-19 in Gaza and Syria: The Cheat Sheet – The New Humanitarian

Yemen floods, Myanmar information bans, and COVID-19 disruption (nearly) everywhere: The Cheat Sheet – The New Humanitarian

The Coronavirus Could Topple Governments Around the World – Nic Cheeseman, Foreign Policy

What is SSR going to look like after Covid19? – Viola Csordas, DCAF-ISSAT

Corona-PeaceLab: How Do We Need to Adapt Crisis Prevention and Peacebuilding? – PeaceLab

COVID-19: Peacebuilders aren't the side dish. We're the delivery service – Mike Jobbins, Medium

Peace First Launches Rapid Response Grants to Address COVID-19 – Peace First

2.a Unity-Separatist issues

Devolved Spain Struggles for Unity Against Coronovirus

2.b Geopolitics

The World Health Organization and Pandemic Politics – David P. Fidler, Think Global Health

3. Development-Related

'Just one case': fears coronavirus may spread like wildfire in world's refugee camps – Reuters

Fragility and Pandemics: Finding the right equation to steer action – Rachel Locke

After the pandemic: How will COVID-19 transform global health and development? – Michael Igoe, Vince Chadwick, Devex

The Coronavirus is a Call To Build Resilience in Fragile States – Nancy Lindborg, USIP

The Covid-19 pandemic in the eyes of a Rohingya – Rashid Mubarak, Asia Times

Broadcast: Fears for world's largest refugee settlement as Coronavirus draws closer – BBC World Service Newshour

Global Health Security – COVID-19 & Humanitarian Response: Leave No-One Behind – Alistair D. B. Cook, RSiS

Coronavirus and aid: what we're watching – New Humanitarian

Q&A: WHO's Mike Ryan on how countries in crisis can perpare for a coronavirus epidemic – New Humanitarian

How You Can Protect Your Community, Not Just Your Own Health – Oeindrila Dube and Katherine Baicker, NY Times

Protecting African Garment Industry from Covid Fallout?

Public health experts: Coronavirus could overwhelm the developing world – Anthony Faiola, Sudarsan Raghavan, Max Bearak and Terrence McCoy, The Washington Post

From cholera to corona: The politics of plagues in Africa – Simukai Chigudu, Africa Is a Country

Roma: Europe's Neglected Coronavirus Victims – Stephan Müller, Fikrija Tair, Bashkim Ibishi and Dragan Gracanin, Reporting Democracy

3.a Elections

Global overview of COVID-19: Impact on elections (regularly updated) – International IDEA

A First Step Toward Reform: Ending Burundi's Forced Contribution System – Crisis Group
This is a pre-COVID-19 analysis but serves to understand current electoral dynamics which may be impacted by the pandemic. Crisis Group is following up on the implications COVID-19 has on this and other situations.

Elections and COVID-19 (International IDEA)

4. Emergency Legislation and States of Emergency

COVID-19, Emergency Legislation, and Sunset Clauses – Sean Molloy, Political Settlements Research Programme

Covid-19 and Derogations Before the European Court of Human Rights – Sean Molloy, VerfBlog

The Virus that Ends Us: On the Ethics of Withdrawal and Affirmation – Jan Pospisil, Austrian Study Centre for Peace and Conflict Resolution (CPD Policy Blog)

Pandemics and Human Rights – Doug Rutzen and Nikhil Dutta (Just Security)

IDEA Declarations of emergency have emerged throughout the world in response to #covid2019 what is the role of the Constitution in times of crisis?

South Asia states of emergency – Asanga Welikala

Political finance oversight during a global health pandemic – Yukihiko Hamada, IDEA

5. Ceasefires

NEW: Ceasefires in the Time of COVID-19 – Siri Camilla Aas Rustad, Tora Sagård, Håvard Mokleiv Nygård, Govinda Clayton and Fredrik Methi, PRIO

The U.N. has appealed for a global coronavirus cease-fire – But is it possible to quarantine conflict? – Govinda Clayton, Washington Post

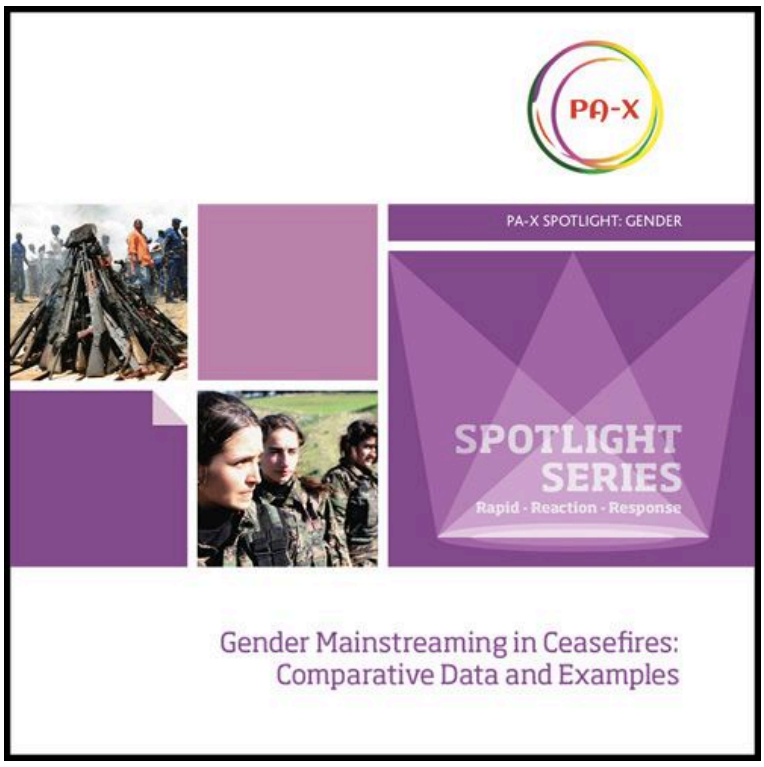
Update on the Secretary General's Appeal for A Global Ceasefire

Coronavirus: ceasefires and resolutions in project at UN

Calling for a global ceasefire – GPPAC

Ceasefires in Armed Conflicts during the Coronavirus Pandemic – ECP, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

Ceasefire Arrangements – Political Settlements Research Programme
When and how are ceasefires negotiated, and what are their critical elements? The Spotlight reviews core elements included in the 267 ceasefire agreements signed between 1990 and 2015 listed on the PA-X Peace Agreements Database.



Gender Mainstreaming in Ceasefires: Comparative Data and Examples – Political Settlements Research Programme
When and how have ceasefire agreements in armed conflict addressed women? Why should ceasefires include gender-specific provisions? Finally, what are the potential strategies for including women in ceasefire monitoring and implementation modalities?

Humanitarian Assistance and Gender Perspectives in Peace Agreements – Political Settlements Research Programme
When and how do peace processes provide for humanitarian assistance? Do peace agreements that provide for humanitarian assistance adopt a gender perspective?

6. Gender

NEW: ICAN's Statement on our Gender- and Conflict-Sensitive Response to COVID-19 – International Civil Society Action Network

Why Women's Rights Must be Central to the UN Security Council's Response to COVID-19 – NGO Working Group on Women, Peace and Security

Gender implications of COVID-19 outbreaks in development and humanitarian settings – Care

Research Report: Impact of COVID-19 Pandemic on Violence against Women and Girls – Erika Fraser, DFID VAWG

COVID-19: Emerging gender data and why it matters – UN Women

Why we need gender perspectives in our global solutions to COVID-19 – Claire Dowling, EIP

Women Peace and Security in the Time of Corona – Sanam Naraghi Anderlini, LSE Centre for Women, Peace and Security (Women Peace and Security blog)

Waging a war against a virus is not what we need to be doing – Cynthia Enloe, WILPF

Women in Bangladesh promote hygiene in refugee camps amid coronavirus fears – Thomson Reuters Foundation News

Covid-19: Militarise or Organise? – Ray Acheson, Women's International League for Peace and Freedom

Pandemics in Crisis-Affected Settings: Ensuring Women & Girls Are Not Forgotten – Alina Potts, GIWPS

Gendering COVID-19: Implications for Women, Peace and Security – Sini Ramo, LSE

7. International Influence and Mediation of Peace Processes

What the Pandemic Means for UN Peacekeeping Work – Robert Ulrich Nagel and Melanne Verveer, PassBlue

Digital Technologies and Mediation Toolkit – United Nations Peacemaker

What the UN Security Council Can Do on Coronavirus: A Global Goods Coordination Mechanism – Rob Berschinski, Human Rights First (Just Security)

How coronavirus is accelerating a new approach to international cooperation – Annalisa Prizzon, Overseas Development Institute

Coronavirus Puts Systems for International Cooperation to the Test – William J. Long, J USIP

U.N. Security Council Paralyzed as Contagion Rages – Colum Lynch, Foreign Policy

A message to the OSCE Community: We need solidarity and co-operation, OSCE core values, to work together to stop the pandemic – OSCE

8. Role of Research and Expertise

Impact evaluations in the time of Covid-19, Part 1 – Markus Goldstein, Florence Kondylis, World Bank
More relevant World Bank blogs about alternative ways of collecting data and conducting evaluations include: Dialing for Data: The Story of a High Frequency Phone Survey in Liberia (Kristen Himelein), and Calling it in: using phones for repeat surveys (Markus Goldstein).

COVID-19 – the social science response to the pandemic – IDS

Covid-19 – a social phenomenon requiting diverse expertise – Hayley Macgregor, Melissa Leach, Annie Wilkinson, and Melissa Parker, Institute of Development Studies (IDS blog)

Fill the gaps, feel the pain: Insights from Sierra Leone on an epidemic's impact on local taxation, public services, and the poor – Vanessa van den Boogaard, International Centre for Tax and Development (ICTD blog)

9. Human Rights

Explainer: Seven ways the coronavirus affects human rights – Amnesty International

COVID-19: A Human Rights Checklist – Human Rights Watch

10. Countries

10.1 Afghanistan

Interview with Barnett R. Rubin on the crisis of Afghan war politics, and Covid-19 – TOLOnews

How to keep Coronavirus from hampering the peace process in Afghanistan – Barnett R. Rubin, Responsible Statecraft

The regional dimension of Covid-19's interaction with war and peace in Afghanistan – Responsible Statecraft

An Ailing America Must Not Abandon Afghanistan – Foreign Policy

Coronavirus Poses Yet Another Challenge to the Afghan Peace Process – Scott Smith, USIP

Only Peace Can Avert a COVID-19 Catastrophe in Afghanistan – M. Ashraf Haidari, Ambassador of Afghanistan to Sri Lanka

10.2 Kosovo

Kosovo's Ousted Government, Secret Deals, and War Crimes Charges – Balkan Transitional Justice

10.3 Sudan

Coronavirus reaches Sudan, one of the countries least equipped to cope with it – Mark Weston

Can there be a democratic public health? From HIV Aids to Covid-19

10.4 Yemen

Yemen coronavirus lockdown to hamper relief effort – The New Humanitarian

A Coronavirus Ceasefire Offers A Way Out for War-Torn Yemen – Crisis Group

10.5 Venezuela

Steve Hege on Venezuela and Colombia During Coronavirus – Steve Hege, USIP

Venezuela Urgently Needs a Humanitarian Accord that Prioritizes Life and Dignity – Feliciano Reyna Ganteaume

10.6 Sri Lanka

Assessing Sri Lanka's response to COVID-19 – The Alliance of Independent Professionals

Update on Sri Lanka's Response to COVID-19 – The Alliance of Independent Professionals

10.7 Israel-Palestine

Could the coronavirus bring peace among Israelis and Palestinians? – Iona Hirsch, The Jerusalem Post

US: Coronavirus cooperation proof Israeli-Palestinian peace talks possible – Tovah Lazaroff, The Jerusalem Post

10.8 Ukraine

Opinion: The Coronavirus Crisis Presents An Opportunity To End War In Ukraine – William B. Taylor, Steven Piper, John E. Herbst, NPR

In Frontline Ukraine, Global Pandemic Puts People at Unimaginable Risk – Igor Mitchnik, Open Democracy

10.9 Somalia

How Will Remittances Affect the Somali COVID-19 Response? – Nisar Majid, Laura Hammond, Khalif Abdirahman, Guhad Adan and Nauja Kleis

10.10 Nigeria

Benue, Taraba government sign peace agreement over Tiv/Jukun crisis – NAN, The Guardian Nigeria

Nigeria Should Build Peace Like it Fights Coronavirus – Oge Onubogu, USIP

10.11 Colombia

Steve Hege on Venezuela and Colombia During Coronavirus – Steve Hege, USIP

Colombia hopes for 'humanitarian' ceasefire during coronavirus as violence resurges – Shauna N Gillooly, The Conversation

10.12 Ethiopia

Ethiopia: Political Momentum for Peace and Human Rights?– The KOFF Peacebuilding Magazine

10.13 Pakistan

Pakistan's Looming Coronavirus Crisis – Cyril Almeida, Richard Olson, USIP

10.14 El Salvador

In El Salvador, gangs are enforcing the coronavirus lockdown with baseball bats – Kate Linthicum, Molly O'Toole, Alexander Renderos, Los Angeles Times

10.15 Philippines

Ex-MILF fighters harvest, donate 100 sacks of calamansi for COVID-19 fight in Isulan – Bong S. Sarmiento, Minda News

10.16 Thailand

Covid-19 ceasefire unlikely to hasten peace in Thailand's south – Craig Keating, The Interpreter

10.17 Libya

VIDEO: 'Which Death Is Going to Be Worse?' Coronavirus Invades a Conflict Zone – Haley Willis, Christiaan Triebert, Natalie Reneau and David Botti, The New York Times

Libya and pandemic politics in armed conflicts – Sherine El Taraboulsi-McCarthy, ODI

10.18 Lebanon

COVID-19: Seven trends that will shape peacebuilding in Lebanon – Ruth Simpson, International Alert

Back to Top

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/03/25/conflict-development-and-covid-19-resources/

2020-03-24 / RESEARCH RESPONSES TO CURRENT EVENTS

COVID-19 and Violent Conflict

PSRP's Programme Director, Christine Bell, writes about designing the most effective responses to the COVID-19 pandemic in impoverished, conflict-affected regions.

https://pixabay.com/photos/corona-world-mask-virus-disease-4912807/

Just Security has published a blog by PSRP Director Christine Bell, on the ways in which conflict, peace processes and COVID-19 responses can be expected to affect each other. She argues the while crisis affects conflict in unpredictable ways, and vice versa, some of the dynamics can be predicted and planned for. The blog argues for conflict sensitive approaches to health interventions, and an approach to delivering healthcare responses also with an eye on the opportunities for peace.

The article offers 11 baseline understandings that are likely to be key in designing the most effective responses to the COVID-19 pandemic in conflict-affected regions.

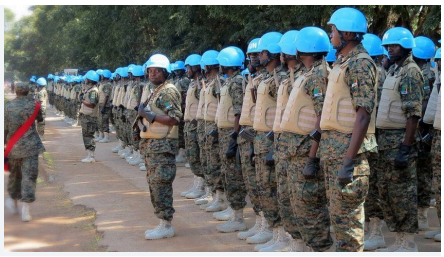
Read the full article at Just Security.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/03/24/covid-19-and-violent-conflict/

2020-02-28 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Peacekeeping in a New Conflict Resolution Age

> "My analysis is that stabilization is toxic for UN peacekeeping because the more successfully these operations stabilize, the less incentive ruling elites have for seeking a political settlement. The result is a no peace/no war stalemate, which leaves the UN with no exit path." Cedric de Coning



These soldiers were trying out their new UN peacekeeping uniforms prior to deploying to the Central African Republic as part of the UN MINUSCA mission. Photo: Tsidoti / CC BY-SA Read More

Today we launch two pieces on peacekeeping, relating to political settlement and inclusion. In different ways both point to the new global marketplace of political change.

First, in Principled Peacekeeping Works, a guest blog post that synthesises new data and analysis on peacekeeping, Cedric de Coning examines the effectiveness of peacekeeping operations as implementation mechanisms in peace processes. In particular, he notes a shift in peacekeeping in providing a 'stabilisation' function, which he argues is a more major departure from existing operations than has been contemplated, with new risks.

Second, in Breaking the Balance? The Impact of Peacekeeping Deployments on Civil–Military Relations, PSRP doctoral student Monalisa Adhikari examines how a shift in UN Peacekeeping forces to using troops from developing countries impacts on the on the domestic politics of troop

contributing countries, some of whom will be engaged in their own transitions. She provides a detailed case study of Nepal.

> "The UN has not prioritized making peacekeeping deployments conditional on respect for civilian supremacy by the security forces of troop contributing countries. Yet, deploying peacekeepers may bring significant institutional, political and financial benefits to security forces, most notably the military, which directly and indirectly impacts the civil–military relations in troop contributing countries." Monalisa Adhikari

Read now:

Cedric de Coning: Principled Peacekeeping Works

Monalisa Adhikari: Breaking the Balance? The Impact of Peacekeeping Deployments on Civil–Military Relations

Photo: Tsidoti / CC BY-SA

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/02/28/peacekeeping-in-a-new-conflict-resolution-age/

2020-02-05 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Introducing PA-X Peace Agreements Database, Version 3

A new version of the PA-X Peace Agreements Database is now live at www.peaceagreements.org.

With this Version 3 release, PA-X remains the most expansive and complete online archive, database, and dataset of peace agreements.

New Peace Agreement Documents from 2019

This new release expands the database to cover all of 2019, as well as some documents that have been made available in 2019, for a total of 34 new documents – bringing the total in the PA-X database to 1823 documents. As always, these are coded for all of substantive and contextual categories that PA-X offers, and can be searched and downloaded in multiple formats.

Visualizing Peace

To all of these resources, we now add a suite of visualisations that show the full variety of peace agreements across time, space, and issues of contention. This is a fascinating resource for exploring PA-X data on peace agreements and learning about how peace processes unfold.

This is a great accomplishment by the fantastic PA-X team, who will continue their work compiling and coding peace agreements throughout 2020, as new agreements are signed and made publicly available.

About PA-X

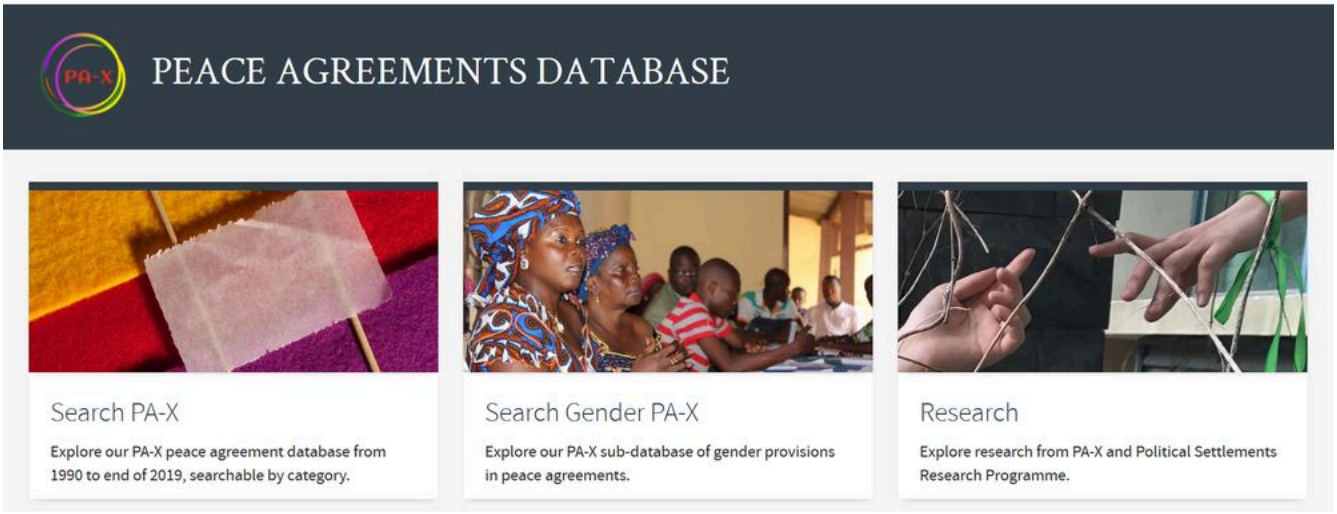
The PA-X Peace Agreements Database is a database and repository of peace agreements from 1990 to 2019. PA-X provides a comprehensive dataset of peace agreements capable of underpinning both quantitative and qualitative research. PA-X has been designed to provide easy access to peace agreement texts and to allow users to explore patterns of agreements over time, both within processes and across processes.

It aims to be accessible to:

- mediators and parties in conflict seeking to understand how compromise can be crafted
- civic actors seeking to influence on-going peace talks and proposals
- social science researchers interested in understanding peace agreements quantitatively and qualitatively.

Explore the PA-X Peace Agreements Database now.

Read our PA-X Publication Series which draws on PA-X data.



Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/02/05/introducing-pa-x-peace-agreements-database-version-3/

2020-01-27 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

New report uses PA-X data to envision a peace agreement for Afghanistan

The RAND Corporation has published a new research report, Envisioning a Comprehensive Peace Agreement for Afghanistan, which presents a plausible final comprehensive peace agreement for Afghanistan, based in part on data from the PSRP's PA-X Peace Agreements Database.

The report includes analysis of realistic compromises, presented in the form of a complete peace agreement text. Authors Laurel E. Miller and Jonathan S. Blake produced the text on the basis of research on the interests and views of the conflict parties, comparative research on past peace agreements from around the world, and extensive consultations with officials, former officials, and experts associated with all the parties and with other interested governments. This research includes a

comparative analysis of peace agreements that relies heavily on data from the PA-X Peace Agreements Database, as presented in Chapter 4.

PSRP welcomes this new report and is pleased to see PA-X being used as a resource in this way.

Report summary:

> Throughout years of halting attempts to negotiate an end to the war in Afghanistan, the conflict parties have articulated only the barest outlines of envisioned outcomes. By not spelling out their preferred terms for peace, the parties have reinforced resistance to a peace process and fed fears of what compromise with the enemy might bring. An effective peace process will require filling this gap. With the aim of sparking the imaginations of policymakers on all sides of the conflict and others interested in encouraging negotiations, this report paints a detailed picture of a plausible political settlement.
>
> To provide concrete ideas and options for the results of peace talks, the authors chose to write an agreement rather than write about one, translating their research and analysis into the format of a comprehensive peace accord. They researched the conflict parties' probable goals in a peace process, studied past peace agreements for Afghanistan and for many other countries around the world, and conducted confidential consultations with people associated with the parties, interested governments, and experts. The agreement text lays out realistic compromises on the most important issues that could satisfy the parties' interests and stand some chance of actually being implemented.

Download Envisioning a Comprehensive Peace Agreement for Afghanistan for free from the RAND website.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/01/27/new-report-uses-pa-x-data-to-envision-a-peace-agreement-for-afghanistan/

2020-01-08 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Founding Women dialogue: perspectives from women constitution makers (video)

International IDEA and the Political Settlements Research Programme hosted the first annual Women Constitution Makers Dialogue in Edinburgh in October 2019. This historic event brought together women who have played an instrumental role in constitution-building in The Gambia, Tunisia, Egypt, Nepal, Kenya, Hungary, South Africa, Syria, South Sudan, Northern Ireland, the Philippines, and the Maldives. In a new video produced by PSRP, event participants share their experiences of

navigating gender and social transformation in a variety of contexts and discuss the importance of women's participation in constitution building.

During the dialogue, discussions ranged from the conceptual frameworks on women's participation, representation, and influence in constitution making processes, to real-world case studies of successes and challenges in identifying and negotiating political inclusion and the strategic interests of women.

Following the success of the event, participants plan to establish a Global Network of Women Constitution Makers to elevate the role of women in constitution making. The annual dialogue will serve as a network forum wherein women constitution-makers, peacebuilders, researchers and international advisors can examine country-level experiences, exchange ideas, and increase the visibility of women constitution makers globally. To get involved, email us at politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk.

Watch Founding Women: A dialogue with women constitution makers now.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2020/01/08/founding-women-dialogue-video/

2019

9 stories · Full original text

2019-12-16 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Explore global peace processes with our new interactive infographics

PSRP has launched a new series of interactive infographics about global peace processes and political settlements.

The first in the series, Peace Processes, compiles key information about peace agreements and how they fit into wider peace processes around the world. Peace Processes is the first in a series of interactive infographics that will be published in 2020, including gender perspectives, political power-sharing, amnesties, and transitional justice. We hope these tools will facilitate research on peacemaking so that new ways of attempting to resolve intractable conflicts in deeply divided places can be developed in a way that maximises social justice.

The data in these infographics is drawn from our own PA-X Peace Agreement Database, a database and repository of peace agreements from 1990 to 2018 that is capable of underpinning both qualitative and quantitative research.

The interactive infographics expand our existing library of infographics, which includes static (pdf) versions of all of our infographics in English and Arabic. Explore all PSRP infographics here.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/12/16/explore-global-peace-processes-with-our-new-interactive-infographics/

2019-12-11 / EVENTS HELD

PRSP jointly hosts two-day workshop on interim governance arrangements

On 9 and 10 December 2019, International IDEA, the Edinburgh Centre for Constitutional Law (ECCL), the Global Justice Academy (GJA), in association with the Political Settlements Research Programme (PSRP) of the University of Edinburgh, and with support from the UK Department for International Development, held the sixth Edinburgh Dialogue on Post-Conflict Constitution Building. This year's theme was 'Interim Governance Arrangements in Post-Conflict and Fragile Settings', with the second day entirely dedicated to Sudan's and South Sudan's current transitional governance arrangements.

A total of 29 high-level experts and practitioners from around the world participated in the two-day workshop to discuss challenges of constitution building in conflict-to-peace transitions. The workshop was divided into two main sections: most of the first day comprised overviews from comparative experts and practitioners who sought to address questions and issues related to interim governance arrangements, including challenges in power-sharing arrangements. The second day focused on these challenges with special attention to Sudan and South Sudan, and where comparative research might point the way to inspiration or options to inform decision-making. Discussions between participants from Sudan and South Sudan as well as high-level international partners during this event ranged from current implementation challenges of a transitional government, the role of civil society in this transitional phase, to contentious issues in the constitution making process, and the role of international actors.

A final policy report will include key insights as to the factors contributing to, and consequences resulting from, particular forms and types of interim governance arrangements. Policy papers arising from each of the Edinburgh Dialogues can be found here.

Photo credit: Hannah den Boer

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/12/11/prsp-jointly-hosts-two-day-workshop-on-interim-governance-arrangements/

2019-12-09 / EVENTS HELD

PSRP, ASPR and RVI host Local Peace Processes Workshop in Nairobi

On 25 November 2019, the Political Settlements Research Programme, the Austrian Study Center for Peace and Conflict Resolution and the Rift Valley Institute hosted a Joint Analysis Workshop on local peace processes in Nairobi, Kenya.

The workshop brought together leading researchers, peace-builders, mediators, and representatives from the United Nations, the UK Department for International Development, the Intergovernmental Authority on Development, the London School of Economics Conflict Research Programme, and the Foreign and Commonwealth Office. Speakers included practitioners working within and to support local peace processes in Central African Republic, Democratic Republic of Congo, Kenya, Ethiopia, Somalia, South Sudan. A report of findings from this workshop and an earlier Joint Analysis Workshop held in London will be published with the British Academy in 2020.

An initial PSRP publication by Laura Wise, Robert Forster, and Christine Bell on the opportunities and challenges for women's engagement in local peace processes is now open access and free to download. The PA-X Local Peace Agreements Database is expected to be published in early 2020.

During the trip to Nairobi, PSRP researchers Christine Bell, Tim Epple, Jan Pospisil, Rebecca Sutton, and Laura Wise also held several bilateral sessions with policymakers to share findings from PSRP research and the PA-X Peace Agreements Database relating to the Horn of Africa region. A new policy memo on the delayed political settlement in South Sudan co-produced by LSE CRP and PSRP is now available to download.

Photo credit: Laura Wise

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/12/09/psrp-aspr-and-rvi-host-local-peace-processes-workshop-in-nairobi/

2019-12-06 / PARTNERSHIPS & PROCESS SUPPORT

PSRP and Oklahoma State University collaborate on global security governance project

Dr Brooke Coe, Assistant Professor at Oklahoma State University, recently undertook a research visit to Edinburgh to work on a new project with the PSRP.

Dr Coe and PSRP Research Fellow, Dr Kathryn Nash, are embarking on a major project to explore the changing nature of global security governance. They are looking at to what degree and in what capacity do global and (sub)regional organisations engage in peace processes in order to understand the role international actors play in transitions away from conflict. This research will add to our understanding of regional and international security governance at a point when the world is becoming increasingly multipolar and when there are moves in several regions to develop policies and practices of subsidiarity.

As part of her visit, Dr Coe met with a number of academics from the University of Edinburgh as well as with the Law School Research Office to help to establish institutional connections between the University of Edinburgh and Oklahoma State University.

Dr Coe earned her BA and PhD from the University of Minnesota. She conducts research and teaches at the intersection of comparative politics and international relations, and her interests include

comparative regional law and organisations in the Global South, state sovereignty and international interventions, and transitional justice. Her work has been published in Global Governance and Global Responsibility to Protect, and her book Sovereignty in the South was recently published with Cambridge University Press.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/12/06/psrp-collaborates-with-oklahoma-state-university-on-global-security-governance-project/

2019-11-28 / EVENTS HELD

Dr Kathryn Nash speaks about using PA-X to inform international policy-making

Dr. Kathryn Nash of the PSRP spoke about the use of PA-X Peace Agreements Database for informing international policy-making at a recent knowledge exchange event.

The event, 'Learning Lunch: Engaging with Policymakers Internationally', took place on 21 November 2019 and included three panellists: Dr Sole Garcia Ferrari (ECA), Dr Sam Spiegel (SSPS) and Dr Kathryn Nash (Law). The researchers shared experiences on their involvement with policymakers drawing from wide-ranging fieldwork and work experiences in respectively Columbia and Mexico; Zimbabwe and Indonesia; and Africa. They discussed the challenges that come with the engagement of policy-making informed by academic research and offered suggestions for overcoming these challenges.

Having worked with policymakers as a diplomat before embarking on an academic career, Dr. Nash's experience offered a unique perspective on this topic. During the event Dr. Nash illustrated the use of PA-X Peace Agreements Database to engage directly with international policymakers who are involved in peace building processes. In addition, the importance of successful collaborations with local communities was stressed when informing policy-making. The event ended with a Q&A session.

The event was part of the Knowledge Exchange Learning Lunch series held by Edinburgh Research Office.

A blog post on the event is forthcoming on our website.

Photo: Hannah den Boer

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/11/28/dr-kathryn-nash-speaks-about-using-pa-x-to-inform-international-policy-making/

2019-11-27 / EVENTS HELD

Dr Kathryn Nash represents PSRP at Knowledge Frontiers Symposium

PSRP Postdoctoral Research Fellow Dr Kathryn Nash attended the UK-Australia Knowledge Frontiers Symposium hosted by The British Academy (BA) in partnership with the Australian Academy of the Humanities (AAH) held from 10-11 November 2019 in Brisbane, Australia. The Symposium brought together early career academics from the United Kingdom (UK), Australia, and the Pacific to discuss questions around the theme of the 'The Future' and the co-production of knowledge. It included an opportunity to apply for seed funding to solidify collaborations between academics from the UK and academics from Australia and the Pacific. This event is part of a series of Knowledge Frontiers Symposia hosted by the BA.

As part of her trip, Dr Nash also attended a workshop on engagement with policymakers led by Professor Karen Hussey, Director of the Centre for Policy Futures at the University of Queensland. She also attended the AAH 50th Symposium on 'Humanising the Future'. The Symposium provided a forum to discuss how humanities scholars can help ensure new and emerging technologies best serve humanity, the environment, and society. It also provided an opportunity to discuss the future of the humanities discipline in a rapidly changing world and academic sector.

Photo: Kathryn Nash

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/11/27/psrp-represented-at-knowledge-frontiers-symposium/

2019-11-13 / EVENTS HELD

Journalism conference examines role of the media in divided societies

On November 8 and 9 2019, the Social Change Initiative in partnership with Conciliation Resources and the Political Settlements Research Programme hosted a conference on the role of the media in deeply divided societies.

The Belfast-based event brought together journalists, peace building practitioners, policy makers, activists, and funders to examine the challenges involved and to consider solutions. More than 25 speakers from Myanmar, the Balkans, Rwanda, Colombia, Kashmir, South Africa, Nepal, Turkey and Northern Ireland considered the role of the media in deeply divided societies, what role social media is playing and how societies should respond, the role of the media in peace agreements around the world, and ways to encourage good practice.

Among the speakers, the PSRP's Christine Bell and Tim Epple presented new research on the role of the media in peace agreements around the world.

Read the full media conference programme and list of conference speakers.

A Twitter thread of highlights from the event hashtag, #SCImedia is now available here: #SCImedia thread.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/11/13/journalism-conference-examines-role-of-the-media-in-divided-societies/

2019-10-31 / RESEARCH CITED OR USED

PSRP research informs UN report on Women, Peace and Security

Research by the Political Settlements Research Programme has informed a new UN report on Women, Peace and Security.

The new report from the UN Secretary General, published on 9 October 2019, sets out the continued importance of the women, peace and security agenda and calls for the UN and its member states to strengthen efforts towards implementation. The report cites data from the PSRP's PA-X Peace Agreements Database on inclusion of gender references in peace agreements, which shows that between 1990 and 2018, only 353 of 1,789 agreements (19.7 per cent) included provisions addressing women, girls or gender.

The same PSRP statistics were also partially quoted on 29 October 2019 by the UN Under-Secretary-General and Executive Director of UN Women, Phumzile Mlambo-Ngcuka, at the UN Security Council Open Debate on Women, Peace and Security in New York, who stated that less than 20 percent of peace agreements included provisions addressing women or gender. Her full remarks are available here. The Washington Post has also featured the debate and the PSRP data.

During the debate the United Nations Security Council unanimously adopted Resolution 2493 urging member states to implement the women, peace and security agenda and calling on member states to ensure and promote the full, equal and meaningful participation of women in all stages of peace processes.

Resolution 2493 builds on the commitments made 19 years ago by UN Security Council Resolution 1325, which acknowledged the disproportionate impact of armed conflict on women and girls and calls on member states to adopt a gender perspective in conflict resolution.

Photo credit: UN Photo

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/10/31/psrp-research-informs-un-report-on-women-peace-and-security/

2019-10-28 / EVENTS HELD

International IDEA and PSRP host historic gathering of women constitution makers

On 24 and 25 October 2019, International IDEA and the Political Settlements Research Programme hosted the inaugural Women Constitution Makers Dialogue in Edinburgh.

This historic event brought together women from around the world who have played an instrumental role in constitution-building in The Gambia, Tunisia, Egypt, Nepal, Kenya, Hungary, South Africa, Syria, South Sudan, Northern Ireland, the Philippines, and the Maldives.

Participants shared their experiences of navigating gender and social transformation in a variety of contexts. Discussions ranged from the conceptual frameworks on women's participation, representation, and influence in constitution making processes, to real-world case studies of successes and challenges in identifying and negotiating political inclusion and the strategic interests of women. A short video featuring interviews with participants is forthcoming.

Following the success of the event, participants plan to establish a Global Network of Women Constitution Makers, which will meet annually to elevate the role of women in constitution making. Interested in getting involved? Email us at politicalsettlements@ed.ac.uk.

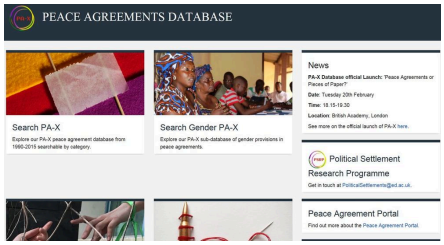
Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2019/10/28/psrp-and-international-idea-host-historic-gathering-of-women-constitution-makers/

2018

1 stories · Full original text

2018-02-21 / NEW RESEARCH, DATA & TOOLS

Why PA-X Matters: Introducing the Peace Agreements Access Tool



In this short post, University of Edinburgh Law School Postdoctural Researcher, Kathryn Nash, outlines the relevance of PA-X, how it has shaped PSRP research to date, and how you can use tool.

The PA-X Peace Agreements Database launched on 20 February 2018. PA-X is the largest dataset of its kind to date, containing more than 1500 agreements from over 140 peace processes between 1990 and 2015. PA-X was created for academics and policymakers as part of the PSRP. It can be used by mediators seeking to understand how compromise has been crafted in past processes, civil society and policy actors seeking to influence peace processes, and academics undertaking both quantitative and qualitative research.

Prior to its official launch, PA-X was used by researchers at the Political Settlements Research Programme to produce cutting-edge research. The PRSP Report Navigating Inclusion in Peace Settlements highlights the difficulties of using peace settlements to address underlying causes of conflict while also making concrete observations about the best entry points during processes to address human rights and create a more inclusive political order. Additionally, researchers have produced several case studies on peace processes in specific countries, including Bosnia-Herzegovina, Burundi, and Egypt.

Users can search agreements in PA-X by region, country, agreement name, or agreement content. The database allows users to search for agreements with provisions from over 200 subcategories, such as gender, power-sharing, or justice reform. It is designed to make peace agreements easily accessible for academics conducting research or policymakers searching for example provisions.

You can watch a video detailing the PA-X search capabilities below, and you can download the complete codebook here.

After you explore our database, we invite feedback, comments, suggestions, and ideas that would help us make the next version even better. We are particularly interested to hear if there are any documents that you think should be part of PA-X, or if you find that there is scope for cooperation. We

would also like to know if the PA-X data are being used in other research projects, or if they have inspired similar endeavours.

Get in touch at PoliticalSettlements@ed.ac.uk, send us a Tweet @PolSettlements, post on our Facebook page @PolSettlements, and follow #paxfax on Twitter for facts from our data.

Original News post: https://peacerep.org/2018/02/21/introducing-pax/